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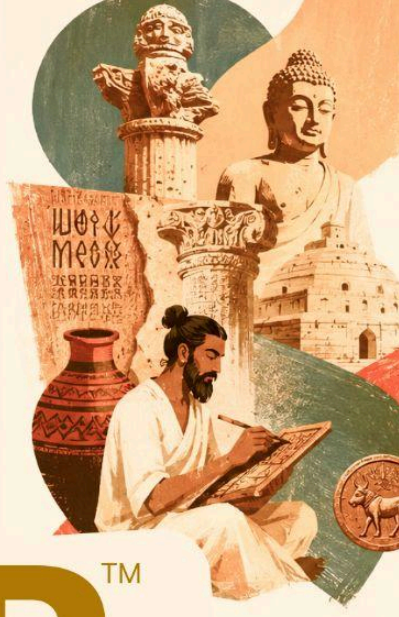

Revised & Updated *for*

UPSC MAINS 2027

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- **14 Yrs PYQs**: Key Microthemes Mapped
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Ancient, Medieval And Art & Culture

General Studies Paper - I

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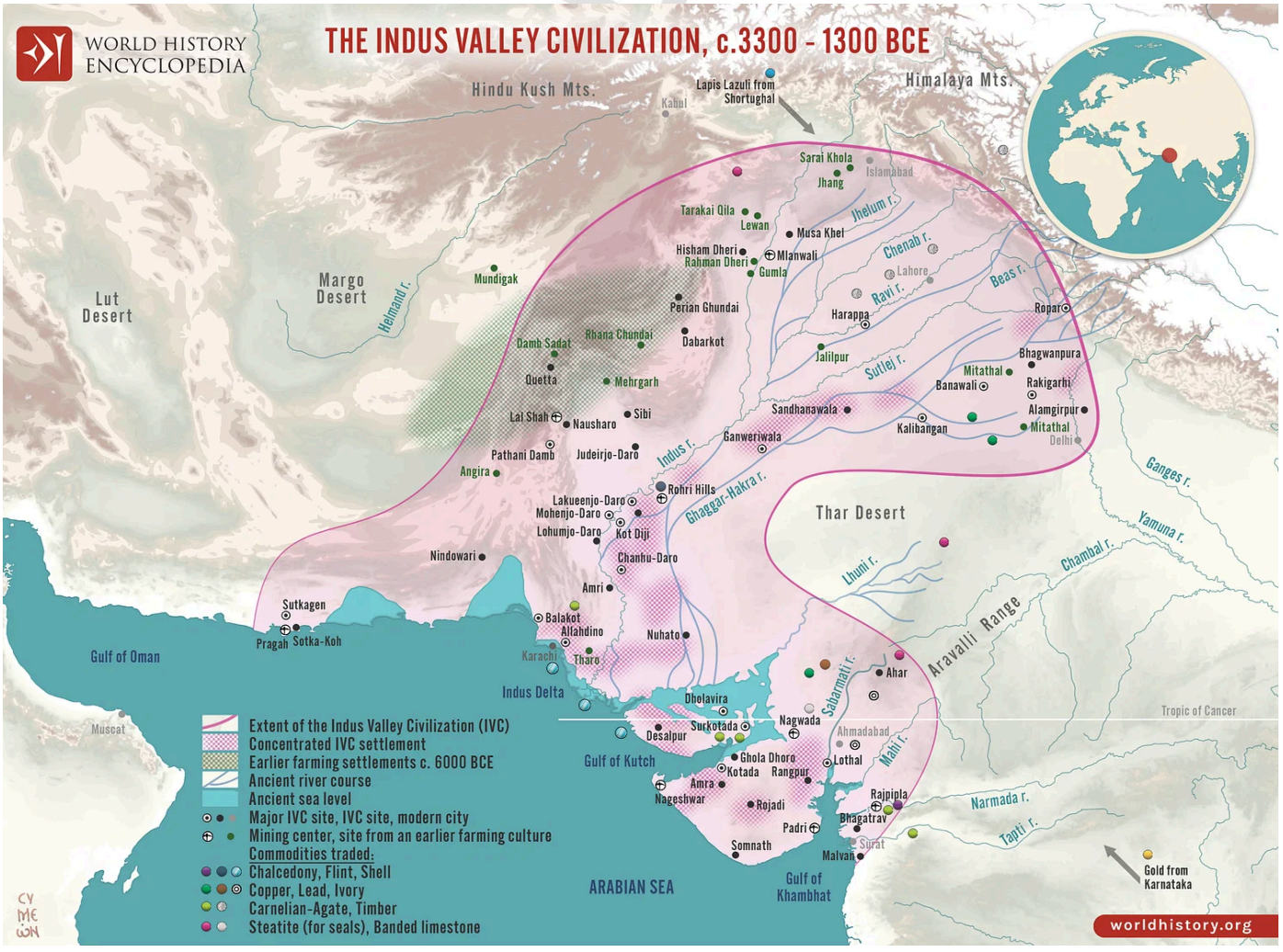
Chapter 1

Prehistory & the Vedic Age

PYQs

[2024] Underline the changes in the field of society and economy from the Rig Vedic to the later Vedic period. (10)
[2015] The ancient civilization in the Indian sub-continent differed from those of Egypt, Mesopotamia and Greece in that its culture and traditions have been preserved without a breakdown to the present day. Comment. (12.5)
[2014] To what extent has the urban planning and culture of the Indus Valley Civiliza- tion provided inputs to the present day urbanization? Discuss. (10)

Harappan civilization



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1. Harappa civilization also known as 'Indus Valley Civilisation' was discovered first at Harappa in modern day Punjab province of Pakistan in 1921 by Daya Ram Sahni. It is identified as a Bronze-age civilization because many objects have been found that are made up of copper-based alloys.
2. **Location:** North-western regions of Indian subcontinent. It spans across 2,000 sites in India, Pakistan, and Afghanistan. Most of the sites are located between Indus and Saraswati River basins.
3. **Extent of Civilization:** Daimabad in Maharashtra (Southernmost), Alamgirpur in UP (Easternmost), Sutgakendor in Pakistan (Westernmost), and Manda in Jammu (Northernmost).
4. **Time-Period:** It flourished from 6000 BCE to 1300 BCE. The archaeological findings reveal the gradual development of the Harappan culture.
   a. Early Harappan (6000 BCE-2600 BCE) is a formative phase of the civilisation.
   b. Mature Harappan (2600 BCE-1900 BCE), the urban phase of the civilization, represents its most prosperous period.
   c. This decadent phase (1900 BCE-1300 BCE) is termed as Late Harappan.

Major Sites & Findings

Site/city	Location	Discovered/Excavated by	Major Findings
Harappa	Pakistan	Daya Ram Sahni in 1921	Red sandstone Male torso, Stone symbols of Lingam, Granaries, Mother Goddess etc.
Mohenjo-Daro	Pakistan	R D Banerjee in 1922	Town Planning, Citadels, Drainage system, Great Bath
Ganweriwala	Cholistan area of Pakistan	Rafique Mughal in 1973	Terracotta unicorn figurines, Twisted clay tablet with Indus script etc.
Rakhigarhi	Haryana in India	First discovered in the 1960s by the Archeological Survey of India.	Granary, cemetery, drains, terracotta bricks.
Dholavira	Rann of Kachchh (Gujarat)	Jagat Pati Joshi in 1968	Unique water harnessing system and its storm water drainage system, only site divided in 3 parts, Megalithic stone circle.
Lothal	Gujrat	S Rao in 1955	Dockyard, fire altars

Key Features of Harappa Civilization

Town planning and Architecture	• **Archaeologists Mortimer Wheeler and Stuart Piggott** noted the **uniformity in Harappan town planning** despite its ancient origins. • **Rectangular Grid Pattern**

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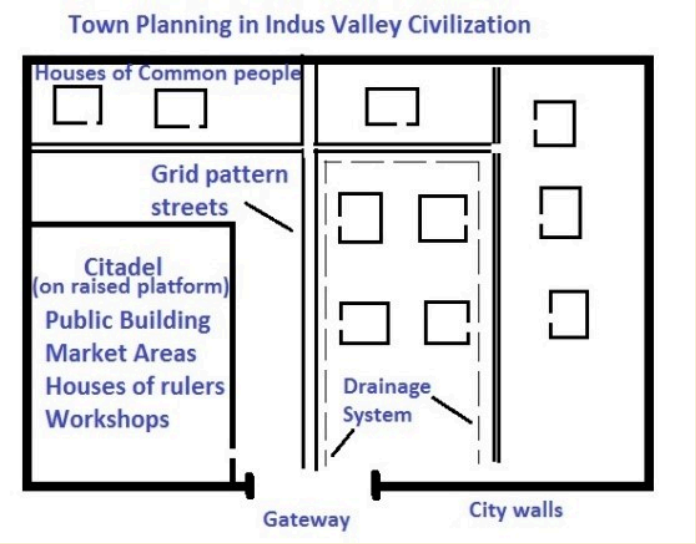
	• **Planned layout** with streets running **north-south and east-west**, forming a **grid pattern**.
	• Streets intersected at **right angles**, dividing the city into **rectangular blocks**.
	• **Main streets** were connected by **narrow lanes**.
	• **House doors opened into lanes**, not main roads, ensuring privacy.
	• Planned Streets and Alleyways in Harappan Cities
	  ○ **Main street (~10 meters wide)** divided the town into **rectangular and square blocks**.
	  ○ **Wide enough** to accommodate carts and pedestrians.
	  ○ **Some streets had covered drains** running alongside for sanitation.
	• **Urban Planning**: Consistent layout in houses, temples, granaries, and streets; most cities had a **raised citadel in the west** and a **lower town in the east**, except **Lothal**.
	• **Building Materials**: **Baked bricks** were used in **Harappa and Mohenjodaro**, while **Kalibangan** primarily relied on **mud bricks**; some sites had **stone structures**.
	• **Great Bath (Mohenjodaro)**: A **watertight brick tank** with **gypsum lining**, **staircases**, and **changing rooms**, indicating advanced public architecture.
	• **Granaries**: Largest structures, with **six granaries in Harappa** and a **massive storage complex in Mohenjodaro**; Harappa also had **two-roomed barracks** and **grain threshing floors**.
	• **Drainage System**: Well-developed with **private courtyards, bathrooms, and drainage outlets**; **covered street drains** with **manholes** for maintenance.
	• **Water Management**: **Kalibangan** had **numerous private wells**, reflecting an advanced water supply system
	• **Sanitation & Hygiene**: Harappan cities prioritized **health and sanitation**, surpassing other **Bronze Age civilizations** in urban cleanliness.
	 

Agriculture	• **Agricultural Practices**: Fields were **ploughed using a wooden ploughshare**. • **Main Crops**: **Wheat, rice, millets, barley, lentils, chickpeas, and sesame** were cultivated. **Harappans were the earliest to produce cotton**, known to the Greeks as **Sindon**.

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	• **Domesticated Animals**: **Oxen, buffaloes, goats, sheep, pigs, dogs, cats, asses, humped bulls, and camels** were domesticated. • **Wildlife Awareness**: **Elephants and rhinoceroses** were well known to them.
Trade and Commerce	• **Standardized Trade System**: **Weights and measures** were standardized, ensuring efficient trade and commerce. • **Foreign Trade Partners**: Conducted trade with **Mesopotamia, Afghanistan, and Iran**. • **Indus Region in Mesopotamian Records**: Known as **Meluha**, with **Dilmun (Bahrain)** and **Makan (Makran coast)** as intermediate trading stations. • **Exports**: **Grain, jewelry, and pottery** were major export items. • **Imports**: Primarily **thin copper and precious stones** from foreign regions.
Religion & Culture	• **Nature Worship**: **Trees (Eg. Pipal) and animals** were revered. • **Male Deity**: Worshipped **Pasupati (Proto-Shiva)**, depicted on seals in a **yogic posture**. • **Female Deity**: **Mother Goddess**, represented in **terracotta figurines**. • **Phallic Worship**: **Linga worship** was prevalent. • **Absence of Temples**: No **temples** have been found at any Harappan site.
Writing System	• **Pictographic Script**: Followed the **boustrophedon style** - written **right to left** in one line and **left to right** in the next. **Undeciphered Script**: The script remains **undeciphered** to date.

Architecture of Harappan Civilization

Great Bath at Mohenjo Daro

1. **Earliest Public Water Tank**: The **Great Bath of Mohenjo Daro** is one of the **oldest known public water tanks**, showcasing **advanced urban planning**.
2. **Structure & Dimensions**: A **rectangular pool** measuring **12m long, 7m wide, and 2.4m deep**, located within a **spacious courtyard** surrounded by a **corridor on all four sides**.
3. **Access & Construction**: **Two flights of brick steps** on the **north and south** led into the bath. Built with **waterproof bricks bonded with gypsum mortar** for **water retention**.
4. **Purpose & Significance**: Likely used for **ritualistic or ceremonial bathing**, suggesting the **importance of water in religious or purification practices**.

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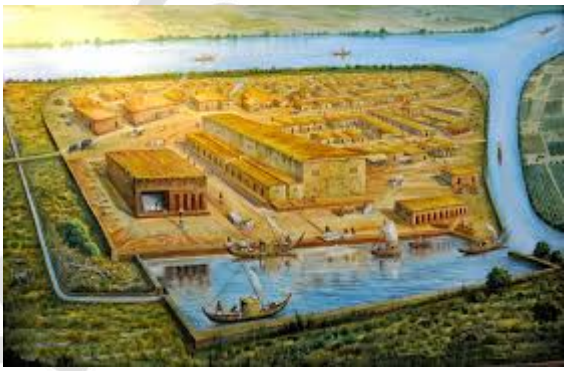
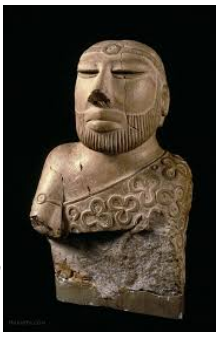
Great Granary at Mohenjo Daro

1. **Common Feature**: Granaries and **warehouses were present at multiple Harappan sites**, indicating an advanced **food storage and distribution system**.
2. **Largest Storage Facility**: The **Great Granary of Mohenjo Daro** is one of the **largest storage structures** of the **Indus Valley Civilization**, measuring **45m long and 15m wide**.
3. **Compartmentalized Storage**: The structure had **multiple compartments**, likely for storing **wheat, barley, and rice**, the staple crops of the civilization.
4. **Raised Platform**: Built on a **raised platform** to **prevent flood damage** and ensure **air circulation** for keeping grains dry.
5. **State-Controlled Storage**: Some scholars suggest these granaries were **state-controlled**, reflecting a **planned economic and administrative system**.



Dockyard at Lothal

1. **Major Port Town**: **Lothal**, in present-day **Gujarat**, was a key **maritime trade center** of the **Harappan civilization**.
2. **Strategic Location**: Situated in a **low deltaic region of Saurashtra**, it was once closer to the **sea**, making it an ideal **port location**.
3. **Oldest Dockyard**: Featured a **rectangular dockyard** (**37m long, 22m wide**), among the **oldest known dockyards**, connected to a **channel leading to the Sabarmati River** for ship movement.
4. **Trade Hub**: Facilitated **commerce with Mesopotamia, Persia, and other civilizations**, playing a significant role in **Harappan trade networks**.
5. **Artifacts & Trade Goods**: Excavations reveal **seals, beads, pottery**, indicating trade in **semi-precious stones, shell items, and cotton textiles**.

Art Forms	Feature
Stone statues	**Stone Sculptures** • **Three-Dimensional Stone Carvings**: The **Harappans excelled** in sculpting realistic **stone figures** with intricate details.**Red Sandstone Torso (Harappa)**: Depicts **detailed body contours**, showcasing advanced craftsmanship. • **Bust of a Bearded Man (Mohenjodaro, Steatite)**: Features **half-closed eyes**, a **fillet around the head**, and a **shawl adorned with trefoil motifs**, indicating refined artistic skills. 
Bronze Casting	**Lost-Wax Technique**: **Bronze figures** were crafted using the **'lost-wax' (cire-perdue) method**. Included both **human and animal representations**. • **Dancing Girl (Mohenjodaro)**: **10.5 cm bronze statue**, depicting a **confident young girl** with one hand on her hip, adorned with bangles. • **Bull (Kalibangan)**: Showcases **muscular strength and movement**. • **Copper dog and bird (Lothal)** - Indicating a tradition of metal figurine crafting

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Art Forms	Feature
Terracotta figures	**Common Medium**: **Terracotta figurines** were more abundant than **stone or metal sculptures.Handmade & Simpler**: These figures were **less refined**, contrasting with the **finely sculpted stone and bronze works**. • **Mother Goddess**: Symbol of **fertility**, with **broad hips and prominent breasts**. • **Male Figurines**: Depicted with **beards and coiled hair**, possibly **deities or priests**. • **Horned Deity Mask**: Suggests early **animal worship** traditions. • **Toy Carts with Wheels**: Indicate **transportation knowledge**. • **Whistles, Rattles & Animal Figurines**: Served as **children's toys**.

Seals	• **Material & Variety**: **Thousands of seals** found, mostly **steatite**, with some in **copper, faience, gold, ivory, and terracotta**.
	• **Design & Script**: Typically **rectangular or square**, featuring **engraved pictographic script** (undeciphered).
	• **Animal Motifs**: Common depictions include **unicorns, bulls, rhinoceroses, tigers, elephants, bison, goats, and buffaloes**.
	• **Religious Significance**: Some seals feature **human figures and deities**, indicating **spiritual or ritual use**.
	• **Functions**:
	  ○ Used for **trade authentication and record-keeping**.
	  ○ Worn as **amulets**, possibly serving as **identity markers**.
	• **Famous Seal**:
	  ○ **Pashupati Seal (Mohenjodaro)**: Depicts a **three-headed figure**, possibly an early **Shiva**, surrounded by **elephants, tigers, rhinoceroses, buffaloes, and antelopes**.

Pottery	**Wheel-Made Pottery**: **Advanced potter's wheels** were used, making wheel-made pottery the norm. **Main Types**: • **Plain Pottery**: Most common, made of **red clay**, used for **vases, pans, and storage vessels**. • **Painted Pottery**: Featured **black geometric, floral, and animal motifs** on a **red background**. **Special Varieties**: • **Polychrome Pottery**: Rare, found at select sites. • **Incised Pottery**: Decorated with **carved patterns**. • **Perforated Pottery**: Had a **large hole at the bottom** with **smaller holes along the walls**, likely used for **straining liquids**.

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Art Forms	Feature
Ornaments used by the Harrapans	**Indus Valley people wore a variety of ornaments**, crafted from **gold, silver, copper, semi-precious stones, and shells**. **Men and women adorned themselves with**: • **Necklaces, fillets, armlets, finger rings, earrings, and anklets**. • **Headbands and girdles**, sometimes made of gold. **Bead-making industry**: • Major centers at **Chanhudaro and Lothal**. • Beads were crafted from **cornelian, jasper, quartz, amethyst, steatite, turquoise, and lapis lazuli**. **Spindle whorls**, made from **terracotta and faience**, indicate the presence of **spinning and textile production**.

Comparison of Harappan and Contemporary Cultures

Feature	Harappan Civilization	Contemporary Cultures (Mesopotamia & Egypt)
Geographical spread	Spread over a wide area including present day India and Pakistan.	It is smaller than the Harappan civilisation
Urban Planning	Well-planned cities with grid patterns, drainage, and uniform brick structures	Irregular city layouts, with monumental architecture (ziggurats in Mesopotamia, pyramids in Egypt)
Writing System	Pictographic script (undeciphered)	Cuneiform (Mesopotamia), Hieroglyphics (Egypt) - both deciphered
Trade & Economy	Extensive trade with Mesopotamia, Afghanistan, and Persia (Meluha); used standardized weights & measures	Trade networks across West Asia and Mediterranean, use of silver as currency
Political Structure	Possibly decentralized governance, no evidence of kings	Monarchies with strong central rulers (pharaohs in Egypt, kings in Mesopotamia)
Religious Practices	Worship of Pashupati (proto-Shiva), Mother Goddess, animal and nature worship	Polytheistic, gods linked to natural forces (Ra, Osiris in Egypt; Anu, Enlil in Mesopotamia)
Architecture	Citadels, granaries, Great Bath, dockyard (Lothal), no large temples or palaces	Grand temples (ziggurats in Mesopotamia), pyramids for pharaohs in Egypt

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Feature	Harappan Civilization	Contemporary Cultures (Mesopotamia & Egypt)
Metallurgy & Craftsmanship	Bronze tools, lost-wax technique, terracotta figurines, seals. Square, rectangular, and circular seals were used.	Advanced metalwork, gold, copper, elaborate sculptures. Cylindrical seals were used.
Social Stratification	Absence of clear hierarchical structures, citadel-lower town distinction	Strict social hierarchies, ruling class, priests, slaves
	No tombs were found	Tombs were found

As **Mortimer Wheeler** stated, "The Indus Valley civilization was an early experiment in urban living, whose lessons remain relevant even today." Thus, the **legacy of Harappa** endures, not as a lost civilization, but as a **foundation for India's cultural and historical evolution**.

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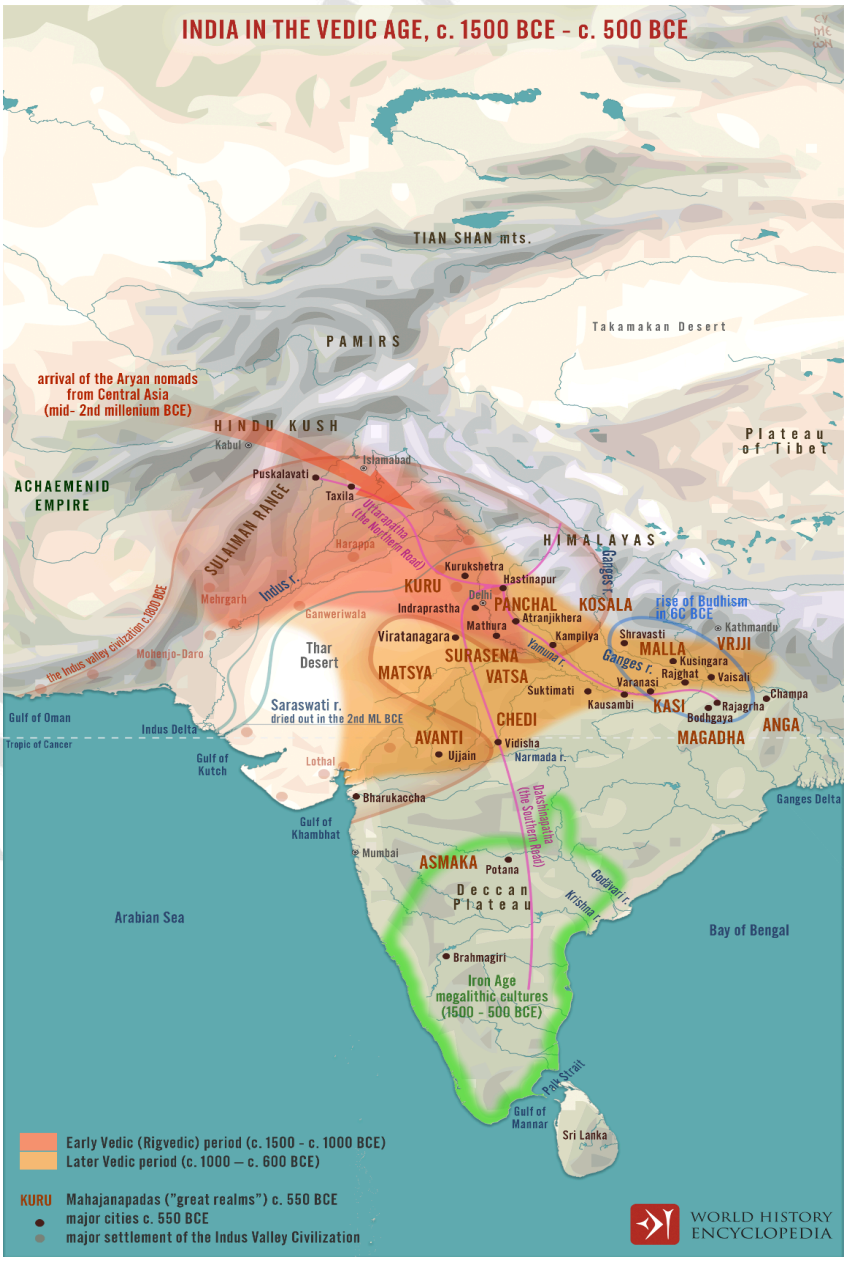
Vedic period

The **Vedic period** is one of the earliest phases of ancient Indian civilization, marked by the composition of the **Vedas** and the formation of the core principles of **Hinduism**. This period is divided into the **Early Vedic period** (c. 1500 BCE - 1000 BCE) and the **Later Vedic period** (c. 1000 BCE - 500 BCE).

Early Vedic Period (Rigvedic Period) (1500 BC - 1000 BC)

Economy

1. **Pastoralism:** The early Vedic Aryans were primarily pastoralists, focusing on cattle rearing (cattle, sheep, goats, horses) for milk, meat, and hides.
2. **Barter System:** Cows were the central medium of exchange; priests received cows, horses, and gold as fees.
3. **Agriculture:** Limited agricultural activity; barley ('yava') was cultivated.
4. **Other Activities:** Hunting, carpentry, tanning, weaving, chariot-making, and metal smelting.



Society

1. **Family Structure:** Patriarchal family; monogamy was the norm, though polygamy existed among chiefs.
2. **Social Units:** Clans (vis) formed tribes (jana). Tribal membership was based on birth, not territory.
3. **Social Equality:** The society was largely egalitarian; occupation was not inherited by birth.
4. **Emerging Inequalities:** Social differentiation emerged due to the concentration of wealth among chiefs and priests.
5. **Women's Role:** Women could choose husbands, marry at an appropriate age, and participate in tribal assemblies.

Religion

1. **Nature of Worship:** Focused on propitiating gods for protection and material gains.
2. **Pantheon:** Male-dominated, including gods like Indra, Agni, Varuna, and Mitra. Goddesses like Ushas and Sarasvati were less prominent.
3. **Sacrifices:** Performed to secure success in wars, progeny, and increased cattle.

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4. **Lack of Temples:** No temples or idol worship during this period.
5. **Texts**: **Rigveda**, **Yajurveda**, **Samaveda**, **Atharvaveda** - mainly focused on hymns and rituals.
6. **Philosophy and Knowledge**: Primarily ritualistic with a focus on **cosmic order**; little philosophical inquiry.

Polity

1. **Political Unit: The 'jana' (tribe), led by a 'rajan' (chief).**
2. **Tribal Assemblies:** 'Sabha', 'samiti', 'vidatha', and 'gana' discussed various issues, limiting the chief's power.
3. **Chief's Role**: Primarily protective, not hereditary, though succession within a family occurred.
4. **Army:** Mobilized only during wars, consisting of able-bodied tribesmen.
5. **Bali:** Voluntary contributions made by tribesmen to the chief.

Later Vedic Period (1000 BC - 600 BC)

Economy

1. **Agriculture:** Became the primary occupation, with rituals marking its initiation. Use of iron tools increased productivity.
2. **Crops:** Wheat, rice, pulses, lentils, millet, and sugarcane were cultivated. Iron tools helped in expanding agriculture.
3. **Population Growth:** Increased population and settlements, such as Hastinapur and Kaushambi, began to show urban characteristics.

Society

1. **Joint Family:** The family evolved into a joint family system with multiple generations living together.
2. **Gotra:** A system developed to track descent, prohibiting inter-gotra marriages.
3. **Social Differentiation:** Introduction of the 'varna' system (brahmanas, kshatriyas, vaishyas, and shudras), with brahmanas gaining significant power.
4. **Role of Women:** Women's participation in public meetings decreased, and their status started to decline.

Religion

1. **Deities:** Vishnu and Rudra gained importance. 'Yajnas' became more elaborate, with animal sacrifices.
2. **Upanishads:** Introduced concepts of karma, rebirth, and moksha. Focused on self-sacrifice and good conduct for liberation. Shift from ritualistic practices to **meditation** and **cosmological theories**.
3. **Texts**: **Upanishads**, **Brahmanas**, and **Aranyakas** - focusing on philosophical teachings and spiritual knowledge.
4. **Language and Script**:Increased use of **Sanskrit** for **philosophical texts** and religious writings.

Polity

1. **Chiefship:** Became hereditary, with the chief's power increasing and popular assemblies like 'sabha' and 'samiti' fading away.
2. **Divine Kingship:** Kingship was increasingly viewed as divine, supported by brahmanas.
3. **Taxation:** Introduction of taxes like 'bali', 'shulka', and 'bhaga' to support the chiefs.
4. **Formation of States:** While a full-fledged territorial state did not emerge, the foundation for the rise of **'mahajanapadas'** (16 kingdoms) was laid by the 6th century BC.

Vedas

The **Vedas** are the oldest and most revered scriptures in **Hinduism**. They represent the foundation of Hindu philosophy, rituals, and spirituality. The word **Veda** comes from the Sanskrit root **'vid'**, meaning **"to know"**.

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These sacred texts are regarded as divinely revealed knowledge and have been passed down through generations via **oral tradition**.

The Four Vedas

Rigveda

1. The **oldest** of the four Vedas.
2. Divided into **ten books** (called **mandalas**). Composed of **1,028 hymns** (known as **suktas**) dedicated to various gods and deities.
3. It contains hymns dedicated to numerous gods, such as **Indra** (god of thunder), **Agni** (fire god), **Varuna** (cosmic law), and **Surya** (sun god).
4. Includes famous hymns like the **Gayatri mantra** and **Purusha Shukta** (the story of the **Primal Man**).
5. The priest associated with the **Rigveda** is called the **Hotri**, who recites hymns to invoke deities during rituals.

Yajurveda

1. A **manual** for the **Adhvaryu priest**, responsible for performing ritual tasks in sacrifices. Focuses on detailed **sacrificial rituals**, including **yajnas** (sacrificial offerings to deities), often involving fire and various offerings.
2. Primarily written in **prose**.
3. Divided into two major parts:
   a. **Black Yajurveda** (Kṛṣṇa Yajurveda) - Older section, contains more **obscure and ritualistic prose**.
   b. **White Yajurveda** (Śukla Yajurveda) - More structured and organized in terms of hymns and mantras.

Samaveda

1. The **Samaveda** is mainly a collection of hymns from the **Rigveda** but arranged for chanting and singing.
2. **Structure**: It consists of **1,875 verses**, most of which are taken from the Rigveda, but they are restructured into **melodic** form to be sung during rituals.
3. **Purpose**: The **Samaveda** enhances the **sonic** and **ritualistic** experience of the Vedic ceremonies.
4. **Priest**: The **Udgatar** priest is responsible for chanting the hymns during sacrifices, using the **Samaveda**.
5. It is closely linked to the **musical** and **chanting traditions** in Hindu rituals.
6. Emphasizes **melodies**, showing how sacred sounds and tones connect with spiritual energy.

Atharvaveda

1. **Magical and Healing Texts**: The **Atharvaveda** contains a **collection of spells**, **incantations**, **charms**, and **prayers** aimed at health, wealth, and warding off evil spirits.
2. **Structure**: It consists of **731 hymns**, focusing on **practical aspects of life**, such as curing diseases, protecting from harm, and ensuring prosperity.
3. **Distinctiveness**: It is the **latest** of the Vedas and includes **folk practices** such as spells and healing rituals not present in the other Vedas.
4. **Priest**: The **Brahmin** priest associated with the **Atharvaveda** is responsible for performing healing and protective rituals.
5. **Key Themes**:
   a. Warding off **evil**, **diseases**, and **black magic**.
   b. Includes hymns for **domestic prosperity**, **family welfare**, and **protection**.
   c. Sometimes regarded as a **more practical, grounded** Veda compared to others.

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Structure of Each Veda

Each Veda consists of four parts

1. **Samhitas**
   a. **Most Ancient Part**: The **Samhita** is the **earliest** portion of the Vedas, consisting of **mantras** (hymns) and **chants** dedicated to the gods.
   b. **Function**: It is primarily concerned with **worship** and **prayers** to the deities, used during **sacrificial rituals**.
   c. **Examples**:
   d. In the **Rigveda**, the Samhitas include hymns like the **Gayatri Mantra**, used for worshiping **Savitr** (the sun god).
   e. In the **Yajurveda**, the Samhitas provide verses for the **Adhvaryu** priests to chant during rituals.
2. **Brahmanas**
   a. **Prose Interpretations**: The **Brahmanas** are prose texts that **explain the rituals** and **sacrificial practices** in the Vedas.
   b. **Function**: They provide **guidelines** on how to conduct the rituals, explaining their significance, the procedure for performance, and the intended results of these rituals.
   c. **Examples**:
   d. The **Aitareya Brahmana** explains rituals associated with the **Rigveda**.
   e. The **Shatapatha Brahmana** deals with the **Yajurveda** rituals and contains explanations for various rituals performed during **yajnas**.
3. **Aranyakas**
   a. **Philosophical Interpretation**: The **Aranyakas** provide symbolic and philosophical interpretations of the rituals and are often associated with **forest-dwelling ascetics** (hermits).
   b. **Function**: These texts reflect on the **meaning** behind the sacrifices and **rituals**, focusing on **spiritual knowledge** and their **symbolic** significance.
   c. **Examples**:
   d. The **Aitareya Aranyaka** deals with rituals connected to the **Rigveda**.
   e. **Chandogya Aranyaka** is associated with the **Samaveda** and discusses meditation and the inner meaning of rituals.
4. **Upanishads**
   a. **Philosophical Core**: The **Upanishads** are **philosophical texts** that delve into the **nature of reality**, **the self** (Atman), and the **universe** (Brahman).
   b. **Function**: The Upanishads primarily focus on **spiritual teachings** and **meditation**, discussing the path to **moksha** (liberation) and exploring the connection between **Atman** (the individual soul) and **Brahman** (the universal soul).
   c. **Examples**:
   d. **Chandogya Upanishad**: Discusses the idea of **Brahman** and **Atman**, and the centrality of the **Om** sound.

Brihadaranyaka Upanishad: One of the most significant Upanishads, exploring the relationship between Brahman and the individual self.

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Chapter 2

Ancient Empires & Kingdoms

PYQs

[2026] Vijayanagara architecture exemplifies the amalgamation of traditions with contemporary practices. Elucidate with examples. (15)
[2026] Analyze the importance of Ashokan inscriptions for reconstructing Mauryan history. (10)
[2024] "Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture." Comment. (15)
[2024] Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (10)
[2022] Discuss the main contributions of Gupta period and Chola period to Indian heri- tage and culture. (15)
[2020] Pala period is the most significant phase in the history of Buddhism in India. Enumerate. (10)
[2017] How do you justify the view that the level of excellence of Gupta numismatic art is not at all noticeable in later times? (10)
[2016] Krishnadeva Raya, the King of Vijayanagar, was not only an accomplished scholar himself but was also a great patron of learning and literature. Discuss. (12.5)
[2013] Chola architecture represents a high watermark in the evolution of temple architecture. Discuss. (10)

Mauryan Empire

Under the Mauryas (322-185 BCE), especially during the reigns of Chandragupta and Ashoka, India experienced one of its most glorious cultural renaissances, with art, architecture, and literature flourishing across the subcontinent.

Important Kings

Chandragupta Maurya (322 BC - 297 BC)

1. Greek accounts mention him as **Sandrokottos**
2. Defeated **Seleucus Nicator I in** 305 B.C
3. Greek Ambassador: Megasthenes (written Book INDICA)

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4. **Sohagura Copper plate inscription** (Gorakhpur) & **Mahasthan inscription** (Bogra): mentions relief measures to be adopted during a famine.
5. **Girnar Records:** Chandragupta's governor Pushyagupta (Brother-in-law of Chandragupta) constructed the Sudarsana Lake. His title was Simant Raja.
6. 297 B.C.: Transferred rulership to Bindusara, and **went to Shravanabelagola** with Jain monk Bhadrabahu, embraced Jainism and Practiced Santhara

Bindusara (297 BC- 273 BC)

1. Bindusara was known by the title **"Amitraghata"** in Sanskrit, meaning "Slayer of Enemies." Greek sources refer to him as **"Amitrochates,"** corroborating his reputation as a formidable ruler.
2. Bindusara followed the **Ajivika sect**, a heterodox religion popular during his time, which focused on asceticism and fate.
3. Because of the southern conquest, he is mentioned in Sangam Literature.

Ashoka (273-232 BC)

1. 3rd king. Known by many names like Ashoka (without sorrow) - Ashokavanadna legend.
2. The term **Priyadasi** is also associated with him (Dipavamsa text).
3. The identification of **Devanampiya** and Ashoka as the same person is established by the **Maski and Gujarra inscriptions**.
4. The title '**Mahasammat**' is received in the context of directing the Mahamatras in the Buddhist text Nikaya. Also, the other two other titles are 'Murdhabhishikta' and 'Janapadasthamaviryaprapt'.
5. **Kalinga War:** Fought at the banks of River Daya, near Dhauli Hills. After this war, Ashoka abandoned his policy of physical occupation, he started favoring cultural conquest
6. He was initiated into **Buddhism by Nigrodh, a 7-year-old monk**.
7. 3 important phases of life of Ashoka: **Kamasoka, Chandasoka, Dhammasoka**
8. Ashoka donated 4 caves known as Barabar caves in Gaya to Ajivika Sect.

Society

Aspect	Details
Social Structure	- 4-fold **Varna system**: Divided into **Brahmins**, **Kshatriyas**, **Vaishyas**, and **Shudras**. - Further divided into **Jatis** based on profession or occupation. - As per **Jataka Stories**, untouchability existed, with **Chandals** being at the lowest rung of society.
Slavery (Arthashastra)	- A man could become a slave by **birth**, **war capture**, **voluntary sale**, or **judicial punishment**. - **Female slaves** who bore sons to their masters were freed, and their children were entitled to legal status as the master's heirs.
Megasthenes' Observations	- Claimed **no slavery** existed but noted **7-fold social divisions**: Philosophers, Farmers, Soldiers, Herdsmen, Artisans, Judicial officials, Councillors (Advisors)
Administrative Committees	- **6 Main Committees** for urban governance: - **No. 3**: Responsible for registration of births and deaths.

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Aspect	Details
	- **No. 6**: Managed sales tax and trade regulation.
Institution of Ganikas	- The institution of **Ganikas (prostitution)** expanded and was regulated, contributing to cultural and economic life.
Untouchability	- As per **Jataka Stories**, untouchability existed, with **Chandals** being the most marginalized group.

Art & Architecture

The Mauryan period (321-185 BCE) marked the dawn of India's monumental architecture and art. It showcased a synthesis of indigenous traditions with external influences like Persian and Hellenistic styles.

Features of Mauryan Art

1. **Material Used:** Predominantly polished stone and wood.
2. **Polish Technique:** Renowned for the "Mauryan polish" seen in pillars and sculptures.
3. **Themes:** Emphasis on Buddhist motifs, royal grandeur, and nature.
4. **Palaces:** Near **Kumrahar**, the ruins of a royal palace are excavated.
5. **Terracotta:** Mother goddesses in clay have been discovered at Ahichatra. Also, Idols, toys, dice, ornaments, and beads.
6. **Folk art: Yaksha of Parkham and Yakshini of Besnagar** - Made up of stone and Mauryan Polish on the surface. Fat bodies and a happy face. The female features had fewer clothes and more jewelry.

Pillars and sculptures

Sarnath Pillar

1. **Inspiration** - from Persian pillars of Darius.
2. **Material:** Monolithic sandstone, highly polished.
3. Mentioned by Chinese traveler **Xuanzang**, who visited Sarnath during the reign of Harshvardhana.
4. **4 Lion** - represents Buddha's teaching in all 4 directions (Aggressive because Ashoka warns people if they do not obey it)
5. **4 Animals** on Abacus -
   a. Lion - ShakyaSimha (Lion of Shakya clan)
   b. Elephant - Shakyamuni entering the womb of his mother Mayadevi in her dream
   c. Horse - Temporal royalty
   d. Bull - Buddha's birth sign Taurus
6. Wheel with 24 spokes (on Abacus) represents the 24 teachings of Buddhism
7. Wheel with 32 spokes (Dharmachakra) represents 32 characteristics of great man (Mahapurusha Lakshana)

Lion Capital, Sarnath

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Other Ashokan Pillars & Capitals

Location	Crowning Animal	Key Features
Basarah - Bakhira (Bihar)	Single Lion	• Lion sitting on square abacus • Relatively less ornamented compared to others
Lauriya - Nandangarh (Bihar (Champaran))	Single Lion	• Pillar has Ashokan edicts • Round abacus with lion capital
Sankisa (Sankissa) (Uttar Pradesh)	Elephant	• Installed post-Buddha's death • Only Elephant capital survives
Rampurva (Bihar)	Zebu Bull	• Hybrid of Persian & Indian elements • Greek-influenced abacus with floral designs

Ramapurva Bull

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Ashokan Inscriptions

British archaeologist **James Prinsep (1837)** deciphered the Brahmi script, unlocking the treasure trove of Ashokan inscriptions. Written primarily on **pillars**, **rock surfaces**, and **cave walls**, these inscriptions provide insights into Ashoka's governance, his embrace of Buddhism, and his philosophy of **Dhamma (righteousness)**.

Classification of Ashokan Inscriptions

1. **Major Rock Edicts** (14 inscriptions) - Cover Ashoka's policies on Dhamma, moral guidelines, non-violence, religious tolerance, and welfare activities. **Language** used was Prakrit (written in Brahmi and Kharosthi scripts). **Eg. Girnar (Gujarat), Kalsi (Uttarakhand), Dhauli (Odisha), etc.**
2. **Minor Rock Edicts** - Personal messages by Ashoka, emphasizing his conversion to Buddhism, moral conduct, and missionary efforts. **Eg. Maski, Gavimath, Palkigundu (Karnataka), Bairat (Rajasthan).**
3. **Major Pillar Edicts** (7 inscriptions) - Focus on administrative policies, public welfare, and Ashoka's commitment to non-violence. **Eg. Delhi-Topra, Delhi-Meerut, Allahabad-Kosam.**
4. **Minor Pillar Edicts** - Primarily deal with Ashoka's reverence for Buddhism and his instructions to the Sangha (Buddhist community). **Eg. Sanchi, Sarnath.**
5. **Cave Inscriptions** - Grants and donations made to the Ajivika sect. **Eg. Barabar Hills (Bihar).**

Languages and Scripts - Prakrit (dominant). Greek and Aramaic in inscriptions from Kandahar (Afghanistan). Major **Scripts used were** Brahmi (most inscriptions in India), Kharosthi (northwest India) and Greek and Aramaic (Afghanistan).

Significance

1. **Early Epigraphy:** Earliest decipherable inscriptions in India.
2. **Political History:** Provides a glimpse into the governance and policies of the Mauryan Empire.
3. **Spread of Buddhism:** Documents Ashoka's efforts to propagate Buddhism across India and beyond (Sri Lanka, Central Asia).
4. **Cultural Integration:** Demonstrates linguistic diversity and interaction with foreign cultures.
5. **Moral Philosophy:** Reflects Ashoka's ideals of ethical governance and humanitarianism.

Themes in Ashokan Inscriptions

1. **Promotion of Dhamma (Moral and Ethical Values)**
   a. **Eg. Rock Edict I** prohibits animal sacrifices and festive gatherings that harm life, advocating compassion towards animals.
   b. **Eg. Rock Edict III** advises practicing morality, generosity, truthfulness, and respect for all living beings.
2. **Religious Tolerance and Harmony**
   a. **Eg. Rock Edict XII** explicitly advocates honoring all sects and promoting mutual understanding to ensure harmony.

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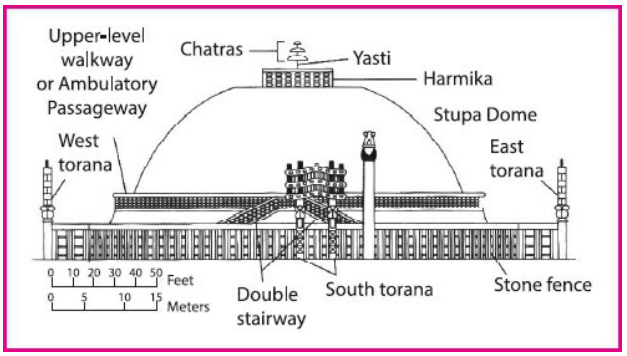
   b. **Eg. Kandahar Greek-Aramaic Edict** highlights Ashoka's message of tolerance and understanding even in regions with Greek populations.
3. **Administrative Policies and Justice**
   a. **Eg. Pillar Edict IV** discusses the appointment of **Dhamma Mahamatras** to oversee the welfare of the people and ensure adherence to Dhamma.
   b. **Eg. Rock Edict V** emphasizes kindness to prisoners and outlines the practice of granting pardons on special occasions.
4. **Non-Violence and Animal Welfare**
   a. **Eg. Rock Edict XIII** reflects his remorse over the Kalinga War and his commitment to peace and non-violence.
   b. **Eg. Rock Edict I** and **Pillar Edict V** ban animal sacrifices and regulate hunting to protect wildlife.
5. **The welfare of the People**
   a. **Eg. Rock Edict II** mentions the establishment of hospitals for humans and animals and the planting of trees along roads for shade.
   b. **Eg. Rock Edict VII** talks about digging wells and planting medicinal herbs for travelers and common people.
6. **Missionary Efforts and Spread of Buddhism**
   a. **Eg. Minor Rock Edict I** highlights Ashoka's dedication to spreading Dhamma through personal example and missionary efforts.
   b. **Eg. Rock Edict XIII** mentions Ashoka's missions to countries like Sri Lanka, Greece, and Egypt to propagate Buddhism.
7. **Remorse and Ethical Transformation** - Eg. **Rock Edict XIII** reveals Ashoka's deep regret over the loss of life and his resolve to follow Dhamma as a way to achieve inner peace and societal harmony.
8. **Environmental Ethics** - Eg. **Pillar Edict V** bans certain types of animal slaughter and mentions regulations to ensure the welfare of wildlife and domesticated animals.

Stupas

1. Originally built with bricks during Ashoka's reign. Later enhancements by the Shunga dynasty added stone reinforcements and elaborate gateways.
2. Purpose: to enshrine some relics of Buddha or some great Buddhist Monk. Eg. **Sanchi**
3. Symbol of death in Buddhism - Bubble
4. It is a representation of "acculturation of megalithic burials".
5. **Architecture of Sanchi Stupa:**
6. **The Stupa Structure**
   a. **Hemispherical Dome (Anda):** Represents the mound of dirt placed over the Buddha's relics. Symbolizes the cosmic universe and the enlightened mind.
   b. **Harmika:** A square railing on top of the dome. Symbolizes the sacred abode of the gods.
   c. **Chhatra (Umbrella):** A central pillar with three disc-like structures atop the harmika. Represents protection and the Three Jewels of Buddhism - Buddha, Dharma, and Sangha.
   d. **Yashti**: The central pillar supports a triple umbrella structure called chattra.



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7. **Toranas (Gateways)** - Four toranas, facing the cardinal directions. Mark the entry points and symbolize the teachings of Buddhism.
   a. Intricate depictions of **Jataka tales** (stories from the Buddha's previous lives).
   b. Symbols like the Bodhi tree, wheel of Dharma, and stupa as representations of the Buddha.
   c. Animals like elephants, lions, and lotuses convey spiritual messages.
8. **Medhi (Circumambulatory Path)** - Allows devotees to walk around the stupa as a meditative practice.
   a. **Lower Path:** Encircles the dome for pradakshina (ritual circumambulation).
   b. **Upper Path:** An elevated circumambulatory pathway, reached via stairs.
9. **Railings (Vedikas)** - made from Sandstone. The design is simple yet sturdy; encircles the medhi and dome. Encloses the sacred space, demarcating it from the outer world.
10. **Decorative Elements - Carvings d**epict scenes of devotion, processions, and nature, emphasizing Buddhist values. **Symbols like Wheel (Dharmachakra):** Represents Buddha's teachings, **Bodhi Tree:** Symbolizes enlightenment, **Lotus:** Signifies purity amidst worldly chaos.

Caves

Barabar Hills	• Oldest surviving rock-cut caves, polished interiors, and inscriptions linked to the Ajivikas sect. • It has 4 caves: Lomash Rishi, Sudama, Karanchaupar, Vishwakarma • Inscriptions have been found in Sudama Cave • Lomash Rishi Caves have wooden works • These are secular in nature (Ajivika, Jainism, Buddhism, Brahmanism)
Nagarjuni Hills	• Polished interiors, extended Ajivikas sanctuaries, inscriptions detailing royal patronage. • Located south of Barabar Hills • It has 3 caves: Gopika, Vadati, Vapiya

Significance of Mauryan Art and Architecture

1. Political Significance
   a. **Symbol of Power:** Massive pillars and stupas reflected the grandeur and authority of the Mauryan empire. **Eg. Lion Capital**
   b. **Unity in Diversity:** The art and inscriptions, found across modern-day India, Pakistan, Nepal, and Afghanistan, signified the vastness and unity of the Mauryan realm. **Eg. Major & Minor Rock Edicts**
   c. **Ashoka's Dhamma:** Inscriptions on pillars and rocks promoted moral governance, peace, and religious tolerance. **Eg. Rock Edict i, iii & xiii**
2. Religious Significance
   a. **Buddhism's Spread:** Ashoka's stupas, pillars, and inscriptions played a key role in spreading Buddhism across Asia. **Eg. Kesariya Stupa of bihar is replicated in south east asia**
   b. **Interfaith Harmony:** Patronage extended to other religions like Jainism and Ajivika, symbolizing religious coexistence. **Eg. Rock Edict XII**
   c. **Sacred Architecture:** Stupas became the focal point for Buddhist rituals and meditation, influencing spiritual traditions. **Eg. Sanchi & Dhamek Stupa**

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3. Artistic and Cultural Innovation
    a. **First Monumental Art:** The Mauryas pioneered the use of stone in large-scale structures, moving from perishable materials like wood.
    b. **Polished Finish:** The unique "Mauryan polish" remains a hallmark of ancient Indian craftsmanship. **Eg. Yaksha of Parkham and Yakshini of Besnagar**
    c. **Integration of Styles:** A blend of indigenous designs with Persian and Hellenistic elements laid the foundation for future Indian art.
4. Social Significance
    a. **Community Engagement:** Stupas and viharas fostered community spaces for worship and dialogue.
    b. **Inclusivity:** Art depicted universal themes of nature, harmony, and prosperity, resonating with the common people. **Eg. Barabar Hills are secular in nature (Ajivika, Jainism, Buddhism, Brahmanism)**
5. Architectural Legacy
    a. **Foundation for Later Dynasties:** Gupta, Kushan, and other dynasties refined and expanded upon Mauryan architectural techniques.
    b. **Influence on Rock-Cut Architecture:** Inspired later monumental works like the Ajanta and Ellora caves.
    c. **National Identity:** The **Lion Capital of Sarnath** is now India's national emblem, symbolizing pride and heritage.

The **Mauryan Empire (321-185 BCE)** left a lasting cultural legacy, seen in **UNESCO World Heritage Sites** like the **Great Stupa at Sanchi** and the **Ashokan Pillars**. From Chandragupta's conquests to Ashoka's transformative embrace of Buddhism, it set the stage for governance based on justice and morality.

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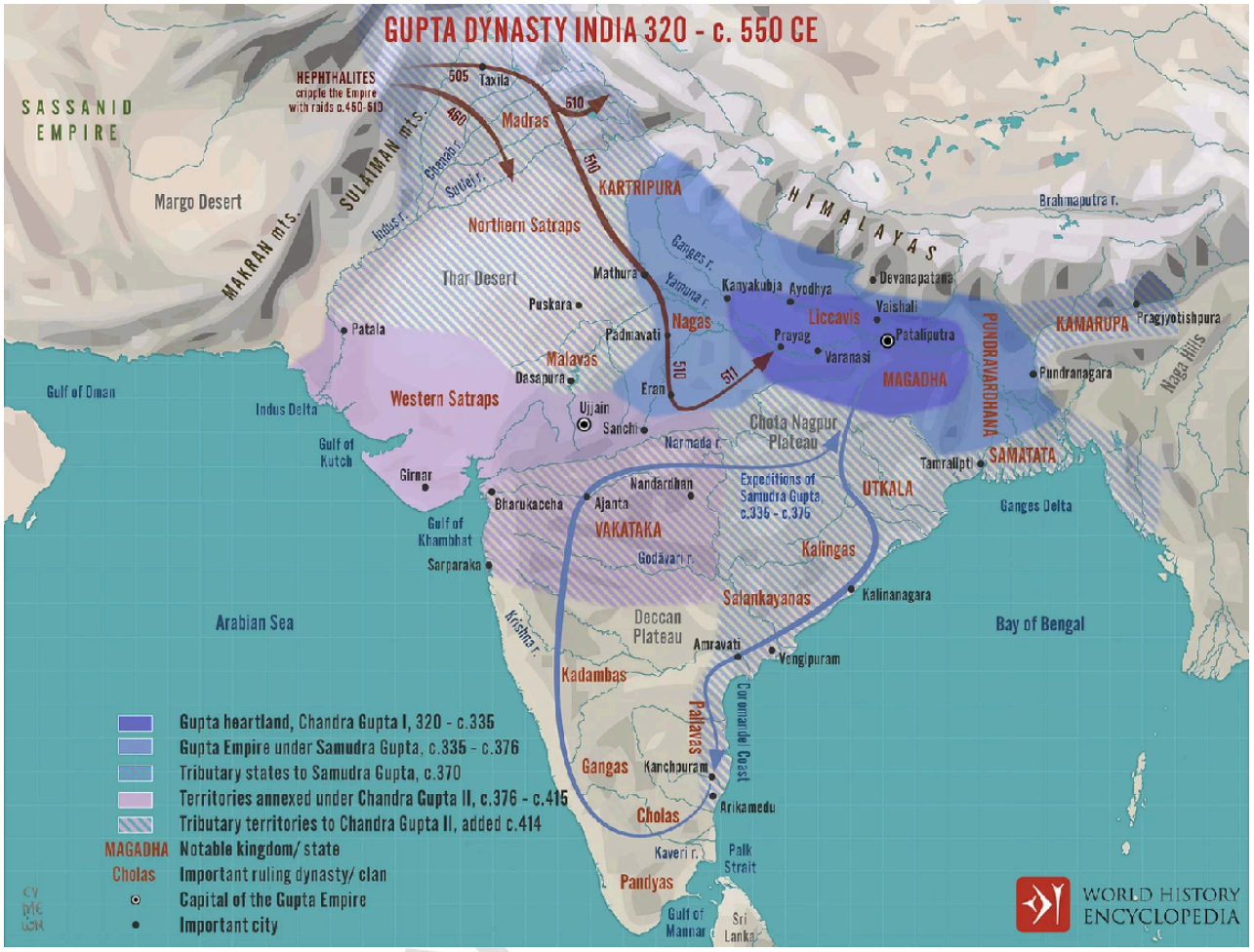
Gupta Empire

The Gupta period, under the leadership of kings like Chandragupta I and Samudragupta, is often referred to as the Golden Age of India, where art, literature, and science reached unparalleled heights



Time Period: 320-550 CE

Important Rulers

Srigupta

1. feudal lord under Kushana, not sovereign
2. The Gupta dynasty was founded by Srigupta in the AD 3rd century.
3. He used the title of Maharaja.

Chandragupta I (AD 319-335)

1. Strengthened his position by matrimonial alliance with the Lichchavis- married Lichchavi princess **Kumaradevi**. Special Kumaradevi-type coins were minted to commemorate her marriage to Chandragupta I.
2. Chandragupta, I started the Gupta Era (Gupta Samvat) in AD 319, which marked the date of his accession (coronation).

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Samudragupta (AD 335-375)

1. Samudragupta has been called the **Indian Napoleon by VA Smith** because of his extensive military conquests. He assumed the titles of **Vikramanka**, **Kaviraja**. He also performed the Asvamedha sacrifice.
2. He subjugated five kingdoms in lower Bengal, upper Assam, Nepal, and the territories farther West as well as number of republican clans.
3. Samudragupta also advanced through the forest tract of Madhya Pradesh to the coast of Orissa and then moved up to Kanchi, the capital of Pallavas.
4. He was a devotee of Vishnu though a follower of the Brahmanical religion, he was tolerant of other faiths, he granted permission to the Buddhist King of Ceylon, **Meghavarman**, to build a monastery at Bodh Gaya.

Chandragupta II (AD 380-412)

1. As per Sanskrit play Devi Chandraguptam written by Vishakhadutt: Chandragupta- II killed his elder brother Ramgupta and ascended throne
2. Chandragupta II followed the same policy of matrimonial alliance when he conciliated the Naga chieftains of the upper and central provinces by accepting the hand of the princess **Kubernaga** and allied himself with the powerful family of the Vakatakas of the Deccan by marrying his daughter **Prabhavati with Rudrasena II**.
3. He issued silver coins (first Gupta ruler to issue silver coins) and adopted the title Vikramaditya and Sakari in memory of his victory.
4. The Mehrauli iron pillar inscription near Qutub Minar enumerates the exploits of a king called Chandra.
5. During his reign the Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hein (399-414) visited India.

Kumaragupta I (AD 415-455)

1. In the last years of Kumara Gupta I, the peace and prosperity of the empire was disturbed due to internal dissensions and external invasions.
2. His son Skandagupta managed to defeat the Hunas as mentioned in Bhitari inscription and Junagarh inscription of Skandgupta.
3. Kumara Gupta I is said to have **founded Nalanda University.**

Skandagupta (AD 455-467)

1. He repulsed the ferrocious Hunas attacks twice.
2. The Heroic Act gave him the title **Vikramaditya (Bhitari Pillar Inscription).**
3. The empire continued but central control weakened and local Governors became feudatory kings with hereditary rights.
4. In his religious outlook, Skanda Gupta was a Vaishnava, but followed the tolerant policy of his predecessors.
5. He repaired the **Junagarh Lake in Gujarat**

Gupta Society

1. **Social Stratification** - The Brahmanas became richer because of land grants and claimed many privileges which are listed in the Narada smriti (AD 5th century).
2. There was a great increase in the number of castes and sub-castes with the large-scale absorption of foreigners and tribals.
3. The position of the Shudras improved slightly; they were permitted to listen to the epics and Puranas, to worship a new God called Krishna and to perform certain domestic rites such as paying fees to the priests.
4. Shudras were now considered as agriculturists rather than servants and slaves.

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5. Women had **limited rights**, with increasing restrictions on remarriage and property ownership. **Manusmriti** reinforced patriarchal norms, but some royal women, like **Prabhavatigupta**, played influential roles.
6. Hinduism, particularly **Vaishnavism and Shaivism**, gained prominence. The Gupta rulers patronized temples, and Sanskrit texts like the **Puranas** were compiled. Buddhism declined but continued in places like Nalanda.
7. **Education & Learning** - **Nalanda, Vikramashila, and Taxila** became major centers of learning. Scholars like **Aryabhata, Varahamihira, and Kalidasa** contributed to astronomy, mathematics, and literature.
8. **Language & Literature** - **Sanskrit flourished**, becoming the court language. **Kalidasa's works** like Meghaduta and Shakuntala are notable. The **Gupta inscriptions** are mainly in Sanskrit, showcasing its dominance.
9. **Art & Architecture** - The **Ajanta caves**, **Dashavatara Temple (Deogarh)**, and development of **Nagara-style temples** mark this period. **Gupta sculpture** emphasized grace and detailed ornamentation.
10. **Economic Prosperity** - **Agriculture** was the backbone, with **land grants to Brahmins and temples**. Trade flourished with **Silk Road connections**, and India exported **spices, textiles, and metals**.
11. **Guild System & Urban Life** - Trade guilds (**Shrenis**) played a key role in economic activities. Cities like **Pataliputra, Ujjain, and Mathura** were thriving centers of commerce and culture.
12. **Judicial System** - The king was the **highest judicial authority**. **Smritis** and **Dharma Shastras** guided legal practices. **Village assemblies** handled local disputes.
13. **Decline of Slavery** - While **forced labor (Vishṭi)** existed, slavery was **less prevalent** than in earlier periods. Many lower-caste groups took up artisanal and trade roles, leading to social mobility.
14. **Fa-Hien's observation about Gupta Empire:**
    a. 1. Vegetarianism 2. Non-Violence 3. Prevalence of caste 4. Existence of slavery 5. Presence of untouchability - Chandalas 6. Remarriage of widows was unfavorable 7. Prevalence of Devadasi system 8. Multi-religious: Buddhism, Hinduism, Jainism

Religion Under the Gupta Empire (4th-6th Century CE)

1. **Revival & Patronage of Hinduism** - Hinduism flourished with **royal support**, particularly for **Vaishnavism, Shaivism, and Shaktism**, leading to the rise of temple-based worship. **(Eg. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh; Udayagiri Caves, Shaivite sculptures)**
2. **Growth of Vaishnavism & Shaivism** - Vishnu and Shiva became **central deities**, with artistic depictions of **Dashavatara (Vishnu's incarnations) and Shiva in Linga form**. **(Eg. Varaha Panel, Udayagiri; Bhitargaon Temple, dedicated to Vishnu)**
3. **Development of Temple Worship** - Religious practices transitioned from **sacrificial rituals to idol worship and Bhakti (devotion)**, leading to **the construction of permanent stone temples**. **(Eg. Tigawa Temple, Shiva shrine; Bhitargaon Temple, one of the earliest brick temples)**
4. **Emergence of Shaktism (Goddess Worship)** - The worship of **Durga, Lakshmi, and Saraswati** gained popularity, often associated with Vishnu and Shiva, and Tantric practices began to develop. **(Eg. Durga Mahisasuramardini sculptures in Gupta temples)**
5. **Evolution of Buddhist Traditions** - **Mahayana Buddhism flourished** with major centers like **Nalanda and Sarnath**, featuring **Bodhisattva images and stupas**. **(Eg. Seated Buddha at Sarnath; Nalanda University as a Buddhist learning hub)**

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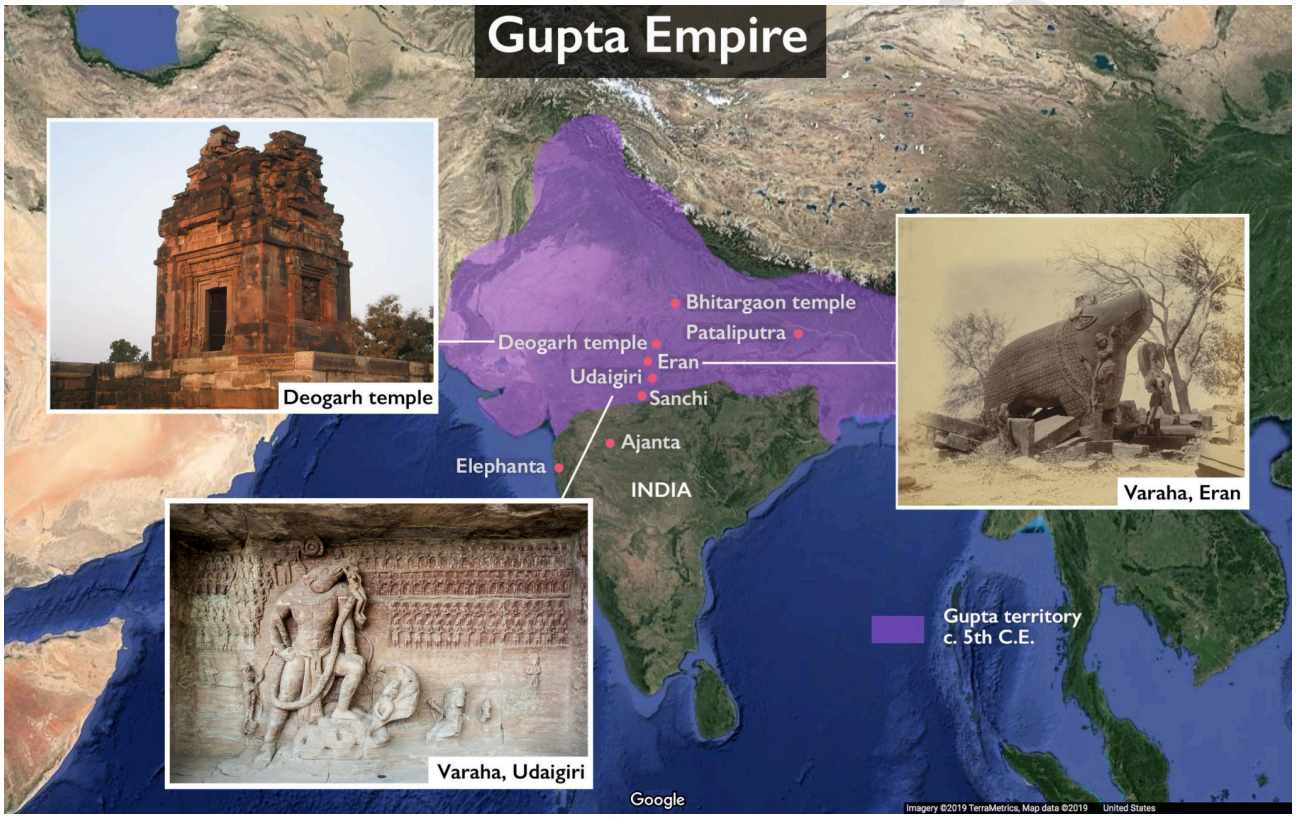
6. **Composition of Religious Texts** - The **Puranas** were compiled, **Smritis (law codes) like Narada Smriti and Yajnavalkya Smriti** were codified, and Buddhist Avadana texts were composed. **(Eg. Vishnu Purana, detailing Vaishnavism; Brihat Samhita by Varahamihira, covering Hindu astrology)**



Gupta Art and Architecture

Temple Architecture

Guptas were the first dynasty to build permanent free-standing Hindu temples. This lay the foundation of the Nagara School of Art.

1. Use of Stone and Brick - Temples were built using both stone and brick, marking a shift from earlier wooden and rock-cut shrines. Eg. Bhitargaon Temple (Uttar Pradesh) - The oldest surviving brick temple in India, with a high curvilinear shikhara.
2. Square Sanctum (Garbhagriha) - The sanctum sanctorum (garbhagriha) was square-shaped, housing the main deity, often without a vestibule. Eg. Tigawa Temple (Madhya Pradesh) - A simple square shrine with a flat roof, representing early temple planning.
3. Presence of a Mandapa (Pillared Hall) - A pillared hall (mandapa) in front of the garbhagriha allowed for congregational worship. Eg. Sanchi Temple No. 17 (Madhya Pradesh).

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4. Development of the Shikhara (Tower) - The early shikharas were modest and pyramid-like, evolving into the curvilinear form seen in later temples. It symbolised a connection between the earthly and divine Eg. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh (Uttar Pradesh).
5. Panchayatana Style (Five-Shrine Layout), with a central shrine and four subsidiary shrines at the corners. Eg. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh - A classic Panchayatana-style temple with a main shrine dedicated to Vishnu and four smaller shrines.
6. Sculptural Ornamentation - Temple walls had intricate carvings of Hindu gods, mythological tales, and floral motifs. Eg. Eran Temple (Madhya Pradesh) - Famous for its Varaha (boar incarnation of Vishnu) sculpture, showcasing advanced relief work.
7. Integration of Hindu Iconography - The temples prominently featured Vishnu, Shiva, and Durga, with their incarnations and symbols.
8. Flat or Stepped Roofs in Early Temples - Initial temples had flat or stepped roofs, before the full-fledged shikhara emerged. Eg. Sanchi Temple No. 17 - A flat-roofed structure with an early prototype of a mandapa.
9. Influence on Later Temple Styles - Eg. Dashavatara Temple influenced later North Indian Nagara temples, while the Bhitargaon Temple's shikhara inspired later curvilinear towers.

Cave Architecture: The rock-cut architecture of the period is represented by the two conventional types the Chaityas and the Vihara

1. The most characteristic feature of the Chaitya is its emphasis on the colossal image of Buddha seated between two standing attendants.
2. The Vihara was planned in the form of rows of cells round a central court.
3. **Use of Rock-Cut Excavation** - Caves were **carved into hills and cliffs**, continuing the tradition of earlier Buddhist caves like Ajanta. Eg. **Udayagiri Caves (Madhya Pradesh)**
4. **Combination of Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain Influences** - While earlier caves were primarily Buddhist, **Hindu and Jain influences** became more prominent. Eg. **Udayagiri Caves have one of the earliest Hindu cave temples.**
5. **Elaborate Sculptural Panels** - Cave facades and interiors had **carved relief panels** of gods, mythological figures, and religious motifs. Eg. **Udayagiri Cave 5 features the famous Varaha (Boar) incarnation of Vishnu.**
6. **Introduction of Hindu Iconography** - Early **Shiva Lingas, Vishnu reliefs, and Durga images** appeared in Gupta caves. Eg. **Elephanta Caves (later developed by Kalachuris) show early Gupta influence in Shiva depictions.**
7. **Chaitya & Vihara Traditions Continue** - Buddhist **Chaityas (prayer halls)** and **Viharas (monasteries)** were still in use but with more Hindu adaptation. Eg. **Ajanta Cave No. 16-17 (decorated in Gupta period).**
8. **Early Attempts at Structural Elements** - Carved **pillars, mandapas (halls), and sanctums** within rock-cut caves. Eg. **Udayagiri Cave 6 has a sculpted entrance and doorway.**
9. **Artistic Refinement and Narrative Sculptures** - More **refined and naturalistic carving styles**, depicting **fluid movement and detailed human expressions**.Eg. **Ajanta Cave paintings, completed during the Gupta period.**

Udaygiri	• Hindu caves with sculptures of Vishnu and Varaha, and inscriptions related to Chandragupta II.
Junagarh	• Buddhist Monastery

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	• Entrance arch is in form of Hindu torna • Unique feature = Presence of a 30-50 ft high citadel-like feature - Upar Kot in front of the prayer hall
Bagh	• 9 sandstone Buddhist caves with mural paintings depicting life scenes and narratives. • Located near Baghani River • Padampani bodhisattva and Mushrrom painting in Rang Mahal (Cave 4)

Sculpture

Gupta sculpture belongs to early Amravati and Mathura schools. Its plasticity is derived from that of Mathura and its elegance from that of Amravati.

1. **Idealized Human Forms** - Figures had **rounded faces, almond-shaped eyes, and delicate smiles**, reflecting **serenity and divine grace**. The Gupta sculptures represent idealised human forms, combining realism with an emphasis on spiritual beauty.
2. **Refinement & Proportion** - Sculptures followed **mathematical proportions**, emphasizing **symmetry and natural posture**.
3. **Elaborate Drapery & Ornamentation** - Clothing had **thin, clinging drapery (wet-cloth effect)**, highlighting the contours of the body.
4. **Blend of Realism and Spirituality** - Expressions conveyed **calmness, devotion, and transcendence**.
5. **Emergence of Hindu Iconography:** The Gupta rulers supported Brahmanism, and Gupta sculptures saw the **emergence of images of Vishnu, Shiva, and other Hindu gods.**
6. **Development of Halo & Mudras** - **Halos (prabhavali)** around deities and **hand gestures (mudras)** became distinctive.
7. **Emergence of Bronze Casting** - Metal sculptures, especially **bronze icons**, became more refined.

Important Sculptural Examples

Buddhist Sculptures

1. **Seated Buddha (Sarnath, UP) - Most refined Buddha sculpture** from the period, depicting **Dharmachakra Mudra (Teaching Gesture)**. **Thin robe with a wet-drapery effect**. The face reflects **calmness, enlightenment, and inner peace**.
2. **Standing Buddha (Mathura) -** More **robust and fleshy**, influenced by **earlier Kushana styles**. Hands in **Abhaya Mudra (fearlessness)**, signifying compassion.

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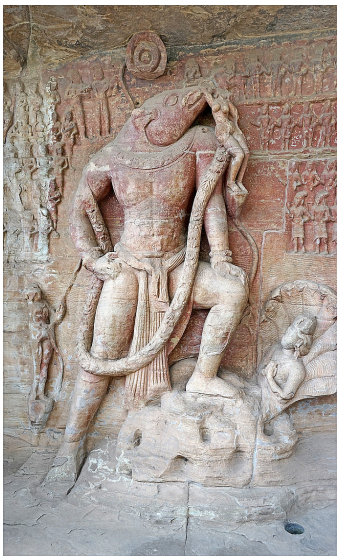
Hindu Sculptures

1. **Vishnu as Varaha (Udayagiri Caves, MP)-** showing **Varaha rescuing Bhudevi (Earth Goddess).**



2. **Standing Vishnu (Mathura & Deogarh) - Four-armed Vishnu**, holding **chakra, conch, lotus, and mace**. Depicts **ornate jewelry, a calm expression, and a divine aura**.
3. **Shiva Linga with Nandi (Udayagiri Caves)** - Early depiction of **Shiva worship**, featuring a **massive rock-cut Shiva Linga**.
4. Jain Sculptures of Jain Tirthankaras (Mathura & Deogarh) - Standing and seated images of Tirthankaras. Minimal ornaments, meditative postures, and serene expressions.

Terracotta Sculptures

1. **Ganga and Yamuna**: Life-sized terracotta figures from Ahichchhatra, originally installed in niches of a Shiva temple
2. **Terracotta Buddha head**: From Devnimori, Gujarat, this early terracotta shows the influence of Greco-Buddhist art

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3. **Terracotta of Krishna battling the horse demon Keshi**: From Uttar Pradesh, this sculpture dates to the 5th century
4. **Bronze Sculptures**
   a. **Sultanganj Buddha (Bihar) - Massive 7.5 feet high bronze statue**, one of the finest Gupta-era metal sculptures. **Detailed ornamentation and symbolic hand gestures (mudras).**
   b. **Hindu Bronze Icons (Brahma from Mirpur Khas, Rajasthan) - Vishnu and Shiva** cast in bronze, **fully developed Gupta aesthetic style**.

Paintings

1. **Religious & Mythological Themes -** Depictions of Buddhist Jataka tales, Hindu deities, and royal court life. Eg. Ajanta Cave 17 - "The Great Departure" shows Prince Siddhartha leaving his palace in search of enlightenment.
2. **Bodhisattva Avalokiteshvara (Ajanta) -** A **painted rock-cut image**, showing a **crowned Bodhisattva** in a **meditative pose**.
3. **Fresco Technique -** Paintings were done using the tempera technique, applying natural pigments on wet plaster. Eg. Ajanta Cave 1 - The famous Padmapani Bodhisattva, where colors remain vivid despite centuries of aging.
4. **Graceful & Realistic Human Figures -** Figures have elongated eyes, curved eyebrows, and serene expressions, creating a sense of spirituality. Eg. Ajanta Cave 16 - "The Dying Princess", portraying sorrow through expressive body language and soft facial features.
5. **Advanced Use of Shading & Perspective -** Artists used shading and gradation to create depth and three-dimensionality. Eg. Ajanta Cave 2 - Depiction of Buddha under the Bodhi tree, where light and shadow effects highlight the divine aura.
6. **Elaborate Ornamentation & Drapery -** Characters wear intricately designed jewelry, crowns, and silk garments with realistic folds. Eg. Ajanta Cave 1 - Vajrapani Bodhisattva, wearing a richly decorated crown and elaborate clothing.
7. **Fluid Movement & Expressions -** Gestures and postures appear natural, emphasizing storytelling through expressions. Eg. Ajanta Cave 17 - Royal Procession Scene, where movement is shown through flowing garments and dynamic poses.
8. **Use of Natural Colors -** Derived from minerals and plants, colors like red, ochre, blue, and green were used. Eg. Bagh Caves - Frescoes use deep reds and ochres, creating a dramatic effect.

Literature

1. **Flourishing of Sanskrit Literature -** Sanskrit became the **court language**, replacing Prakrit. **Eg.** Kalidasa's plays and poems were composed in **classical Sanskrit**.
2. **Growth of Classical Poetry & Drama -** Development of **Mahakavya (epic poetry) and Nataka (drama). Eg.** Kalidasa's **Shakuntala, Meghaduta, and Raghuvamsha** are **masterpieces of Sanskrit poetry**.
3. **Emergence of Prose Literature -** Not just poetry, but **refined prose works** also developed. **Eg.** Vishakhadatta's **Mudrarakshasa** (a political drama about Chandragupta Maurya's rise).
4. **Advancement in Grammar & Linguistics -** Systematic grammar was developed, following **Panini's tradition. Eg.** Bhartrihari's **Vakyapadiya**, discussing **linguistics and philosophy of language**.

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5. **Scientific & Mathematical Writings** - Extensive works in **astronomy, mathematics, and medicine**. **Eg.** Aryabhata's **Aryabhatiya** (mathematics & astronomy), Varahamihira's **Brihat Samhita** (astronomy).
6. **Philosophical & Religious Texts** - Development of **Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain scriptures**. **Eg. Puranas** (Eg. , Vishnu Purana), elaborating on Hindu mythology and cosmology.
7. **Epigraphic & Historical Writings** - Inscriptions in **Sanskrit**, documenting **royal achievements**. **Eg.** Allahabad Pillar Inscription by Harisena, detailing **Samudragupta's conquests**.
8. **Legal & Dharmashastra Texts** - Expansion of **law codes and ethical guidelines** for rulers and society. **Eg.** Narada Smriti and Yajnavalkya Smriti refined earlier **legal traditions**.
9. **Buddhist & Jain Texts** - Buddhist texts were **written in Sanskrit instead of Pali**, influencing later Mahayana traditions. **Eg.** Asvaghosa's **Buddhacharita**, an **epic on Buddha's life**.
10. **Decline of Prakrit & Pali Literature** - Though still in use, **Prakrit and Pali declined** in favor of Sanskrit. **Eg.** Jain Agamas were **translated from Prakrit to Sanskrit**.

Key Literary Figures of the Gupta Period

- **Kalidasa** - The greatest Sanskrit poet and dramatist.
  - Shakuntala - A romantic drama about Shakuntala and King Dushyanta.
  - Meghaduta - A lyrical poem where a yaksha sends a message via a cloud.
  - Raghuvamsha - An epic detailing the Raghu dynasty's heroic lineage.
- **Bharavi** - Author of Kirātārjunīya, depicting Arjuna's encounter with Lord Shiva, emphasizing heroism.
- **Bhāsa** - An early dramatist known for Madhyamavyayoga and Charudattam, exploring complex characters and themes.
- **Panchatantra** - A collection of animal fables by **Vishnu Sharma**, imparting political and moral lessons.
- **Bṛihatkathā** - Attributed to **Gunadhya**, this vast collection of tales influenced later works like Kathasaritsagara.

Science and Technology

1. **Physics**
   a. Vaiseshika school (atomic theory) - discovery of atoms and molecules even before the Greeks.
   b. Brahmagupta (later 6th and early 7th centuries) anticipated Newton by declaring that "All things fall to Earth by law of nature", for it is the nature of the Earth to attract things.
2. **Chemistry**
   a. There was great development in Metallurgy with large-scale production of various metals like gold, silver, copper, iron, brass, and other alloys.
   b. Gupta period copper statue of Buddha from Sultanganj and Iron pillar of Mehrauli at Delhi are finest examples.
3. **Mathematics**
   a. **Introduction of Zero & Decimal System** - The **place value system and decimal notation** were developed. Eg. The **Bakshali Manuscript** (5th century) contains early examples of the **decimal system**.
   b. Knowledge of Geometry is reflected in the Sulvasutras of 5th century BC.
   c. Aryabhatiya (499 CE)(**Surya Siddhanta**) introduced the concept of **Earth's rotation** on its axis, **trigonometric functions, approximation of π (pi) (π = 3.1416), and quadratic equations**.

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4. **Astronomy**
    a. **Heliocentric Concept (Earth's Rotation)** - Aryabhata in **Aryabhattiya** (AD 499) proposed that **Earth rotates on its axis**, causing day and night.
    b. **Planetary Motion & Eclipses** - Aryabhata provided a **scientific explanation for solar and lunar eclipses**.
    c. **Spherical Earth Theory** - He suggested that the Earth was **round**. He calculated the **Earth's circumference as ~39,968 km**, close to modern estimates (~40,075 km).
    d. **Varahamihira** in his book **Brihat Samhita** (AD 6th century) stated that the Moon rotates round the Earth and the Earth rotates around the Sun.
5. **Medicine**
    a. **Charaksamhita of Charaka** (AD 100) refers to various diseases with cure and treatments and also about prevention and control through diet.
    b. **Susrutasamhita of Susruta** refers to various kinds of diseases and operation with anaesthesia, surgical instruments, cataract and rhinoplasty **(nose reconstruction)** etc.
    c. **Use of Herbal Medicine** - Extensive documentation of **medicinal plants**.
    d. **Nalanda University was a center for medical studies.**
6. **Architecture & Engineering**
    a. **Structural Temples** - Transition from **rock-cut to stone-built temples**.
    b. **Water Management** - Development of **stepwells and irrigation systems** for agriculture.
    c. **The Dashavatara Temple (Deogarh) - An early Panchayatana-style temple showcasing Gupta engineering skills.**
7. **Textiles & Chemical Sciences**
    a. **Dyeing Techniques** - Development of **natural dye extraction from plants**. Eg. **Gupta-era textiles and dyed fabrics were highly valued in Silk Road trade.**
    b. **Alchemy & Chemistry** - Experiments with **mercury, sulfur, and herbal formulations** for medicines.
8. **Metallurgy & Engineering**
    a. **Advanced Iron Technology** - High-quality **wrought iron production**, resistant to rust. Eg. **Delhi Iron Pillar** - A 7.2m tall iron pillar, **resistant to corrosion**, showcasing advanced metallurgy.
    b. **Bronze & Copper Statues** - Large bronze icons of **Buddha and Hindu deities** were cast using the **lost-wax technique**. **Eg. The Sultanganj Buddha (Bihar) - A 7.5 ft bronze statue, one of the finest Gupta-era metal sculptures.**

Significance of Gupta Art & Architecture

1. **Political Structure and Governance**
    a. **Royal Patronage**: **Eg. Udayagiri Caves**, commissioned by **Chandragupta II** (Vikramaditya), feature reliefs depicting the king's military conquests and divine association, like the famous **Gajendramoksha** relief, which represents the king's divine role as a protector.
    b. **Imperialism and Military Power: Eg.** The Allahabad Pillar Inscription (or Prayag Prashasti) of Samudragupta
    c. **Divine Kingship**: **Eg.** The **gold coins of Samudragupta** show the king with divine symbols such as halos, portraying him not only as a ruler but also as a divine figure chosen by the gods
2. **Economy**:
    a. **Gupta coinage**, such as the **gold coins of Chandragupta II**, were used not only for domestic trade but also in international trade, particularly with the Roman Empire
    b. **Gupta coins were often made of high-quality gold**, known as "dinaras," as well as silver and copper., reflecting the economic stability and wealth of the Gupta Empire.

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3. **Standardization of Hindu Temple Architecture** - Introduced key elements like **garbhagriha, mandapa, shikhara, and Panchayatana layout**, influencing later temple styles. **(Eg. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh)**
4. **Refinement of Rock-Cut Architecture** - Marked the transition from **Buddhist to Hindu cave temples**, incorporating intricate carvings and sculptures. **(Eg. Udayagiri Caves, Madhya Pradesh)**
5. **Pioneering Sculptural Excellence** - Emphasized **naturalism, idealized beauty, and spiritual grace**, setting a standard for Indian religious iconography. **(Eg. Seated Buddha at Sarnath)**
6. **Growth of Narrative Paintings** - Developed advanced techniques of **shading, perspective, and storytelling**, influencing Indian and Southeast Asian art. **(Eg. Ajanta Cave 1 - Padmapani Bodhisattva)**
7. **Evolution of Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain Art** - Supported the artistic growth of **multiple religious traditions**, creating diverse yet interconnected artistic expressions. **(Eg. Bodh Gaya Buddha images)**
8. **Advanced Metallurgical Achievements** - Demonstrated **high-level ironwork and bronze casting techniques**, leading to corrosion-resistant structures and sculptures. **(Eg. Delhi Iron Pillar, Sultanganj Buddha)**
9. **Integration of Science & Aesthetics** - Applied **mathematical principles** to temple proportions, ensuring symmetry and architectural balance. **(Eg. Gupta temple designs inspired Nagara and Dravida styles)**
10. **Influence on Later Indian Dynasties** - Provided the artistic foundation for **Chalukya, Pallava, and Rajput temple-building traditions**. **(Eg. Ellora rock-cut temples)**
11. **Spread of Indian Art to Southeast Asia** - Gupta artistic principles influenced **Khmer, Thai, and Javanese temple architecture and sculpture**. **(Eg. Borobudur, Indonesia)**
12. **Cultural & Religious Legacy** - Established **classical depictions of Hindu gods, Buddhist deities, and Jain Tirthankaras**, shaping Indian religious imagery for centuries. **(Eg. Gupta-style Buddha statues influenced art in Sri Lanka, China, and Japan)**

Its legacy is reflected in **UNESCO World Heritage Sites** like **Ajanta and Ellora Caves** (Buddhist and Hindu rock-cut art) and **Nalanda Mahavihara** (Buddhist learning center).

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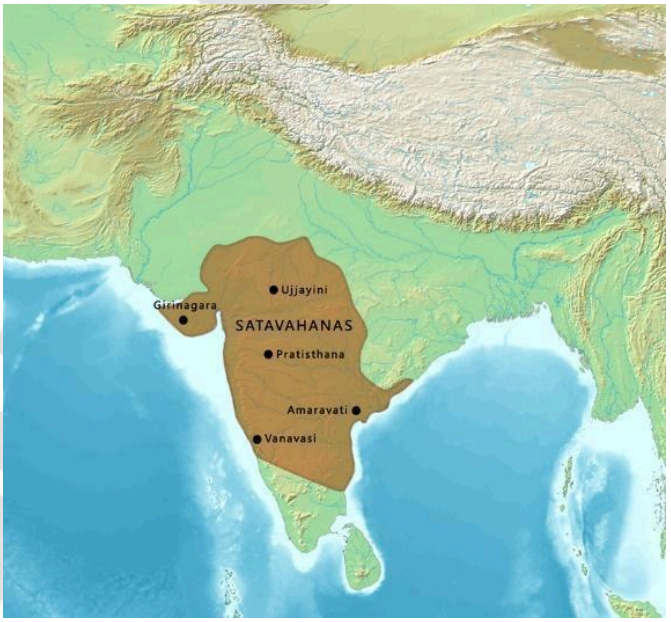
Satvahana Empire

The Satvahanas Empire ruled the Deccan region from the 1st century BCE to the early 3rd century AD. Their reign was crucial in shaping the political, cultural, and economic landscape of South and Central India.

Art and Architecture of Satvahanas

Stupa Architecture

1. The sculptures of **the Amaravati Stupa r**epresent the architectural development of the Satavahana periods.
   a. The stupas at Amaravati are predominantly made of a **distinctive white marble.**
   b. Amravati is full of sculptures depicting various scenes from the life of Buddha.
   c. At Amravati, there is a beautiful scene showing Buddha's feet being worshipped.
   d. Secular images were also made in the form of female images, trees, animals, and birds.
   e. Sculptures at Amaravati have a profound and quiet naturalism in human, animal, and floral forms.
2. They also constructed a large **number of stupas** at Goli, Jaggiahpeta, Gantasala, Amravati Bhattiprolu, and Shri Parvatam.



Cave Architecture

Ajanta Caves	The **Ajanta Caves** (Caves 9, 10, 12, and 13) were excavated during their rule and adorned with early Buddhist paintings and carvings.
Karle Lonavala, Maharashtra	• Large chaitya hall, exquisite wooden and stone carvings, and one of the largest early Buddhist structures. • Carved from living rock. Huge lion pillar infront of chaitya hall
Pandavleni Nashik, Maharashtra	• On the banks of Gomai River • 24 Buddhist Caves of Hinayana sect • sculptures of Buddha and Bodhisattvas. • 3rd cave is financed by Gautami Balsari- Inscription

Sculptures

1. **Amravati School of Sculpture - Known for white limestone sculptures depicting Jataka tales and social life.**
   a. The Satavahanas developed the **Amravati School of Art**, known for its **high technical ability** and intricate designs.
   b. **Distinct features**: Ayaka pillars, Ayakapatas, Purna Kumbha motifs, and Lotus motifs.
   c. The school was influenced by both **Gandhara and Mathura** styles but retained a **distinctly South Indian identity**.
2. Satavahana sculptures share characteristics with **Nagarjunakonda sculptures**.

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3. **Religious Influence on Art**
   a. Both **Buddhism and Brahmanism** flourished under Satavahana rule. **Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati** became major Buddhist centers.
   b. Brahmanical deities like **Vishnu, Garuda, and Naga** were also depicted in sculptures. The **Amaresvara temple's Nandi sculpture** is a fine example of **Brahmanical art** from this period.
4. **Evolution of Buddhist Iconography**
   a. Early Buddhist art followed the **Hinayana tradition**, depicting Buddha symbolically (Eg. **footprints, Bodhi tree, begging bowl**).
   b. With the rise of **Mahayana Buddhism**, Buddha was depicted in **human form**, showing **oval faces, rounded shoulders, and symbolic hand gestures** like the **Abhaya and Pravachana mudras**.
5. **Artistic Style and Techniques**
   a. Early Satavahana art was **flat and simple**, but later it became more **naturalistic, refined, and dynamic**.
   b. Sculptures had **greater plasticity, freedom of movement, and intricate details**.
   c. **Figures were elongated, graceful, and sensuous**, especially female forms with **full breasts, wide hips, and supple bodies**.
   d. Scenes often had **crowded compositions**, creating a **sense of movement and energy**.
6. The **erotic sculptures are few in number**, but their presence is felt. The images were full of vigour, activity, and grace.
7. Sculptures feature **realistic expressions, elaborate jewelry, and finely carved drapery**, showing high craftsmanship. **Eg. Yaksha and Yakshi figures at Karle and Bhaja caves**

Paintings

1. The Satavahana paintings are the earliest surviving specimens (excluding prehistoric rock art) in India, and they are to be found only at the **Ajanta Caves.** Caves IX and X were patronised by Satavahana, and the painting throughout the caves appear to have started with them.
2. **Narrative Storytelling Approach** - Paintings were arranged in a **continuous narrative style**, illustrating stories in sequential panels. **Eg. Jataka tale paintings at Ajanta depict multiple events within a single composition.**

Significance of Satavahana

1. **Political Unification of the Deccan**
   a. The Satavahanas **reunified the Deccan** after the decline of the Mauryan Empire.
   b. They acted as a **bridge between North and South India**, ensuring cultural and political continuity.
2. **Cultural Flourishing:** The Satavahanas were great patrons of art and culture, evident from the stupendous architecture and intricate sculptures in places like **Amravati.**
3. **Social Integration:** They promoted social harmony through a policy of religious tolerance.
   a. Buddhist monuments and inscriptions found in their region, like those at **Sanchi and Nasik.**
   b. Simultaneously, the rulers continued Vedic traditions and performed Vedic sacrifices. Eg. **Ashvamedha (horse sacrifice) by Gautamiputra Satakarni.**
4. **Contributions to Art and Architecture** - The Satavahanas laid the foundation for **rock-cut cave architecture, stupas, and sculptures**. **Eg.** The **Amaravati Stupa** is a masterpiece of early Buddhist art, known for its intricate carvings and narrative panels.
5. **Cultural Integration and Literature** - Satavahana period witnessed **the flourishing of Prakrit literature** and inscriptions. **Eg.** The **Gatha Saptashati**, a collection of **Prakrit poems**, is attributed to Hala, a Satavahana ruler.

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6. **Influence on Later Dynasties**
   a. The administrative and cultural traditions of the Satavahanas **influenced later South Indian kingdoms** like the **Ikshvakus, Pallavas, and Chalukyas**.
   b. Their **maritime trade policies** were continued by the **Cholas and Cheras**, leading to India's global trade dominance in later centuries.
7. **Administrative Innovations:**
   a. They introduced administrative innovations, including a well-structured bureaucracy with officers such as **'Amatyas' and 'Mahamatras'**
   b. The Satavahanas were the **first Indian dynasty** to issue **coins with royal portraits**, reflecting a **strong sense of identity and statehood**. Their coins were inscribed in **Prakrit and Dravidian scripts**, indicating **linguistic diversity**. **Eg.** Gautamiputra Satakarni's coins depict him as the "destroyer of Kshatriyas," emphasizing his military achievements.
8. **Economic Impact:**
   a. By promoting trade and commerce, both internally and with the Roman Empire, they significantly boosted the economy.
   b. Land grants made to Brahmins and Buddhist monks, not only served religious and social ends but also promoted agricultural expansion into the frontier regions.

The **assimilation of faiths**, **military power** and **trading prowess** makes them one of the **most important empires** in the history of the Deccan region and at large, that of **Bharatavarsha**.

Pallava Empire

The Pallava period (**275 AD to 897 AD**) marks the transformation of Tamil society, integrating Sanskritic traditions with local Tamil culture, creating a unique socio-religious synthesis. - **R. Champakalakshmi**

Important Rulers

Sivaskanda Varman	• According to the early Prakrit charters of the Pallavas, the first great King was Sivaskandavarman
Simhavarman/Simhavishnu (575 AD - 600 AD)	• **He was a Buddhist** +Included Sri Lanka in his kingdom. • Defeated the contemporary Tamil ruler.
Mahendravarman (600 AD - 630 AD)	• **Inscription of Mandagapattu**: described him as Vichitrachita, Chitrakarapuli and Chaityakari. He wrote a play Mattaavilasa Prahasana • **Defeated by Pulakesin II**
Narasimhavarman I / Mahamalla/Mamalla (630 AD - 668 AD)	• **Killed Pulakesin II in Battle of Vatapi and assumed the title 'Vatapikonda'**. • Sent a naval **expedition to Sri Lanka** and reinstated Sinhalese Prince Manivarma.
Narasimhavarman II (695 AD - 722 AD)	• Also known as Rajasimha, his regime was mostly peaceful. He was more inclined towards the development of art and architecture.

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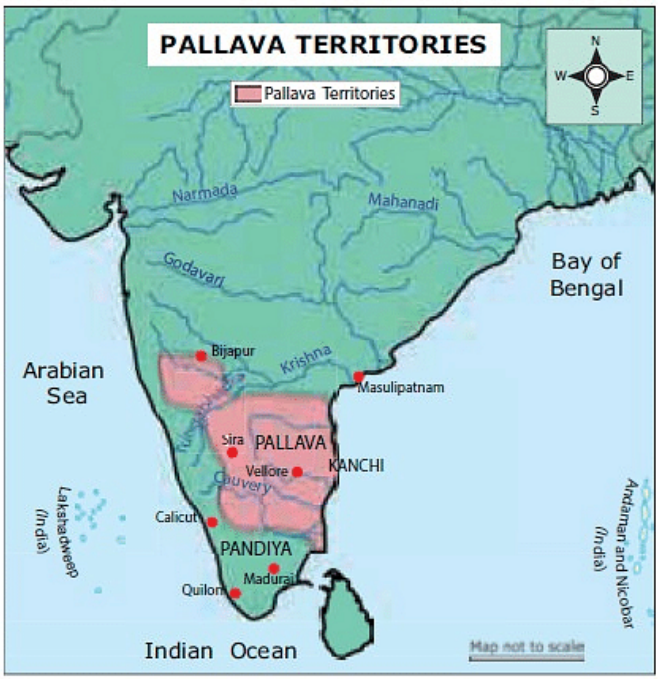
Nandivarman II (730 AD - 795 AD)	• Nandivarman II was the last important king of the Pallava dynasty. • In 740 AD, Nandivarman II **suffered a humiliating defeat against the Chalukya** King, Vikramaditya II, who occupied Kanchi once again.
Aparajitavarman (880 AD - 897 AD)	• The Chola king Aditya I, defeated the last Pallava ruler Aparajitavarman and seized the Kanchi region.

Society of Pallavas



1. The caste system became rigid and the Brahmans occupied a high place in the society. In addition to caring for temples, the kings and nobles of the empire gave them land grants (**Devadhana and Brahmadeya**).
2. The ruler carried out **rituals to ascribe Kshatriya status to himself**. The ceremony involved conducting sacraments laid down for the twice-born castes.
3. While society was **predominantly Hindu**, **Buddhism and Jainism coexisted** under royal patronage, with temples built for **Shaivism and Vaishnavism**
4. Women participated in **temple donations, religious activities, and arts**, though they had **limited political power**. Practices like **Sati were rare** but existed

Religion of Pallavas

1. The Pallavas Dynasty followed **Hinduism.** They performed various yajnas and built many temples for Hindu gods and goddesses, such as **Shiva, Vishnu, Brahma, and Lakshmi.**
2. The **Shaiva Nayanars and the Vaishnava Alwars** contributed to the rise of Shaivism and Vaishnavism under the Bhakti Movement.
3. The Vedic tradition was further reinforced by **Advaita philosophy of Sankaracharya,** aimed at cleaning the Vedic philosophy of its obscurities and its inconsistencies thereby making it both comprehensible and acceptable to the people at large.
4. Though the Pallava Kings followed Hinduism, they were generally **liberal towards other religions and sects.**

Education & Literature of Pallavas

1. **Ghatikas, educational institutions** catering to the needs of resurgent Sanatana Dharma, were pervasive. Every temple had a Ghatika attached to it. Eg. The University of Kanchi was the most well-known educational institution comparable to Nalanda University.
2. However, by the 8th century, the **Matha, a combination of a rest house, a feeding centre and a seminary**, began to play a crucial role in spreading education of a particular sect.
3. **Sanskrit Literature** - The **Kiratarjuniyam of Bharavi, Dasakumaracharita of Dandi and the Mattavilasaprahasana of Mahendravarman I** were the best Sanskrit works of the period.

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4. **Bhakti Movement:** This era witnessed the rise of devotional hymns by **Nayanmars** (devotees of Shiva) and **Alwars** (devotees of Vishnu).
   a. Tevaram: Composed by Nayanmars, these hymns are central to Tamil Shaiva tradition.
   b. Nalayira Divya Prabandham: A compilation of Alwar hymns, enriching Tamil Vaishnavism.
5. **Development of Script:** The Pallava dynasty significantly contributed to the evolution of the **Grantha script**, which was employed for writing Sanskrit. Over time, this **script developed into the Tamil script**. Eg. Pallava inscriptions in the G**rantha scrip**t are present in Mahabalipuram.
6. The **Tamil literature** had also developed under the patronage of the Pallavas.
   a. Tiruvelluvar, the author of 'kural' lived during this period.
   b. Perundevanar was patronized by Nandivarman II and he translated the Mahabharata as Bharathavenba in Tamil.
   c. Nandikkalambagam was another important work but the name of the author of this work is not known.

Art and Architecture of Pallavas

Temple Architecture

The Dravidian style of temple architecture began with the Pallava rule. They introduced the art of excavating temples from the rock.

1. **1st stage (rock-cut temples): Mahendra Group of temples known as Mandapas**
   a. Built by **Mahendravarman I;** At Panamalai, Mandagattu, Kanchipuram
   b. **Mandagattu Inscription** mention him as Vichitrachitta, Chitrakarapuli (tiger among artist), **Chaityakari (Temple builder)**
   c. **It did not use bricks, iron, lime, wood, etc.**
   d. These Mandapas were the pillared Varandas which consisted of Garbhagirha at the end.
   e. Eg. Rock-cut temples at **Mahabalipuram**, Trimurti Mandapa of Mandaggapattu.

2. **2nd stage: Mahalipuram temples: monolithic rathas**
   a. by **Narsimhavarman 1**, Port city of Mamallapuram, UNESCO World heritage site.
   b. **free-standing monolithic shrines called 'Rathas' (chariots) built of granites** which were constructed alongside pillared halls.
   c. The **Mandapas** are more ornamental, with pillars built on lions' heads.
   d. Eg. Mahishasuramardhini Mandapa, Tirumurthi Mandapam and Varaha Madapam.
3. **3rd stage: Rajasimha group (Narsimhavarman 2):** Structural development of temples.
   a. These temples were built by using the **soft sand rocks.**
   b. **Shore Temple complEg.** Facing east towards the sea and has three shrines -east and west to Shiva and the middle for Vishnu (Anantashayana). It is India's first Green Energy Archaeological Site.

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c. **Kailashnathar Temple at Kanchipuram:** Largest single work of art ever undertaken in India **(built by using sand stones)**

4. **4th stage: Nandivarman Group**
   a. Declining stage of south Indian Architecture
   b. Small Temples were built
   c. Eg. **Vaikundaperumal; Tirunelveli; Mukteshwara Temples**

Cave Architecture

1. **Monolithic Excavation:** Pallava artisans pioneered the technique of carving entire temples from single rock formations, transitioning from earlier wooden constructions to more durable stone edifices.
2. **Architectural Elements:**
   a. **Pillared Facades:** The cave entrances often feature intricately carved pillars with lion bases, a distinctive Pallava motif.
   b. **Sculpted Panels:** Interior walls are adorned with bas-reliefs depicting Hindu deities and mythological narratives, reflecting the religious devotion of the era.
3. **Notable Examples:**
   a. **Mahishasuramardini Mandapa:** Located in Mamallapuram, this cave temple houses exquisite carvings of deities like Vishnu and Durga, exemplifying Pallava artistry.
   b. **Varaha Cave Temple:** Also in Mamallapuram, this temple features detailed panels portraying Vishnu's Varaha avatar rescuing Bhudevi, showcasing the Pallavas' narrative sculpting skills.

Sculpture

1. **Only sculptures** in most of the cave temples of Mahendra's time are the **dvarapalakas**

   a. **Rock-Cut Phase (Early Pallavas)** - Monolithic cave temples with **bas-reliefs** (Eg. "Descent of the Ganges," Mahabalipuram). Simple yet expressive carvings depicting Hindu deities and mythological scenes.
   b. **Structural Temple Sculptures** - Transition from rock-cut to **free-standing temple sculptures** (Eg. Kailasanathar Temple, Kanchipuram). Highly detailed narrative panels showcasing episodes from Hindu epics.
   c. **Intricate Stone Carvings** - Use of **intricate designs and sculpted pillars** with lion motifs (Mahabalipuram, Kanchipuram). Depictions of gods, celestial beings, and saints with expressive postures.
   d. **Bronze Sculptures (Later Pallavas) - Early metal casting techniques** for religious icons (Eg. Vishnu and Shiva bronzes). Graceful, well-ornamented figures influencing later Chola bronzes.
   e. **Iconography and Themes** - Emphasis on **Shaivism and Vaishnavism**, with sculptures of Shiva, Vishnu, and consorts.
2. **Recently eighth-century Kotravai sculpture** near Ulundurpet was unearthed by ASI
3. **Mahishasuramardini Mandapa (Mahabalipuram)** - Features a **bas-relief of Goddess Durga** slaying the buffalo demon Mahishasura. Showcases **dynamic movement and fine detailing** in Pallava rock-cut art.
4. **Descent of the Ganges (Arjuna's Penance) - Largest bas-relief panel** in India, depicts **Bhagiratha's penance** to bring Ganges to Earth. Contains detailed carvings of **animals, celestial beings, and sages**.
5. **Varaha Cave Temple (Mahabalipuram)** - Features a **sculpture of Varaha (Vishnu's boar incarnation) rescuing Bhudevi**. Depicts fine **curved forms and expressive postures** in Pallava relief work.

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6. **Kailasanathar Temple (Kanchipuram) - First structural temple** built by Rajasimha Pallava. Richly decorated with **sculptures of Shiva, Parvati, and Ganas**, along with intricate panels.
7. **Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)** - Features **intricate carvings of Nandi, lion pillars, and celestial figures**.
8. **Gangaikonda Pallava Isvaram (Kanchipuram)** - Famous for **large panels of Shiva, Vishnu, and Brahma** in Pallava sculptural style.
9. **Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva Reliefs (Mamallapuram)** - Depict **trinity gods (Trimurti)** with refined **body proportions and ornamentation**.
10. **Early Bronze Sculptures (Pallava Period, 7th-8th Century CE) - Bronze images of Shiva and Vishnu** showcase the transition from rock-cut to metal sculpture. Predecessors of the famous **Chola bronzes**.
11. **Pancha Rathas (Five Rathas, Mahabalipuram)** - Monolithic rock-cut structures with **sculptures of deities, animals (elephants, lions), and warriors**.

Importance of Pallavas

1. **Foundation of Dravidian Temple Architecture** - The Pallavas pioneered the **transition from rock-cut to structural temples**, influencing later Chola, Vijayanagara, and South Indian temple styles. **Eg.** Kailasanathar Temple (Kanchipuram), Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram).
2. **Development of Sculpture and Art** - Pallava art introduced **detailed bas-reliefs, narrative panels, and monolithic sculptures**, setting the foundation for South Indian artistic traditions. **Eg.** "Descent of the Ganges" at Mahabalipuram, Mahishasuramardini Mandapa.
3. **Promotion of Sanskrit and Tamil Literature** - Pallavas patronized **both Sanskrit and Tamil scholars**, fostering cultural integration. **Eg.** King Mahendravarman I authored Mattavilasa Prahasana
4. **Political Unification and Administration** - Unified the **northern Tamil region and southern Andhra**, establishing an efficient **provincial and local governance system**.
5. **Military Strength and Rivalries** - Defended against **Chalukyas, Pandyas, and Rashtrakutas**, maintaining dominance in South India. **Eg.** Narasimhavarman I defeated Pulakesin II (Chalukyas) and captured Vatapi.
6. The group of monuments at Mahabalipuram, built by the Pallava kings, has received global attention and appreciation and has been put on UNESCO's world heritage list.

The Pallavas **laid the foundation of South Indian temple architecture, literature, and administration**, leaving a lasting impact on **art, religion, and governance** that shaped medieval South India.

Rashtrakuta Empire

The Rashtrakutas (**753-982 CE**), particularly under rulers like Dantidurga and Amoghavarsha I, were notable patrons of art and literature, best exemplified by the grandeur of the rock-cut temples at Ellora

Important Rulers

Rulers	Contributions
Dantidurga	• Dantidurga was the founder of the Rashtrakuta dynasty. • He overthrew the Chalukyan king, Kirtivarman II, and established the dynasty's rule in the Deccan.

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Rulers	Contributions
Krishna I	His greatest contribution was the construction of the architectural marvel, the Kailasnath Temple at Ellora, which stands as a remarkable testament to the rock-cut architectural techniques of ancient India.
Govinda II	• The capital was shifted to Malkhed from the previous capital, Nashik. • He is noted for his efforts to expand the empire, mainly through military campaigns, one of which led to the capture of the king of Lanka and his minister
Dhruva	• During his reign Rashtrakuta power reached its zenith. • He defeated Pallavas, Eastern Chalukyas, Palas and Prathiharas. • By defeating Vatsaraja of Prathihara and Dharmapala of pala dynasty he conquered Kannauj • He was the first Deccan king to control Kannauj.
Amoghavarsha	• Amoghavarsha is considered the greatest of the Rashtrakuta kings, ruling for an impressive 68 years. • His reign is often compared to that of Emperor Ashoka, as he was beloved by his subjects for his wisdom and peace-loving nature.
Indra III	• Al-Masudi, an Arab traveller, regarded the Rashtrakuta king Balhara (likely Indra III) as the greatest king of India during his reign.
Krishna III	• He defeated Parantaka Chola in battle of Takkolam • Successors of Krishna III **were** too weak to save kingdom from its decline

Society of Rashtrakutas

1. **Religion-based social life** that followed Hindu traditions with tolerance for other religions like Buddhism and Jainism
2. **Divisions: Al-Biruni** mentions **sixteen castes,** including the four basic castes of Brahmins, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudras.
   a. **Lower castes:** The **Antyajas** caste provided many menial services to the wealthy. Brahmins **enjoyed the highest status**; only those Kshatriyas in the Sat-Kshatriya sub-caste (noble Kshatriyas) were higher in status.
   b. **Brahmins:** The careers of Brahmins usually related to education, the judiciary, astrology, mathematics, poetry and philosophy or the occupation of **hereditary administrative posts.** Also, Brahmins increasingly practised

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non-Brahmanical professions (agriculture, trade in betel nuts and martial posts.

3. **Inter-caste relations** existed, including inter-caste marriages, though less common for Brahmins. In the later stages, **Inter-caste functions were rare as dining together between people of various castes was avoided.**
4. **The Muslim newcomers were called Navayats, who settled particularly on the west coast of India.**
5. **Occupation:** People in the professions of sailing, hunting, weaving, cobbling, basket making and fishing **belonged to specific castes** or subcastes.
6. **Family system:** Joint families were the norm, but **legal separations between brothers** and even father and son have been recorded in inscriptions.
7. **Position of women:** Women and daughters had **rights over property and land**. Money and properties inheritable by women were called **Stridhana. The widow inherited their husband's properties.**
8. **As per an Arab merchant Sulaiman, Sati or Sahagamana (self-immolation) was practiced among the royal family but it was voluntary.**
9. **Entertainment:** Dancing was a popular entertainment, and inscriptions speak of royal women being charmed by dancers, both male and female, in the king's palace.
10. Other recreational activities included **attending animal fights** of the same or different species.
11. **Superstitious Beliefs - Eg. Alberuni** informs us that people considered the sneezing as a bad omen. **Pushpadanta** also considers cow touch and pipal tree touch as productive of good results and sitting of crow overhead as a bad omen.

Religious Contributions of Rashtrakutas

1. **Support for Multiple Religions**: The Rashtrakuta kings supported Hinduism, Jainism, and Buddhism. They showed religious tolerance in the traditional spirit of the time.
2. Significant patronage of **Jainism**, particularly under the reign of **Amoghavarsha,** a devout follower of the Digambara sect of Jainism. Their feudatory, the Western Ganga dynasty, built Jain monuments at Shravanabelagola and Kambadahalli.
3. **Buddhism** also found support and was popular in places such as Dambal and Balligavi, although it had declined significantly by this time
4. **Hinduism**:
   a. They patronized followers of the Siva, Vaishnava, and Shakta faiths. Almost all of their inscriptions begin with an invocation to god Vishnu or Siva.
   b. King Krishna I's coins bear the legend "Parama Maheshwara," another name for Lord Siva. The famous Kailasanatha temple at Ellora and other rock-cut caves are attributed to them.
   c. Their family deity was a goddess named Latana, also known as Rashtrashyena, Manasa Vindyavasini

Art, Architecture & Literature under Rashtrakutas

Temple Architecture

1. **Kailasanatha Temple:**
   a. The **Kailasanatha Temple** is the largest rock-cut **Hindu temple** within the **Ellora Caves** in Maharashtra, India. **King Krishna I** initiated the construction of the **Kailasanatha Temple**.
   b. The architectural style is Dravidian, lacking the Shikhara common to the Nagara style, and is similar to the Virupaksha temple at Pattadakal in Karnataka. The temple follows the **Karnata Dravida** architectural style.
   c. Its four main components include the **main shrine, entrance gateway, Nandi pavilion, and a courtyard surrounded by smaller shrines**.

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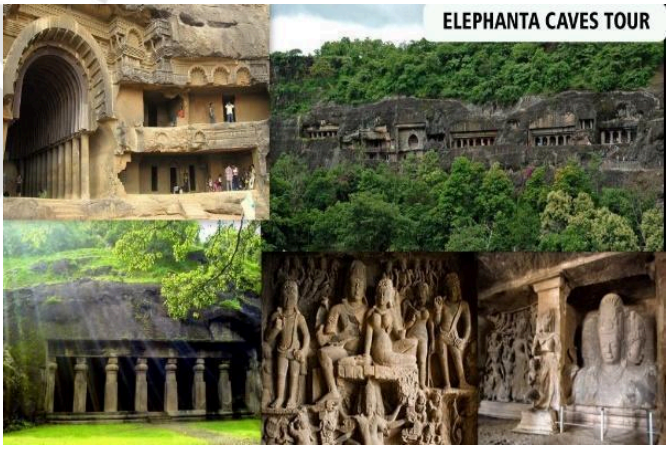
d. The temple is renowned for its **intricate sculptures and architectural brilliance**.
e. A notable sculpture depicts **Goddess Durga slaying the Buffalo demon**.
f. Another sculpture portrays **Ravana attempting to lift Mount Kailasa, the abode of Lord Shiva**.
g. The **walls of the temple are adorned with scenes from the Ramayana**.

2. **Navalinga Temple:**
   a. The **Navalinga temple complex** was built in the **9th century** by **Amoghavarsha I or his son Krishna II**.
   b. Located in **Kukkanur, Koppal district, Karnataka**, it lies **north of Itagi and east of Gadag**.
   c. The **nine temples**, built in **Dravidian style**, derive their name from the presence of **lingas**, symbolizing **Lord Shiva**.
3. Besides Ellora and Elephanta, the Rashtrakutas also contributed to the Kashivishvanatha temple and the Jain Narayana temple at Pattadakal in modern Karnataka.
4. Other rock-cut temples in the Maharashtra region include the Dhumer Lena and Dashvatara cave temples in Ellora, and the Jogeshvari temple near Mumbai6. There are also Rashtrakuta temples around Gulbarga in Sedam, Chincholi, and Aland Taluks

Cave Architecture

1. **Elephanta cave:**
   a. **Elephanta Island**, located **6 miles from Mumbai**, houses **7 rock-cut caves**. The **Portuguese** named it **Elephanta** after a large elephant statue they found.
   b. The entrance features **massive Dwarapalaka figures**, enhancing its grandeur.
   c. Sculptures like **Nataraja and Sadashiva** surpass even **Ellora** in beauty and craftsmanship.
   d. Other notable sculptures include **Ardhanarishvara** and **Maheshamurti**.
   e. The **Trimurti** sculpture, the most imposing, represents **Shiva as creator, preserver, and destroyer**.
   f. **Elephanta Caves** is a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**.



2. **Dasavathara cave:**
   a. **Cave 15 (Dashavatara Cave)** at **Ellora** is among the finest rock-cut temples.
   b. This **two-story temple** features **Shiva as Nataraja** and **Shiva emerging from a Linga**, with **Vishnu and Brahma** paying homage.
   c. The **most striking relief** depicts **Narasimha slaying Hiranyakashipu**, emerging from a pillar.
   d. Other notable reliefs include **Gangadhara, Shiva-Parvati's marriage, Tripurantika, Markandeya, Garuda, Nandi in the mandapa, and a dancing Shiva**.
   e. The **panel arrangements in dyads** symbolize **both cooperative and antagonistic energy**, highlighting **power transference**.

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Literary Contributions

1. The **Rashtrakuta rulers** were **great patrons of learning**, fostering the growth of **Kannada and Sanskrit literature**.
2. The **three gems of Kannada literature-Pampa, Ranna, and Ponna**-flourished under their patronage. Their notable Kannada works include:
   a. **Pampa** - Adipurana, Vikramarjuna Vijaya
   b. **Ranna** - Gadhayudha
   c. **Ponna** - Shantipurana
3. **Amoghavarsha I** authored Kavirajamarga, the **first treatise on Kannada poetics**, though some attribute it to **court poet Srivijaya**.
4. **Mahaviracharya**, a mathematician, composed Ganitasarasangraha in **Sanskrit**.
5. **Halayudha** contributed to Sanskrit literature with Kavirahasya.

Significance of Rashtrakutas

Islamic scholars like **Al-Masudi** and **Ibn Khordadbih (10th century CE)** highlighted the **Rashtrakutas' supremacy**, noting that other Indian rulers revered them as a higher power and **paid homage in submission**.

1. **Powerful Dynasty** - The Rashtrakutas dominated **Deccan and North India**, often clashing with the **Pratiharas and Palas** in the **Tripartite Struggle** for control over **Kannauj**. **Dhruva Dharavarsha (8th century CE)** defeated the **Pala ruler Dharmapala** and **Pratihara king Vatsaraja**.
2. **Patrons of Learning** - They promoted **Kannada and Sanskrit literature**. **Amoghavarsha I** wrote Kavirajamarga, the **first Kannada treatise on poetics**. **Pampa** composed Adipurana, a **Jain epic**, while **Ranna** authored Gadhayudha. In Sanskrit, **Mahaviracharya** wrote the **mathematical treatise Ganitasarasangraha**.
3. **Architectural Marvels** - The **Kailasanatha Temple at Ellora**, built by **Krishna I**, is one of the greatest **rock-cut temples** in India, sculpted from a single rock.
4. **Religious Tolerance** - Rashtrakuta rulers patronized **Shaivism, Vaishnavism, Jainism, and Buddhism**. **Amoghavarsha I**, though a Jain follower, granted **land and resources** to Shaiva temples and Buddhist monasteries.
5. **Economic Prosperity** - The Rashtrakutas controlled **important trade routes** connecting the Deccan with **Arab traders**. The **Arab traveler Sulaiman (9th century CE)** described their empire as the **richest and most powerful in India**, exporting **spices, textiles, and precious stones**.
6. **Administrative Efficiency** - The Rashtrakutas adopted a **decentralized governance system** with local administration led by **feudal lords (Samantas)**. Inscriptions (**Sanjan Copper Plate (871 CE)**) highlight a structured tax and revenue system.
7. **Cultural Synthesis** - The Rashtrakutas encouraged **art, music, and temple traditions**, influencing **later Chalukya and Hoysala architecture**.

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Kushan Dynasty (1st-3rd century CE)

The **Kushanas** rose to power after the **Parthians**. They were one of the **five clans** of the **Yueh-Chi** (Moon Tribe/Tocharians), originally from the **North Central Asian steppes near China**.

Coinage -

1. The coins of the Kushana were mostly of gold and to some extent of copper.
2. Kushan coins were of **high quality,** matching **Roman weight standards.**
3. The rulers used grand titles like **"King of Kings," "Caesar," and "Lord of All Lands"** on their coins.
4. Coin designs followed the **Greco-Bactrian style,** featuring the king on one side and a deity on the other.
5. **The Gupta Empire's early coinage was influenced by late Kushan coin designs.**

Kushan Empire Religion

1. The **Kushan Empire** embraced **religious diversity**, reflecting its **multicultural** nature.
2. They followed **Zoroastrianism, Buddhism, and Hinduism**, depicting **Iranian, Greek, Brahmanical, Buddhist, and Zoroastrian** deities on their coins.
3. Under **Kanishka**, **Iranian influences** dominated, with **Nana** as the chief deity, though he also **patronized Buddhism** and convened the **Fourth Buddhist Council**.
4. **Mahayana Buddhism** flourished during his reign, and he sent **missionaries to China and Central Asia** for its propagation.
5. **Huvishka**, his successor, expanded religious representation, featuring **Greek, Brahmanical, Buddhist, and Roman deities** on his coins.

Kushan Empire Society

1. The **Kushan society** retained the **fourfold caste system** (Brahmanas, Kshatriyas, Vaisyas, and Sudras), but **caste rigidity was less strict**, allowing **foreigners to integrate into Hindu society**. As per Manusmiriti Foreign Rulers got mixed and got the title of Vratya Kshatriya.
2. The Kushanas were of the Yue-chi origin and were foreigners who were eclectic in their religious belief to begin with. But they later became either Buddhists or worshippers of Siva or Vishnu.
3. Institution of Child marriage started in Kushana (Girl's best Age decided in 8-10 years).
4. Abolition of Upanayana to female.

Art & Architecture of Kushans

The art and architecture of the Kushans were influenced by a variety of cultures, including:

1. **Gandhara School of Art**: This school marked a blend of Graeco-Romano-Buddhist styles and techniques. While owing its origins to Greek and Roman styles, the art was essentially Indian in spirit.

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2. **Hellenistic:** The Gandhara school of art was heavily influenced by Hellenistic artistic traditions, which were introduced to the region by the Greeks.
3. The **Mathura School of Art** emphasized **Hindu deities** like **Vishnu, Shiva, and Devi**, featuring a **distinctly Indian style** with **softer features and dynamic movement** in sculptures.
4. **Stupas** - The **Kushans** were prolific builders, expanding and renovating **Buddhist stupas**. **Eg.** The **Great Stupa at Sanchi**, originally **Mauryan**, was **expanded with gateways and railings** under Kushan influence. **Eg. Kanishka built a grand stupa and monastery in Peshawar**, housing Buddha's relics.
5. **Monasteries** - They established **Buddhist monasteries**, serving as **centers of learning and religious practice**. **Eg.** The **Dharmarajika monastery** in **Taxila** featured **monk cells around a courtyard and a central stupa**.
6. **Rock-cut Caves** - Continued the tradition of **carving chaityas (prayer halls) and viharas (monasteries)** in western India. **Eg.** The **Kanheri Caves near Mumbai**, adorned with intricate carvings, reflect Kushan-era religious practices.
7. Caves hewn in solid rock with pillars and sculptures showed great improvement over the excavation techniques used during Asoka's time.
8. Chaityas with rows of columns on two sides were fine examples of art, sculpture, and architecture, with the Chaitya at Karle being an excellent illustration
9. **Urban Planning** - Developed **well-planned cities** with advanced infrastructure.
    a. **Eg. Kanishkapura** and **Huvishkapura**, established in **Kashmir** by **Kanishka and Huvishka**, respectively.
    b. **Eg.** The **400-ft tower at Peshawar**, mainly **wooden**, was built under the supervision of **Greek engineer Agesilous**.
    c. **Eg. Kanishka also built a tower near Taxila**, showcasing his architectural patronage.

Gandhara School of Art

1. The Influence of this art was mainly Hellenistic in the context of style and Buddhist in the context of religion.
2. Certain distinctive features of this art were as follows:
    a. The most remarkable contribution was the evolution of the image of Buddha, possibly in imitation of the Greek God Apollo. Images of Buddha and Bodhisattvas were created in black stone illustrating the past and present lives of Buddha.
    b. **Realistic representation of the human figure** (it is the hallmark of this art form), clearly indicating limbs and other organs of the body, i.e. the representation was a prototype of the human body.
    c. In realistic representation, the **anatomical accuracy** was emphasised.
    d. **Distinguished muscles** constituted a distinctive part of the images made under this art.
    e. The hairstyle **was curly**, which represents **Greek influence.**
    f. The **drapery was transparent** and here we find a beautiful harmony between the drapery and physical features of human body
    g. One excellent example was the **Bamiyan Buddha of Afghanistan**

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h. V. A. Smith noted that Gandhara art was based on the cosmopolitan art of Asia Minor and the Roman Empire. The Gandhara School's technique spread through China to the Far East, influencing the art of China and Japan

Mathura School of Art

1. The chief patron of this art form were Kushanas and **chief material was white spotted red sandstone.**
2. Some distinctive features of this art were as follows:
   a. **Bold and Grand Images** - Figures were **solid, masculine, and firm**, with **no Greek influence**.
   b. **Expressive Eroticism** - **Physical beauty** was emphasized, reflecting **grace and sensuality**.
   c. **Religious and Spiritual Influence** - **Halo** was used to depict **spirituality**, and images of **Shiva, Lakshmi, Surya, Balarama, Vishnu, and Kubera** were prominent.
   d. **Earliest Buddha and Bodhisattva Images** - Buddha was depicted **shaven-headed, in Abhaya Mudra, wearing a tight robe**, with **round-shaped sculptures** allowing a **360-degree view**.
   e. **Jain Influence** - Features **cross-legged naked Tirthankara images**, including **Rishabhanatha and Parshvanatha**.
   f. **Kushan Royal Depictions** - **Kanishka and Vima Kadphises** were portrayed in **Central Asian attire**. The **headless Kanishka statue from Mathura** depicts him as a **warrior**.
   g. **Influence on Amaravati Art** - Elements of Mathura art influenced the **Amaravati School**.
   h. **Yaksha and Yakshini Sculptures** - Produced **remarkable female figures**, known for their **beauty and elegance**.

Inscriptions

1. **Kushan inscriptions** were in **Bactrian (Greek script)** and **Prakrit (Brahmi or Kharosthi script)**.
2. The **Rabatak Inscription** is the most significant, confirming **Kanishka's genealogy**, listing **Kujula Kadphises, Vima Takto, and Vima Kadphises** as his ancestors.

Literature: The Kushana period witnessed a remarkable development of literature and **Sanskrit language**.

1. **Ashvaghosha** - A **Buddhist philosopher, poet, and playwright**, known for:
   a. Buddhacharita - An **epic poem on Buddha's life**.
   b. Saundarananda - A **poetic tale of Nanda's conversion**.
   c. Sariputra Prakarana - The **first major Sanskrit drama**.
2. **Nagarjuna** - A **Mahayana Buddhist philosopher**, foundational to the **Madhyamika school**, wrote:
   a. Mulamadhyamakakarika - Explores **emptiness (sunyata) and the Middle Way**.
   b. Prajnaparamita Sutras - Contributed to **wisdom literature** in Mahayana Buddhism.
3. **Vasumitra** - A **Buddhist scholar**, presided over the **Fourth Buddhist Council** under **Kanishka**, compiled the Mahavibhasa Shastra, a **key Buddhist commentary** (regarded as the Bud-dhist encyclopaedia).
4. **Charaka** - A **renowned physician**, authored the Charaka Samhita, a **foundational Ayurvedic text**.

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Significance of Kushans

1. **Cultural Crossroads** - The **Kushan Empire** connected the **Greco-Roman, Indian, and Chinese worlds**, enabling the exchange of **ideas, goods, and art**. **Eg.** The **Gandhara School of Art**, blending **Greco-Buddhist imagery**, exemplifies this cultural synthesis.
2. **Cultural Renaissance** - The Kushan era **initiated a cultural revival**, later reaching its peak under the **Guptas**, influenced by **Hellenic, Roman, Parthian, and Scythian traditions**.
3. **Spread of Mahayana Buddhism** - The Kushans **expanded Mahayana Buddhism** to **Central Asia, China, Korea, and Japan**. **Eg. Kanishka convened the Fourth Buddhist Council**, shaping **Mahayana philosophy**.
4. **Silk Road Control** - The empire **dominated key Silk Road trade routes**, facilitating **commerce between East and West**.
5. **Religious Tolerance** - Kushan rulers **patronized Buddhism** while respecting **Hinduism, Zoroastrianism, and local faiths**. **Eg.** Their **coins featured deities from multiple religions**, reflecting their inclusive approach.
6. **Advanced Coinage System** - The Kushans issued **high-quality gold coins**, setting **new monetary standards** that influenced later Indian dynasties.

Decline of Kushans

1. After **Vasudeva I's death (225 A.D.)**, the **Kushan Empire split** into **Western and Eastern halves**.
2. The **Western Kushans (Afghanistan)** fell to the **Sassanid Empire**, losing **Bactria** and other regions. **In 248 A.D., the Persians defeated them again**, replacing them with **Kushanshas (Indo-Sassanids)** as vassals.
3. The **Eastern Kushans** ruled **Punjab**, but by **270 A.D., the Yaudheyas** gained independence on the **Gangetic plain**. By the **mid-4th century**, **Samudragupta (Gupta Empire)** subjugated them.
4. **White Huns (5th century)** and later **Islamic invasions** ultimately led to the **Kushan Empire's extinction**.

The Kushan Empire, a vibrant hub at the crossroads of civilizations, left an enduring legacy. Their strategic position on the Silk Road fueled economic prosperity and cultural exchange, resulting in a unique blend of artistic styles.

Chola Empire

Ruler	Time Period	Contributions
Vijayalaya Chola	Mid 9th century AD	Vijayalaya Chola is recognized as the founder of the Imperial Chola dynasty, initiating the revival of the Chola Empire in the 9th century.
Vijayalaya Chola	Mid 9th century AD	He seized Tanjore (Thanjavur) from the Mutharaiyars and established it as the Chola capital.
Aditya I	871-907 AD	He incorporated Pallava lands, ending their dominance, and set the stage for Chola supremacy in the south.
Parantaka I	907-955 AD	Defeated Pandyas + Ceylon Ruler at Battle of Vellur

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Ruler	Time Period	Contributions
Parantaka I	907-955 AD	Defeated by Krishna III in Battle of Takkolam, Rashtrakuta army overran Tondaimandalam.
Parantaka I	907-955 AD	Provided vimana of the famous Nataraja temple at Chidambaram with a golden roof.
Rajaraja I	985-1014 AD	Rajaraja I is regarded as one of the Chola Empire's greatest rulers, significantly enlarging its territory, including parts of South India, Sri Lanka, and the Maldives, and making it a naval power.
Rajendra Chola I	1014-1044 AD	Rajendra Chola I, the son of Rajaraja I, further expanded the empire through successful naval campaigns to Southeast Asia, especially against Srivijaya.
Rajendra Chola I	1014-1044 AD	He captured lands in northern India, representing the peak of Chola power.
Rajendra Chola I	1014-1044 AD	Rajendra Chola, I established a new capital at Gangaikonda Cholapuram and built the renowned Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple.
Rajadhiraja Chola	1044-1054 AD	He led successful military campaigns in Sri Lanka and against the Chalukyas, but his death in battle signaled the beginning of the Chola Empire's gradual decline.
Kulottunga I	1070-1122 AD	Kulottunga I is recognized for bringing stability back to the Chola Empire following a time of political unrest.
Kulottunga I	1070-1122 AD	Sent a large embassy of 72 merchants to China and maintained cordial relations with the kingdom of Sri Vijaya.
Kulottunga I	1070-1122 AD	Classic writer Kamban (who wrote Ramayana in Tamil) was at his court

Religion

1. Chola rulers were ardent **Saivite**. Shiva was the preeminent god for the Cholas and he was represented in two forms. The iconic form of Siva was Lingodhbhava, and the Nataraja idol was the human form.
2. A highly evolved philosophical system called Saiva Siddhanta was founded during this period.
3. Kulathunga Chola was ardent shaivite. He persecuted vaishnavites. Bhakti saint Ramnujacharya left Srirangam and settled in Melkote, Karnataka.
4. **Bhakti Movement Flourished** - Chola rulers supported **Bhakti poets like Appar, Sundarar, and Manikkavasagar**, leading to the spread of **devotional worship and temple-centric traditions**.

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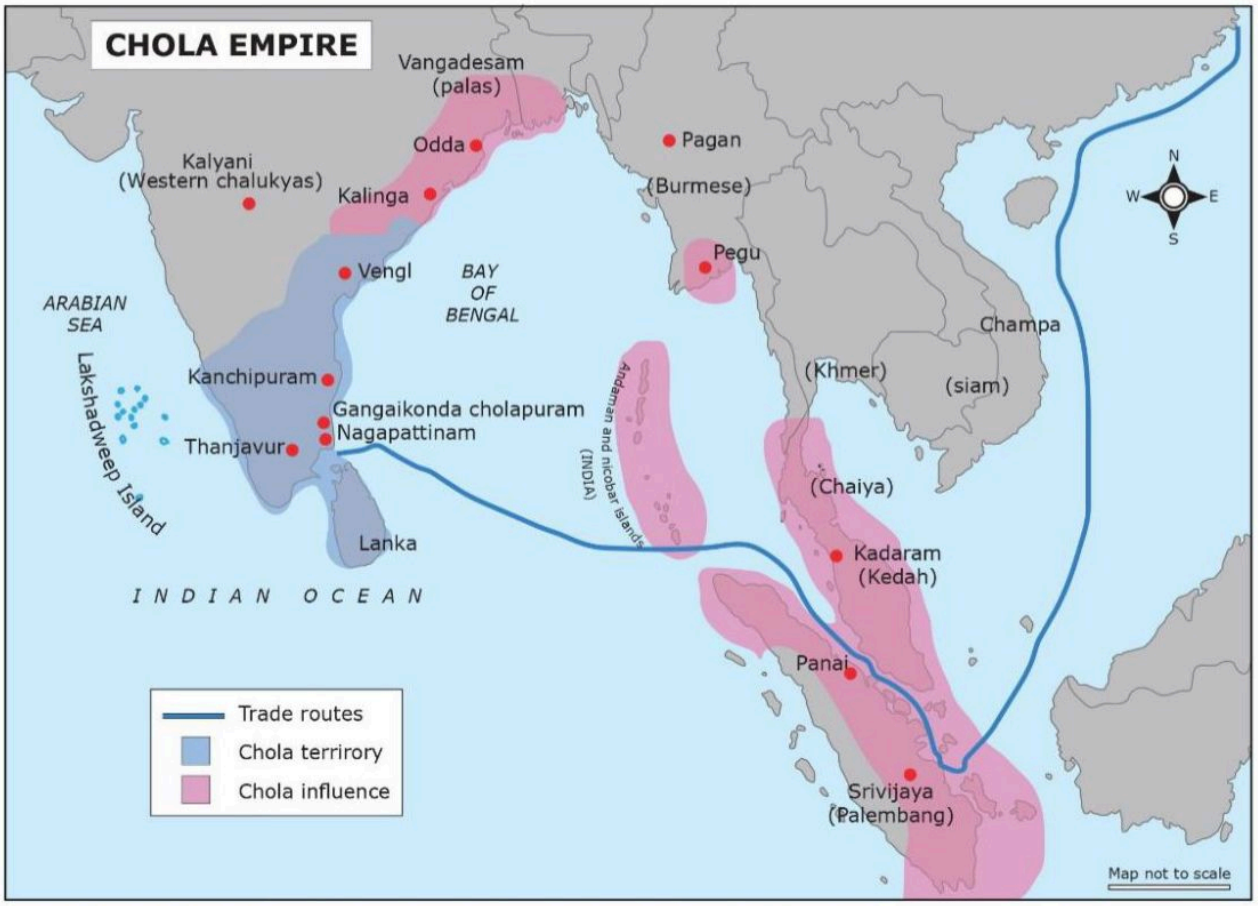

5. **Influence of Agamas and Temple Rituals** - Chola-era temples followed **Agamic traditions**, with elaborate rituals, temple festivals, and processions playing a central role in religious life.
6. Buddhism and Jainism saw a **gradual decline**, but Buddhist monasteries like **Nagapattinam Buddhist Vihara** were still supported for maritime links with Southeast Asia.

Society

1. **Aryanisation & Sanskritisation** - Aryanisation was consolidated, and Sanskritisation (lower castes imitating upper-class traditions) began.
2. **Caste System** - Widely prevalent, with divisions into Idangai (left-hand castes) and Vadangai (right-hand castes).
3. **Temple-Centric Life** - Temples were economic, social, and cultural hubs.
4. **Social Evils** - Devadasi system emerged, and Sati became a sacred practice.
5. **Slavery** - Many kinds of slaves existed, records mention instances of free men becoming slaves in order to escape starvation .
6. **Religious Clashes** - Conflicts between Shaivites and Vaishnavites intensified.
7. **Education & Literature** - Growth of Tamil & Sanskrit texts; temples as learning centers.
8. **Urbanization & Guilds** - Trade guilds (Shrenis) drove economic growth in cities.
9. **Dominance of Brahmins and Vellalars** - **Brahmins** controlled temples and education, while **Vellalars (landowning agriculturalists)** played a key role in administration and village governance.

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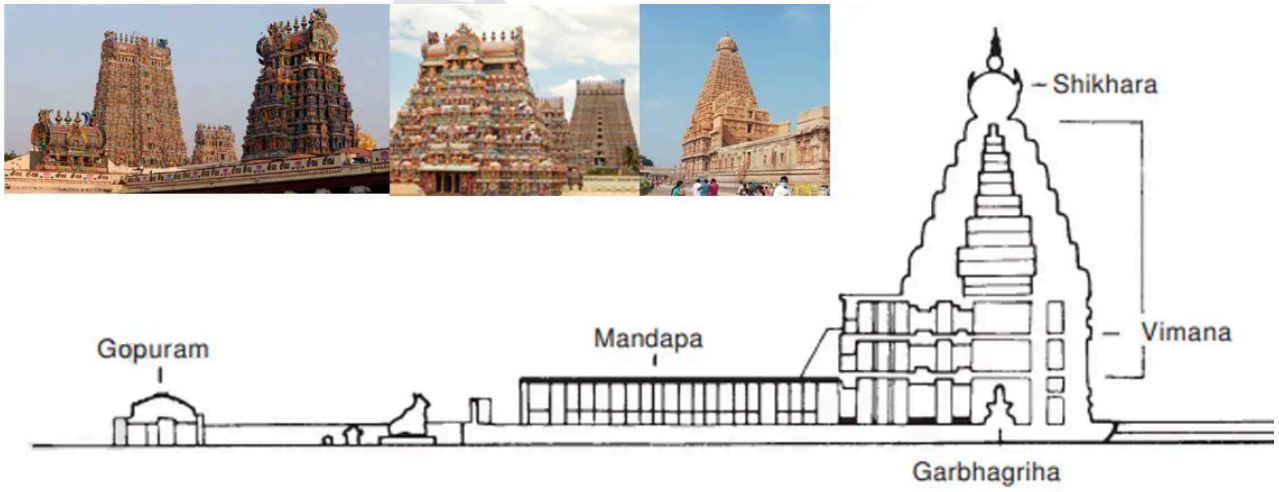
10. **Village-Based Social Organization** - Society was **village-centric**, with local assemblies like **Ur (commoners), Sabha (Brahmin-dominated councils), and Nagaram (merchant guilds)** managing civic affairs.
11. **Education - Ghatikas (Brahmin-run schools)** and **temple schools** provided education in **Sanskrit, Tamil, and Vedic scriptures**, while **Nalanda and Nagapattinam** were key Buddhist learning centers.
12. **Thriving Merchant and Artisan Communities** - Trade guilds like **Ayyavole-500 and Manigramam** flourished, fostering a wealthy merchant class and skilled artisans in **bronze work, sculpture, and textiles**.

Chola Architecture

Features of Chola Architecture

1. **Dravidian Style & Monumentality:** creating massive stone-built structures with towering Vimanas and large temple complexes. **Eg. Brihadeeswara Temple (Thanjavur) is one of the finest examples.**
2. **Towering Vimanas (Shikharas) Over Sanctum**, unlike later South Indian temples that emphasized Gopurams. **Eg. Brihadeeswara Temple Vimana (66m) is among the tallest in India.**
3. **Pillared Mandapas (Halls):** Large, intricately carved Mandapas (halls) were built for religious gatherings, dance performances, and rituals. **Eg. Airavatesvara Temple (Darasuram)**
4. **Ornate Gopurams (Entrance Gateways):** Early Chola temples had small Gopurams, but later, larger entrance towers became prominent. **Eg. Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple**
5. **Extensive Temple Complexes:** Chola temples were designed as self-sufficient complexes with multiple shrines, temple tanks, and corridors. **Eg. Rajarajeswaram Temple (Thanjavur)**
6. **Detailed Carvings & Frescoes:** Temple walls and pillars featured mythological stories, kings, warriors, and dancers. **Eg. Brihadeeswara Temple and Nataraja Temple (Chidambaram) have murals and sculptures.**
7. **Use of Monolithic Stones:** The Cholas used large single-stone blocks for temple foundations, pillars, and Nandi statues. **Eg. The monolithic Nandi at Brihadeeswara Temple**
8. **Functional & Ritualistic Design:** Temples included large temple tanks for rituals and water storage. **Eg. Chidambaram Temple Tank (Sivaganga Tank) was used for religious ceremonies.**
9. **Influence on Southeast Asia:** Chola temple architecture influenced temples in Cambodia, Indonesia, and Thailand. **Eg. Angkor Wat (Cambodia)**



DRAVIDA STYLE OF TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE

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SOME FAMOUS CHOLA TEMPLES	SOME FAMOUS CHOLA TEMPLES	SOME FAMOUS CHOLA TEMPLES
BRIHDESHWAR TEMPLE (TANJORE)	**BRIHDESHWAR TEMPLE (GANGAIKONDA CHOLPURAM)**	**AIRATESHWARA TEMPLE (DARASURAM, TANJORE)**
11th CE under **RajRaja 1** • Shiva temple (huge lingam set in a two-storeyed sanctum) • On bank of **kaveri River** • largest and tallest of all Indian temples • First all Material Granite temple in the world • Aka Dakina Meru • Outside: Fort walls of shivganga fort • **Nayakas** of Tanjore constructed **Shivaganga Tank** in 16th CE • Many shrines are added to temple by **pandyas, vijaynagar rulers and maratha too** • Recently in the news due to the kumbhabhishekam (consecration) ceremony. 5 such ceremonies held till now	11th CE under **Rajendra 1** • Shiva temple • smaller in size and more refined • The vimana is deliberately kept shorter- as a mark of respect to his father's work. **Exceptional quality sculptures: (Bronze)** • Bhogashakti • Subramanya • Saurapitha (Solar altar) • navagrahas (nine planets) are carved out of a single stone • lotus altar with 8 dieties is auspicious	12th CE under **Raj Raja II** • Smallest Among all three • named after 'Airavat', the majestic white elephant of Lord Indra. • **No Axial Mandap** • Front Mandap is known as **Rajgambhira Tirumandapam**Events related to 63 nayanar saints are depicted here • 10 Musical steps with Sa Re Ga Ma (7 Steps) & other three sound of "AUM"

Chola Sculptures

1. **Bronze Sculptures (Lost Wax Technique)** - perfected the **lost wax (cire-perdue) technique**, producing bronze images of deities, saints, and royal figures. Eg. **Nataraja idol (Shiva's cosmic dance) at Chidambaram Temple**.
2. **Graceful & Dynamic Postures** - Sculptures depicted deities in **elegant, rhythmic poses**, often showing movement and balance. Eg. **Nataraja's dancing form** symbolizes cosmic cycles.
3. **Realism & Detailed Ornamentation** - Chola sculptures exhibit **refined detailing** in facial expressions, jewelry, drapery, and anatomical accuracy. Eg. **Parvati and Vishnu idols** show delicate craftsmanship.
4. **Religious & Devotional Themes** - Most sculptures were of **Shaivite and Vaishnavite deities**, with some Buddhist and Jain influences. Eg. **Somaskanda (Shiva with Parvati & Skanda) panels** were common.
5. **Iconography Based on Agamas** - Sculptures followed strict **Shilpa Shastra (Agamic texts)** for proportions, mudras, and attributes of deities. Eg. **Ardhanarishvara images** represent the union of Shiva & Shakti.
6. **Use of Stone & Bronze** - While **bronze sculptures** were widely used for processions, **stone sculptures** adorned temple walls and pillars. Eg. **Dvarapalas (guardian figures) at Brihadeeswara Temple**.

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7. **Multi-Armed Deities** - Many sculptures depicted deities with **multiple arms**, symbolizing divine powers. Eg. **Vishnu with four arms holding the conch, discus, lotus, and mace**.

Literature

1. **Growth of Tamil Literature -** The Chola period saw significant contributions to Tamil literature, especially in religious, devotional, and poetic works. **Eg. Kamban's Ramayana, a Tamil adaptation of Valmiki's Ramayana.**
2. **Bhakti Movement Influence -** Literature flourished under the Shaivite (Nayanar) and Vaishnavite (Alvar) saints, leading to devotional hymns. **Eg. Periyapuranam by Sekkizhar, narrates the lives of 63 Nayanars**.
3. **Sanskrit & Tamil Coexistence -** While Tamil was the primary literary language, Sanskrit was used for court records, inscriptions, and religious texts. **Eg. Umapati Sivacharya's Sanskrit texts on Shaivism.**
4. **Growth of Shaiva & Vaishnava Texts -** Chola literature saw the compilation and refinement of Shaiva Agamas and Vaishnava scriptures. **Eg. Nalayira Divya Prabandham, a collection of 4,000 Tamil hymns by Alvars.**
5. **Royal Patronage to Scholars -** Chola kings patronized poets and scholars, leading to advancements in grammar, philosophy, and epic poetry. **Eg. Pugalendi's Nalavenba, a didactic Tamil work on ethics.**
6. **Tamil Lexicons and Grammar** - Works like **Nannul (Tamil grammar)** and **Viracoliyam (linguistic study)** refined Tamil syntax and literary rules.

Chola Paintings

1. **Murals on Temple Walls** - Found in **Brihadeeswara Temple (Thanjavur), Gangaikonda Cholapuram, and Chidambaram Nataraja Temple**, painted on **lime-plastered surfaces**.
2. **Religious and Mythological Themes** - Chola murals primarily depicted **Shaivite legends**, such as the **Ananda Tandava (cosmic dance) of Shiva**, and episodes from **Bhakti saint traditions**. **Eg.** Brihadeeswara Temple murals portray **Shiva granting darshan to Rajaraja Chola I and his guru Karuvurar**.
3. **Graceful Figures and Expressive Faces** - Figures are **slender, with elongated eyes, arched eyebrows, and detailed facial features**, enhancing their **divinity and realism**. **Eg. Sundarar and Parvati's wedding scene in Brihadeeswara Temple**
4. **Use of Natural Pigments** - Colors were extracted from **red ochre, yellow, black, and white minerals**, mixed with organic binders.
5. **Narrative Composition** - Paintings followed a **storytelling sequence**, guiding devotees through **sacred events**. **Eg.** In **Chidambaram Nataraja Temple**, murals illustrate **Shiva's cosmic dance and celestial beings playing musical instruments**, creating a **visual hymn**.
6. **Dynamic Postures and Movements** - The paintings captured **fluid motion**, with figures in **dancing poses, battle stances, or devotional gestures**.
7. **Blend of Artistic Styles** - Chola paintings were influenced by **Ajanta frescoes and Pallava sculptures**, creating a **unique South Indian mural tradition**.
8. **Royal Portraits:** Some paintings depict royal figures like **Rajaraja Chola I** and his preceptor, **Karuvur Devar**, in moments of intense concentration.
9. **Apsaras and Gandharas:** Flying apsaras and gandharas are depicted in the paintings, adding to the scene's extravagant proportions.

Performing arts under Cholas

1. Chola rulers actively promoted **Carnatic music and Bharatanatyam**, incorporating them into **temple rituals and royal performances**. Eg. **Natya Mandapa in Brihadeeswara Temple**

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2. **Bharatanatyam flourished** as **Devadasis (female temple dancers)** performed it as a **devotional offering to deities**. This institutionalized **dance as a sacred tradition in temples**.
3. **Classical Music & Thevaram Revival** - **Carnatic music evolved**, focusing on **raga (melody) and tala (rhythm)**. **Rajaraja I revived Thevaram music** in temples, appointing musicians to **sing devotional hymns**.
4. **Nataraja as a Symbol of Performing Arts** - The **Nataraja (Adal Vallan, King of Dance) idol** became the motif of **Tamil music, dance, and drama**, with hymns composed by **Nayanmars**.
5. Classical and folk dramas like **Koothu and Natakam** depicted **mythological stories and royal achievements**. Eg. **Terukoothu (street theatre) gained popularity in villages**.
6. **Martial Art: Silambam** - Cholas also patronized **Silambam**, a **traditional staff-fencing martial art**, practiced for **self-defense and military training**.

Significance of Chola Art & Architecture

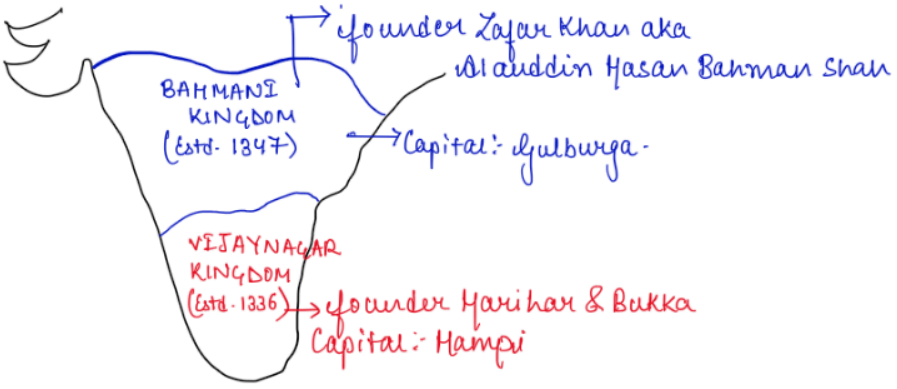
1. **Dravidian Architecture:** pinnacle of the Dravidian style, characterized by grand temples, towering gateways (gopurams), and well-organized temple complexes. **Eg. Brihadeshwara Temple**
2. Chola temples served **as cultural centres**. Often, these temples were part of larger complexes that included assembly halls, courtyards, and additional shrines.
3. **Innovations in Civil Architecture:** The Cholas were also adept in civil engineering, creating sophisticated irrigation systems to support their economy and society. **Eg. Kallanai Dam** (Grand Anicut).
4. **Innovations in Structural Temples** - Unlike earlier rock-cut temples, Cholas built **massive stone temples with complex layouts**, emphasizing **monumentality and durability**. Eg. Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple
5. **Refinement of Bronze Sculptures** - Chola artists excelled in **lost-wax bronze casting**, creating lifelike, expressive idols of **Hindu deities, saints, and dancers**. Eg. Chola Nataraja (Dancing Shiva)
6. **Integration of Bhakti Movement in Art** - Chola temples became **centers of religious devotion**, adorned with sculptures and inscriptions glorifying **Shaivism and Vaishnavism**. Eg. **Tirumurai inscriptions in Chidambaram Temple** immortalized the **Nayanar saints' hymns**.
7. **Symbol of Political Power and Imperial Glory - Eg. Rajendra Chola I's Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple** symbolized his conquest of North India (Ganga region).
8. **Integration of Temples in Socio-Economic Life - Eg. Temples had granaries, employed artisans, and issued land grants** to sustain local economies.

The Chola Empire, renowned for its architectural marvels like the Brihadeeswarar Temple and its artistic brilliance in bronze sculptures, left an indelible mark on South Indian history.

Vijayanagara Empire

Vijaynagar Empire

The Vijayanagara Empire (**1336-1646 CE**) was a powerful South Indian empire, which flourished as a centre of cultural, political, and economic prosperity.



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Important Rulers

Rulers	Contribution
Sangam Dynasty	**Sangam Dynasty**
Harihara I (AD 1336-1356)	• He was the founder of the Sangama dynasty. • He took part in 1344 in the confederacy organized by Krishna Nayak of Warangal to drive out the Muslims from the Deccan.
Bukka I (AD 1356-1379)	• He is described in inscriptions as the master of the Eastern, Western, and Southern oceans. • He brought about reconciliation between Ihe Jains and the Vaishnavas by asking them to worship in their own manner with equal freedom.
Harihara II (AD 1379-1404)	• He was the first ruler to assume the legal title of Raja Parmeshwara, Maharajadhiraja. • He embarked upon a policy of expansion towards the Eastern Sea coast, and led the Vijayanagara Empire into fresh conflicts. • Sent an expedition to northern Sri Lanka.
Devraya I (1406-1422)	• Telugu poet Srinath, writer of Harvilasam lived in his court. • Italian traveller Nicole Conti visited his court. • He built a dam on Tungabhadra River for irrigation • He was the first Vijaynagar ruler to enlist Muslims in the army
Devraya II (1422-1446)	• He was the greatest ruler of the Sangam dynasty and held the title of Gajbetkar. • He wrote a Sanskrit book "Mahanatak Sudhanidhi" • Also wrote a commentary on "Badrayan's Brahmasutra" • During his period the Persian traveler, Abdur Razzak visited his court
Sulava Dynasty (AD 1486-1505)	• Saluva Narasimha was the founder of Saluva dynasty. • Narasimha was succeeded by Tirumal (1491) and Immadi Narasimha. • Vasco Da Gama landed in Calicut during his reign in 1498.
Tulava Dynasty (AD 1505-1570)	**Tulava Dynasty (AD 1505-1570)**
Vira Narasimha	• He was the founder of the Tuluva dynasty • According to Nuniz, he was a pious king and distributed gifts at sacred places
Krishnadeva Raya (1509-1529)	• In his court 8 learned scholars used to get patronage & they were called as "Ashatadigaja" • One of the Ashtadigajja was Allahsani Pedanna. • He wrote "Amuktamalayada" in Telugu. It talks about administration. • His Sanskrit books are: Jamvati kalyan & Usha parinay

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Rulers	Contribution
	• He built Hazara Swami temple & Vitthal Swami Temple. • Two Portuguese travellers visited his court: Domingo Paes & Duarte Barbosa
Aravidu Dynasty (AD 1570-1652)	**Aravidu Dynasty (AD 1570-1652)**
Venkata II	• He was the last great ruler of Vijayanagara who kept the empire intact. • The only exception was that in 1612 Raja Wodeyar founded the State of Mysore

Vijayanagara Society

1. **Caste-Based Hierarchy** - Society was divided into four main castes, as described by **Allasani Peddana in Manucharitam**:
   a. **Viprulu (Brahmins)** - Teachers and priests.
   b. **Rajulu (Kshatriyas)** - Associated with the ruling dynasty.
   c. **Matikaratalu (Vaishyas)** - Merchants engaged in trade and commerce.
   d. **Nalavajativaru (Shudras)** - Primarily agriculturists, but also engaged in various professions.
2. **Temple-Centric Society & Devadasi System** - Temples served as **social, cultural, and economic hubs**, where religious functions, education, and charity were organized. The practice of **dancing girls (Devadasis) attached to temples** was also prevalent. Eg. **Virupaksha and Vittala Temples**.
3. **Women's Status** - Women **occupied an honorable position** and contributed to **literature, administration, and cultural life**.
   a. **Learned Women & Scholars** - Eg. **Gangadevi (Madura Vijayam), Hannamma (court scholar of Prauda Deva), Tirumalamma (Sanskrit poetess under Achyuta Raya)**.
   b. **Women in Various Fields** - As per Portuguese writer **Nuniz**, Vijayanagar women were **experts in wrestling, astrology, accounting, and soothsaying**.
   c. **Widow Remarriage** - Though the **plight of widows was pitiable**, they were **allowed to remarry**, and the state encouraged it by **not levying taxes on such marriages**.
4. Vijayanagar's capital **Hampi** was a **major urban and commercial center**, bustling with **markets, caravanserais, and foreign traders**. **Duarte Barbosa and Domingo Paes** praised its wealth and vibrancy.
5. **Rich Cultural Life** - The period witnessed advancements in **music, dance, and literature** in **Kannada, Telugu, Tamil, and Sanskrit**.
   a. **Music & Dance** - Bharatanatyam and Carnatic music flourished, supported by temple traditions.
   b. **Literary Contributions** - Eg. **Krishnadevaraya's Amuktamalyada (Telugu), Purandara Dasa's Carnatic music compositions**.
6. **Social Evils** - While society was **culturally rich**, social evils like **Sati, caste rigidity, and the Devadasi system** persisted.

Religion and Philosophy

1. Early Vijayanagara rulers were followers of Saivism.
2. Virupaksha was their family God.
3. Later they came under the influence of Vaishnavism. But Siva continued to be worshipped.

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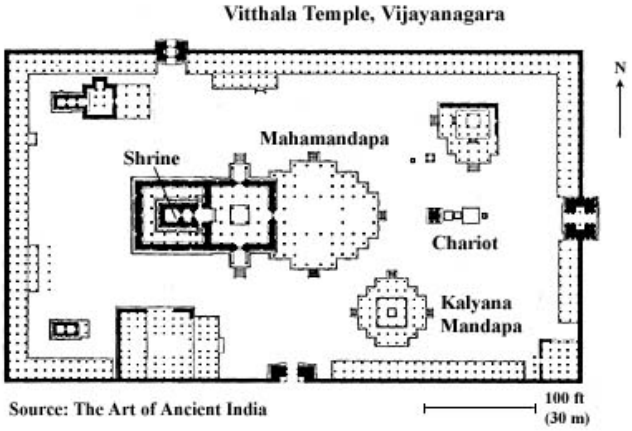
4. Vaishnavism was professed in various forms. Sri Vaishnavism of Ramanuja was highly popular.
5. The Dvaita System of Madhava was also practiced
6. **Bhakti Movement and Regional Saints** - Devotional movements flourished with saints like **Purandaradasa (Haridasa tradition), Kanakadasa, and Vyasatirtha**, spreading Bhakti ideas.



Art & Architecture of Vijaynagar Empire

The temples were adorned with beautiful sculptures. According to Domingo Paes, a Portuguese traveller, the city of Vijayanagara was surrounded by seven walls covering an area of about 96 kilometres. Inside the city, there were magnificent palaces and temples.

Temple Architecture

1. Combination of Dravid, Indo Islamic, European, Hoyasala, Pandya, Chalukya.
2. **Features:**
   a. Gopuram will be on all four side
   b. Highly decorative walls
   c. Mythical creature **Yali (Horse)** engraved on temple walls
   d. **Central Mandap is known as kalyan mandap (kalyan means marriage)**
   e. **Amman Shrines,** which were shrines dedicated to the god's bride or wives
   f. Secular architecture (Lotus mahal with large windows-european impact)
   g. Rock Cut idol of Narsimha on SheshaNag near Hampi.
3. **Dravidian Style with Larger Gopurams - Eg. Virupaksha Temple, Hampi** (52m high gopuram with intricate carvings).
4. **Mandapas (Pillared Halls) for Rituals & Ceremonies - Eg. Vittala Temple, Hampi** (famous for its **musical pillars**).
5. **Elaborate Temple Complexes** with **sanctums, pillared halls, tanks, and shrines**. **Eg. Raghunatha Temple, Hampi** (extensive temple layout with multiple shrines).
6. **Monolithic Stone Chariots** Symbolizing divine vehicles. **Eg. Stone Chariot at Vittala Temple, Hampi** (dedicated to Garuda, Vishnu's vehicle).
7. **Monolithic Sculptures and Pillars - Eg. Lakshmi Narasimha Statue, Hampi** (6.7m tall single-stone sculpture of Narasimha).
8. **Kalyana Mandapas (Marriage Halls)** - Special **mandapas** for divine weddings were a key feature in Vijayanagara temple architecture.
9. **Temple Tanks and Water Management** - Temple complexes included **pushkarinis (sacred tanks)** for ritual bathing and water conservation. **Eg. Pushkarini Tank at Krishna Temple, Hampi**.
10. **Influence of Indo-Islamic Elements** - Some temples included **Islamic-inspired arches, domes, and motifs**, showing cross-cultural architectural exchange.
    a. **Eg. Lotus Mahal, Hampi** (blended Hindu and Islamic architectural styles).
11. **Use of Hard Granite Stone - Eg. Hazara Rama Temple, Hampi** (granite relief panels narrating the Ramayana).

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Vijayanagara Art

Music

1. Origin of **Carnatic music** attributed to **Purandhar Das**.
2. **Theory and Practice in Sync** - Music theory evolved alongside practice, shaping **modern Carnatic music**.
3. **Introduction of the Mela System** - **Vidyaranya's Sangithasara** introduced the **15 Mela system**, forming the basis for later **Melakarta ragas**.
4. **Nine Musicological Treatises** - The **Vijayanagara Musicological Nonet** contributed to raga, tala, prabandha, and veena traditions.
5. **Advancement of Tala System** - **Taaladeepika (Thippendra) and Talakalabdhi (Achyutaraya)** defined **Tala-Dasha-Pranas** and introduced **new Deshi talas**.
6. **Refinement of Raga Structure** - **Ramamatya's Swaramelakalanidhi** eliminated redundant elements, refining raga classification.
7. **Commentaries on Sangitaratnakara** - **Kallinatha and Bhandaru Vittaleshwara** expanded earlier **musicological concepts**.
8. **Standardization of Veena Tuning** - **Ramamatya's Veena system** introduced **Madhyamela tuning**, still used today.
9. **Integration of Music and Dance** - **Sangeetha Suryodaya** documented **Nritta and tala structures**, linking music with dance.
10. **Introduction of Suladi and Gamaka** - **Natyachudamani (Somanarya)** categorized ragas and detailed **gamakas (ornamentation styles)**.
11. **Influence of Persian Music** - **Bhandaru Lakshminarayana** recorded the adoption of **Koulū (Khayal) and Gajalu (Ghazal)** into Indian music.

Dance

1. **Patronage of Temple and Court Dances** - Dance flourished in **temples and royal courts**, with kings supporting **Bharatanatyam, Kuchipudi, and Yakshagana**.
2. **Integration of Dance with Bhakti Tradition** - Devotional themes dominated, with **dance dramas depicting Ramayana, Mahabharata, and Puranic stories**.
3. **Expansion of Natya and Abhinaya Traditions** - The **Natyashastra** was elaborated upon, emphasizing **expressive (abhinaya) and rhythmic (nritta) dance forms**.
4. **Temple Dancers (Devadasi System)** - Devadasis performed ritual dances in **temples like Hampi's Virupaksha Temple**, enhancing religious ceremonies.
5. **Codification of Tala and Movement** - Treatises like **Sangeetha Suryodaya** detailed **dance forms, talas, and intricate rhythmic patterns**.
6. **Emergence of Yakshagana and Dance-Drama** - Early forms of **Yakshagana**, a dance-drama tradition in Karnataka, developed under Vijayanagara rule.
7. **Integration of Music, Dance, and Drama** - **Natyachudamani** described the **blending of music, storytelling, and dance** into temple performances.

Paintings

1. **Temple Murals as a Key Feature** - Wall paintings were integral to **temples and palace complexes**, depicting **mythological stories and royal life**. **Eg.** Murals in **Virupaksha Temple, Hampi**, illustrate **scenes from Ramayana and Mahabharata**.

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2. **Use of Fresco-Secco Technique** - Paintings were made on **dry lime-plastered walls** using natural pigments, ensuring durability.
3. **Narrative storytelling in Murals in Virupaksha and Lepakshi Temples - Eg.** The **Virabhadra Temple, Lepakshi**, features a **colossal mural of Veerabhadra** (largest fresco of a single figure in India).
4. **Royal Portraiture and Court Scenes - Eg. The Battle of Vijayanagara mural in Hampi** portrays **Krishna Deva Raya's military triumphs**.
5. **Bold Colors and Outlined Figures** - Artists used **bright reds, yellows, blues, and greens**, with **thick black outlines** for dramatic effect.
6. **Fusion of Indigenous and Persian Styles** - Persian influence is visible in **floral motifs, geometric patterns, and decorative borders**.
7. **Development of Ceiling Paintings with cosmic and divine themes. Eg.** The **Lepakshi Temple ceiling** displays a **gigantic multi-armed figure of Veerabhadra, celestial dancers, and Gandharvas**.
8. **Influence on Nayaka and Mysore Paintings - Thanjavur Nayaka murals (17th century)** and **Mysore paintings** inherited the **bold outlines and religious themes** from Vijayanagara murals.

Aspect	Details
Drama	- **Yakshagana**, a popular dance-drama, was closely associated with temple walls.
Sculpture	- Featured the **largest number of portrait sculptures** during this period.
Sculpture	- Notable: Portrait sculpture of **Krishnadeva Raya** and his queen at Tirumala.

Literature of Vijayanagar Empire

1. The Vijayanagara rulers patronised Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada and Tamil literature.
2. Krishna Deva Raya (Andhra Bhoja). He wrote 'Amuktamalyada', a book on polity in Telugu which explains how a king should rule. He also wrote a Sanskrit drama, 'Jambavati Kalyanam'.
3. Achyuta Raya patronised Rajanatha and the poetess Tirumalambadevi, who wrote Vardambika Parinayam.
4. **Development of Kannada Literature** - Kannada literature saw a revival under Vijayanagar rulers, particularly during the reign of Devaraya II.
   a. **Kumaravyasa** - Wrote Karnataka Bharata Kathamanjari, a Kannada version of the Mahabharata.
   b. **Chamarasa** - Authored Prabhulinga Leele, a biographical work on Allama Prabhu, a Lingayat saint.
   c. **Ratnakaravarni** - Wrote Bharatesha Vaibhava, narrating Jain legends.
   d. **Lakshmisha** - Authored Jaimini Bharata, a poetic retelling of the Mahabharata.
5. Development of Telugu Literature - Telugu literature flourished under Krishnadevaraya, a poet himself.
   a. **Allasani Peddana** - Called Andhra Kavita Pitamaha (Father of Telugu Poetry), wrote Manucharitram.
   b. **Nandi Timmanna** - Authored Parijatapaharanamu, narrating the tale of Krishna.
   c. **Dhurjati** - Wrote devotional poems on Lord Shiva.
   d. **Madayyagari Mallana** - Wrote Rajasekhara Charitramu.
6. Narahari (Kumaravalmiki) composed a popular Ramayana version of Torave Ramayana, in Kannada.
7. **Influence of the Bhakti Movement** - Eg. **Purandaradasa** and **Kanakadasa**, famous Haridasa poets, composed devotional songs in **Kannada**, spreading Bhakti ideology among common people.

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8. **Emergence of Classical Poetry and Court Literature -** Poetry was highly refined, following both **Desi (local) and Marga (classical)** styles, and was often composed in **Prabandha** (structured poetic form). Eg. Dhurjati's Kalahastiswara Satakam
9. **Telugu Literary Renaissance -** The reign of Krishnadevaraya saw the rise of the **Ashtadiggajas**, eight great poets who shaped Telugu literature. Their works enriched **Prabandha** (classical poetry), focusing on themes of devotion, heroism, and romance.

Significance of Art & Architecture

1. **Expansion of Temple Architecture -** Vijayanagar rulers introduced **Raya Gopurams** (grand entrance towers) and **Kalyana Mandapas** (wedding halls) in temples. The **Vittala Temple** in Hampi features the iconic **stone chariot and musical pillars**.
2. **Excellence in Iconography and Sculpture - Eg.** The **Lakshmi Narasimha Statue** in Hampi, carved from a single stone, represents the artistic grandeur of the period.
3. **Growth of Religious Art and Bas-Reliefs -** Temples were decorated with **murals, frescoes, and sculpted panels** depicting Hindu mythology. **Eg.** The **Hazara Rama Temple** in Hampi has intricate **bas-reliefs illustrating the Ramayana**.
4. **Indo-Islamic Influence on Architecture due to i**nteraction with the Deccan Sultanates. **Eg.** The **Lotus Mahal** in Hampi blends **Persian-style domes and arches with Indian artistic detailing**.
5. **Advancement in Military and Defensive Architecture - Eg.** The **Tungabhadra River fortifications** and **massive gates of Hampi** reflect the emphasis on military defense.
6. **Mastery in Stone and Material Usage - Eg.** The **Elephant Stables** in Hampi, built with granite, feature **Islamic-style domes but Hindu ornamentation**.
7. **Flourishing of Painting and Murals -** Vijayanagar rulers encouraged **frescoes and murals** depicting religious themes and royal life. **Eg.** The **Lepakshi Temple murals**
8. **Educational Focus**- The temples were centers of learning Vedic texts and science, indicating a knowledge-based society.

The Vijayanagara Empire provided an era of growth and stability in the South when the empires in North India were disintegrating. It left a rich legacy in its unique architectural style, the Vijayanagara Style, which had elements of both Central and Southern India

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Pushyabhuti /Vardhana Dynasty of Sthaneshwar

The Pushyabhuti dynasty, also known as the Vardhana dynasty, ruled Sthaneshwar (modern-day Thanesar, Haryana). It gained prominence after the fall of the Gupta Empire and played a crucial role in North Indian politics during the 6th-7th centuries CE.

Important Rulers

Prabhakarvardhana (580-605 CE) :1st Notable King

1. Fought against Gurjaras and Huns and established his authority till Malwa and Gujarat.
2. He had 3 Children i.e. Rajyavardhana , Harshavardha and a daughter named Rajyashri

Harshvardhana : (606 AD- 647 AD)

1. Warned Rulers like: Sasanka, Maitrakas of Valabhi and Gurjara of Broach, Pulikesin II (Chalukya), Rulers of Sindh, Nepal, Kashmir, Magadha, Odra (northern Odisha) and Kongoda (another geographical unit in ancient Odisha)
2. Alliance with : Bhaskarvardhana of Kamarupa (Pragiyaotisha),Assam
3. Marriage alliance with Maitrakas: Dhruvabhatta + daughter of Harsha. Soon, Valabhi became a subordinate ally of Harsha.
4. Pulkeshin II defeated Harsha and assumed the title of "Parameswara"(Mentioned in Aihole inscription written by Ravi Kirti in Sanskrit language) and gave Sakalottarapathanatha title to Harsha

Upon his **accession in 606 CE**, Harsha rescued his sister **Rajyasri** from the **Vindhya mountains**, where she had fled to escape **Deva Gupta of Malwa**. He prevented her **self-immolation after avenging Deva Gupta** and brought her back to **Kanauj**. Later, **Rajyasri embraced Buddhism** and influenced **Harsha's conversion**.

Administration

1. **Titles & Authority** - Harsha initially served as **Commander-in-Chief** before assuming the titles **Maharajadhiraja** and **Parambhattaraka**.

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2. **Governance** - He was assisted by a **council of ministers** for **internal and external administration**.
3. **Feudal System** - **Feudatories managed administration** and were compensated with **Jagirs** instead of salaries (**Jagirdari system/feudalism**).
4. **Administrative Divisions** - Followed the **Gupta model**. Harsha's empire was divided into **provinces**, though their exact number is unknown. Each province comprised **Bhuktis**, which were further divided into **Vishayas (districts)**. **Vishayas** were subdivided into **Pathakas**, consisting of multiple villages for administrative ease. **Harsha Charita** mentions various officials managing **local administration**.
5. **Revenue System** - Bhaga, Hiranya and Bali were the three kinds of tax collected during Harsha's reign. Bhaga was the land tax paid in kind. One-sixth of the produce was collected as land revenue. Hiranya was the tax paid by farmers and merchants in cash. The crown land was divided into four parts.
    a. Part I - for carrying out the affairs of the state
    b. Part II - for paying the ministers and officers of the crown
    c. Part III - for rewarding men of letters
    d. Part IV - for charity to religious institutions
6. **Charity** - Every **five years**, Harsha **organized religious assemblies**, donating treasury surpluses and **personal belongings**.
7. **Military** - **Hieun Tsang** mentions the four divisions (chaturanga) of Harsha's army.
    a. Ordinary soldiers were known as Chatas and Bhatas. Cavalry officers were called Brihadisvaras. Infantry officers were known as Baladhikritas and Mahabaladhikritas.
    b. **Cavalry Chief** - **Vrahadasvatara**
    c. **Overall Armed Forces Head** - **Maha-Senapati**
8. **Justice System** - According to Hieun Tsang, perfect law and order prevailed throughout the empire, as the law-enforcing agencies were strong. **Strict punishments** included **life imprisonment, limb amputation, and ordeals by fire & water**. **Mimamsakas** were appointed as **judicial officers**.

Hiuen Tsang's Description of Indian Cities Under Harsha

1. **Urban Structure** - India had **numerous villages, towns, and major cities**, with **Kanauj replacing Pataliputra** as the political and cultural center.
2. **Kanauj's Grandeur** - Described as a **city of lofty structures, beautiful gardens, and rare collections**, with **refined, well-dressed residents** who valued **learning and art**.
3. **Fortifications & Layout** - Most towns had **outer walls and inner gates**; streets were **narrow**, but walls were **high and wide** for protection.
4. **Residential Architecture** - Houses had **wooden balconies coated with lime mortar**, and floors were smeared with **cow dung for hygiene and purity**.
5. **Public & Religious Buildings** - **Monasteries, viharas, and stupas** were built using **kiln-fired bricks, red sandstone, and marble**.
6. **Harsha's Religious Patronage** - Constructed **numerous viharas, monasteries, and stupas along the Ganges**.
7. **Charitable Institutions** - Built **rest houses (dharmasalas) for travelers** and **hospitals providing free medical care** for the sick and poor.

Economy

1. **Trade and commerce declined**, evident from the **waning prominence of trade centers, fewer coins, and weakened merchant guilds**.

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2. The downturn affected **agriculture and handicrafts**, as reduced trade lowered demand for goods.
3. **Farmers shifted to subsistence farming**, producing mainly for self-consumption.
4. This led to the rise of a **self-sufficient village economy**, reducing reliance on long-distance trade.
5. Compared to the **Gupta period's prosperity**, Harsha's era saw a **significant economic decline**.

Society

1. **4-fold division + caste system** was firmly established. According to Hieun Tsang, the occupations of the four divisions of society continued to be in practice as in the previous times.
2. **Position of women declined** - **Women wore purdah**, though **higher-class women** were exempt, as noted by **Hiuen Tsang**. **Sati was practiced**; **Yasomatidevi**, wife of **Prabhakara Vardhana**, **self-immolated after his death**.
3. Consumption of meat, onion was avoided.
4. People were given complete freedom of worship and social harmony prevailed
5. Lifestyle - People led a **modest lifestyle**, as noted by **Hiuen Tsang**. Wore **colorful cotton and silk garments**, with **refined craftsmanship** in textiles.
6. Education - **Monasteries served as educational centers**, with learning focused on **religion**. **Vedas were taught orally**, not in written form. **Sanskrit** was the language of scholars. Education spanned from **9 to 30 years of age**. **Wandering Bhikshus and Sadhus** were revered for their **wisdom and culture**.

Religious Policy of Harsha

1. **Early Shaivism** - Harsha initially **worshipped Shiva** until **631 CE**.
2. **Conversion to Buddhism** - Influenced by his **sister Rajyasri** and **monk Hiuen Tsang**, he adopted **Mahayana Buddhism**.
3. **Religious Tolerance** - He engaged in **discourses with scholars from various faiths**.
4. **Ban on Animal Slaughter** - Restricted **meat consumption** and **animal slaughter**.
5. **Buddhist Assemblies** - Convened two **Buddhist assemblies (643 CE)** at **Kanauj and Prayag**.
6. **Kanauj Assembly** - Attended by **20 kings**, including **Bhaskaravarman of Kamarupa**, along with **Buddhist, Jain, and Vedic scholars**.
7. **Buddha Procession** - A **three-foot Buddha statue** was paraded, and a **golden Buddha idol** was consecrated in a monastery. A **large tower** was constructed, housing a **golden Buddha statue** as tall as the king.
8. **Harsha convened the Mahamoksha Parishad** every **five years** at **Prayag (Ganga-Yamuna confluence)**.
9. He **distributed his wealth** among **Buddhists, Vedic scholars, and the poor**. **Buddhist monks** received **lavish gifts** throughout the **four-day assembly**.

Art & Culture

1. Harshavardhana was a great patron of art and education and actively encouraged literary and scholarly pursuits.
2. He was an accomplished writer himself and authored three Sanskrit plays: Nagananda, Ratnavali, and Priyadarshika.
3. A significant portion (one-fourth) of state revenue was allocated to support scholars and intellectuals.
4. Nalanda University had an estimated 10,000 students and 2,000 teachers. Dharmapala, Chandrapala, Shilabhadra, Bhadrihari, Jayasena, Devakara and Matanga were important teachers in the university receiving royal patronage.

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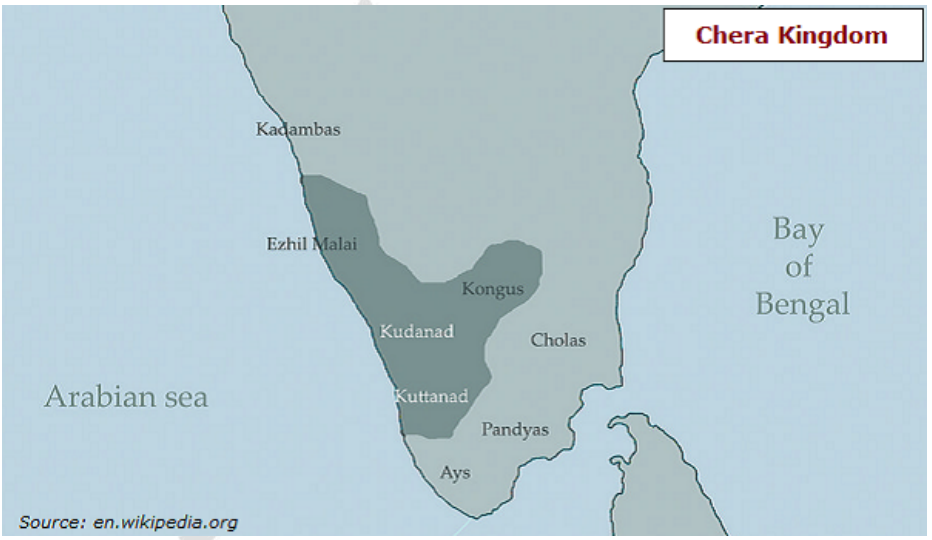
5. The curriculum covered a wide range of subjects, including Vedas, Buddhism, philosophy, logic, urban planning, medicine, law, and astronomy.
6. Bana, the author of Harshacharita and Kadambari, was a Asthana Kavi (court poet) in Harsha's royal court.

Chera Empire

The Chera dynasty was an ancient dynasty that ruled parts of present-day Kerala and Tamil Nadu in southern India from around the 4th century BCE to the 12th century CE. Also known as the Keralaputras, their kingdom was located to the west and north of the Pandya kingdom.

Cultural and Religious Contributions

1. The Cheras were patrons of Tamil literature, supporting poets and scholars of the Sangam period.
2. Padirruppattu and other Tamil texts celebrate Chera rulers, documenting their deeds and achievements.
3. Cheran Senguttuvan's Pattini Cult: Introduced Kannagi worship, which became an enduring religious tradition in Tamil Nadu.



4. Religious Patronage: Promoted local deities and temple architecture, integrating regional traditions with mainstream South Indian religious practices.
5. **Chera temples** followed the **Dravidian architectural style**, featuring **pyramid-shaped gopurams, intricate carvings, and sculptures**. They were mostly **octagonal or rectangular**, built with **sandstone and granite**. Eg. Thiruvanchikulam Mahadeva Temple
6. The famous **temple of Sabarimala** was built during the Chera period. The temple is dedicated to **Lord Ayyappa**, who is believed to be the son of Lord Shiva and Lord Vishnu in the form of Mohini.
7. The **Natyashastra** mentions the **Chera kingdom** as a center for **music and dance**, renowned for its **graceful and elegant style** in performing arts.
8. The Cheras were also known for their expertise in shipbuilding, and they had a thriving maritime trade with other parts of the world.
9. Cheras were **skilled painters** and they produced a wide variety of works, including murals, frescoes, and miniature paintings. Eg. **murals at the Padmanabhapuram Palace**

Despite frequent conflicts with rival kingdoms, the Cheras remained a significant force in early Indian history, contributing to the rich heritage of Tamil and Malayalam traditions.

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Chalukyas of Badami

The **Chalukyas of Badami (543-753 AD)** were the successors of the Vakatakas in western Deccan. Originating in **Karnataka**, they expanded into a vast empire, marking the **shift from smaller kingdoms to larger South Indian dynasties**. According to Bilhana, the author of Vikramankacharita, the original home of the Chalukyas was Ayodhya.

Key Rulers of the Chalukya Dynasty

Ruler	Contribution
Pulakesin I (543-566 AD)	• Founder of the Chalukya dynasty, established Vatapi (Badami) as the capital. • Overthrew the Kadambas, expanding Chalukyan dominance. • Performed five major Vedic yajnas, including the Ashvamedha sacrifice. • Earned titles like Satyashraya, Vallabha, and Dharmamaharaja.
Kirtivarman I (566-597 AD)	• Consolidated Chalukyan power and completed the conquest of the Kadambas. • Expanded the kingdom into Goa (Revatidwipa).
Pulakesin II (608-642 AD)	• Greatest ruler of the Chalukya dynasty. • Defeated Harshavardhana on the banks of the Narmada. • Subjugated Kadambas of Banavasi and Gangas of Mysore. • Married Durvinita's daughter, strengthening ties with the Gangas. • First expedition against **Pallavas (Mahendravarman I) was successful**, but was later **killed by Narasimhavarman I**, who captured **Badami**. • Sent an **embassy to Persian King Khusrau II (625-626 CE)**, depicted in **Ajanta paintings**. • **Hiuen Tsang** visited his kingdom, praising his administration.
Vikramaditya I (655-680 AD)	• **Restored Chalukya power**, expelled Pallavas, avenged Pulakesin II's defeat, and defeated **Cholas, Pandyas, and Keralas**. However, was later **defeated by Pallava king Parameshvaravarman (674 CE)**.
Vinayaditya (681-693 CE)	**Defeated Yashovarma of Kanauj and continued wars against Pallavas.**
Vijayaditya (693-733 CE)	**Strong warrior, defeated Pallava king Parameshvaravarman, maintained Chalukya dominance.**
Vikramaditya II (733-744 CE)	**Defeated Arabs in Gujarat, Pallava king Nandivarman II, Cholas, Pandyas, and Kalabras, erected a victory pillar on the southern coast.**
Kirtivarman II (744-753 CE)	• **The last ruler faced economic decline due to Pallava-Chalukya conflicts.** • **Rashtrakuta king Dantidurga defeated Kirtivarman II, marking the end of the Chalukya dynasty and the rise of Rashtrakutas.**

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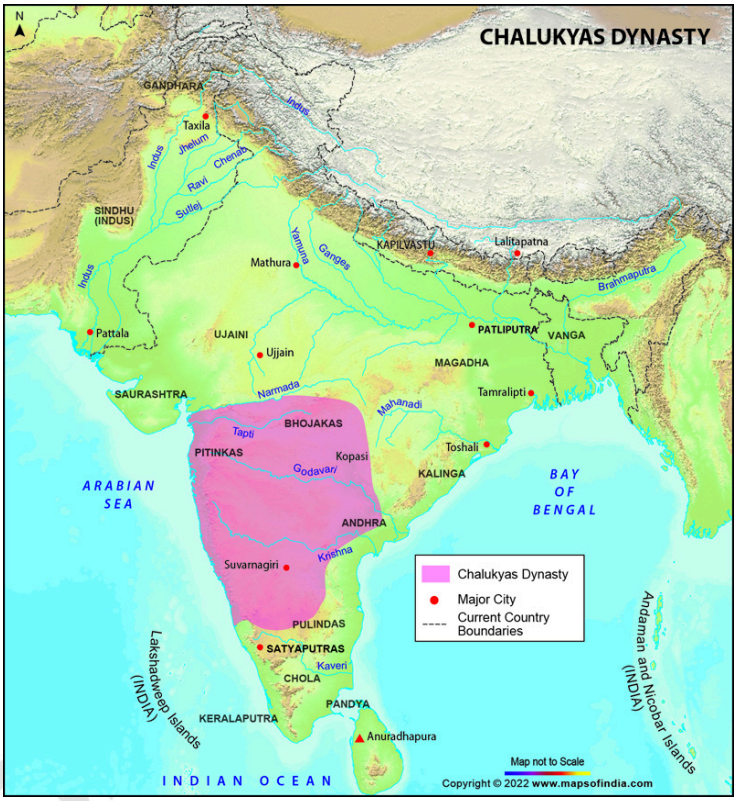
Society & Culture

1. Caste-based society, but women enjoyed some rights.
2. Sati was rare, as widows like Vinayavathi and Vijayanka are mentioned in texts.
3. The Devadasi system (dedication of women to temples) became prevalent.
4. Some women held political power, such as Vijayanka (poetess), Kumkumadevi (administrator), and Lokamahadevi (warrior queen).



Religion

1. **Religious Revival** - The period marked the **revival of Hindu culture and spirituality**, with **Vaishnavism, Shaivism, Shakta cults, and Jainism** receiving royal patronage.
2. **Vedic Rituals & Brahmanism** - **Pulakesin I** performed the **Ashvamedha sacrifice**, and several **Brahmanical treatises** were composed.
3. The **Chalukyas worshipped multiple Hindu deities**, with special reverence for **Saptamatrika** (mother goddesses).
4. Their **royal emblem featured a boar (Varaha, an avatar of Vishnu), conch, chakra (wheel), and a mirror**.
5. **Vikramaditya I** shifted from **Vaishnavism to Shaivism**, breaking the family tradition.
6. **Temple Construction** - Flourished under Chalukya rule, with major temple sites at **Badami, Mahakuta, Pattadakal, Aihole, and Alampur**.
   a. **Badami** - Includes **Melagitti Shivalaya** and **four rock-cut halls**.
   b. **Aihole** - Known as the **"Town of Temples,"** with around **70 structures**.
   c. **Vikramaditya I** brought **sculptors from Kanchipuram** for temple construction.

7. **Religious Tolerance** - Though **Hinduism dominated**, the Chalukyas **supported Jainism**.
8. **Decline of Buddhism** - As noted by **Hiuen Tsang**, **Buddhism declined in Western Deccan**, but **Jainism thrived**.
9. **Jain Patronage** - **Pulakesin II's court poet Ravikirti**, author of the **Aihole inscription**, was Jain. **Vikramaditya I's daughter, Kumkuma Devi, requested a royal grant for a Jain temple**.
10. Shaivism gained prominence under Vikramaditya I, with sects like Pashupata, Kapalikas, and Kalamukhas emerging.

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Literature

1. Both Sanskrit and Kannada literature flourished.
2. Vijayanka (wife of Chandraditya, son of Pulakesin II) was a noted Sanskrit scholar.
3. Pujyapada wrote "Kalyanakaraka" (treatise on medicine).
4. Shyama Kunda Charya and Srivardhadeva were eminent scholars.
5. Ravi Kirti's Aihole inscription, written in Sanskrit and Old Kannada script, is a remarkable poetic work.

Art & Architecture

1. The **Chalukyas** introduced the **"Chalukyan" or "Vesara" style**. It blended **Nagara (North Indian) and Dravida (South Indian) architectural elements**, shaping **Deccan architecture**.

First Phase - Cave Temples

1. Found in **Ajanta, Ellora, and Nasik**.
2. **Monolithic structures** excavated in **sloping hills**.
3. **Brahmanical dedication** but **Buddhist in style and technique**.

Second Phase - Structural Temples

1. Early temples had **flat or slightly inclined rooftops**; later, **Vimana (tower structures) appeared**. **Stellate (star-shaped) and northern stepped diamond plans** were used in temple layouts.
2. **Pillared Mantapa** was added to the **Garbhagriha**, a feature absent in **Gupta temples**.
3. The temples feature **monolithic pillars**, with their height determining the **overall structure of the mandapa and temple**.
4. **Chalukyan architects did not use mortar**, allowing natural **ventilation and light** to reach the temple interiors.
5. The **vestibules** were adorned with **artificial lighting features**, which not only eliminated darkness but also created a **mystical ambiance**.
6. Temple doorways were **highly ornamented**, featuring **pilasters, molded lintels, and cornice tops**.
7. **Sculptures of Shiva and Vishnu** showcase **perfection in carving**, reflecting a blend of **Nagara and Dravida styles**.

Examples

1. Early structures (Aihole & Badami):
   a. Lad Khan Temple - Simple, flat-roofed pillared structure.
   b. **Durga Temple at Aihole** - Built on a **horse-shoe shaped platform**, imitating **Buddhist Chaityas**.
   c. Meguti Jain Temple - An unfinished yet significant Jain structure.
   d. Muktheeswarar Temple & Melagutti Sivalaya (Badami) - Notable Hindu shrines.
2. Rock-cut caves at Badami:
   a. Four caves, three Hindu and one Jain.
   b. Vaishnava Cave (578 AD) features Vishnu seated on Ananta and Narasimha reliefs.
3. Later structures (Pattadakal):
   a. Papanatha Temple - Influenced by northern styles.
   b. Sangameshvara Temple & Virupaksha Temple - Iconic Dravidian-style temples.
   c. Virupaksha Temple, built by Queen Lokamahadevi, **was m**odeled after **Kailasanatha Temple at Kanchi**, employing sculptors from Kanchi.

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4. Chalukyan paintings:
    a. Found in Badami cave temples and Ajanta caves.
    b. Ajanta murals depict Pulakesin II receiving a Persian embassy.

Significance of the Chalukya Dynasty

1. **Political Unification of the Deccan** - The Chalukyas **integrated Karnataka, Maharashtra, and Andhra Pradesh**, shaping Deccan politics and administration.
2. **Introduction of Vesara Architecture** by blending **Nagara (North Indian) and Dravida (South Indian) architecture**
3. **Religious Patronage** - Supported **Vaishnavism, Shaivism, Jainism, and Buddhism**, commissioning **temples and monasteries**.
4. **Contributions to Art and Sculpture** - Their **temples and cave carvings** reflect **intricate craftsmanship**, especially in **Badami, Aihole, and Pattadakal**.
5. **Maritime Strength** - Established a **strong naval presence**, with **Pulakesin II commanding 100 ships**.
6. **Resistance Against Harsha** - **Pulakesin II defeated Harsha** on the **banks of the Narmada (630 CE)**, defining the north-south political divide.
7. **Trade and Economic Growth** - Despite limited **agricultural land**, they promoted **trade via the west coast**, connecting with **Persia and Southeast Asia**.

The **Chalukyas of Badami** ("Plateau kingdom") dominated **Deccan politics for nearly two centuries**, making significant contributions to **polity, religion, art, architecture, and painting**.

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Chapter 3

Medieval India — Mughals & Marathas

PYQs

[2023] What were the major technological changes introduced during the Sultanate period? How did those technological changes influence Indian society? (15)
[2022] How will you explain that medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days? (10)

Mughal Empire

The Mughal Empire (1526-1857 CE) was a powerful dynasty that ruled large parts of the Indian subcontinent from the early 16th to the 19th centuries, known for its remarkable contributions to art, culture, and architecture. Its significance lies in its lasting impact on Indian society, shaping the region's cultural identity and administrative practices.

Important Rulers

Ruler	Contributions
Babur	• **Babur ascended the throne of Farghana (Uzbekistan) in 1494** at age 12 after his father's death. • **1526** - Defeated **Ibrahim Lodi** in the **First Battle of Panipat**, effectively using **cannons in warfare**. • **1527** - Fought and defeated **Rana Sanga** in the **Battle of Khanwa**, securing his rule in India. • **1528** - Defeated **Medini Rai** in the **Battle of Chanderi**. • **1529** - Defeated and killed **Mahmud Lodi** in the **Battle of Ghaghara**. • **Tuzuk-i-Baburi**, his autobiography, was written in **Turki** and later translated into **Persian and other languages**.
Humayun	• His son Humayun (1530-1540) thus inherited a precarious Mughal kingdom. Humayun had to face two Afghan rulers: • **Bahadur Shah of Gujarat** • **Shershah of Bihar** • Against Bahadur Shah he was successful but shershah defeated Humayun in two consecutive battles. • **Battle of Chausa (Bihar) 1539** • **Battle of bilgram (kannauj) 1540** • The second battle forced Humayun to leave India and he fled to Iran.

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Ruler	Contributions
	• **Humayun returned to Delhi along with Bairam khan** & started building a new city in Delhi called deenpanah in 1555 • Humayun defeated the Afghans and recovered the Mughal throne. After six months, he died in 1556 due to his fall from the staircase of his library. • His biography Humayunnama was written by **Gulbadan Begum** in Persian language.
Akbar	Afghans of Bihar had a famous general called Hemu. He fought with Akbar in the 2nd battle of Panipat in 1556. Since he was only 14 years old, he was kept under the **regency aka as petticoat government (1556-1560). In 1560 Akbar overthrew the regency and started ruling as per his own will.** • **1561** - Akbar sent **Adham Khan** to attack **Malwa**; after discovering Adham **hid looted wealth**, Akbar **killed him in fury**. • **1562** - **Amber ruler Bharmal** offered his **daughter's marriage** to Akbar, marking his **first Rajput matrimonial alliance**. • **1568** - **Chittor (Mewar) ruler Uday Singh** fled, leaving **Jaimal & Fateh Singh** to defend. After a **difficult battle**, Akbar **executed 30,000 Rajput soldiers** but honored Jaimal & Fateh Singh with **statues outside Agra Fort**. • **1572** - Akbar **conquered Gujarat**, founded **Fatehpur Sikri**, and built the **Buland Darwaza**. • **1576** - **Battle of Haldighati** against **Maharana Pratap** (son of Uday Singh), led by **Raja Man Singh** on Akbar's behalf. • **1601** - Akbar captured **Ahmednagar, Berar, and Khandesh**; seized the **impregnable Asirgarh Fort** in Khandesh.
Jehangir	• **Born as Salim**, named after **Sufi saint Sheikh Salim Chisti**. • **1608** - **Captain William Hawkins** (English East India Company) sought permission to establish a **factory in Surat**. • **1615** - **Sir Thomas Roe** secured Mughal approval for **factories on the eastern coast**. • **Jehangir built a "Chain of Justice"** after ascending the throne. • **1611** - Married **Mehrunisa**, later titled **Nur Jahan**. • **Nur Jahan** influenced court affairs, introduced **Persian fashion**, and promoted **Persian art & culture**. • **1615** - Signed a **treaty with Amar Singh** (Maharana Pratap's son), returning parts of **Chittor** on the condition that its **fort walls remain unrepaired**. • **First Mughal emperor to enlist Marathas** in his army.
Shah Jahan	• **Shah Jahan** attempted to recover **Kandahar and ancestral lands** in the northwest but **failed**. • His **Deccan campaign succeeded**, annexing **Ahmadnagar**, while **Bijapur and Golkonda** signed treaties. • **1631** - His wife **Mumtaz Mahal** died in **Burhanpur**; he began constructing the **Taj Mahal** in her memory. • **European travelers** like **Bernier, Tavernier, Mandelslo, Peter Mundy, and Manucci** documented Mughal India.

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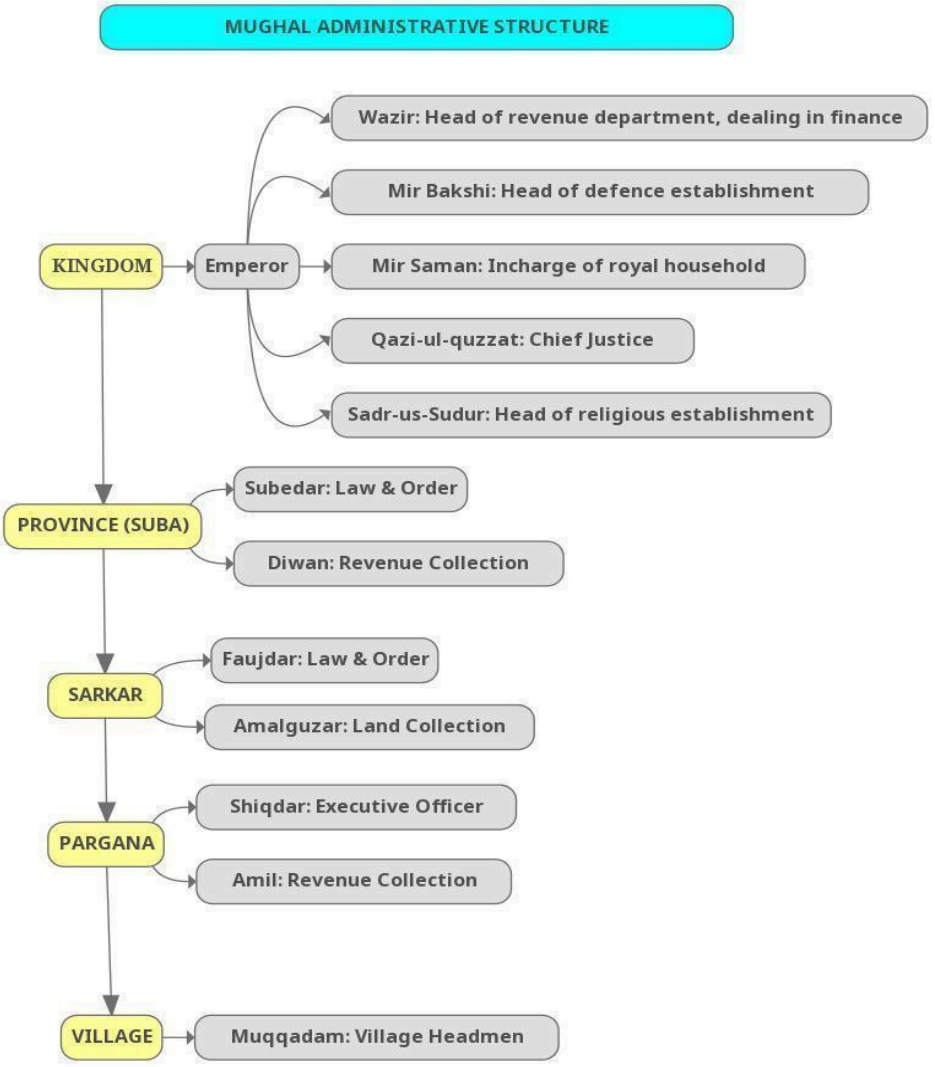
Ruler	Contributions
	• **War of succession** broke out among his sons **Dara Shikoh, Shah Shuja, Aurangzeb, and Murad**, with **Aurangzeb emerging victorious**..
Aurangzeb	• **Aurangzeb took the title "Alamgir"** and **forbade the Kalma inscription on coins**. • **Banned the Nawroz festival**, considering it a **Persian tradition**. • **Appointed Muhtasibs** in all provinces to **ensure adherence to Sharia**. • **Banned singing in court**, allowing only **instrumental music**, despite his own expertise in **Veena**. • **Ironically, the largest number of Persian books on music** were written during his reign. • **Abolished Jharokha Darshan and Tuladan**. • **Conquered Bijapur (1686) and Golconda (1687)**, expanding Mughal rule in the Deccan.

Administrative structure under the mughals

1. **Akbar established the Mughal administration**, distinct from the **Delhi Sultanate**.
2. **1580** - He divided the empire into **12 subas** (later increased to **15**), each subdivided into **sarkars, parganas, and mahals**.
3. **Shah Jahan introduced "Chalka"**, a unit comprising multiple **parganas**.



Central Administration in Mughal Empire

1. The **Mughal state was military-based and highly centralized**, with the **emperor's word as law**.
2. The **emperor controlled all functions**, including **military and judiciary**, and had **absolute authority over officials**.
3. **All officers derived their power from the emperor**, who could **appoint, promote, or dismiss them at will**.

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Officers	Nature of work
Wazir	• Wazir was the **head of the revenue department**, managing **finance**. • Under the **Delhi Sultans and Mughals**, the **Wazir held both civil and military powers**. • **Bairam Khan's regency** significantly **enhanced the Wazir's authority**.
Mir Bakshi	• **Mir Bakshi** was the **paymaster-general and army administrator**. • He approved **mansabdar appointments and salary papers**. • Responsible for **branding horses (dagha) and verifying soldiers' muster rolls (chehra)**. • Considered the **head of the nobility**, not the **Diwan**. • Supervised **spies (Barids) and news reporters (Waqia-Navis)**.
Mir Saman	• **Mir Saman** was the **officer in charge of the royal arsenal**. • Managed **procurement and storage** for the **royal household**. • Supervised the **manufacture of weapons and luxury items**.
Qazi-ul-quzzat	• Headed the Judicial department. • This post was sometimes combined with that of Sadr-us sudur.
Sadr-us-Sudur	• **Sadr-us-Sudur** was the **head of the ecclesiastical department**, ensuring adherence to **Sharia law**. • Managed the **distribution of charities**, including **cash and land grants**. • Investigated **proper allocation and utilization** of grants.
Ahadi	Gentlemen troopers
Walashahi	Royal bodyguard

Provincial Administration in Mughal Empire

The empire was divided into several provinces known as Subas for smooth administration and revenue collection.

Officers	Nature of Work
Subedar	**Subedar (Governor of a Suba)** was **appointed by the emperor**. Responsible for **law enforcement, revenue collection, and executing royal decrees**.
Diwan	• **Head of the provincial revenue department**, appointed **directly by the emperor**, not the **Subedar**. • Functioned **independently** and was **answerable to the central administration**. • Responsible for **expanding cultivation** and **increasing state revenue**.

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Officers	Nature of Work
Bakshi	• **Bakshi** was appointed by the **imperial court** on **Mir Bakshi's recommendation**. • Performed the **same duties at the provincial level** as **Mir Bakshi at the central level**. • **Inspected horses and soldiers** maintained by **mansabdars** in the province. • **Reported provincial affairs** to the central administration.
Daroga-i-Dak	• Responsible for **developing the communication network** across the empire. • Managed the **postal system**, ensuring messages reached **remote areas**. • Maintained **Dak Chowkis** with **runners, horses, and boats** for **efficient mail delivery**.

Local Administration in Mughal Empire

Sarkars

1. **Subas were divided into Sarkars, Parganas, and villages**.
2. **Fauzdar and Amalguzar** were key officials at the **Sarkar level**.
3. **Fauzdar** was the **executive head**, responsible for **law enforcement and suppressing rebellions**.
4. His **jurisdiction varied**, sometimes covering **multiple Sarkars or multiple Faujdars within a single Sarkar**.

Pargana Administration

1. The Parganas were the administrative units below the sarkar.
2. The **shiqqdar was the executive officer of the pargana and assisted the amils** in revenue collection.
3. The amil also looked after the revenue collection at the pargana level. His duties were similar to those of the Amalguzar at the sarkar level.

Other Officers

Kotwal

1. **Kotwal**, appointed by the **imperial court**, ensured the **safety of townspeople and their property**.
2. Comparable to a **modern police officer**, he **maintained records of people entering and leaving the town**.
3. **Issued permits** for outsiders traveling in or out of the city.
4. Regulated **trade practices**, enforced **standard weights**, and **prevented illicit liquor production**.

Qiladar - He was the officer in charge of the forts (quila). Each quiladar has entrusted the responsibility of one quila.

Military System - The **Mughal military system** was **complex**, relying on **four classes of troops** instead of a **large standing army**.

The **four troop categories** were:

1. **Mansabdars** - Nobles who maintained troops under the **Mansabdari system**.
2. **Dakhili** - Imperial troops directly under the **emperor's control**.
3. **Ahadis** - **Elite bodyguards** and special forces, personally recruited by the emperor.
4. **Chiefs' Troops** - Forces maintained by **local chiefs and vassals** to defend borders and maintain order.

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Mansabdari system

The concept of mansab dates back to Chengiz Khan, who divided his army into grades from 10 to 10,000. Akbar gets credit for dividing services from 10 to 5,000 into a regular hierarchy.

1. **Mansab** means **rank**, with the lowest being **10** and the highest **5000**, though exceptions existed (**Mansingh had 7000**)
2. **Salary System** - Paid by **Akbar**, and Mansabdars had to **pay their soldiers** from it.
3. **Zat and Sawar System** - Introduced in **1595-96**:
    a. **Zat Rank** - Determined **personal rank, salary, and status**.
    b. **Sawar Rank** - Indicated the **number of cavalry (horsemen) to be maintained**.
4. During Akbar's reign, mansabs ranged from 10 to 5,000. Ranks increased under Akbar's successors.
5. There were sixty-six categories in multiples of 10, but this was a notional number.
6. Rank holders up to 500 were called mansabdars, those from 500 to 2,500 were called amirs, and those above 2,500 were called amir-i-umda or amir-i-azam. Later, all those below 1,000 were called mansabdars.
7. Ranks from 5,000 to 10,000 were reserved for royal princes.
8. Nobles could aspire to a maximum rank of 7,000 until Aurangzeb's time4. Later, princes were granted ranks as high as 40,000 zat
9. **Payment System** -
    a. Salaries were **paid in cash** or through **Jagirs (land grants)**.
    b. **Jagirdars collected revenue** on behalf of the state.
    c. All **Jagirdars were Mansabdars**, but **not all Mansabdars were Jagirdars**.
10. **Military Obligation** -
    a. Mansabdars had to **maintain horses, elephants, camels, and carts** based on their **Zat rank**.
    b. Strict **quality control for horses and war animals** was enforced.
11. **Promotion System** -
    a. Nobles **entered at lower ranks** and were **promoted based on performance**.
    b. The emperor had **discretionary power to induct efficient officers at higher ranks**.
12. **Corruption and Manipulation** -
    a. **Borrowing of soldiers** before inspections was a common fraud.
    b. Some nobles **avoided presenting full contingents** to retain Jagir revenues.

Administrative Functions of Mansabdari System

Mansabdars could hold military, administrative, or court positions, allowing the state to use them for various jobs

1. **Revenue Collection:** Mansabdars were often responsible for revenue collection in their designated territories.
2. **Local Governance:** The Mansabdars acted as the emperor's representatives in various regions, helping to maintain law and order and implement imperial policies.
3. **Military Organization:** Mansabdars were accountable for recruiting and training soldiers, ensuring loyalty to the emperor.

Merits of Mansabdari System

1. The Mansabdari system was a unique and distinct system and formed the backbone of the Mughal administration. It is said that, till the system functioned the mughal state functioned well.

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2. It introduced the **Concept of Uniformity in the administration** which led towards political unification.
3. It also **weakened the caste and the feudal system** as it made it mandatory for the mansabdars to appoint soldiers from all castes and religions.
4. **Strong Military Organization** - Ensured a **well-maintained army**, with **Mansabdars responsible for troop upkeep**.
5. **Flexible Rank System** - Allowed the emperor to **promote or demote officials** based on **merit and loyalty**.
6. **Encouraged Meritocracy** - **Talented individuals** could rise through ranks, fostering **competition and efficiency**.
7. **Dagh System (Branding of Horses)** - Prevented **fraud in military recruitment** and ensured **combat readiness**.
8. **Integration of Rajputs & Nobles** - Helped **assimilate Rajput rulers and other local chiefs** into the Mughal administration.
9. **Reduced Chances of Rebellion** - Since Mansabdars **depended on imperial grants**, they remained **loyal to the emperor**.
10. **Effective Tax Collection** - **Jagirdars were accountable** for collecting and submitting revenue, reducing **tax evasion**.

Demerits of Mnasabdari System

1. According to Badayuni, **Mansabdars cheated the government by bringing to master men from the streets** in military uniform and passing them off as soldiers.
2. **Nobles resisted strict enforcement of the Dagh system**.
3. The **Jagir-based salary system** led to **exploitation of peasants** and **economic instability**.
4. **High Cost to the Treasury** - Large salaries and land grants **strained the imperial finances**.
5. **Burden on Peasants** - Excessive taxation by Jagirdars led to **peasant exploitation and economic distress**.
6. **No Permanent Standing Army** - The **emperor lacked direct control** over troops, making the army **unreliable in times of crisis**.
7. **Frequent Transfers of Jagirs** - Jagirdars were often **transferred**, leading to **neglect of land and inefficient administration**.
8. **Unrest Among Nobility** - Competition for **higher mansabs** created **rivalries and factionalism** at the Mughal court.
9. **Collapse Under Later Mughals** - As **resources depleted**, the empire **couldn't sustain Mansabdars**, leading to **military and administrative breakdown**.

Land Revenue System in Mughal Empire

1. **Assessment (Tashkhidjama)** determined the **state's share**, while **actual collection (Hasil)** ensured revenue realization. **Terms Used** - **"Mal" and "Mal Wajib"** were used instead of **"Kharaj"**.
2. **Methods of Revenue Assessment**
   a. **Galla Bakhshi (Crop-sharing)** - Crop divided at the **threshing floor, in the field, or after stacking**. **Malikzada favored crop sharing** as it **equally distributed seasonal risks** between peasants and the state. **Abul Fazl criticized it** for being **costly**, requiring **watchmen to prevent misappropriation**.
   b. **Kankut/Daeaband** - Estimated **yield per bigha** based on field measurement.
   c. **Zabti (Standardized System)** - Introduced by **Sher Shah, refined by Akbar**. It involved measuring land, fixing cash revenue rates (dastur), and reducing uncertainties in revenue demand.
   d. **Nasaq** - Used **previous revenue figures** for assessments, avoiding annual measurements.

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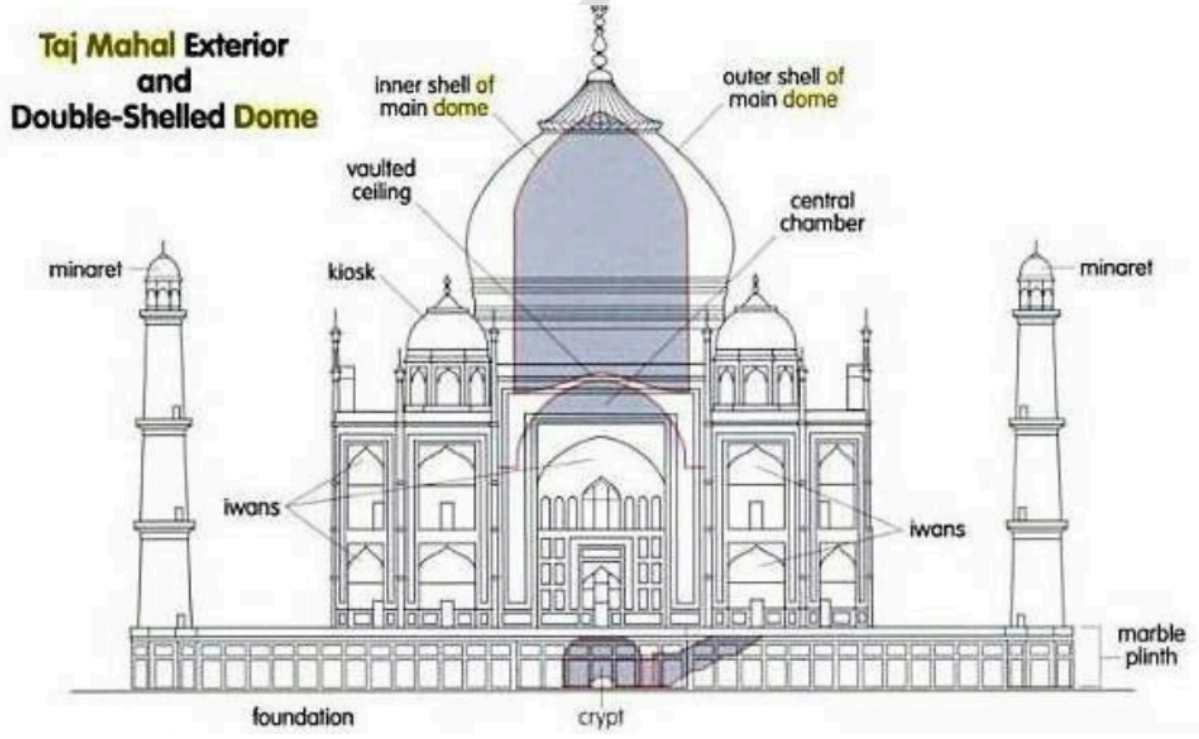
e. **Ijara (Revenue Farming)** - Though generally disapproved, villages were sometimes farmed out to revenue officials or their relatives, especially when peasants couldn't cultivate the land12. This became common during the 18th century in jagir lands

3. **Revenue Demand & Payment**
   a. **Share of Produce** - Typically **1/3 to 1/2**, but could go up to **3/4** in some regions (higher under Aurangzeb than Akbar).
   b. **Mode of Payment** - Mostly **cash**, except **crop-sharing and kankut**, which allowed **conversion to cash at market rates**.

Collection & Relief Measures

1. **Collection Timing** -
   a. **Crop-sharing:** State took its share **directly from fields**.
   b. **Kharif crops:** Revenue collected in **stages**; **Rabi crops:** Before harvest.
2. **Relief Measures:**
   a. **Bad harvests: Crop-sharing, Kankut, and exclusion of damaged areas (Nabud) under Zabti**.
   b. **Taqavi Loans:** Provided for **seeds and cattle** purchase

1. **Revenue Administration**
   a. **Karori (1574-75)** - Managed **assessment and collection**.
   b. **Amin (Shah Jahan's reign)** - Primarily **assessed revenue**.
   c. **Qanungo** - Maintained **land revenue records**.
   d. **Chaudhuri** - Leading **zamindar, collected revenue, and guaranteed Taqavi loans**.
   e. **Shiqqdar (Sher Shah's era)** - Managed **revenue collection & law enforcement**.
   f. **Muqaddam & Patwari** - **Village headman & land record keeper**, respectively.
   g. **Faujdar** - **Military official** assisting in tax collection from **defiant zamindars & peasants**.



2. **Written Agreements** - Revenue terms recorded in **Patta, Qaul, or Pasulqarar**, with **Qabuliyat (acceptance) by the assessee**.
3. **Regressive Taxation** - **Small landholders** bore a **higher burden** than larger ones.

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Art & Architecture of Mughals

Features of Mughal Architecture

1. **Symmetry and Proportion - Mughal architecture** is characterized by **precise symmetry and geometric planning**. Balance is maintained from **grand facades to intricate details**. **Eg.** The **Taj Mahal** showcases **perfect symmetry**, with **four identical minarets framing the central dome**.
2. **Use of Domes and Minarets - Mughals popularized domes and minarets**, serving **aesthetic, functional, and symbolic roles**.
   a. **Domes** - The **bulbous (onion-shaped) dome**, often crowned with a **lotus design**, became a **signature feature**. **Eg.** The **Taj Mahal's marble dome** is one of the most iconic globally.
   b. **Minarets** - Served both **decorative and structural purposes**, enhancing a building's **grandeur**.
3. **Ornamental Facades - Mughal architecture featured intricate decorations**, including **calligraphy, floral motifs, and geometric patterns**. **Pietra dura (marble inlay with precious stones)** showcased artistic excellence. **Eg.** The **Red Fort, Delhi**, displays **elaborate floral inlays and calligraphy**, symbolizing **imperial wealth and refined taste**.
4. **Materials used** - Early Mughal buildings used red sandstone, while later structures showcased intricate marble inlay work**. Eg. Fatehpur Sikri (red sandstone) vs. Taj Mahal (white marble).**
5. Many Mughal structures followed **symmetrical Persian gardens** divided into four parts by water channels, symbolizing paradise. **Eg. Shalimar Bagh in Kashmir follows the Charbagh layout.**
6. **Influence of Religious and Cultural Elements**
   a. **Islamic Calligraphy and Symbolism** - Mughal architecture featured **Quranic inscriptions** on **arches, domes, and entrances**, adding a **spiritual aura**. **Eg. Taj Mahal's entrance** is adorned with **Quranic verses**, enhancing its sanctity.
   b. **Hindu and Jain Influences** - Mughals integrated **local architectural elements**, reflecting **cultural diversity**. **Eg. Akbar's Tomb, Sikandra**, combines **Hindu chhatris, Jain-style ornamental brackets, and Islamic domes**.
7. Grand entrances with arched iwans (vaulted halls) and ornamental gates were common features. **Eg. Buland Darwaza (Fatehpur Sikri) is India's largest gateway.**
8. Delicate lattice screens (Jali work) allowed ventilation and diffused light, while floral, geometric, and arabesque motifs adorned walls. **Eg. The jali screens of Itmad-ud-Daulah's Tomb (Agra).**

Architecture under different Rulers

Babur: He was fond of formal gardens and a couple of gardens are ascribed to him. **Eg.** Mosque of Kabuli Bagh at Panipat and Jami Masjid at Sambhal near Delhi

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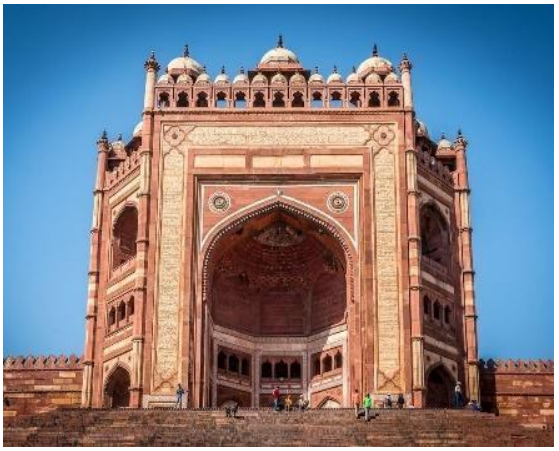
Humayun

1. **Foundation of Dinpanah** - Humayun **began constructing the city**, but it remained **unfinished**.
2. **First distinct example of Mughal architecture**, built by his widow **Begha Begum**.
3. **Blend of Persian and Indian styles**, featuring a **high double dome and chhatris**, giving it a **pyramidal appearance**.
4. **Charbagh-style garden**, emphasizing symmetry.
5. **Red sandstone, double-storeyed structure**, raised over a series **of cells**, resembling **musical composition**.
6. **The octagonal central chamber** houses the **cenotaph**.
7. **First use of red sandstone and white marble in Mughal architecture**.

Akbar

1. **Made Agra his capital**, establishing it as the Mughal **seat of power**. **Fusion of Hindu and Islamic architectural styles** in his constructions.
2. **Extensive use of red sandstone** was a hallmark of Akbar's architecture. **Introduced the 'Tudor Arch' (four-centered arch)**, adding structural uniqueness.
3. **Agra Fort**
   a. **Delhi Gate and Jahangiri Mahal** are the **only surviving structures from Akbar's reign**.
   b. Most structures, including **Diwan-i-Aam and Diwan-i-Khas**, were **built by Shah Jahan**.



Fatehpur Sikri

1. Built as a **tribute to Sheikh Salim Chisti**. Described as a **"frozen moment in history"**, showcasing a **blend of Hindu and Persian styles**.
2. **New capital city of Akbar**, constructed in **red sandstone** using the **trabeate system. Structures were built from local rock**, assembled **without mortar**.

Key Structures in Fatehpur Sikri

1. **Buland Darwaza (1576)** - Built to **commemorate Akbar's victory over Gujarat, tallest gateway in the world**.
2. **Salim Chisti's Tomb - Only white marble structure** in Fatehpur Sikri.
3. **Ibadat Khana** - Hall for **religious discussions** among scholars of different faiths.
4. **Other Notable Buildings - Panch Mahal, Pachisi Court, Jami Masjid, Hiran Minar, Jodha Bai's Palace**.

Panch Mahal

1. **Five-story palace** with **open terraces on each level**.

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2. Built in **trabeate style**, featuring **pillared verandas, architraves, and brackets**.
3. Likely used for **royal recreation**.

Other Contributions

1. **Govind Dev Temple, Vrindavan** - Built in **red sandstone** by **Raja Man Singh** with **stone donated by Akbar**.

Jahangir

1. **Focused more on paintings**, with **less emphasis on architecture**.
2. **Key constructions** during his reign:
   a. **Akbar's Tomb (Sikandra)** - **Designed by Akbar**, construction began in his lifetime and was **completed by Jahangir**.
   b. **Moti Mahal (Lahore)**.
   c. **Shalimar Bagh and Nishat Bagh (Kashmir)**.
3. **Nur Jahan commissioned** the **Tomb of Itmad-ud-Daulah (Agra)** in **white marble**, introducing **extensive pietra dura (stone inlay work)**.
4. **White marble became the primary building material**, with **partial use of red sandstone**.

Shah Jahan

1. The Mughal empire reached its **architectural zenith under Shah Jahan.**
   a. In **1631**, Shah Jahan started the construction of the **Taj Mahal** in memory of his wife, Mumtaz Mahal (Arjumand Bano Begum). It was completed in **1648**.
   b. **Ustad Isa** and **Isa Muhammad Effendi** were the chief architects, while **Ismail Khan** designed the dome of the Taj Mahal.
2. During Shah Jahan's reign **mosque-building** flourished, with notable constructions including: -
   a. **Moti Masjid** in **Agra** (crafted entirely in white marble).
   b. **Sheesh Mahal** and **Mussaman Burj** in Agra.
   c. **Jama Masjid** in **Delhi** was built using red stone.
3. **Pinnacle of Fort-Building:** Eg. **Red Fort** in Delhi with the **Rang Mahal**, **Diwan-i-Aam**, and **Diwan-i-Khas**.
4. **Shahjahanabad City:** Established by Shah Jahan as the new capital of the Mughal Empire, present-day **Old Delhi**. He is also credited with the construction of **Shalimar Bagh** in Lahore
5. The famous **Peacock Throne** in the Diwan-i-Khas (Hall of Private Audiences, or Ministers' Room) in the Red Fort of Delhi was built for Shah Jahan.

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Aurangzeb

1. **Mughal architecture declined**
2. In 1668 the Tomb of Rabia Durani (Aurangabad) or Bibi Ka Maqbara was erected by Azam Shah, the son of Aurangzeb to commemorate his mother Dilras Begum who was titled Rabia Durani post her death.
3. He also built Zinat Mahal in Delhi in memory of his wife.

Mughal Paintings.

1. Mughal School of painting originated in the reign of Akbar in 1560 CE who was keenly interested in the art of painting and architecture.
   a. In the beginning of his rule a **studio of painting** was established under the supervision of **two Persian masters, Mir Sayyed Ali and Abdul Samad Khan**, who were originally employed by his father Humayun.
   b. A large number of Indian artists from all over India were recruited to work under the Persian masters.
   c. The Mughal style evolved as a result of a **happy synthesis of the indigenous Indian style of painting and the Safavid school of Persian painting**. Later European themes and styles were also incorporated.
   d. It is marked by **naturalism** based on close observation of **nature** and fine and delicate drawing and is primarily **aristocratic and secular**.
   e. An **illustrated manuscript of theTuti-nama** in the **Cleveland Museum of Art (USA)** appears to be the first work of the Mughal School.
   f. **Subject Matter and Themes**: Mughal artists favored royal court scenes, portraits, and accurate depictions of flora and fauna.
   g. Under Akbar's patronage, the Mughal painting depicted political conquests, court scenes, secular texts, portraits, Hindu mythologies, and Persian and Islamic themes.
   h. Jahangir encouraged delicate observations and fine details, with a focus on naturalism and scientific accuracy in rendering flora and fauna.
   i. Shah Jahan's era saw a preference for idealization and stylization over naturalistic depiction, with a concentration on subliminal qualities and exalted beautification
   j. Some of the **famous painters in Akbar's court** other than the two Persian masters already mentioned are **Dasvanth, Miskina, Nanha, Kanha, Basawan, Manohar, Doulat, Mansur, Kesu, Bhim Gujarati, etc.**
2. Jahangir had great fascination for nature and took delight in the **portraiture of birds, animals and flowers.**
   a. Some important manuscripts illustrated during his period are, an **animal fable book called Ayar-i-Danish, the Anwar-i-sunavli, another fable book.**
   b. The **famous painters of Jahangir are** Aqa Riza, Abul Hasan, Mansur, Bishan Das, Manohar, Goverdhan, Balchand, Daulat, Mukhlis, Bhim and Inayat.
   c. The **portrait of Jahangir** illustrated is a typical example of miniature executed during the period of Jahangir.

Literature during the Mughals

Persian Literature

1. **Persian was the administrative language** of the **Mughals and Deccan states**, influencing **Rajput administration**.
2. **Abul Fazl** (patronized by Akbar) wrote **Akbar Nama** and **Ain-i-Akbari** (Mughal administration).
3. **Padshah Nama** (biography of **Shah Jahan**) was written by **Abdul Hamid Lahori and Muhammad Waris**, following the **Akbar Nama style**.
4. **Alamgir Nama**, by **Muhammad Kazim**, documented **Aurangzeb's reign**.
5. **Babur's autobiography (Baburnama)** was originally in **Chaghatai Turkish**, translated into **Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-e-Khanan**.

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6. **Dabistan** - An **impartial account of various religions**.
7. **Persian poetry flourished** with works by **Abul Faizi, Utbi, and Naziri**.

Sanskrit Literature

1. **Flourished under Mughal rule**, known for **kavyas and historical poetry**.
2. **Rajavalipataka** (history of Kashmir) by **Prajna Bhatta**, written during **Akbar's reign**.
3. **Greek-Arabic knowledge** was **translated into Sanskrit** through Persian sources.

Translations from Sanskrit to Persian

1. **Mahabharata** was translated under **Abul Faizi** (Akbar's court poet).
2. **Upanishads** were translated by **Dara Shukoh** as **Sirr-i-Akbar (The Great Secret)**.

Regional Literature

1. **Flourished with lyrical poetry and Bhakti influences**.
2. **Abdur Rahim Khan-e-Khanan** blended **Persian themes** into **Brij Hindi poetry**.
3. **Marathi literature thrived**, led by **Eknath, Tukaram, Ramdas, and Mukteshwar**.

Development of Music During the Mughal Empire

1. **Musical Synthesis:** There was a synthesis of Turko-Persian musical traditions with classical Indian music, leading to the development of the Hindavi-Persian tradition, which later evolved into Hindustani music
2. **Royal Patronage:** Mughal rulers, particularly Akbar, Jahangir, and Shah Jahan, supported musicians and encouraged innovation.
3. **Development of Musical Forms**:
   a. **Dhrupad** as a musical genre was brought to perfection.
   b. **Khayal** singers of Delhi attained perfection as a classical genre under Akbar's patronage.
   c. **Bishnupad** (songs to Vishnu) was briefly described in Ain-i-Akbari
4. **Musical Instruments:** Musicians played various instruments, including stringed instruments like ghichak, bin, surmandal, rabab, and qabuz, as well as qanun, surna, and tambour
5. **Establishment of Gharanas:** Distinct schools of music (gharanas) emerged due to Mughal patronage, laying the foundation for the Hindustani classical system.
6. **Categories of Musicians:** Abul Fazl mentioned different categories of musicians and singers, such as the Khawanadgan, the Goyinda, the Dhari, the Kalawants, and the Khuniyagaran
7. **Sufi Influence:** Chishti Sufi saints greatly contributed to the evolution of Hindustani music
8. **Introduction of New Instruments:** Instruments like the sitar and tabla gained prominence during this era
9. Regional Music - Raja Man Singh of Gwaliyar (1486-1517) was a patron and skilled musician. He created new melodies compiled in Man Kautuhal and contributed to the development of Dhrupad music.

Important Mughal Emperors and Their Contributions to Music

1. **Humayun (1530-1540, 1555-1556):** Brought Persian musicians to India during his exile in Iran, influencing Indian music.
2. **Akbar (1556-1605)** - The Golden Age of Mughal Music
   a. The Ain-i-Akbari, written by Abu'l-Fazl ibn Mubarak, suggests that there were 36 musicians of high grate in the Mughal court of Akbar.
   b. Akbar studied Hindu vocalization under Lal Kalawant
   c. Employed Tansen, one of the most legendary figures in Indian classical music.
   d. Encouraged the Dhrupad style, making it the dominant court music form.

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e. Maintained a Naqqar Khana (royal orchestra) for performances in his court.

3. **Shah Jahan (1628-1658)**
   a. Encouraged grandeur in musical performances and supported musicians.
   b. Patronized Khushhal Khan 'Gunasamudra', a descendant of Tansen.
4. **Aurangzeb (1658-1707):** Disapproved of music and banned it from the royal court, leading musicians to seek patronage in regional courts. Despite the ban, musical traditions continued in private gatherings.
5. **Later Mughals (1707-1857)**
   a. Under Muhammad Shah 'Rangila' (1719-1748), Mughal music revived, with Khayal becoming more popular.
   b. Decline of central Mughal patronage led to the rise of regional courts like Awadh, Hyderabad, and Jaipur as musical centers.

Important Musicians

1. **Naubat Khan**
   a. Renowned rudra veena player in Akbar's court.
   b. Father-in-law of Tansen's daughter, contributing to his musical lineage.
2. **Khushhal Khan 'Gunasamudra' (d. 1675)**
   a. Great-grandson of Tansen, chief musician in Shah Jahan's court.
   b. Known for his exceptional performance in Raga Todi, which captivated the emperor.
3. **Sadarang (Niyamat Khan) and Adarang (Firoz Khan)**
   a. Musicians under Muhammad Shah Rangila who popularized Khayal singing.
   b. Sadarang is credited with refining Khayal, which became the dominant style of Hindustani classical music.
4. **Amir Khusrau (1253-1325, Pre-Mughal Influence)**
   a. Though he lived before the Mughal period, his contributions influenced Mughal-era music.
   b. Credited with developing Qawwali and early forms of Khayal and Tarana.
   c. Introduced the Sitar and modified the Tabla from Persian percussion instruments.

Contributions of Tansen (c. 1500-1586): Tansen, originally named Ramtanu Pandey, was one of the most legendary figures in Indian classical music. As a court musician of Emperor Akbar and one of the Navaratnas (Nine Gems), Tansen played a pivotal role in shaping Hindustani classical music.

- **Development of Hindustani Classical Music**
- Integrated Persian and Indian musical elements, creating a unique Mughal-era fusion.
- Formalized and structured Dhrupad as the dominant style of Hindustani classical music.
- His innovations influenced later gharanas, particularly Gwalior Gharana.
- **Creation of New Ragas (Ragini System)**
- Tansen is credited with developing and modifying several ragas, many of which are still performed today:
- Miyan ki Malhar - Believed to have the power to bring rain.
- Miyan ki Todi - A morning raga attributed to Tansen.
- Darbari Kanada - A serious and meditative night raga, suited for royal courts.
- Miyan ki Sarang - A variation of Sarang raga, sung in the afternoon.
- Megh Malhar - Associated with the power to invoke rain, similar to Miyan ki Malhar.
- Bhairav and Bhairavi - Although older ragas, Tansen contributed to their refinement and popularization.

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- **Innovations in Performance and Style**
- Introduced improvisation techniques that later became essential in Khayal music.
- Emphasized voice modulation, rhythm, and tonal quality, which shaped Hindustani classical music's development.
- Expanded the role of instrumental accompaniment, particularly using the rudra veena, tanpura, and pakhawaj.
- **Founder of the Gwalior Gharana**
- Considered the spiritual founder of the Gwalior Gharana, one of the oldest Hindustani classical gharanas.
- His students and descendants carried forward his musical traditions, ensuring their survival.
- **Influence on Later Musicians and Gharanas**
- His descendants and disciples continued his musical legacy under Mughal patronage.
- Sadarang and Adarang, famous musicians in Muhammad Shah's court, were influenced by Tansen's style.
- His musical lineage contributed to the development of Khayal, Thumri, and Tappa.

Development of Musical Forms

1. **Dhrupad**
   a. Dominant in Akbar's court, structured, devotional, and meditative.
   b. Performed by kalawants, professional dhrupad singers.
   c. Gwalior Gharana became the center of Dhrupad music.
2. **Khayal**
   a. A more expressive and flexible form than Dhrupad, gaining popularity under Muhammad Shah.
   b. Promoted by Sadarang and Adarang.
3. **Qawwali:** A Sufi devotional music form, developed by Amir Khusrau but popularized in Mughal courts.
4. **Tappa:** A folk-inspired, fast-paced vocal form that gained recognition in the later Mughal period.

Musical Instruments Introduced or Popularized

1. **Sitar:** Evolved from Persian string instruments.
2. **Tabla:** Modified from Persian percussion instruments.
3. **Veena:** Continued to be played by classical musicians like Naubat Khan.
4. **Sarangi:** Gained prominence as an accompaniment for vocal music.

Decline of Mughal Empire

Economic Factors

1. **Agricultural Stagnation** - Excessive **land revenue demands** led to **declining productivity** and **rural distress**. Eg. Jat and Satnami rebellions
2. **Revenue Burden** - The **Jagirdari system** led to **corrupt revenue collection**, causing **peasant discontent**, as seen in the **Bengal famine (1670s)** and **Maratha resistance**.
3. **Decline in Trade** - The **loss of Gujarat's trade centers** and **European dominance in sea routes** (Eg. **British control of Surat port, Dutch in Coromandel Coast**) reduced Mughal commercial revenue.

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4. **Wealth Drain** - Extravagant **nobility lifestyles, military expenses, and trade deficits** drained the empire's treasury.

Administrative Factors

1. **Weak Successors** - Post-Aurangzeb rulers, like **Bahadur Shah I (1707-1712), Jahandar Shah (1712-1713), and Farrukhsiyar (1713-1719)**, were **puppets of nobles**, leading to **political instability**.
2. **Decentralization - Governors of Bengal (Murshid Quli Khan), Awadh (Saadat Khan), and Hyderabad (Nizam-ul-Mulk)** became independent, reducing Mughal central authority.
3. **No Permanent Standing Army** - Unlike the **Marathas (who had a mobile guerrilla force) or the British (with a disciplined standing army)**, the Mughals relied on **Mansabdars**, who often **underreported troop numbers**.
4. **Deccan Conquests (Aurangzeb's Prolonged Wars)** - The empire expanded **beyond its administrative and military capacity**, leading to **logistical issues**.

Political Factors

1. **Regional Revolts** -
   a. **Deccan Revolt - Marathas under Chhatrapati Shivaji** and later **Peshwas** successfully challenged Mughal control.
   b. **Bengal & Awadh - Nawabs like Alivardi Khan (Bengal) and Saadat Khan (Awadh)** became autonomous.
   c. **Jat, Sikh, and Rajput Rebellions - Jat leader Raja Suraj Mal, Guru Gobind Singh's Sikh resistance**, and **Rajput defiance under Sawai Jai Singh II** weakened the empire.
2. **External Invasions** -
   a. **Persian Invasion (1739) - Nadir Shah looted Delhi**, taking the **Kohinoor diamond and Peacock Throne**.
   b. **Afghan Invasions (1748-1761) - Ahmad Shah Abdali's repeated attacks**, culminating in the **Third Battle of Panipat (1761)**, devastated the empire.

Factionalism & Court Intrigues

1. **Rise of Powerful Nobles** - Rivalry between **Turani, Irani, and Hindustani factions** weakened unity.
2. **Sayyid Brothers (Kingmakers, 1713-1720)** - Controlled the Mughal throne by **placing and removing emperors at will**.
3. **Internal Power Struggles - Murder of emperors like Farrukhsiyar (1719)** and constant succession wars destabilized the empire.

Social & Cultural Factors

1. **Religious Intolerance** -
   a. **Aurangzeb's Jizya tax (1679)** alienated Hindus and led to **rebellions (Rajput and Sikh revolts)**.
   b. **Destruction of temples**, like **Kashi Vishwanath and Mathura's Krishna Janmabhoomi**, angered Hindu communities.

British & European Expansion

1. **Battle of Buxar (1764)** - The British defeated **Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II, Nawab of Awadh, and Nawab of Bengal**, further diminishing Mughal authority.
2. **Mughal Emperor as British Puppet** - By **1803**, the British had taken control of **Delhi**, reducing the Mughal emperor to a mere figurehead under British protection.

While the **Mughal Empire declined as a political entity, its cultural and historical impact continues to define India's heritage**.

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Maratha Empire

The Maratha Empire was an early modern Indian confederation that rose to prominence in the 18th century, dominating much of the Indian subcontinent. The Maratha Empire was established by Chhatrapati Shivaji in the late 17th century as a response to the chaos and misrule in the Deccan region.

Maratha Rulers & Their Achievements

Name	Key Achievements
Chhatrapati Shri Shivaji Maharaj (1627-1680)	• **Founded the Maratha Empire (1674)**, challenging the Mughals and Adilshahi. • **Pioneered Guerrilla Warfare (Ganimi Kava)**, using terrain effectively. • **Built a Strong Navy**, securing the Konkan coast. • **Fortified 370+ Forts**, including **Raigad and Pratapgad**. • **Established Ashtapradhan Mandal**, ensuring efficient governance. • **Implemented Chauth & Sardeshmukhi**, reforming taxation. • **Escaped Aurangzeb's Agra Prison (1666)**, showcasing strategic brilliance. • **Crowned as Chhatrapati at Raigad (1674)**, asserting sovereignty.
Chhatrapati Sambhaji (1681-1689)	• Defeated the Portuguese and Chikka Deva Raya of Mysore. • **Resisted Aurangzeb's Invasion** - Fought fiercely against the Mughal expansion into Maratha territories. • **Strong Naval Defense** - Strengthened the **Maratha Navy**, continuing Chhatrapati Shivaji's maritime policies. • **Expanded the Empire** - Led successful campaigns in **Goa, Karnataka, and Konkan** against Mughals, Portuguese, and Siddis. • **Battle of Wai (1687)** - Defeated Mughal forces, showcasing military brilliance. • **Promoted Sanskrit and Literature** - Wrote **"Budhbhushanam"** and encouraged learning despite wartime challenges.
Chhatrapati Rajaram and Tarabai (1689-1707)	• **Ascended the Throne (1689)** - Became Chhatrapati after **Sambhaji Maharaj's execution** by Aurangzeb. • **Shifted Capital to Jinji** - Escaped to **Jinji (Tamil Nadu)**, making it a strategic base against the Mughals. • **Prolonged the Mughal-Maratha War** - Led a **10-year resistance** against Aurangzeb, preventing total Mughal control. • In 1705, Tarabai commanded the Marathas in their battle against the Mughals in Malwa.
Chhatrapati Shahu (1707-1749)	• Established the Peshwas' reign within the Maratha Empire. • In 1713, Shahu designated **Balaji Vishwanath** as the **Peshwa.**
Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath	• Regarded as the second founder of the Maratha Empire. • Took charge as Prime Minister in the 18th century. • Oversaw northward expansion of the Maratha Empire.

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Name	Key Achievements
Peshwa Baji Rao I (1720-1740)	• Was one of the greatest exponents of **guerrilla tactics** after Chhatrapati Shivaji. • **Initiated the system of confederacy**. Thus, many families became prominent and established their authority.
Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao (Nanasaheb) (1740-1761)	• **Signed agreement with Ahmad Shah (Mughal emperor)** - Peshwas assured to protect the Mughal from internal and external enemies in return for the Chauth of the north-west provinces, total revenue of Agra & Ajmer provinces. • **Defeat at the 3rd Battle of Panipat** 1761 by Ahmad Shah Durrani checked the expansion of Marathas and fragmented the empire.
Peshwa Madhav Rao I (1761-1772)	• Restored the Maratha Empire after the Third Battle of Panipat.

Maratha Empire Administration under Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

Central Administration

1. **Ashtapradhan**, or Council of Eight, was a group of eight ministers responsible for governing the Maratha Kingdom.
2. **Peshwa or Pantpradhan**: Prime Minister responsible for overseeing the entire administration.
3. **Amatya or Mazumdar**: Finance Minister, managing the Empire's accounts.
4. **Shurunavis or Sacheev**: Secretary, who prepared royal orders.
5. **Mantri**: Interior Minister, overseeing internal affairs and intelligence.
6. **Sari-i-Naubat or Senapati:** Commander-in-Chief, in charge of the military and defense.
7. **Sumant or Dabir**: Foreign Minister, managing relationships with other rulers.
8. **Nyay Adhyaksh**: Chief Justice, handling civil and criminal justice.
9. **Panditrao**: High Priest, managing religious matters.
10. **Chitnis**: Personal Secretary to the Chhatrapati, acting as a senior writer and sometimes seen as second to the Peshwa in their absence

Administrative System of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

1. **Provincial Administration** - The kingdom was divided into **provinces (Prants)**, each managed by a **Sarsubedar**. Revenue collection was handled by state officials instead of outsourcing to middlemen.
2. **Local Governance** - Provinces were subdivided into **Tarafs (districts)** and **Parganas (sub-districts)**. Villages (**Mauza**) were governed by **Deshpandes, Deshmukhs, Kulkarnis, and Patils** for law and order.
3. **Revenue System** - Based on **Malik Amber's Kathi system**, farmers paid **40% of their produce** as tax. **Chauth (25%)** and **Sardeshmukhi (10%)** were levied on neighboring Mughal territories.
4. **Ryotwari System** - Implemented direct tax collection from farmers (**ryots**) to reduce corruption and enhance communication with the government.
5. **Mirasdars Regulation** - Restricted the power of **Mirasdars** (hereditary landowners) who evaded taxes, ensuring state control over land revenue.
6. **Military Administration** - Soldiers were paid in **cash**, while chiefs received **Saranjam (revenue grants)**. His cavalry (**Paga**) had **30,000-40,000 troops** under **Havaldars**.

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7. **Naval Strength** - **First Indian king to develop a naval force**, building dockyards and warships for trade and defense
8. **Guerrilla Warfare** - Trained troops in **mountain combat and ambush tactics**, effectively countering larger armies.

Maratha Administration under Peshwas (1714-1818)

1. **Rise of Peshwas** - Originally part of **Shivaji's Ashta Pradhan**, the **Peshwa's role became hereditary** under **Balaji Vishwanath (1713-1720)**, who centralized administration.
2. **Central Secretariat (Poona)** - Managed **revenues, expenditures, salaries, and foreign grants**, ensuring financial oversight.
3. **Provincial Administration**
   a. **Sar-Subahdar** governed large provinces, further divided into **Subahs and Pranths**.
   b. **Mamlatdar & Kamavistar** handled district administration, supervised by **Deshmukhs & Deshpandes**.
   c. **Deshpande (accounting) & Deshmukh (law and order)** governed **Parganas**.
4. **Financial Oversight** - Officials paid a **deposit (Rasad)** upon appointment to **prevent misappropriation**.
5. **Revenue System**
   a. **Land Revenue** became the primary source, shifting from **produce sharing to tax farming**.
   b. Assessment based on **crop type, irrigation, and land productivity**.
6. **Village & Urban Administration**
   a. **Villages** were self-sufficient, led by hereditary **Patels** (revenue collection) and **Kulkarnis** (record-keeping).
   b. **Kotwal** governed cities, handling **law, order, price regulation, and civil disputes**.
7. **Judicial System**
   a. **Arbitration was preferred**, with disputes settled by **Panchayats** at village and town levels.
   b. Criminal cases followed a hierarchy from **Patel to Peshwa**, often using flogging and torture.
8. **Military Structure**
   a. **Cavalry** was the backbone, with **Jamindars supplying horsemen** of varying quality.
   b. **Infantry included Arabs, Rohillas, Sikhs, and Sindhis**, paid higher than native Marathas.
   c. **Artillery managed by Portuguese, Indian Christians, and later English.**
   d. **The Navy protected ports, controlled piracy, and collected customs**, with bases at **Konkan, Khanderi, and Vijayadurg**.

Society of the Maratha Empire

1. **Hierarchical Social Structure** - Society was stratified with **Brahmins in administration, Marathas as warriors, and traders/artisans in commerce**. **Eg. Chitpavan Brahmins dominated bureaucracy.**
2. **Role of Women** - Women had **relative freedom**, with some involved in **governance and warfare**, though **child marriage and widow restrictions existed**.
3. **Religious Tolerance & Bhakti Influence** - Society was **Hindu-dominated but tolerant**, influenced by **Bhakti saints like Tukaram and Namdev**.
4. **Military-Oriented Society** - The Marathas built a **merit-based army**, recruiting **Mavles, Sardars, and mercenaries**.
5. **Thriving Trade & Handicrafts** - Internal trade and **textile, metalwork, and shipbuilding industries** flourished. **navy safeguarded maritime trade.**
6. **Decentralized Governance** - **Village panchayats and local councils** managed administration and revenue collection.

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Their influence persisted in **modern Maharashtra's social and political structure**, and their spirit of **self-rule (Swarajya) inspired India's later freedom movements**.

Bhakti movement

Bhakti as a religious concept means devotional surrender to a personally conceived Supreme God for attaining salvation.

1. Between the **7th and 10th centuries**, **Saiva Nayanar** and **Vaisnava Alvar** saints promoted **Bhakti** across **all social groups**, transcending **caste and gender barriers** in South India.
2. **Bhakti movement in North India** - From 13th to 15th century many popular socio-religious movements flourished in North and East India and Maharashtra. Emphasis on bhakti and religious equality characterized these movements.

A.L. Basham - "The Bhakti movement was one of the most creative and significant movements in the history of Hinduism."

R.C. Majumdar - "The Bhakti movement was not a revolt but a reaffirmation of the essence of Hinduism, emphasizing devotion over rituals."

The last of three epilogue verses of the **Shvetashvatara Upanishad, 6.23**, uses the word Bhakti as given under:

He who has the highest Bhakti (love, devotion of Deva (God),

just like his Deva, so for his Guru (teacher),

To him who is high-minded, these teachings will be illuminating.

Influences Leading to the Emergence of the Bhakti Movement

As Buddhism and Jainism declined, Hinduism underwent a phase of spiritual revival.

1. **Influence of Alvar and Nayanar Traditions:** In Tamil Nadu, the Alvars (Vishnu devotees) and Nayanars (Shiva devotees) composed devotional hymns that emphasized deep emotional devotion to a personal deity.
2. **Islamic Influence:** The arrival of Islam introduced concepts of equality and direct worship, prompting Hindu reformers to challenge caste barriers and ritualistic practices.
3. **Complex rituals and priestly dominance** alienated the masses. Eg. **Basavanna (12th century, Karnataka)** rejected temple rituals and promoted direct worship of Shiva through Ishtalinga.
4. **Rigid caste system** denied spiritual access to lower castes. Eg. **Ravidas**, a chamar by caste, asserted spiritual equality in his hymns.
5. **Simplicity and Accessibility - Personal devotion (bhakti)** offered salvation without mediation. Eg. **Guru Nanak Dev** emphasized Nam Simran (remembrance of the Name) as the true path to salvation.
6. **Use of Vernacular Languages** - Eg. **Namdev (Maharashtra)** emphasised devotion to Vitthala through kirtans in Marathi, **Shankaradeva** used the Assamese language to spread his message
7. Influence of Islamic Sufi Thought - Ideas of love, equality, and devotion influenced Bhakti saints. Eg. Kabir's synthesis of Bhakti and Sufi ideas.

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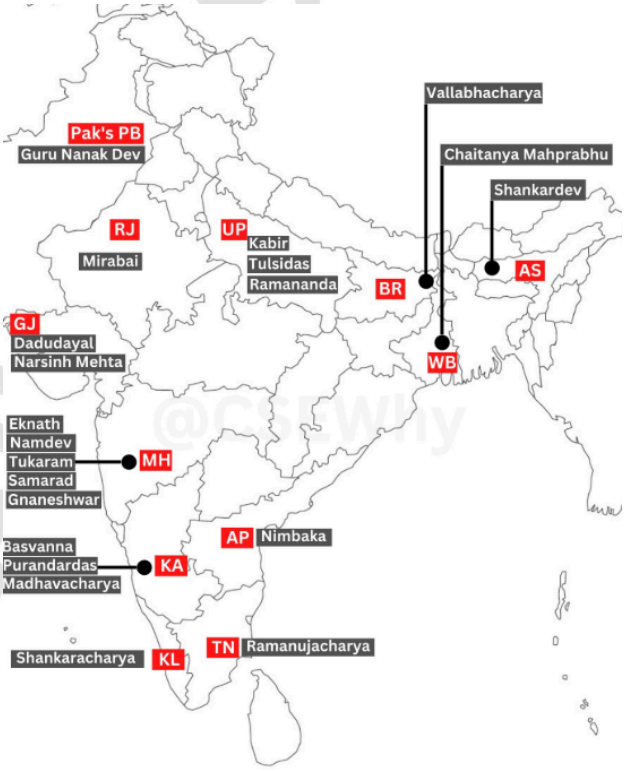
Key Features of the Bhakti Movement

1. **Personal God**: Advocated **direct connection with a personal deity**, either **Saguna (with form, Eg. Rama, Krishna)** or **Nirguna (formless, Eg. Kabir, Nanak's teachings)**.
2. **Equality and Social Reform**: Opposed **caste hierarchy**, promoting **social inclusivity**, attracting **lower castes, women, and marginalized groups**.



3. **Regional Language and Accessibility**: Bhakti saints composed **poetry and hymns in vernacular languages** (Eg. **Tamil, Hindi, Marathi, Bengali**), making spiritual teachings accessible.
4. **Rejection of Orthodox Authority**: Challenged **Brahmanical dominance**, rituals, and external formalities, advocating an **individualistic approach to spirituality**.
5. **Nomadic Lifestyle:** Many Bhakti saints traveled from village to village, spreading their message of love, devotion, and social equality, thus reaching a diverse audience.
6. **Social Inclusivity:** The movement attracted people from all social backgrounds, including lower castes, Brahmins, and women, breaking traditional barriers of caste and gender.
7. **Opposition to Social Inequality:** Bhakti saints actively challenged caste discrimination and preached that all individuals, regardless of birth or status, could attain spiritual enlightenment.
8. **Devotion Over Rituals**: Emphasized **bhakti (devotion)** as the **supreme path** to salvation, rejecting elaborate rituals and priestly mediation.
9. **Inspiration from Sufism**: Shared similarities with **Sufi mysticism**, including **devotional singing (sama & kirtan), emphasis on love, and social unity**.
10. **Temple and Community Worship**: Encouraged **congregational singing (bhajans, kirtans), community feasts (langar)**, fostering **social bonding**.
11. **Presence of Women Saints**: **Mira Bai, Akkamahadevi, and Lal Ded** were key women figures who challenged **patriarchal norms** through their spiritual expressions.
12. **Non-Sectarianism**: Bhakti saints like **Kabir and Guru Nanak** preached **religious harmony**, blending **Hindu and Islamic traditions**.
13. **Simple and Humble Living:** Saints promoted a life of simplicity, humility, and selfless service, valuing pure devotion over scholarly knowledge or asceticism.

Spread of the Bhakti Movement in Various Parts of India

The **Bhakti movement** emerged in **South India** (7th-9th century CE) and gradually spread to **North India** (12th-17th century CE), adapting to local traditions and languages. It was divided into **Nirguna Bhakti (Formless God)** and **Saguna Bhakti (God with form)**.

South India (7th-9th Century CE) - Early Bhakti Movement

1. **Regions**: **Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala**.

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2. **Key Features**:
   a. Emphasized **Saguna Bhakti** (worship of deities with form).
   b. **Vernacular compositions** in **Tamil** (Eg. Thevaram, Divya Prabandham).
   c. **Close ties with temple traditions**, particularly in **Chidambaram, Srirangam, and Madurai**.
   d. Laid the foundation for **later movements like Sri Vaishnavism (Ramanuja, 11th century)**.
3. **Major Saints:Alvars**: **Andal, Nammalvar, Periyalvar** (Vishnu worshippers); **Nayanars**: **Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar** (Shiva worshippers).
4. **Texts:Divya Prabandham** (Alvars' hymns); **Tevaram** (Nayanars' devotional poems).

Limitations of the South Indian Bhakti Movement

- **Did Not Oppose Caste System**: The movement did not consciously challenge **Brahmanism, varna, or caste hierarchy**; lower castes continued to face discrimination.
- **Integration with Brahmanical Traditions**: Despite promoting **bhakti as superior**, it retained **idol worship, Vedic recitations, and pilgrimages**, aligning with Brahmanical rituals.
- **Targeted Jains & Buddhists, Not Brahmins**: The movement opposed **Jainism and Buddhism** rather than **Brahmanical dominance**, indirectly reinforcing **Hindu orthodoxy**.
- **Brahmin-Controlled Temples**: Temples, dominated by **Brahmins**, became central to **Bhakti practices**, further consolidating Brahmanical influence.
- **Strengthened Hierarchical Structures**: Instead of dismantling caste barriers, **Bhakti was absorbed into traditional Brahmanical Hinduism**, reinforcing **social stratification**.
- **Gradual Absorption into Orthodox Hinduism**: After reaching its peak in the **10th century**, the movement was **assimilated into the Brahmanical framework**, losing its radical appeal.

Maharashtra (13th-17th Century CE) - Varkari Tradition

1. **Key Features**:
   a. **Varkari tradition** - Annual pilgrimage to **Pandharpur**.
   b. **Promoted equality** - Open to lower castes like **Chokhamela (Dalit saint)**.
   c. **Social activism** - Saints spoke against **Brahmanical orthodoxy**.
   d. Used **Marathi poetry (Abhangs, Ovis)** to spread teachings.
2. **Major Saints**:
   a. **Dnyaneshwar**: Wrote **Dnyaneshwari (Marathi commentary on Bhagavad Gita)**.
   b. **Namdev**: His hymns were included in **Guru Granth Sahib**.
   c. **Tukaram**: Famous for **Abhangas (devotional songs)**.

Karnataka (12th Century CE) - Veerashaiva Movement

1. **Philosophy**:
   a. **Worship of Shiva as Linga**, rejecting idol worship and temple rituals.
   b. Strong emphasis on **monotheism, social equality, and opposition to caste hierarchy**.
2. **Key Features**:
   a. **Vachana literature** (poetic compositions in Kannada) made religious teachings accessible.
   b. Rejected **Brahmanical authority**, promoted **gender equality**, allowing **women saints** like Akka Mahadevi.
   c. Advocated **work as worship** and integrated spiritual practices into daily life.

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3. **Major Saints**: **Basavanna**: Founder of **Lingayat sect**, rejected Vedic rituals.; **Akka Mahadevi**: Female saint, emphasized **spiritual liberation**.

Gujarat and Rajasthan (14th-16th Century CE)

1. **Key Saints**: **Narsinh Mehta, Dadu Dayal, Mirabai**.
2. **Philosophy**:
   a. **Narsinh Mehta (Gujarat)** emphasized **Krishna devotion and social equality**.
   b. **Dadu Dayal (Rajasthan)** preached **Nirguna Bhakti**, rejecting idol worship.
   c. **Mirabai (Rajasthan)**, a Rajput princess, devoted her life to **Krishna bhakti**, rejecting royal life.
3. **Key Features**:
   a. Worshiped **Krishna (Saguna Bhakti)** through **bhajans**.
   b. Emphasized **love and surrender to God**.
   c. **Bhakti literature in Gujarati and Rajasthani**, influencing later traditions.
   d. **Mirabai's songs and poems** became part of **folk and devotional traditions**.
   e. **Dadu Panth** and **Ramsnehi sect** emerged, opposing Brahmanical dominance.
   f. **Emphasis on community worship and social harmony**.

East India (15th-16th Century) - Vaishnavism & Monotheism

Key Saints: Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (Bengal), Shankaradeva (Assam).

Philosophy: Saguna Bhakti (Krishna devotion) mixed with monotheistic elements.

Key Features

1. Chaitanya's Gaudiya Vaishnavism emphasized Radha-Krishna devotion and ecstatic kirtans.
2. Shankaradeva's Neo-Vaishnavism in Assam rejected idol worship and promoted monotheism.
3. Bengali and Assamese bhakti literature flourished, influencing regional identity.

Inclusive approach, appealing to all castes.

North India (14th-17th Century) - Nirguna & Saguna Traditions

Philosophy

1. Nirguna Bhakti (formless God): Kabir, Nanak opposed idol worship and emphasized oneness of God.
2. Saguna Bhakti (deities like Rama, Krishna): Mirabai, Tulsidas, Surdas promoted personal devotion.

1. **Major Saints**:
   a. **Kabir**: Criticized both **Hindu and Muslim rituals**, promoted **Nirguna Bhakti**.
   b. **Ravidas**: A Dalit saint, emphasized **equality and devotion**.
   c. **Tulsidas**: Wrote **Ramcharitmanas (Hindi version of Ramayana)**, popularizing Rama worship.
   d. **Surdas**: Wrote **Sursagar**, devoted to **Krishna's childhood (Saguna Bhakti)**.

Key Features

Hindustani & Braj Bhasha bhakti poetry, making spirituality accessible.

Sikhism emerged under Guru Nanak, blending Hindu and Sufi influences.

1. Rejection of Brahmanical rituals (Kabir, Nanak) but temple-centered worship (Tulsidas).

Women's role (Eg. Mirabai) expanded spiritual participation.

1. Emphasized **universal brotherhood and social equality**.

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Core Teachings of Important Bhakti Saints

Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

1. Bhakti to Lord Krishna is the highest path to liberation, emphasizing personal and direct devotion.
2. Central to his practice, the Hare Krishna mantra is a means to attain spiritual purity and bliss.
3. Krishna is the supreme deity, and devotion to him leads to divine fulfillment.
4. Total surrender (Sharanagati) to God, submitting to His will, is essential in the path of Bhakti.
5. Devotion is accessible to everyone, regardless of caste or gender, challenging the social hierarchies of the time.
6. The ultimate goal is to develop prema (divine love) for Krishna, which transcends formal rituals.
7. Krishna's divine pastimes (lila) are central to devotion and spiritual practice.
8. Devotees should show compassion to all living beings, seeing them as part of God's creation.
9. His teachings led to the spread of Gaudiya Vaishnavism, particularly through Sankirtana.
10. His teachings were spread globally through ISKCON, expanding his message of love and devotion.

Kabir Das

1. Kabir Das emphasized devotion to one formless God (Nirakar), challenging traditional religious practices and rituals.
2. He believed in the unity of God and rejected distinctions between Hinduism and Islam, promoting a universal spiritual path.
3. Kabir's teachings focused on self-realization through personal experience and direct connection with God, rather than relying on rituals or priestly mediation.
4. He was critical of caste distinctions, advocating for equality and unity among all people, irrespective of their social status or religion.
5. His poetry and hymns, written in Hindi vernacular, emphasized the importance of devotion, meditation, and simplicity.
6. Kabir's dohas (couplets) stressed the futility of worldly attachments and the importance of detachment.
7. His message resonated with the common people and contributed to the Bhakti movement by making spirituality accessible to all.
8. He advocated for truthfulness, love, and tolerance in human relations, emphasizing the importance of internal purity over external rituals.

Guru Nanak

1. Guru Nanak founded Sikhism, emphasizing the worship of one supreme God, transcending religious boundaries and rituals.
2. He taught that the goal of life is to attain spiritual liberation (moksha) through devotion, service, and meditation on God's name.
3. Guru Nanak rejected caste distinctions, advocating for social justice, equality, and the service of humanity.
4. His teachings emphasized the importance of honest work, sharing with others, and living a truthful life.
5. He introduced the concept of Naam Simran (constant remembrance of God's name) as a central practice for achieving spiritual progress.
6. Guru Nanak's hymns, known as Shabads, focused on love, compassion, and devotion, highlighting the universal message of peace.
7. His teachings promoted the idea of universal brotherhood, transcending religious and social divisions.

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8. He laid the foundation for the Sikh community, which was based on equality, service, and the pursuit of spiritual truth.

Sant Tukaram

1. Sant Tukaram was a Marathi saint who devoted his life to the worship of Vithoba (a form of Lord Krishna), emphasizing simple devotion.
2. He rejected caste and ritualism, advocating for pure, heartfelt devotion to God as the path to liberation.
3. His abhangas (devotional hymns) and kirtans (singing of God's praises) focused on the love and devotion to Vithoba.
4. Tukaram emphasized that true spirituality lies in selfless service, humility, and devotion to God, rather than in outward religious practices.
5. His teachings were simple and aimed at the common people, encouraging devotion and surrender to the divine.
6. Tukaram was a critic of ritualistic practices, arguing that devotion should come from the heart, not from superficial acts.
7. He promoted equality and non-attachment to worldly possessions, teaching that one should focus on inner peace and connection with God.
8. Tukaram's emphasis on faith in God's grace as the way to salvation made his teachings popular among the masses.

Meera Bai

1. Meera Bai was a Rajput princess and a devotee of Lord Krishna, known for her deep love and devotion to him, particularly the child Krishna (Radha-Krishna).
2. Her teachings focused on devotion (bhakti) as the path to liberation, emphasizing personal love and surrender to God.
3. Meera Bai rejected the traditional role of women in society, asserting that women too have the right to devote themselves to God without restrictions.
4. Her poetry and bhajans (devotional songs) expressed her deep emotional connection with Krishna, depicting the divine as a loving companion.
5. Meera's devotion to Krishna transcended social norms and she faced opposition for her devotion, but she remained steadfast in her spiritual practices.
6. She promoted love and detachment from materialistic life as means to attain union with God.
7. Her songs emphasized the idea of divine union, where the soul is united with the divine through love and devotion.
8. Meera Bai's teachings contributed significantly to the Bhakti movement, particularly in Rajasthan and North India, inspiring millions with her unwavering faith in Krishna.

Thyagaraja

1. **Thyagaraja** (1767-1847) was a renowned **Carnatic composer** and saint, widely regarded as one of the trinity of Carnatic music along with **Muthuswami Dikshitar** and **Shyama Shastri**.
2. His compositions, mainly **kritis**, focus on devotion to **Lord Rama**, expressing deep emotional love and surrender.
3. Thyagaraja believed in **devotion (bhakti)** to God as the ultimate means of liberation, emphasizing personal and heartfelt connection with God.
4. He was critical of **ritualism** and **superficial practices**, arguing that true devotion is about inner purity and love for the divine.

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5. Thyagaraja emphasized the importance of **honesty**, **humility**, and **truthfulness** in both spiritual and worldly matters.
6. He composed in **Telugu** and **Sanskrit**, and his works are known for their simplicity, lyrical beauty, and emotional depth.
7. Thyagaraja promoted the idea of **singing the divine name** as a way to overcome the distractions of the material world and attain spiritual enlightenment.
8. His works have inspired generations of musicians and devotees, and his contributions to **Carnatic music** are unparalleled.

Basava (Basavana)

1. **Basava** (1105-1167) was a 12th-century **Veerashaiva** saint and philosopher, and the central figure in the **Bhakti movement** in Karnataka. He was a prominent proponent of **Lingayatism** and is credited with transforming **Shaivism** into a more inclusive and devotional tradition.
2. He taught the importance of **devotion (bhakti)** and the worship of **Shiva** as the supreme deity, emphasizing the idea of direct, personal connection with God, free from rituals.
3. Basava's philosophy rejected caste distinctions and promoted the idea of **equality**, advocating for a society where devotion and service to God were open to all, regardless of social status.
4. He introduced the concept of **Jangama** (a spiritual teacher or devotee of Shiva), who would wear a **linga** (a symbolic representation of Shiva) and serve as the spiritual guide.
5. Basava focused on **internal spirituality** and believed that the soul's union with God could be achieved through **meditation**, **devotion**, and a **life of service**.
6. His teachings were expressed through **Vachanas** (short devotional poems), which emphasized living a simple, truthful, and devoted life while avoiding materialistic pursuits.
7. He rejected the need for **temple rituals** and emphasized the significance of **personal devotion** to the formless Shiva, without any intermediaries.
8. Basava's contributions laid the foundation for **Lingayatism**, and his teachings continue to influence spiritual practices in South India today.

Impact of Bhakti Movement

1. Development of Vernacular Literature: Bhakti poets composed works in regional languages, enriching local literatures. Tulsidas authored the Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi, bringing the story of Lord Rama closer to the common people. Similarly, Guru Nanak's hymns, written in Gurmukhi, laid the foundation for Sikhism and its rich literary tradition.
2. Social Reform and Unity: By advocating for social justice and criticizing oppressive practices, the movement fostered unity. Tukaram, a Marathi saint, used his abhangas (devotional poems) to challenge social injustices and inspire collective identity among the Marathi-speaking populace.

Religious Transformation

1. Shifted focus from **ritualistic worship** to **personal devotion (bhakti)**, making religion **more accessible** to the masses.
2. Challenged **Brahmanical orthodoxy** and emphasized **direct connection with God**, reducing the role of priests.
3. Encouraged **monotheism** (especially among Nirguna Bhakti saints like Kabir and Guru Nanak).

Social Reforms & Equality

1. Opposed **caste-based discrimination**, promoting **social inclusivity**.

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2. Saints like **Ravidas, Kabir, and Chokhamela** fought for **Dalit empowerment**.
3. **Women participation increased**, with figures like **Mirabai, Akka Mahadevi, and Andal** challenging patriarchal norms.

Growth of Regional Literature

1. Bhakti saints composed poetry in **vernacular languages** like **Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Kannada, Bengali, and Gujarati**, making religious teachings more accessible.
2. Influenced later **literary traditions**, inspiring works like **Tulsidas' Ramcharitmanas** and **Surdas' Sursagar**.

Integration with Sufism

1. The Bhakti and Sufi movements **shared values of love, devotion, and social harmony**.
2. Influenced **Sikhism** through **Guru Nanak's teachings**, which combined Bhakti and Sufi elements.

Impact on Hinduism & Temple Culture

1. Strengthened **Vaishnavism and Shaivism**, promoting deities like **Rama and Krishna** (Saguna Bhakti).
2. Led to **mass devotional practices** like **bhajans, kirtans, and community feasts (langar)**.
3. Encouraged the **temple-centric tradition**, particularly in South India and Maharashtra.

Political Influence

1. Some rulers, like the **Vijayanagara kings** and **Mughal emperor Akbar**, patronized Bhakti saints, fostering religious tolerance.
2. Inspired **peasant and tribal movements**, as seen in the **Sant traditions of Maharashtra and Rajasthan**.

Impact on Indian Society & Nationalism

1. Fostered **cultural unity**, bridging differences between **Hindus and Muslims**.
2. Saints like **Kabir and Guru Nanak** preached **universal brotherhood**, influencing later reform movements.
3. **Gandhi's ideas of inclusivity and non-violence** were inspired by Bhakti teachings, particularly from **Kabir and Tulsidas**.

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Chapter 4

Religion, Philosophy & the Sangam Age

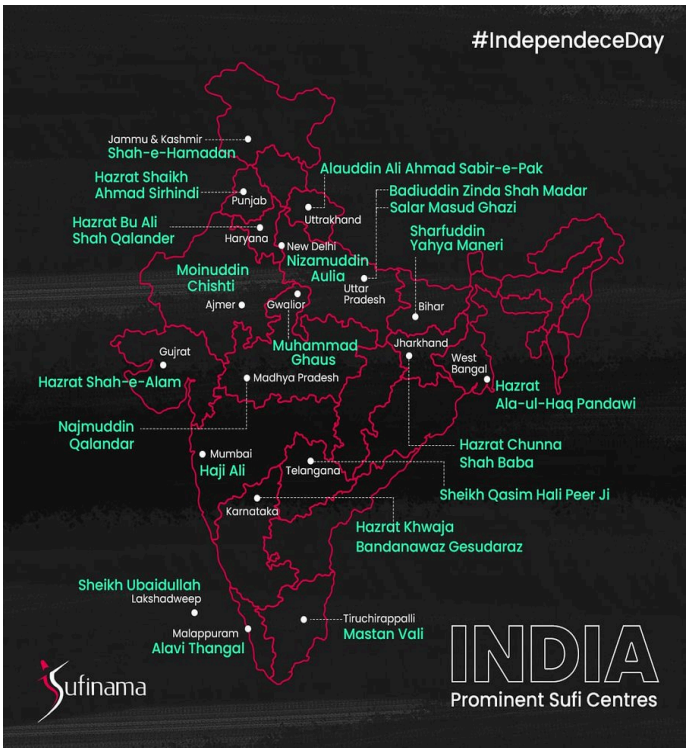
PYQs

[2021] Evaluate the nature of the Bhakti literature and its contribution to Indian culture. (2021)
[2020] Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect the spirit of the age. Comment. (15)
[2020] Indian philosophy and tradition played a significant role in conceiving and shap- ing the monuments and their art in India. Discuss. (15)
[2019] Highlight the Central Asian and Greco -Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. (10)
[2018] The Bhakti movement received a remarkable re-orientation with the advent of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Discuss. (15)
[2016] Early Buddhist Stupa-art, while depicting folk motifs and narratives successfully expounds Buddhist ideals. Elucidate. (12.5)
[2014] Gandhara sculpture owed as much to the Romans as to the Greeks. Explain. (10)
[2014] Sufis and medieval mystic saints failed to modify either the religious ideas and practices or the outward structure of Hindu/Muslim societies to any appreciable extent. Comment. (10)
[2013] Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of South India, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment. (10)

Sufi movement

Sufism emerged in the **8th century**, with early Sufis like **Rabia al-Adawiya, Al-Junaid, and Bayazid Bastami**. By the **11th century**, it evolved into a **structured movement**, gaining prominence during the **Delhi Sultanate**. **Shaikh ali Hujwari of Data Gunj** was the first reputed sufi in India. **(Book- Kashful-ul-Mehjoob)**

K.A. Nizami - "Sufism in India was a movement of love and humanism, transcending religious boundaries and emphasizing spiritual unity."



Principles of Sufism

1. Monotheism & Divine Love: Sufis believed in one God, emphasizing that everything exists within Him. Attaining God requires renouncing worldly attachments and embracing pure love.

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2. Wahdatul Wujud (Oneness of Existence): The idea that God and creation are interconnected, with all existence stemming from Him. True realization comes from detachment from material desires.
3. Purity of Mind: Unlike formal Islamic rituals, Sufis prioritized inner purity over external practices. A truthful, simple life free from worldly greed was essential for divine connection.
4. Ego Destruction: Overcoming self-centeredness and dissolving personal identity in God was vital. Sufis emphasized self-restraint and humility to attain spiritual enlightenment.
5. Devotion to God: Attaining God required constant remembrance (Zikr) and complete surrender, leading to spiritual unity with the Divine.
6. **Fana and Baqa** (Stages of Sufi Realization):
   a. Fana (Self-Annihilation): The dissolution of ego and material desires to attain unity with God.
   b. Baqa (Eternal Existence in God): A state of spiritual harmony where the individual exists in divine consciousness.
7. Universal Brotherhood: Sufis preached equality and love for all, rejecting divisions. They believed serving humanity was the highest form of worship, as God loves those who are kind to His creation.
8. Service to Mankind: True spirituality, according to Sufis, involves helping the poor and needy, as God is best attained through compassion and service.
9. Faith in Guru (Murshid): A spiritual guide (Murshid) was essential for attaining divine wisdom, similar to the Bhakti tradition of Guru devotion.
10. Love for Music: The Chishti Sufis saw music (Sama) as a path to God, using devotional songs to purify the heart and awaken divine love. Many Sufi saints, like Khwaja Bakhtiyar Kaki, attained spiritual ecstasy through music.

Major Sufi Orders in India

There are two types of Sufi sects: **Ba-Shara** and **Be-Shara**. Ba-shara was in accordance with Islamic law (shara), while be-shara was not in accordance with (shara).

1. Chishti Order:
   a. The **Chishtiya Sufi Order** was introduced in India by **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti**, who migrated from **Central Asia** under the guidance of **Khwaja Usman**.
   b. The **Chishti saints** actively engaged in **proselytization**, spreading **Islam in caste-ridden Indian society**, where **its egalitarian values** found appeal.
   c. Unlike **Hindu yogis or Buddhist monks**, Chishti Sufis **did not practice complete detachment** but renounced **worldly luxuries** while actively engaging with society.
   d. **Participated in battles** during wars and provided **spiritual guidance and healing** in peacetime.
   e. **Teachings and Influence**: **Communal harmony, spiritual fulfillment, and religious tolerance** were central to their mission.
   f. The order was further popularized by disciples like: **Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki, Baba Fariduddin Ganj-e-Shakar, Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya, Nasiruddin Chiragh Delhi**
   g. **Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya - The Most Eminent Chishti Sufi**:
   h. Known as the **"Beloved of God"**, he emphasized **love for the divine** alongside adherence to **Sharia**.
   i. Gained **great reverence among common people and nobility**, providing **spiritual guidance** to both.
   j. His **hospice (Khanqah)** remained **open to all**, offering **food, shelter, and teachings**, promoting **social inclusivity**.
   k. Even **kings sought his blessings**, though he remained **independent from political power**.

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l. Managed the expenses of his hospice through **donations**, maintaining **equality across caste, creed, and religion**.

2. Qadiri Order
   a. The **Qadriya Order**, named after **Abdul Qadir Jilani**, was introduced in **India** by **Abdul Qadir of Badayun** in the **late 14th century**. It originated in the **Persio-Arab region**, with its followers later migrating to India.
   b. **Key Representatives**: **Muhibullah Shah, Miyan Meer. Dara Shikoh** (eldest son of Shah Jahan and a major patron of Sufi philosophy)
   c. **Philosophy & Teachings**:
   d. Similar to the **Chishti Order**, but followers owed allegiance to **Abdul Qadir Jilani**, regarded as the **most perfect Sufi** (a claim lacking historical substantiation).
   e. Strongly influenced by **Ibn al-Arabi's doctrine of Wahdat-ul-Wujud** (Unity of Existence), which saw **God and creation as interconnected**.
   f. Unlike **Chishti, Suhrawardi, and Naqshbandi orders**, the **Qadriya order remained relatively less significant** in India.
   g. Gained popularity primarily due to **Ibn al-Arabi's influence** and **Dara Shikoh's patronage**, who sought to **bridge Hindu-Muslim spiritual traditions**.
   h. While the **Qadriya order** contributed to **India's Sufi landscape**, it **did not gain as much prominence** as the **Chishti, Suhrawardi, or Naqshbandi** traditions.
   i. Maintained a balance between mysticism and Islamic law.

3. Suhrawardi Order:
   a. The **Suhrawardi Order** was named after **Sheikh Shahabuddin Suhrawardi Maqtul**, who was executed for his **mystical beliefs**, similar to **Mansoor Hallaj**.
   b. He introduced the **Doctrine of Light (Nur)** and believed in **Hulul (incarnation of God in man)**, which led to opposition from orthodox theologians.
   c. In India, The **Suhrawardi Order arrived later than the Chishtis**, brought by **Bahauddin Zakariya**, its most important proponent in India.
   d. **Bahauddin Zakariya** was deeply spiritual from an early age and completed his **mystic training in just 17 days**.
   e. Bahauddin Zakariya **popularized the order in North India**, especially in **Punjab and Multan**.
   f. He was a **contemporary of Nizamuddin Auliya**, though their approaches differed.
   g. His successors, **Sheikh Rukn-ul-Din and Sheikh Sadr-ul-Din**, continued his legacy, but the order remained **influential only for a short time**.
   h. **Philosophy & Teachings**:
   i. Like **Ibn al-Arabi**, he believed in **one existence** flowing through the world, making it **organic and vibrant**.
   j. Unlike the **Chishti Order**, Suhrawardis believed **wealth was necessary** to better serve humanity.

4. **Naqshbandi Order**
   a. The **Naqshbandi Order** originated in the **Perso-Arab world**, founded by **Khwaja Baha-ul-Din Naqshband**.
   b. The order was introduced in India during **Babur's invasion**, as many of his soldiers and followers were **disciples of Ubaidullah Ahrar**.
   c. After the **establishment of the Mughal Empire**, the Naqshbandi Sufis **propagated their teachings**, led by **Khwaja Kalan and his companions**.
   d. Unlike **Chishti, Qadri, and Suhrawardi orders**, the **Naqshbandis were more orthodox and puritanical**.
   e. They sought to **purify Islam from foreign influences** absorbed from **native Indian traditions**.
   f. While most Sufi orders traced their lineage to **Ali**, the Naqshbandis linked themselves to **Abu Bakr**, the first Caliph.

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g. They promoted a **strict Islamic state**, recommending the **imposition of Jizya (tax on non-Muslims)**, but Mughal rulers did not always follow their advice.
h. **Role of Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi**
i. strongly opposed **Akbar's policy of Sulh-e-Kul (peace with all religions)** and **Din-e-Ilahi (Akbar's syncretic religion)**.
j. He rejected the **Unity of Existence (Wahdat-ul-Wujud)** of **Ibn al-Arabi** and instead promoted the **Unity of Appearance (Wahdat-ul-Shuhud)**.
k. His philosophy **sparked controversy**, leading to conflicts between **Wahdat-ul-Wujud and Wahdat-ul-Shuhud schools**.
l. He was imprisoned by **Jahangir** for **political interventions**, especially for criticizing **Akbar's policies**.
m. **Contributions of Shah Waliullah & Shah Abdul Aziz**
n. **Shah Waliullah**, a prominent **Naqshbandi scholar**, attempted to **reconcile Wahdat-ul-Wujud and Wahdat-ul-Shuhud**, arguing they represented **different stages of spiritual realization**.
o. He sought to **revive Islamic rule** as the **Mughal dynasty declined**, foreseeing the **rising British dominance**.
p. His son, **Shah Abdul Aziz**, continued his work, emphasizing **political activism** and **Islamic supremacy**, but his **puritanical approach ultimately weakened Indian Muslims** politically.

Prominent Sufi Saints in India

1. Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (Ajmer):
   a. Known as Gharib Nawaz (Benefactor of the Poor).
   b. Preached love, tolerance, and compassion for all.
   c. His shrine, Ajmer Sharif Dargah, remains a major pilgrimage site.
2. Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi):
   a. Promoted social welfare, charity, and inclusivity.
   b. His teachings emphasized that love for humanity is love for God.
   c. The Nizamuddin Dargah in Delhi remains a center of Sufi devotion.
3. Baba Farid (Punjab):
   a. Spread Chishti Sufism in North India, particularly Punjab.
   b. His poetry, included in the Guru Granth Sahib, reflects devotion and humility.
4. Sheikh Salim Chishti (Fatehpur Sikri):
   a. His spiritual influence on Emperor Akbar led Akbar to build his tomb in Fatehpur Sikri.
5. Hazrat Amir Khusro:
   a. A disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, he contributed significantly to Indian music, poetry, and Sufi culture.
   b. Credited with developing Qawwali music, blending Persian and Indian styles.

Role of Sufi Saints (Pirs) in Indian Society

1. Spiritual Guidance and the Murid-Murshid Relationship:
   a. Pirs (Sufi masters) guided Mureeds (disciples) along the path to spiritual enlightenment.
2. Dargahs as Cultural and Spiritual Centers:
   a. Sufi shrines (Dargahs) became places of meditation, charity, and community gatherings.
   b. Open to people of all faiths, fostering a sense of unity and inclusivity.

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Social and Religious Contributions of Sufism in India

Religious Reforms & Spiritual Influence

1. Sufism made **Islam more accessible** by emphasizing **love, devotion, and personal connection with God**, rather than strict legalism.
2. It introduced **mysticism (Tasawwuf)**, focusing on **inner spirituality** over external rituals.
3. Sufis **bridged Hindu-Muslim religious traditions**, encouraging **syncretism** and promoting **communal harmony**.

Social Reform & Equality

1. Sufi saints rejected **caste discrimination** and promoted **universal brotherhood**.
2. Their **hospices (Khanqahs)** provided **food, shelter, and guidance** to people of all faiths and classes.
3. Saints like **Nizamuddin Auliya and Baba Farid** preached **social justice and inclusivity**, attracting followers from all backgrounds.

Growth of Vernacular Literature

1. Sufi poets composed in **regional languages** like **Persian, Hindi, Punjabi, Bengali, and Urdu**, making religious teachings more accessible.
2. **Amir Khusrau**, a disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, **enriched Hindavi and Persian poetry**, pioneering **Qawwali and Ghazals**.
3. Many Sufi texts influenced **Bhakti poets**, contributing to a **shared literary tradition**.

Impact on Indian Music & Art

1. Sufism **popularized devotional music** such as **Qawwali and Sama (spiritual concerts)**, influencing **Indian classical music**.
2. The **Chishti order** particularly encouraged **music as a medium of divine connection**.
3. Sufi traditions inspired **Persian and Mughal art**, influencing **architecture, calligraphy, and miniature paintings**.

Development of Khanqahs & Dargahs

1. Sufis established **hospices (Khanqahs)** that became centers for **spiritual guidance, charity, and education**.
2. **Dargahs (shrines of Sufi saints)**, like those of **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (Ajmer) and Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi)**, remain major pilgrimage sites, attracting people across religions.

Political Influence & Advising Rulers

1. Sufis played a **mediatory role between rulers and common people**, promoting **justice and tolerance**.
2. **Dara Shikoh**, the Mughal prince, was deeply influenced by Sufism and **translated Hindu scriptures like the Upanishads into Persian**.
3. Some Sufi orders, like **Naqshbandis**, actively **advised Mughal rulers** on religious policies, while others, like the **Chishtis**, maintained distance from politics.

Hindu-Muslim Cultural Synthesis

1. Sufism contributed to the **fusion of Hindu and Islamic traditions**, influencing the **Bhakti movement**.
2. Many Hindu poets and saints, like **Kabir and Guru Nanak**, were influenced by **Sufi philosophy**.
3. Practices like **Langar (free community meals)**, adopted by Guru Nanak, were originally popularized by **Sufis**.

Strengthening Islamic Influence in India

1. Sufi saints helped **spread Islam peacefully**, attracting **converts from marginalized communities** by offering **equality and social justice**.

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2. Their **non-coercive approach** made Islam more appealing in a **caste-dominated society**.

Establishment of Educational Institutions

1. Many Sufi saints established **madrasas (Islamic schools)** alongside Khanqahs, promoting **education, philosophy, and Sufi literature**.
2. Their teachings influenced later scholars like **Shah Waliullah**, who worked on Islamic revivalism.

Interaction Between Bhakti and Sufi Movements

1. Shared Socio-Religious Influence

- **Bhakti and Sufi movements emerged as spiritual reform movements**, emphasizing **devotion (bhakti) and mysticism (sufism)** over rigid religious orthodoxy.
- Both movements **challenged priestly monopoly** and **promoted egalitarian values**, attracting marginalized groups like **artisans, Jats, and Khatris**, dissatisfied with the Brahmanical caste order.
- **Langar**, a communal meal system, was first popularized by **Sufi saints** and later adopted by **Guru Nanak** as a tool to challenge caste-based discrimination.

2. Cultural and Linguistic Exchange

- **Bhakti kirtans** (devotional songs) bore similarities to **Sufi sama** (spiritual music), suggesting cultural convergence, particularly in **Bengal** where historians like **Enamul Haq** argue that **Chaitanya's movement was influenced by Sufism**.
- **Amir Khusrau**, the pioneer of **qawwali**, blended **Persian with Braj Bhasha**, just as Bhakti poets like **Mira Bai, Rajjab, and Dadu** composed in multiple regional languages.

3. Philosophical & Yogic Exchange

- Sufi saints like **Nizamuddin Auliya** admired **yogic practices** such as **asanas, mudras, and breathing exercises**, leading to cultural synthesis.
- Texts like **Patanjali's Yoga Sutra** were translated into **Arabic** by **Alberuni**, and **Amrit Kunda (a Hatha Yogic text)** was translated into **Persian** by **Ruknuddin Samarqandi**, reflecting **Hindu-Muslim philosophical interaction**.

4. Role of Women in Mysticism

- Both movements **offered women greater spiritual space**, with **Mira Bai** composing **Bhakti poetry** and **Chishti Sufi orders** giving **women a higher spiritual status** than orthodox religious circles.

5. Challenge to Religious Orthodoxy

- Bhakti and Sufi traditions **weakened the Brahminical and Ulama monopoly over religious scriptures**, using **mysticism and devotion** rather than scriptural authority.
- Figures like **Mulla Daud** (connected to **Sufi Chirag Delhi**) even **declared Vedas and Puranas as revealed texts**, reflecting **religious synthesis**.

Religions in India - Buddhism & Jainism

Buddhism and Jainism emerged as major religious movements in ancient India, challenging the dominant Vedic traditions.

Buddhism began in India during late 500BCE from the teachings of a prince named Siddhartha Gautama who later came to be known as Gautama Buddha, meaning 'enlightened one'.

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Jainism is one of the **oldest religious traditions**, tracing its origins to **24 Tirthankaras (spiritual teachers)**. The first was **Rsabhadeva**, while the last, **Vardhamana Mahavira**, lived in the **6th century B.C.** as a **contemporary of Gautama Buddha**.

D.D.Kosambi- Buddhism was first organized challenge to Brahmanical orthodoxy, replacing rituals with ethics and reasoning

Jawaharlal Nehru - Buddha's message is most revolutionary and humanistic in history, seeking to liberate the mind from suffering

Reason for Emergence of Buddhism & Jainism

1. Complex sacrifices and priestly dominance made religion inaccessible to common people. Eg. Costly yajnas like Ashvamedha are monopolised by Brahmanas.
2. Protest Against Caste Hierarchy- Eg. Upanishadic exclusivity limited religious knowledge to upper castes.
3. Sanskrit monopoly weakened mass participation. Buddhist teachings in Pali and Jain teachings in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit enhanced popular accessibility and spread.
4. Growth of towns, trade, and guilds created wealthy merchant classes. Buddhism and Jainism suited merchants by promoting non-violence and ethical trade.
5. Iron technology expanded agriculture, making animal sacrifice economically costly. Ahimsa gained practical importance.
6. Desire for Social and Moral Reform due to corruption and moral decay in later Vedic society.Buddhism and Jainism emphasised on right conduct, compassion, and self-discipline.
7. Political Context and State Support - Mahajanapadas sought alternative ideologies to legitimise rule. Eg. Magadha rulers like Bimbisara and Ajatashatru supported Buddha and Mahavira.
8. Pre-existing ascetic traditions (Shramanas) questioned Vedic orthodoxy. Buddha and Mahavira emerged from this tradition.

Key Teachings of Buddhism

1. **Four Noble Truths:**
   a. Life is full of suffering (Dukkha).
   b. The cause of suffering is desire (Trishna).
   c. Suffering can end by eliminating desire (Nirvana).
   d. The path to Nirvana is the Eightfold Path.
2. **Eightfold Path (Ashtangika Marga):**
   a. Right View, Thought, Speech, Action, Livelihood, Effort, Mindfulness, Concentration.
3. **Middle Path**: Buddhism advocates avoiding both **extreme asceticism** and **excessive indulgence**, promoting a balanced approach to life.
4. **Karma and Rebirth**: The doctrine of **karma** plays a central role in Buddhism, stating that **one's present life is shaped by past actions**. Rebirth continues until all sins are eradicated, leading to liberation from the cycle of life and death.
5. **Existence of God**: The Buddha neither **affirmed nor denied** the existence of God, instead focusing on **individual actions and ethical conduct**.
6. **Concept of Soul**: Rather than engaging in debates about the **soul (atman) and Brahma**, the Buddha emphasized **compassion and non-violence (ahimsa)** towards all living beings.

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7. The ultimate goal in Buddhism is **nirvana**, which signifies **freedom from desires and suffering**, leading to liberation from rebirth. Unlike **Vedic rituals**, the Buddha emphasized **moral and ethical living** as the path to enlightenment.
8. **Moksha**: Liberation from rebirth comes through **righteous actions and self-discipline**, leading to **nibbana**, which signifies the end of **ego and desires**, thus putting an end to suffering.
9. **Non-Self (Anatta)**: The Buddhist concept of **self** is not fixed but composed of **five changing aggregates (skandhas)**-body, sensations, perceptions, mental formations, and consciousness. Attachment to these causes **suffering (dukkha)**, and realizing their impermanence leads to liberation.
10. **Origin of the World**: The Buddha viewed the **social order as a human construct**, rather than a **divine creation**. He encouraged rulers and householders to govern with **compassion and justice**, emphasizing **personal responsibility in shaping society**.
11. **Dhamma**: Refers to the **teachings of the Buddha**, which represent universal truths and the **path to enlightenment**.
12. **Three Jewels (Triratna)**: Buddhism upholds three core principles:
    a. **Buddha** - The teacher and enlightened one.
    b. **Dhamma** - The teachings and path to enlightenment.
    c. **Sangha** - The monastic and lay community of followers.Taking refuge in these three signifies **formal acceptance into Buddhism**.
13. **Final Words of Buddha**: His last message to followers was: **"Be lamps unto yourselves; all must strive for their own liberation."** This emphasized **self-reliance and personal effort** in attaining enlightenment.

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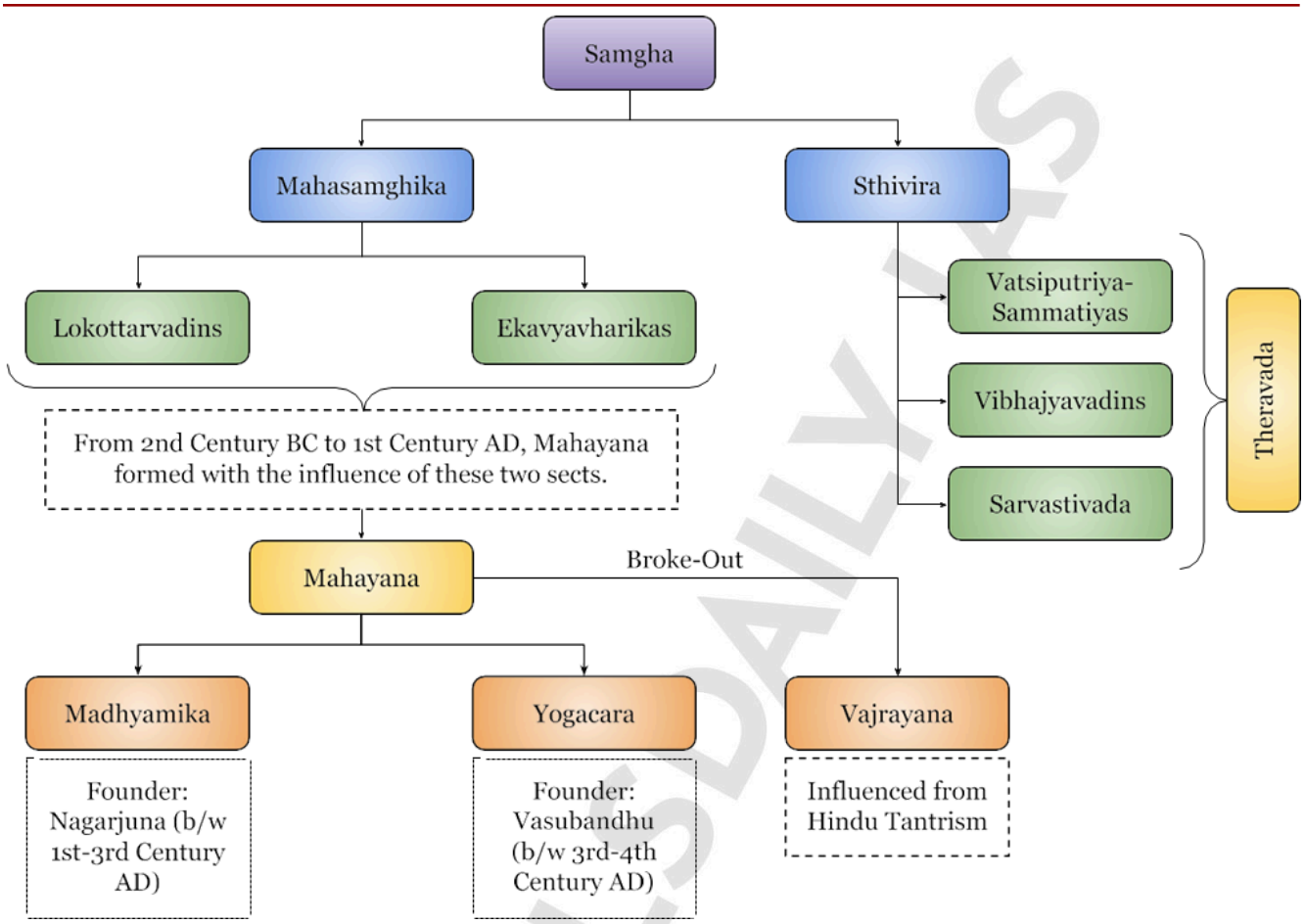
Different Sects of Buddhism



Hinayana (Lesser Vehicle)

1. Follows the original teachings of Buddha (orthodox approach).
2. Focuses on individual salvation through self-discipline and meditation.
3. Does not involve idol or image worship.
4. Believes in a religion without a god, as **Karma** is regarded as the divine force.
5. Sponsored by **Asoka**, with **Mahayana** emerging later.
6. Uses **Pali** language.
7. Faced dissension within other schools:
    a. **Sthaviravada (Theravada in Pali)**: Also known as "Doctrine of Elders", viewed Buddha as a superhuman deity. Focused on three core ideas: **Anatman** (no-self), **Anitya** (impermanence), **Dukkha** (suffering).
    b. **Sarvastivadins**: Believed in the existence of all things, both physical and mental. Patronized by **Kanishka** and also called **Hetuvadins**.
    c. **Sauntantrika**: An offshoot of Sarvastivadins, more critical in nature.
    d. **Sammitiyas**: Rejected the doctrine of soullessness.

Mahayana (Greater Vehicle)

1. Believes in the divinity of **Buddha** and **Bodhisattvas**.

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2. Aims for the salvation of all, with the assistance of **Buddha** and **Bodhisattvas**.
3. Known as **Bodhisattvayana** or the "Bodhisattva Vehicle".
4. Embraces idol and image worship.
5. Major philosophical schools:
   a. **Madhyamika**: Blends uncompromising realism of Hinayana with the idealism of Yogacharya, called **"Qualified Realism"**.
   b. **Yogacharya**: Focuses on idealism, claiming the world is shaped by consciousness, and is no more real than a dream.
6. Uses **Sanskrit** in India, with many other regions following local languages.
7. Propagated by **Kanishka** and later **Harsha**.
8. More optimistic than Hinayana, recognizing both good and evil in the world.
9. **The Divine Buddha is referred** to as **Amitabha** ("Immeasurable Glory") and **Amitayus** ("Immeasurable Age").
10. Key texts include:
    a. **Vaipulya Sutra**: Extensive teachings of Buddha.
    b. **Lalitavistara**: An early text with a supernatural account of Buddha's life.
    c. **Lotus Sutra**: Prominent Mahayana text outlining the **six perfections (paramitas)**:
    d. **Dana** (generosity)
    e. **Sila** (morality and discipline)
    f. **Ksanti** (patience)
    g. **Virya** (effort)
    h. **Dhyana** (concentration)
    i. **Prajna** (wisdom).
11. Several Buddhas across time and space, such as **Vairochana**, **Amitabha**, **Avalokiteshwara**, and **Maitreya**.

Vajrayana (Vehicle of Thunderbolt/Diamond)

1. Focuses on magical mysticism.
2. Attainment of salvation through supernatural powers, known as **Vajra**.
3. Accompanied by **Tantrism** and ritualistic practices.
4. Rituals replace abstract meditation techniques.
5. Includes **sexual rites** as part of the spiritual practices.
6. **Taras** (saviouresses) are key deities, depicted as the spouses of Buddha and Bodhisattvas.
7. Originates from a mix of **Shaivism** and **Buddhism**, prominent in **Eastern India**.
8. Famous for the six-syllable mantra, **"Om Mani Padme Hum"**.

Key Teachings of Jainism

1. **Five Vows (Pancha Mahavratas)**:
   a. **Ahimsa (Non-Violence)** - Do not harm any living being.
   b. **Satya (Truthfulness)** - Always speak the truth.
   c. **Asteya (Non-Stealing)** - Do not take anything without permission.
   d. **Brahmacharya (Celibacy/Chastity)** - Practice self-restraint.
   e. **Aparigraha (Non-Possession)** - Avoid material attachment.

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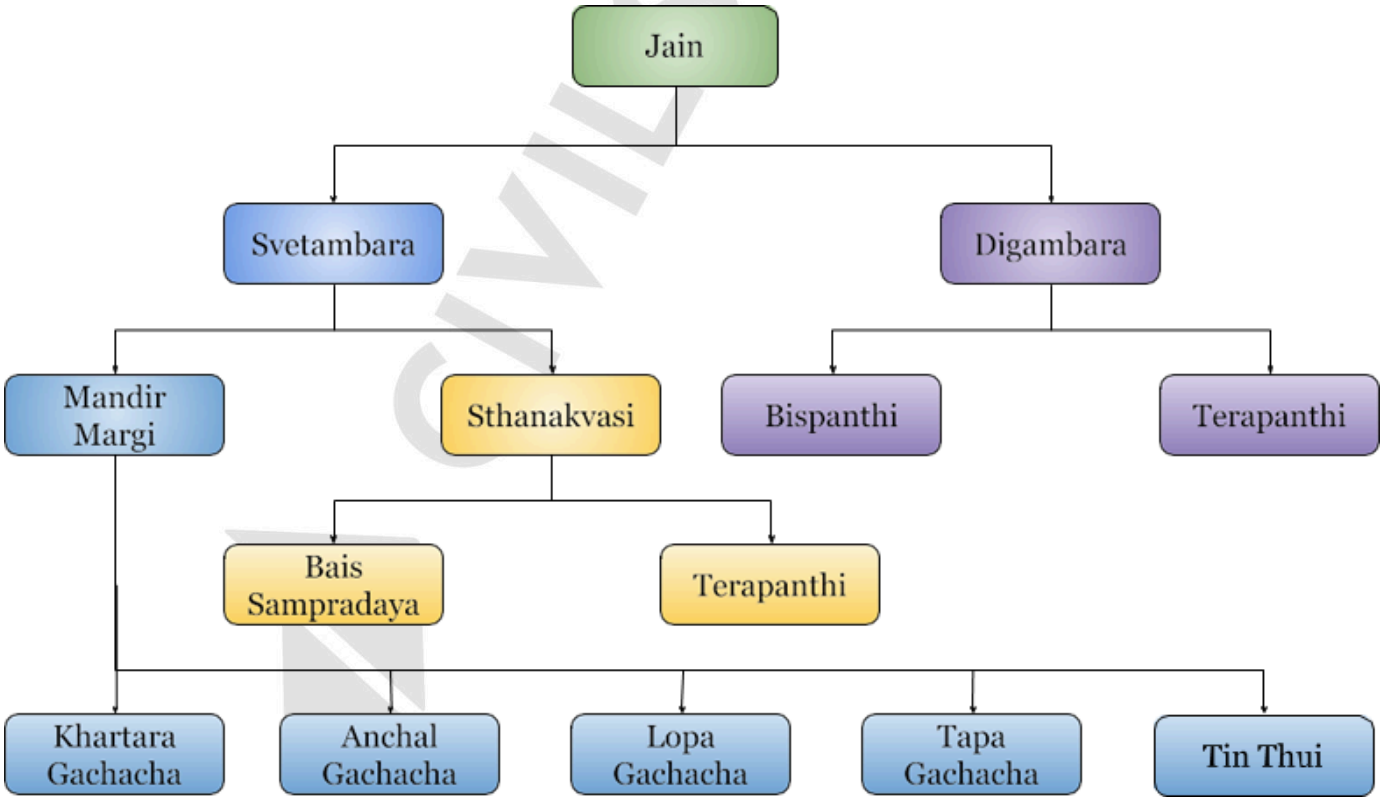
2. **Concept of Soul and Matter**: Mahavira taught that **soul (jiva) and matter (ajiva)** are the two fundamental elements of existence.
   a. He believed that the **soul remains in bondage** due to desires accumulated over past lives.
   b. Liberation from this bondage leads to a **pure soul**.
   c. **All living and non-living things possess a soul** and are capable of experiencing **pain or harm**.
3. **Moksha (Liberation)**: Jainism emphasizes that **one's destiny is shaped by their own actions**. Liberation (**moksha**) can be attained by **living a life of purity, virtue, and renunciation**. Mahavira advocated for **strict asceticism and rigorous penance** as the path to **nirvana**, the highest state of spiritual enlightenment.
4. **Concept of God**: Mahavira rejected the idea of a **supreme creator** and believed that the universe operates according to **an eternal cycle of creation and destruction**, governed by natural laws.
5. **Rejection of Vedas**: He **denied the authority of the Vedas**, opposing **Vedic rituals** and the **dominance of Brahmins** in religious practices.
6. **View on the Varna System**: Jainism did not **completely reject** the caste system but sought to **reduce its inequalities**. According to Mahavira, a person's **varna (social status)** is determined by **the karma of past lives**, rather than birth alone.
7. **The Three Jewels (Triratna) of Jainism**: Liberation from worldly attachments requires following the **Triratna (Three Gems)**:
   a. **Samyak Darshan (Right Faith)** - Developing the correct perception of reality.
   b. **Samyak Gyan (Right Knowledge)** - Gaining true knowledge to remove ignorance.
   c. **Samyak Charitra (Right Conduct)** - Living a disciplined and virtuous life.

Different Sects of Jainism



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Digambaras and Their Subsects

The Digambaras originated in Sravanbelagola, Karnataka, under the guidance of Bhadrabahu. They are known for not wearing any clothes, symbolizing the conquest of sin.

Key beliefs of the Digambaras include:

1. Monks must remain naked, as it represents the victory over sin.
2. Tirthankaras should be depicted without clothes or ornaments.
3. Mahavira, the 24th Tirthankara, never married.
4. Only men can achieve enlightenment.

The Digambara sect was primarily dominant in South and Central India, contributing significantly to the development of regional vernacular languages. They believe that the original Jain scriptures have been lost over time.

Subsects of Digambaras

1. **Bisapanthis**: Worshipped idols of Tirthankaras and deities like Bhairava, offering flowers, fruits, and vegetables. They adorned idols with saffron clothes.
2. **Terapanthis**: Opposed the influence of religious leaders called Bhattarakas, who had begun deviating from the original Jain practices. They continued worshipping Jain Tirthankaras but rejected the worship of minor gods like Bhairava, Ksetrapal, and Padmavati.
3. **Taranapanth**: Founded in the 16th century in Bundelkhand, this sect is also known as Samaiyapanth. They did not believe in idol worship or external religious rituals. Their sacred center was Malhargarh, near Gwalior.

Svetambaras and Their Subsects

The Svetambara sect emerged in Magadha under Sthulbahu's leadership. They are known for wearing white clothes and were dominant in North and West India.

Key beliefs of the Svetambaras:

1. Women are capable of attaining Nirvana and are allowed to join the monastic order.
2. They have preserved many Jain texts.

Subsects of Svetambaras

1. **Sthanakvasis**: Opposed idol worship and temple practices, arguing these were not mentioned in Jain canonical texts. Founded by the merchant Lavaji, they conduct religious activities in prayer halls (Sthanaks) rather than temples. Sthanakvasi ascetics always cover their mouths with white cloth (muhapatis), not just when speaking.
2. **Murtipujakas**: Engage in idol worship, offering symbolic items such as flowers and fruits to Tirthankaras. Monks of this sect cover their mouths with cloths (muppati) and collect food from laypeople's homes. They stay in temples or designated buildings (Upashrays). The Murtipujaka sect is divided into six orders (Gaccha).

Reasons for the Decline of Buddhism

1. **Shifting Royal Patronage**
    a. **Gupta rulers (4th-6th century CE)** favored **Brahmanical Hinduism**, leading to a **decline in Buddhist state support**.

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   b. Unlike Jainism, which maintained a **strong merchant base**, Buddhism **struggled without state sponsorship**.
2. **Foreign Invasions:** Non-Buddhist rulers like the Shakas, Kushans, Huns, and Rajputs favored Vedic traditions over Buddhism. **Arab and Turkish invasions further weakened Buddhism, forcing monks to flee to Nepal, Tibet, and Sri Lanka.**
3. **Decay of Monasteries:** Buddhist monasteries became wealthy and corrupt, with monks engaging in worldly affairs, deviating from Buddhist principles.
4. **Urban Character** - Buddhism thrived in **urban trade centers** and was patronized by **merchants, artisans, and bankers**. The **decline of urbanization** after the **Kushana period** led to a **loss of economic support** for Buddhist monasteries, weakening the **Buddhist Sangha**.
5. **Assimilation by Brahmanical Hinduism**
   a. **Buddha was incorporated as an incarnation of Vishnu**, reducing the need for a **separate Buddhist identity**.
   b. The **Bhakti movement** emphasized **devotion and inclusivity**, drawing followers away from Buddhism.
6. **Sectarianism and the Rise of Mahayana & Vajrayana**
   a. The emergence of **Mahayana and Vajrayana Buddhism** introduced **new deities, rituals, and Tantric practices**, making it resemble **Hindu traditions**.
   b. The **use of Sanskrit** instead of **Prakrit/Pali** distanced Buddhism from the **common people**, reducing its accessibility.
7. **Internal Weaknesses & 'Death-Wish' Mentality**
   a. Some Buddhist texts prophesied the **eventual decline of Dharma**, leading to **passivity** and a lack of **aggressive revival efforts**.
   b. The **Sangha (monastic order)** became **self-absorbed**, focusing on **internal debates** rather than **expanding its influence**.
8. **Intellectual Snobbery and Social Aloofness**
   a. Later Buddhist monks became **intellectually elitist**, focusing on **philosophical debates** rather than engaging with **common people**.
   b. Hinduism, through **Bhakti traditions**, remained **deeply connected to daily life**, while Buddhism became **isolated** from the masses.

Schools of Indian Philosophy

Indian philosophies encompass a diverse range of intellectual traditions that explore fundamental questions about existence, knowledge, reality, and liberation. Rooted in ancient texts like the Vedas, Upanishads, and Sutras, these schools of thought provide systematic frameworks for understanding the universe and human life.

Six Schools of Indian Philosophy

Orthodox Schools

1. **Key Belief**: The Vedas are regarded as the supreme revealed texts containing the path to salvation. The authority of the Vedas was never questioned by this school.
2. **Sub-schools**: The Orthodox schools consist of six sub-schools: Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, and Vedanta.

Heterodox Schools

1. **Key Belief**: These schools rejected the authority of the Vedas and questioned the existence of God. They proposed alternate paths to spiritual understanding.

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2. **Major Sub-schools**: Buddhism, Jainism, and Lokayata (Materialism) are the key heterodox traditions.

Orthodox Schools

School	Founder	Core Philosophy	Key Texts	Key Concepts	Views on God
Samkhya	Kapila	Dualistic realism; Purusha (spirit) and Prakriti (matter) are the two realities.	Samkhya Sutra	Theory of causation (Satkarya-vada); Knowledge through Perception, Inference, and Hearing (Pratyaksha, Anumana, Shabda).	No specific belief in God; emphasizes nature (Prakriti) and spirit (Purusha) as fundamental realities.
Yoga	Patanjali	Salvation through meditation and control over the body, mind, and senses.	Yoga Sutras	Eightfold path (Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi). Union with the supreme consciousness.	Acknowledges God (Ishvara) as a teacher and guide, but the focus is on personal realization through self-discipline.
Nyaya	Gautama	Logical reasoning and valid knowledge acquisition are key to attaining liberation (moksha).	Nyaya Sutras	Four sources of knowledge: Perception, Inference, Comparison, and Testimony (Pratyaksha, Anumana, Upamana, Sabda).	God is the eternal, infinite self that creates, sustains, and destroys the universe, but is not the ultimate focus.
Vaisheshika	Kanada	Everything in the universe is reducible to atoms; Brahman causes consciousness in atoms.	Vaisheshika Sutra	Atomism, five basic elements (Earth, Water, Fire, Air, Ether); focus on categories like substance, quality, action, etc.	God is a guiding principle, and is responsible for consciousness within the material world.
Mimamsa	Jaimini	Focuses on interpreting Vedic texts, especially rituals, and emphasizes performing duties (dharma) for salvation.	Mimamsa Sutra	Importance of Vedic rituals and sacrifices; dharma as the key to salvation.	No clear focus on God; emphasizes ritualistic actions for salvation, often without invoking a personal deity.
Vedanta	Vyasa	Brahman is the only reality; everything else is	Brahma Sutras, Upanishads,	Atman and Brahman are one; liberation (moksha) is achieved through	God (Brahman) is the ultimate reality; in some schools, God is

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School	Founder	Core Philosophy	Key Texts	Key Concepts	Views on God
		illusion (Maya). Self (Atman) and Brahman are identical.	Bhagavad Gita	self-knowledge and realization of the true nature of reality.	personal (as in Vishishtadvaita and Dvaita).

Sub-schools: Advaita (Non-dualism), Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-dualism), Dvaita (Dualism).

1. **Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism) - Shankaracharya**
   a. Proclaims **Brahman and Atman as one**.
   b. Describes **Brahman as formless, eternal, and beyond words**.
2. **Vishishtadvaita Vedanta (Qualified Non-Dualism) - Ramanujacharya**
   a. States that **Brahman (God) has a definite form**.
   b. Liberation occurs when the **Jiva (soul) realizes its connection with Paramatman (God)**.
3. **Dvaita Vedanta (Dualism) - Madhavacharya**
   a. Asserts that **Brahman (God) and Jiva (individual soul) are separate entities**.
   b. Salvation is attained through **faith, devotion, and divine grace**.

Heterodox Schools

Charvaka

1. representing a **materialistic worldview**.
2. The term **Lokayata** refers to **ideas based on common human experience**.
3. **Rejects supernatural beliefs** and emphasizes **sensory perception as the only valid source of knowledge**.
4. Dismisses the concept of **spiritual salvation**, arguing that **rituals were created for priestly gain**.
5. Advocates **material well-being and practical engagement with the world**.
6. **Key Belief**: Rejects rituals, karma, and reincarnation.

Ajivika

1. **Core Philosophy**: Ajivikas believe in fatalism, asserting that everything in the universe is pre-determined by fate (Niyati). They reject the Vedic philosophy but believe in the existence of the soul.
2. **Notable Beliefs**: Transmigration of the soul and karma, though beyond human control.
3. **Key Figures**: Makkhali Gosala, Purana Kassapa, Pakudha Kachchayana.

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The Sangam Age

The Sangam Age **(300 BCE to 300 CE)** refers to the period in ancient South Indian history marked by the flourishing of Tamil literature, culture, and political institutions. It is highly significant for providing valuable insights into the socio-political, economic, and cultural life of ancient Tamil Nadu.

Three Sangams of Ancient Tamil Nadu set up by the Pandyan kings.

1. **First Sangam** (Held in **Madurai**) - Attended by **gods and legendary sages**. **No literary works** from this Sangam have survived.
2. **Second Sangam** (Held in **Kapadapuram**) - Only **Tolkappiyam**, an ancient Tamil grammar text, has survived.
3. **Third Sangam** (Held in **Madurai**) - Some **Tamil literary works** from this period have survived, providing valuable insights into **Sangam history**.

Political System

1. During the Sangam Age, the Tamil country was ruled by three dynasties: the Cheras, the Cholas, and the Pandyas.
2. The Cholas controlled the fertile and irrigated lands around the Kaveri basin, establishing their capital at Uraiyur (present-day Tiruchirapalli). The Pandyas ruled over the littoral and pastoral parts with Madurai as their capital. The Cheras controlled the hilly region in the west, establishing their capital at Vanji (present-day Karur).
3. **Hereditary monarchy** was the form of government. The king was called Ko**, Vendan Korravan, Mannam and Iral**. The king was considered the representative of god **(Irai)**. **Avai** was the royal court.
4. The centre of administration was in the hands of kings. The local chieftains were known as **Velirs.**
5. Each Sangam Age dynasty had a distinct royal emblem: **Tiger for the Cholas, Carp/Fish for the Pandyas, and Bow for the Cheras**.
6. Two councils served the purpose of providing the king with assistance in his day-to-day administrative responsibilities. They were known as **Aimperunkulu** which was the 'Assembly of the Great Five' and **Enperayam** which was 'The Council of the Great Eight.'
7. During the Sangam Age, each kingdom was divided into many units for proper administration like **Mandalam (entire kingdom), Nadu (Major subdivisions), Ur (Town), Perur (Large village), Sirur (Small village), Pattinam (Coastal town), Valanadu, and Koottram. Manram, Avai, Podiyil, and Ambalam** were the village councils.

Sangam Economy

1. **Division of Land:** As per Tolkappiyam -- Kurinji (hilly tracks), Mullai (pastoral), Marudam (agricultural), Neydal (coastal) and Palai (desert).

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2. **Chief Occupation:** Agriculture, rice was the most common crop.
3. **Other Economic Activities:** Handicraft included weaving, metal works and carpentry, ship building and making of ornaments using beads, stones and ivory.
4. **Cotton of Uraiyur** : Great demand in west due to high level expertise in weaving
5. **Important Ports:** Puhar(TN), Tondi, Muziris(Kerala), Korkai(TN), Arikkamedu(TN)
6. **Flourishing Trade:** Many gold and silver coins of Roman Emperors like Augustus, Tiberius and Nero in TN. Though after 3rd century AD Indian merchants relied more on South Asian trade as Roman Empire was ended by Huna
7. **Exports**: Cotton fabrics, spices (pepper, ginger, cardamom, cinnamon turmeric), ivory products, pearls and precious stones.
8. **Imports** : Horses, gold, and sweet wine
9. **Trade with Romans :** Book "Periplus of the Erythrean sea" and Pliny, in his book "Natural History", complains that the Roman empire was drained of gold. Pepper was the 1st spice used in Europe. Black pepper is also known as Yavanpriya.

Sangam Society

1. **Five-fold Land Division** (Tolkappiyam) - **Kurinji (hills), Mullai (pastoral), Marudam (agriculture), Neydal (coastal), Palai (desert)**.
2. **Social Structure** - Four classes: **Arasar (rulers), Anthanar (priests), Vanigar (traders), Vellalar (farmers)**.
3. **Tribal Communities** - **Thodas, Irulas, Nagas, and Vedars** inhabited the region.
4. Rich lived in houses of brick and mortar while the poor lived in mud houses
5. **Position of Women :**
   a. Respected and educated and can choose their life partner. Mostly the role of the women was subordinate and dependent on the economic milieu. The Brahmanical concepts of the ideal women as chaste wife and mother are noticed in early Tamil texts.
   b. The women of the Sangam age were given training in **literature (iyal), music (isai) and drama (nadagam). Women Poets** like Avvaiyar, Nachchellaiyar, and Kakkaipadiniyar contributed to Tamil literature. Kakkaippadiniyar has contributed two works on prosody namely Kakkaippadiniyam and Siru-Kakkaippadiniyam.
   c. **Prevalence of Sati (known as Tippayadal)** in the higher strata of society. The life of widows was miserable.
   d. As per **Kalithogai**, a Sangam poem, women moved around the town freely, played on the riverbeds and seashores, and even participated in temple festivals.
   e. Women had no property rights but were treated with consideration.
   f. **Tolkappiyar** states that a woman is guarded by the three **great feminine virtues**, accam, nanam and madam.
   g. The Heroine of Silappathigaram , Kannagi had been hailed for her Chastity and worshipped by the people .
   h. **Marriage** - **Tolkappiyam** states that **Aryans introduced ritualistic marriage** in Tamil society. It also refers to the **eight forms of marriage**, as mentioned in the **earliest Dharmashastras**.
   i. Sangam texts mention **three types of marriage** in early Tamil society:
   j. **Love marriage** - Based on **secret love and courtship**.
   k. **Marriage by bravery** - Winning the bride through a **bull-fight**.
   l. **Arranged marriage** - Settled by **relatives**, often involving **bride price**.
   m. **Condition of widows - Purananuru** references the practice of widows **shaving their heads as a sign of mourning.** The widow had to discard all ornaments, including the tali or its nucleus as well as bangles which were distinctive symbols of the married woman.

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n. Sangam literature, including **Agananuru, Narrinai, and Ainkurunuru**, mentions **concubinage and harlotry**, indicating that it was a **recognized institution** in early Tamil society.

6. **Slavery** - Sangam texts like **Tolkappiyam** and **Thirukkural** mention **adimai (slaves)**, but **S. Manickam** argues that there is **no conclusive evidence** of slavery or slave markets in ancient Tamilakam.
7. **Festivals** - Onam, Karthigai, Pongal, Thaineeradal, Pangunivilavu were popular celebrations and festivals among the people. On festival occasions the village elders and learned persons were given respective status. Every ceremony was preceded by lighting the lamp, called vilakketral.
8. **Family life** - House warming, purification ceremony, puberty and marriage ceremonies were popular family ceremonies connected with family life. Erecting hero stones was a ceremony considered to respect the dead.
9. **Entertainment** - Kings and elites enjoyed **songs and music**, performed by **Panar (professional singers and dancers)**. Various **Kuthu dance forms**, like **Alliyakkuthu and Kuravaikkuthu**, were popular during **festivals** in Tamil society.
10. **Customs and notions** - Eg. The cawing of crow was considered a signal of arrival of guests. The cry of the lizard was considered an ill omen. Dreams were considered as advance readings of future events.
11. **Food Habits** - Rice was the staple food. There are several references to the use of other grains like maize and millet.
12. **Dress and Ornaments** - Barks of trees, plaited leaves as well as cotton and silk cloth used as dress. Rich ladies wore Kalingam which was a famous variety of fine cotton. Silk, too, is found mentioned in several places. Thoyyakam, Pullakam, Kulai, Punkuli, rings, chain, thodi and anklet were their important ornaments. All the married women wear tali, which is the symbol of marriage.
13. **Education** - Education was accessible to **all social groups**, including **kings, priests, merchants, peasants, Kuravars, Maravars, and shepherds** in Sangam society. "The learned alone are said to possess' eyes, while in respect of the unlettered, they (the eyes) are but sores" (**Thiruvalluvar**)
14. **Fine Arts** - Panar and Viraliyar moved about the country in companies carrying with them all sorts of quaint instruments.

Sangam Religious Beliefs

1. **The chief god of the Sangam age was Murugan (god of the hill). Kottravai (Sakti), Siva, Muruga and Thirumal (Mayavan) were the other chief deities worshipped by the Sangam people.**
2. According to **Tolkappiyam**, Seyon was the chief god in Kurunji land, Mayon the chief god in Mullai, Vendan the chief god in Marutam, Varuna in Neytal and Korravai in Palai land.
3. Other gods such as Siva, Indra, Varuna, Kubera, Yama, Tirumala, Balaram, etc. were also known to the people of Sangam age. Worship of the mother goddess(Kottravai) was also in practice. She was considered the consort of Sivasakti, representing cosmic energy.
4. **Nadu Kal/Virrukal worship**: Erected in memory of the bravery shown by the warriors
5. Sangam society practiced **ancestor worship** through **offerings** and honored the dead by erecting **Hero Stones (Veerakkal)** and **Memorial Stones (Nadukal)**.

Sangam Literature

1. It is broadly classified into **narrative (Melkannakku)** and **didactic (Kilkanakku) works**.
2. **Melkannakku** comprises **eighteen major texts, eight anthologies, and ten idylls**.
3. **Kilkanakku** consists of **eighteen minor didactic works**.

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4. **Tolkappiyam** - Written by **Tolkappiyar**, it is **the earliest Tamil literary work**, primarily on **grammar**, but also provides insights into **political and socio-economic conditions**.
5. **Ettutogai (Eight Anthologies)** - Includes **Aingurunooru, Narrinai, Agananooru, Purananooru, Kuruntogai, Kalittogai, Paripadal, and Padirruppatu**.
6. **Pathinenkilkanakku (Eighteen Minor Works)** - Focuses on **ethics and morals**. **Tirukkural** by **Thiruvalluvar** is the most significant work.
7. **Sangam Epics** - The five major epics are Silappadikaram by **Ilango Adigal**, Manimekalai by **Sittalai Sattanar**, Jivaka Chintamani, Valayapati and Kundalakesi. Of these, only the first three are now available.
    a. **Silappadikaram** - A tragic tale of **Kovalan (merchant from Puhar)**, who falls for **Madhavi (dancer)**, neglecting his wife **Kannagi**. After **Kovalan's unjust execution** by the **Pandyan king**, **Kannagi avenges his death** and is later worshipped as a **goddess of chastity**, marking the rise of the **Kannagi (Pattini) cult**.
    b. **Manimekalai** - It was a sequel to Silappadikaram. It deals with the adventures of the daughter born of Kovalan and Madhavi. She consecrated herself to the service of Buddha, Dharma and Sangha.
8. **Thirumurugatrupadai and Paripaatal** contain poems about Muruga, Vishnu, Siva and Durga. Post Sangam works generally deal with morals and ethics.

Sangam Art and Architecture

Architecture & Town Planning

Secular Architecture - The type of housing depended on socio-economic status.

1. The poor lived in thatched houses (Kurumbai) made from kusa, darbai, and ugam grasses.
2. The rich and elite constructed larger homes (Valamanai, Nagar) using better materials.
3. Royal palaces were fortified structures with elaborate gateways and defensive walls.

Religious Architecture

1. Temples were referred to as Kottam, Niyamam, and Koil in Sangam literature. Early temples were simple wooden structures (Podiyil), where a wooden plank (Kantu) was worshipped.
2. Walls were painted with deities, and temples gradually evolved with brick walls and wooden roofs.

Madakkoil

1. The Madakkoil style was introduced by Chera king Kochenganan (3rd-6th century CE).
2. Known as Perunthirukkoil, these temples had a unique Vimana (tower) built on an empty Tala (raised platform). This elevated design protected temples from floods and torrential rains.

Dance & Music

1. Dance was originally a folk tradition but evolved into a structured profession by 300-600 CE.
2. Silappadikaram provides a detailed account of dance, including: Types of dance performances, Dance teachers (Adalasan), Musicians (Vocal & Instrumentalists), Stage setup, costume, and makeup

Manimekalai also references dance and its role in religious and cultural life.

1. Formal dance education began at age 5, on an auspicious day and time. Training lasted 7 years, after which the disciple performed on stage. Dance manual (Nattiyanannul) guided teachers in training students.

Dance accompanied by music, performed by a group called Nattuvangam.

1. Music & Instruments - Tala (Rhythmic beats) called Kotti was the basis of music. Types of Musicians included Panar, Porunar, Kodiar, Viraliar, Koothar. Musical instruments like Yaazh (Stringed instrument), Flute, Drums are mentioned in Silappadikaram

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Folk Music & Everyday Life - Eg. Mugavai Pattu was sung while measuring grains.

Painting & Sculpture

1. The Tamil term "Oviam" refers to pictures and paintings. Manimekalai mentions a painting treatise (Oviachennool), indicating an established tradition. Kandiipavai (Painted figure) is referenced in Manimekalai.
2. Oviya Elini were painted backdrops for stage performances. The Kol (Vattigai) was the brush used for painting.
3. The Chitra Mandapa (Hall of Paintings) was built with expertise from Greek (Yavana), Avanti, and Magadha artists.

The **Sangam Age** represents a **golden era in Tamil history**, marking the **earliest phase of Tamil literary, cultural, and political development**. It laid the foundation for the **rich linguistic, artistic, and administrative traditions** that continued to evolve in later centuries.

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Chapter 5

Temple Architecture & Painting

Temple Architecture

Adam Hardy, in his book **"The Temple Architecture of India" (2007)**, describes Nagara and Dravida styles as "the two great classical languages of Indian temple architecture

Between **600-750 A.D.**, temple architecture developed into the **Nagara style in the north** and the **Dravida style in the south**, while a **fusion of both**, known as the **Vesara style**, emerged in the **Deccan** and matured after **750 A.D.**

The basic structure of a Hindu temple consists of

1. **Garbhagriha (Sanctum)** - A **small cubical chamber** that houses the **main deity**, gradually expanding over time.
2. **Mandapa (Hall)** - A **portico or colonnaded hall** at the entrance for **worshippers**.
3. **Shikhara/Vimana (Tower)** - A **mountain-like spire**, curving **Shikhara** in **North India** and pyramidal **Vimana** in **South India**.
4. **Vahana & Dhvajastambha** - The **deity's mount** (Vahana) and a **standard pillar (Dhvajastambha)** positioned axially before the sanctum.

Sculpture, iconography and ornamentation

1. **Elaborate Ornamentation** - Temples are richly adorned with **sculptures and intricate carvings**, integral to their design.
2. **Planned Placement of Deities** -
   a. **River goddesses (Ganga & Yamuna)** - Placed at the **entrance** of the **garbhagriha** in **Nagara temples**.
   b. **Dvarapalas (doorkeepers)** - Positioned at **gateways/gopurams** in **Dravida temples**.
   c. **Mithunas (erotic imagery), Navagrahas (nine planets), and Yakshas** - Placed at **temple entrances** for protection.
3. **Outer Wall Sculptures** -
   a. Various **forms of the main deity** are depicted.
   b. **Ashtadikpalas (guardians of directions)** are placed facing the **eight cardinal directions**.
4. **Subsidiary Shrines** - Surround the main temple, **dedicated to family members or incarnations** of the **primary deity**.
5. **Ornamental Elements** - Decorative features include **Gavaksha, Vyala/Yali, Kalpa-lata, Amalaka, and Kalasha**, each having distinct placements and symbolic meanings.

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Evolution of Temple Architecture

1. Early Beginnings (Pre-3rd Century BCE)

1. Temples were often adorned with **images of gods**, incorporating **mythological narratives from the Puranas** into their artistic representations. Each temple housed a **principal deity**, and shrines were classified into three types:
   a. **Sandhara** - Without **pradakshinapatha** (circumambulatory path).
   b. **Nirandhara** - With **pradakshinapatha**.
   c. **Sarvatobhadra** - Accessible from **all sides**.
2. Deogarh in Uttar Pradesh, Eran, Nachna-Kuthara and Udaygiri near Vidisha in Madhya Pradesh.

2. Gupta Period (4th-6th Century CE) - The Golden Age

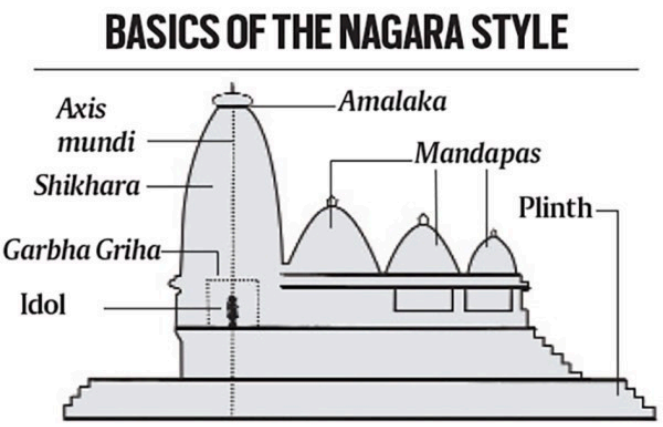
1. Transition to Structural Temples: The Gupta era marked the shift from rock-cut to free-standing temples, laying the foundation for classical Hindu temple architecture.**3. Early Medieval Period (7th-13th Century CE) - Regional Styles Emerge**

This period saw the crystallization of three major architectural styles:

1. **Nagara Style (Northern India)**
2. **Vesara Style (Central India/Deccan)**
3. **Dravidian Style (Southern India)**
4. **Rock-Cut Continuation: Parallel to structural temples, rock-cut architecture peaked with sites like Ellora's Kailasa Temple (8th century CE), a monolithic marvel blending styles.**

Nagar Style of Temple Architecture

1. Nagara-style temples are often built on a raised stone platform with steps leading up to them.
2. Unlike in South India it does not usually have elaborate boundary walls or gateways.
3. The garbhagriha is always located directly under the tallest tower.
4. While the earliest temples had just one tower, or shikhara, later temples had several.
   a. The term "shikhara" refers to man-made representations of the natural and cosmological order.
   b. The Amalaka or Kalash on the Shikhara is a distinctive feature.
   c. Nagara temples have subdivisions based on the shape of the shikhara.



Based on sketches from E B Havell's *The Ancient and Medieval Architecture of India*, 1915. Not a visual representation of Ayodhya's Ram temple.

5. A Nagara-style temple typically includes a circumambulatory passage around the garbha griha, along with one or more mandapas (halls) on the same axis.
6. Elaborate murals and reliefs often decorate its walls.
7. **Eg.** Kandariya Mahadev Temple in Madhya Pradesh, the Sun Temple in Konark, the Sun Temple in Modhera, Gujarat, and the Ossian Temple in Gujarat.

Classification of Nagara Style

Adam Hardy classifies the Nagara style of temple architecture based on the **style of Shikhara**.

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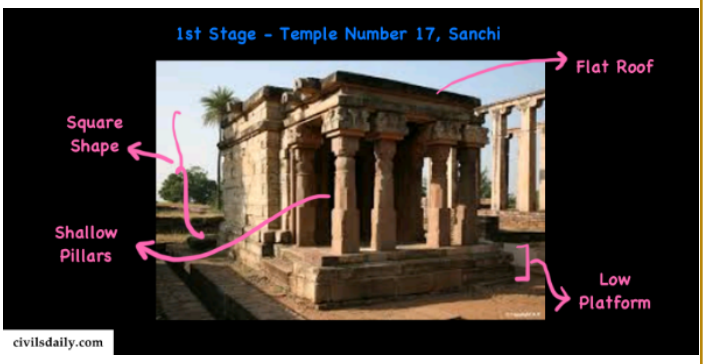
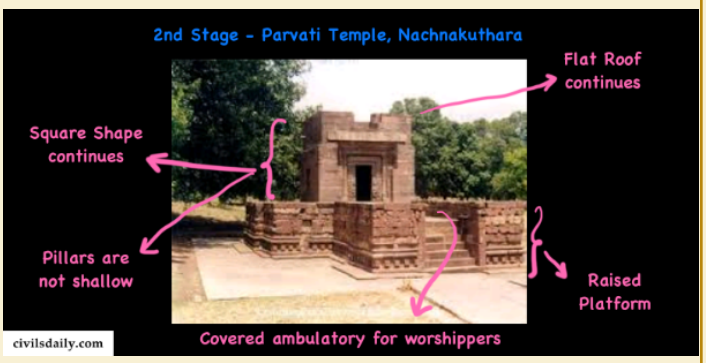
Stages of Temple Architecture	Features
Stage 1 	• Flat roof temples • Square temples • Shallow pillared approach at the front • Low platforms • **Eg. Temple 17, Sanchi & Kankali Temple, Tigwa**
Stage 2 	• Continued- Flat roof, square pillared approach (not shallow) • High or upraised platforms • Covered ambulatory around the sanctum (garbhagriha) for worshippers to do a parikrama • Two storied temples (sometimes) • **Eg. Parvati Temple, Nachnakuthara, MP**
Stage 3 	• Most of the features of 2nd stage are carried forward • Flat roof evolved into a curvilinear roof (shikhara) • Introduction of **Panchayatan style** of temple making • **Eg. Dashavatara Temple, Deogargh & Durga Temple Aihole, Karnataka**

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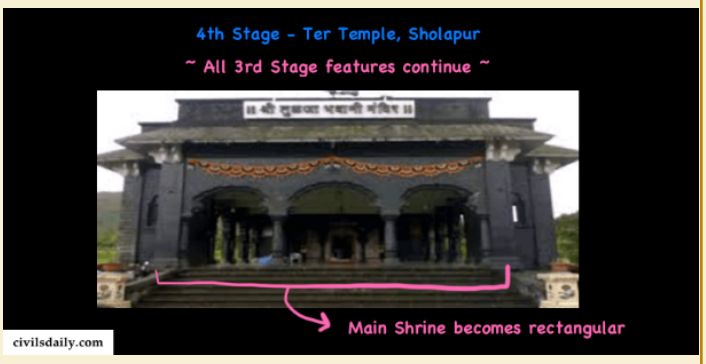
Stages of Temple Architecture	Features
Stage 4 	• Most of the features of 3rd stage are carried forward • Noticable change from square to rectangular shape of the main shrine • **Eg. Ter Temple, Sholapur**
Stage 5 	• Most of the features of 3rd stage are carried forward • Introduction of circular temples with shallow rectangular projections • **Eg. Maniyar Math, Rajgir**

Type	Details
Rekha Prasad or Latina	• It is the most common name for the simple shikhara. It is square at the base and walls curve or slope inward to a point on top • E.g: **Sun Temple at Markhera** in Madhya Pradesh (MP) and the **Sri Jagannath Temple** in Odisha.

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Type	Details
Phamsana	• It is the second major type of architectural form in the nagara order. These are **shorter and broader than latina ones**. • Multiple slabs rise upwards in a moderate slope on a straight incline like a pyramid, meeting at a single point above the building's mid-point. • The phamsana design is generally used for the mandapas while the main garbhagriha is housed in a latina building. • An example of this style is the **Jagmohan of Konark Temple**
Valabhi	• These are rectangular buildings with a roof that rises into a vaulted chamber. • They are usually called 'wagonvaulted buildings'. • An example of this style is the **Teli Ka Mandir**, a 9th-century temple in Gwalior.
Shekhri	• It has a primary **Rekha-Prasad Shikara** and one or more rows of lesser steeples (a tower with a pointed top) on both sides of the centre spire. • **Mini Shikaras** can also be found at the base and on the corners. • The **Kandariya Mahadev Temple** in **Khajuraho** is a notable example of this style

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Type	Details
Bhumija	• It was developed in **Malwa** under the **Paramara dynasty**. • It has miniature spires in horizontal and vertical rows all the way to the top, creating a grid-like effect on each face. The actual shikhara often approaches **a pyramidal shape**. • The **Udayeshwar Temple** in Madhya Pradesh is an example of this architectural style.

Regional Variation of Nagar Architecture

1. East India School: There are three schools that developed in east India these are Assam, Bengal and Odisha School.

1. **Assam School:**
   a. **Terracotta** was the primary material used in construction.
   b. Temples had **four chambers**: **Garbhagriha** (sanctum) and **three mandapas** known as **Calanta, Pancaratna, and Natamandira**.
   c. The **Ahom style** emerged from the fusion of the **Tai migration (Upper Burma)** and the **Pala architectural style of Bengal**, seen prominently around **Guwahati**. Eg. Kamakhya Temple (17th Century CE)
2. **Bengal School:**
   a. Temple structures were influenced by **village huts**, featuring **double-roofed (dochala) and four-roofed (chauchala) designs**.
   b. **Pala Style (9th-11th centuries)**: Eg. **Siddheshvara Mahadeva Temple (9th century, Barakar, Burdwan District)** - Features a **tall curving shikhara with amalaka**, similar to Odisha temples.
   c. **Sena Style (11th-13th centuries)**: Later temples continued **nagara**

- plinth
- threshold
- columns
- entrance
- walls
- motifs
- corners
- roofs
- superstructure
- plan

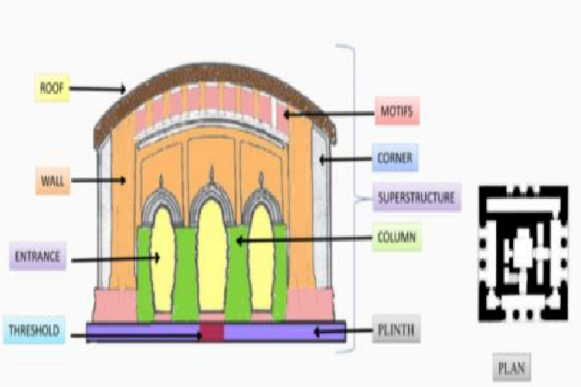

Figure 2: Parameters chosen for comparison

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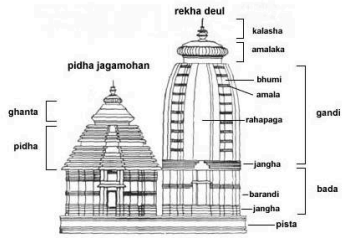
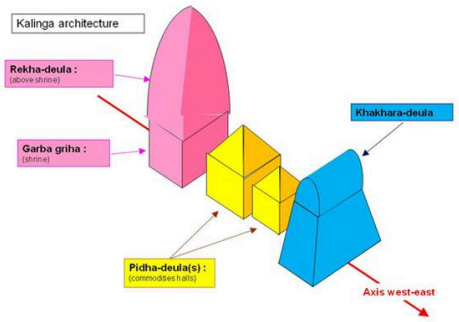
influences and evolved towards **localized Vanga architecture**. Eg. **Telkupi Temples (Purulia District, 9th-12th century)**.

d. **Impact of Sultanate & Mughal Architecture**: **Black to grey basalt & chlorite stone pillars**. **Bangla Roof (curved, sloping roof)** inspired by **Bengali bamboo huts**.
e. **Terracotta Temple Tradition in Bengal** (17th Century Onwards) - **Unique fusion** of **Pala period elements** (Eg. sculptural style), **Local vernacular building techniques** (Eg. bamboo hut-inspired roofs) and **Islamic architecture features** (Eg. arches and domes). Eg. The **Vishnupur temples** (Bankura, West Bengal)
f. Temples were typically built on a **square platform**.
g. The **exteriors** were richly decorated with **paintings, ornamental tiles, and terracotta tablets**, while the **interiors remained plain**.
h. Elements of **Islamic domes and multilobed arches** were also incorporated.

3. **Odisha School**
   a. **Architectural Classification** - Odisha temples follow a **distinct sub-style of the nagara order**, classified into three types:
   b. **Rekha Deul** - Tall, curvilinear shikhara (main shrine).
   c. **Pidha Deul** - Pyramid-shaped structures, often mandapas.
   d. **Khakra Deul** - Oblong, barrel-roofed structures, usually associated with goddess shrines.





Key Features

1. **Shikhara (Deul)** - Vertical almost to the top, then curving sharply inward.
2. **Mandapa (Jagamohana)** - A square hall preceding the shrine.
3. **Temple Plan** - Mostly **square base** with an upper **circular mastaka**, giving a **cylindrical appearance**.
4. **Carvings** - Exteriors are **richly ornamented**, while **interiors remain bare**.
5. **Enclosures** - Odisha temples are often surrounded by **boundary walls**.

Notable Example - Konark Sun Temple (1240 CE)

1. **Built entirely of stone**, dedicated to **Surya (Sun God)**.
2. **Originally 70m high**, but the shikhara collapsed in the **19th century**.
3. **Jagamohana (Dance Pavilion)** - Largest enclosed space in Hindu architecture.
4. **Chariot Design** - The temple is sculpted to resemble **Surya's processional chariot**, with:
   a. **Twelve giant stone wheels**, complete with spokes and hubs.
   b. **Seven stone-carved horses at the entrance staircase**.
5. **Three colossal Surya sculptures**, each carved from different stones, placed on three walls.
6. **Sunlight Alignment** - The **fourth wall had a doorway** allowing the **actual sun rays to enter the garbhagriha**

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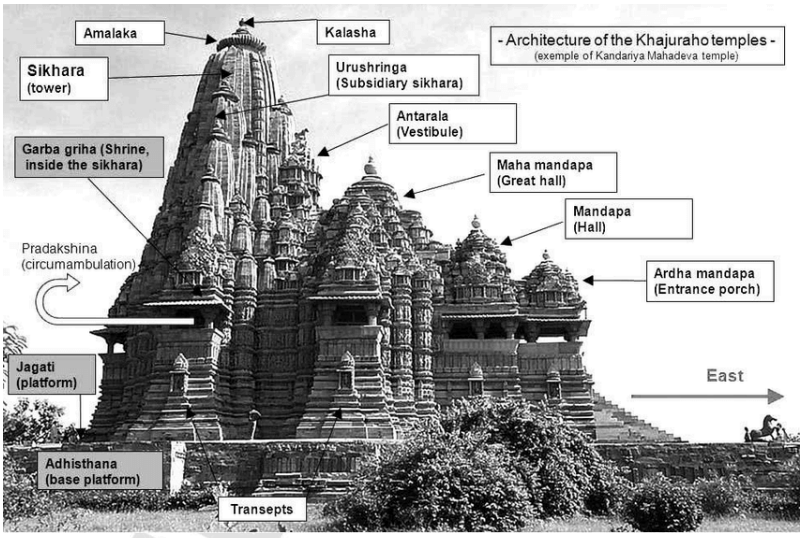
2. Central Indian School (Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh)

1. **Gupta Period Temples (Early Developments)**
   a. Made of **sandstone** and featured **small shrines with four pillars** supporting a **mandapa** (porch-like extension) and a **garbhagriha** (sanctum).
   b. Early **flat-roofed temples** include **Udaigiri (Vidisha) and Sanchi**, reflecting early Hindu temple construction alongside Buddhist structures.
   c. The **Deogarh Temple (6th century CE, Uttar Pradesh)** exemplifies **late Gupta temple architecture** with a **panchayatana layout** (one main shrine with four subsidiary shrines at the corners).
   d. The temple's **curvilinear shikhara** (rekha-prasada) marks it as an **early example of Nagara architecture**.



   e. Dedicated to **Vishnu**, its walls feature reliefs of **Sheshashayana, Nara-Narayan, and Gajendramoksha**.
2. **Medieval Period Temples - Chandela Dynasty (Khajuraho)** - The **Lakshmana Temple (954 CE)**, built by King Dhanga, represents a **mature Nagara temple** with:
   a. A **high platform**, four subsidiary shrines, and **curved shikharas** ending in **amalaka and kalasha**.
   b. **Projecting balconies and verandahs**, making it architecturally distinct from earlier temples like Deogarh.
   c. **Kandariya Mahadeo Temple** (Khajuraho) is the **pinnacle of Central Indian temple architecture**, showcasing elaborate **sculptures and architectural grandeur**.
3. **Erotic Sculptures & Symbolism**
   a. **Khajuraho temples are renowned for their erotic sculptures**, reflecting the **integration of human experience (kama) with spiritual pursuits**.
   b. **Mithuna (embracing couple) sculptures**, considered auspicious, are placed at **temple entrances, exterior walls, and between mandapas and the sanctum**.
   c. Sculptures are highly **stylized**, with **sharp facial features, long eyes, and intricate detailing**.
4. **Tantric & Yogini Temples**
   a. **Chausanth Yogini Temple (Khajuraho)** is one of the few surviving **Yogini temples**, dedicated to **goddesses associated with Tantric worship** (7th-10th century CE).
   b. Similar **Yogini temples** were built across **Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, and Tamil Nadu**, but few remain intact today.

3. Western Indian School (Gujarat, Maharashtra, Rajasthan)

1. **Varied Use of Stone Materials**
   a. **Sandstone** is the most commonly used material.
   b. **Grey to black basalt** appears in **10th-12th century temple sculptures**.
   c. **Soft white marble**, used extensively in **Jain temples at Mount Abu (10th-12th century) and Ranakpur (15th century)**, is highly manipulatable for intricate carvings.
2. **Distinct Regional Sculpture Style**
   a. **Samlaji (Gujarat)** showcases a blend of **post-Gupta influences with local artistic traditions**.

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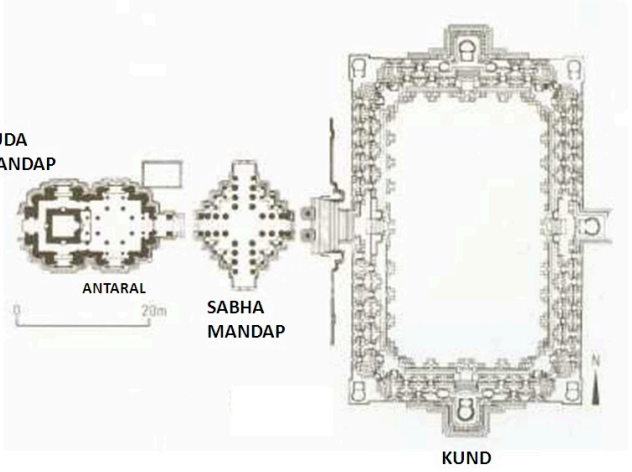
   b. **Grey schist sculptures (6th-8th centuries CE)** have been found, indicating early artistic developments.
3. **Modhera Sun Temple (11th Century CE, Gujarat)**
   a. Built by **Raja Bhimdev I of the Solanki Dynasty in 1026 CE**.
   b. Features **Surya Kund**, a massive **rectangular stepped tank** with **108 miniature shrines** carved within the steps.
4. **Architectural Highlights**
5. **Ornamental Arch-Torana** leads to the **Sabha Mandapa (assembly hall)**, which is **open on all sides**, a characteristic of **Western and Central Indian temples**.



6. **Influence of Gujarat's woodcarving tradition** is evident in the **rich sculptural and decorative carvings**.
7. **Garbhagriha (sanctum) walls are left plain**, allowing the **sunlight to shine directly into the shrine during equinoxes**, demonstrating an advanced **astronomical alignment** in temple design.
8. **Water bodies** (tanks, rivers, or ponds) were often integrated into temple complexes from early times.

4. Himalayan School (Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand)

1. Developed in **Kumaon, Garhwal, Himachal, and Kashmir**, incorporating local traditions.
2. **Influence of Gandhara, Gupta, and post-Gupta traditions**, due to Kashmir's proximity to **Taxila, Peshawar, and the Northwest Frontier**.
3. Smaller stone temples adapted to mountainous terrain. **Tri-ratha sanctum** (rectangular with three projections)

Temple complexes in Hills

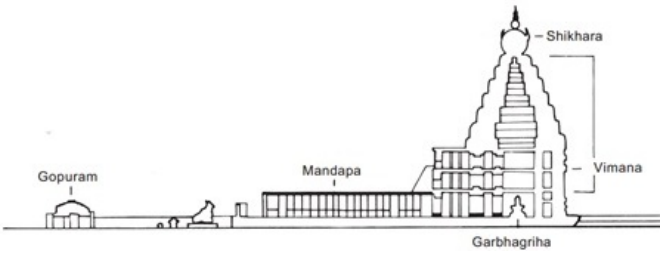
4. **Wooden buildings with pitched roofs**, adapted to **snowy conditions**.
5. **Fusion of stone and wood architecture** - Garbhagriha and shikhara follow **rekha-prasada or latina style**, while **mandapa retains wooden structures**.
6. Some temples adopt a **pagoda-like shape**.
7. **Moderate ornamentation**, moving away from **post-Gupta heavily carved styles**.
8. **Eg.** Pandrethan Temple (8th-9th century, Kashmir), Laksna-Devi Mandir (Chamba, Himachal Pradesh), Jageshwar and Champavat Temples (Kumaon, Uttarakhand)

Dravid Style of Temple Architecture

The Dravidian style of temple architecture flourished in south India from the 8th century to the 13-14th century A.D. It was pioneered by Pallava.

Features:

1. **Enclosure & Gopuram:** Dravida temples are enclosed within a **compound wall**, with a monumental **gopuram (entrance gateway)** at the front.



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2. **Vimana Shape:** The main temple tower, called **vimana**, follows a **stepped pyramidal structure**, unlike the curving **shikhara** of Nagara temples.
3. **Shikhara & Crowning Element:** In South India, **shikhara** refers only to the **stupika or octagonal cupola** at the temple's top, equivalent to North Indian **amalaka and kalasha**.
4. **Temple Entrance Features:** Unlike Nagara temples, which have **mithunas and river goddesses (Ganga & Yamuna)** at the entrance, Dravida temples feature **dvarapalas (fierce door-keepers)**.
5. **Five Temple Shapes:**
   a. **Square - Kuta / Caturasra**
   b. **Rectangular - Shala / Ayatasra**
   c. **Elliptical (elephant-backed) - Gaja-prishta / Vrittayata**
   d. **Circular - Vritta**
   e. **Octagonal - Ashtasra**
6. **Temple Tank:** A **large water reservoir** (temple tank) is usually present within the complex.
7. **Subsidiary Shrines:** These are either integrated within the **main vimana** or built as **separate small shrines** beside it.
8. **Growth & Expansion:** Over time, new **boundary walls and taller gopurams** were added, expanding the temple complex. Eg. **Srirangam Temple** has **seven concentric enclosure walls**.
9. **Urban Centres:** Temples became **administrative hubs**, controlling large land areas. Major temple towns: **Kanchipuram, Thanjavur, Madurai, and Kumbakonam** (8th-12th centuries).
10. **Iconographic Influence:** Temple shape was **determined by the deity** it housed. Different shapes were often combined to create **unique architectural styles** in various periods.

Pallava Dynasty (6th-8th Century CE)

- **Early Temples:** Mostly **rock-cut** structures, attributed to **Mahendravarman I**, a contemporary of **Pulakesin II (Chalukya King)**.
- **Later Temples:** Developed into **structural** temples.
- **Shore Temple, Mahabalipuram:**
  - Built during **Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha) (700-728 CE)**.
  - **Three shrines** - Two dedicated to **Shiva** (east & west-facing), one to **Vishnu (Anantashayana)**.
  - Presence of an **early gopuram**, **Nandi sculptures**, and a **water tank**.
  - **Erosion** due to sea salt has caused disfiguration of carvings.

Chola Dynasty (9th-13th Century CE)

- **Brihadeeswara (Rajarajeswara) Temple, Thanjavur (1009 CE)**
  - Built by **Rajaraja Chola I**, it is the **largest & tallest** Indian temple.
  - **Vimana:** A **70m-high** pyramidal structure with an **octagonal monolithic shikhara** (stupika).
  - **Gopurams:** First temple to have **two large gopuras** with elaborate **sculptural decorations**.
  - **Sculptural Features:**
  - **Nandi figures** at the shikhara's corners.
  - A **3m-tall kalasha** on top.
  - Stucco figures, some possibly **added during the Maratha period**.
  - **Sanctum & Mythology:**
  - **Main deity: Shiva Lingam** in a **two-storeyed sanctum**.

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- **Surrounding walls:** Decorated with **painted murals and sculptures** depicting **mythological narratives**.

Difference Between Nagara and Dravida Style of Temple Architecture

Feature	Nagara Style (North Indian)	Dravida Style (South Indian)
Location	Found in **North India**, mainly in states like Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, and Gujarat.	Found in **South India**, especially in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Kerala.
Shikhara/Vimana	The **shikhara (tower)** is **curvilinear** and rises vertically before curving inward.	The **vimana (tower)** is **pyramidal and stepped**, rising in terraces.
Temple Compound	**No boundary walls**; temples are usually open.	Enclosed within **a compound wall** with multiple **gopurams** (gateway towers).
Entrance Gateway	No grand entrance towers, though some have **toranas (arched gateways)**.	Large, elaborately carved **gopurams (ornate entrance towers)** at the temple entrance.
Garbhagriha	The **garbhagriha** is **always located directly under the tallest tower**.	In some of the temples, the main temple in which the **garbhagriha is situated** has **one of the smallest towers**. Eg. **Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple in Srirangam, Tamil Nadu**.
	Images of Goddesses Ganga and Yamuna are placed outside the Garbhagriha.	**Sculptures of fierce dvarapalas** or guarding the temple is generally a common feature.
Mandapa (Hall)	Generally **pillared**, sometimes open or enclosed.	Large **mandapas**, often with **multiple pillared halls**.
Water Tank	Usually **not present** within temple premises.	**Temple tanks** (pushkarni or kalyani) are commonly found.
Stone Platform	Entire temple is built on a **stone platform with steps leading up to it.**	Generally, it is not built on a **stone platform.**
Subsidiary Shrines	Smaller shrines are placed **around the main temple**.	Subsidiary shrines are either **attached to the main vimana** or placed separately within the temple complex.
Example Temples	**- Lingaraja Temple (Odisha)**	

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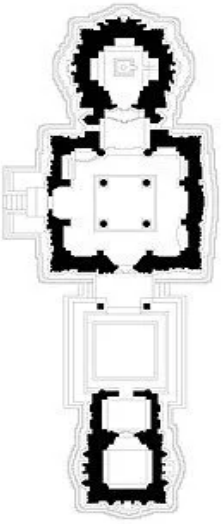
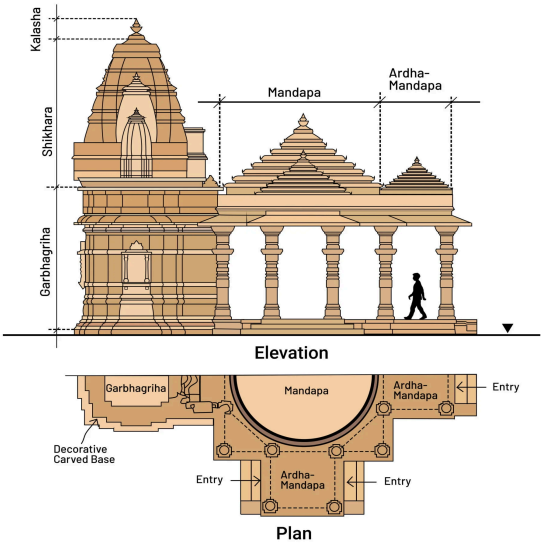
Vesara style of temple architecture

Vesara, which is Sanskrit for "mule," is a hybrid 'offspring' of Nagara and Dravida style of temple architecture. The trend was started by the **Chalukyas of Badami (500-753AD**), further refined by the **Rashtrakutas of Manyakheta (750- 983AD) in Ellora, Chalukyas of Kalyani (983-1195 AD)** in **Lakkundi, Dambal, Gadag** etc. and epitomized by the **Hoysalas (1000-1330 AD)**



Unique features of Vesara style of temple architecture

1. **Rectangular Complex**: The **main shrine** and a **small enclosure** were positioned on opposite ends of the **rectangular perimeter wall**.
2. **Entrance Porch (Ardhamandapa)**: Featured **decorative columns** and served as a **transition space** between the outer and inner temple areas.
3. **Mandapa (Main Hall)**: Acted as the **gathering and worship space**, adorned with **intricately carved columns** and decorative elements.
4. **Mahamandapa**: **Extended hall** where **ritual dances** and larger congregations took place.
5. **Garbhagriha (Sanctum Sanctorum)**: The **inner sanctum** housing the deity, usually **oriented towards the east**.
6. **Antarala (Vestibule)**: A **foyer-like space** connecting the **Garbhagriha** and **Mandapa**, facilitating transition between sacred and public areas.
7. The **Vesara style** features a **spire-shaped shikhara**, blending the **curvilinear form of Nagara** with the **ornate design of Dravida vimana**
8. Vesara temples featured **highly carved walls, ceilings, doorframes, and pillars** and were sometimes built on **elevated platforms** serving as open **ambulatory passageways**..
9. **Pradakshina Patha (Circumambulatory Path)**: Surrounding the **Garbhagriha**, allowing **devotees to walk around the deity** as a part of worship.
10. **Architectural Features**
    a. **Gavakshas**: Ornamental arches on the shikhara with a horseshoe shape.
    b. **Amalakas**: Ribbed disc-shaped structure at the top of the tower.
    c. **Stupi**: Miniature **stupa-like** representation at the summit of the tower.
    d. **Shalas**: Barrel vault structure at the top of the tower.
    e. **Pediment**: Semi-circular ornamental structure over columns.



Typical Plan and Elevation of Indian Temple Architecture

Influence of Nagara Architecture

1. **Panchayatan style**: Five-shrine layout with a central shrine and four subsidiary shrines.
2. **Passages** connecting the **mandapa** and **sanctuary**.
3. **Shikhara and Bhumija pillars are similar** to Nagara temples in Karnataka.
4. **Stepped diamond or stellate (star-shaped) plan**, characteristic of Nagara temples.

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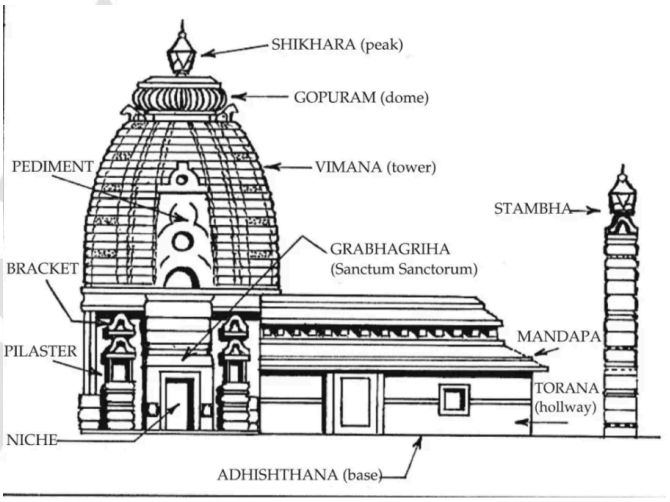
Influence of Dravida Architecture

1. **Vimana design** showing Dravidian influence.
2. **Decorative elements** from both Nagara and Dravida styles, seen in **miniature structures** and **wall carvings**.
3. The Chalukyan builders modified the Dravida towers by minimizing the height of each storey and arranging them in descending order of height from base to top.
1. **Famous temples built with this style include:** Kallesvara temple, Kukkanur; Ramalingesvara temple, Gudur; Mahadeva temple, Ittagi; Kasivisvesvara temple, Lakkundi (and several other temples at Lakkundi); Brahmadeva temple, Savadi - notable for being fully stellate; Mallikarjuna temple, Sudi (and Joda-kalasha temple)

Temples of Western Chalukyas

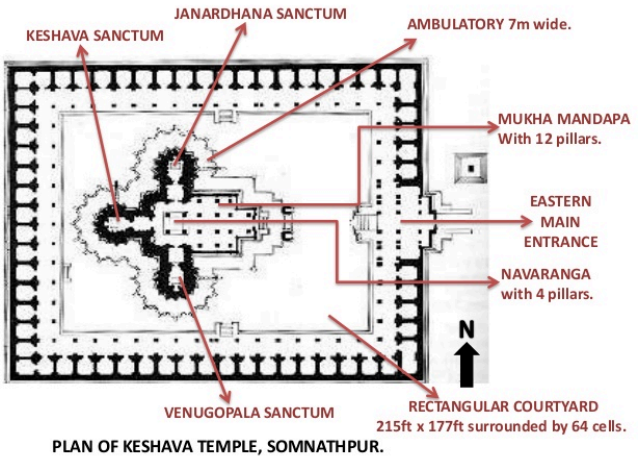
1. They are created by **piling large blocks of stone**. The joints between different units of a structure are visible.
2. Early temples were primarily **rock-cut caves**, later transitioning to **structural temples**.
3. **Two special features of Chalukya temples - Mantapa and Pillars:**
   a. **Mantapa**: The mantapa has two types of roof - domical ceilings (the dome-like ceilings standing on four pillars are very attractive) or square ceilings (these are vigorously ornamented with mythological pictures).
   b. **Pillars**: the miniature decorative pillars of Chalukya temples stand with its own artistic value.



4. **Ravana Phadi Cave, Aihole**: Known for its **Nataraja sculpture** surrounded by **Saptamatrikas**.
5. **Pattadakal Temple Complex (8th Century CE, Vikramaditya II's Reign)**:
   a. **Virupaksha Temple**: Largest temple in Pattadakal, a fine example of **Dravida architecture**.
   b. **Papnath Temple**: early **Dravida-style** temple dedicated to **Shiva**.
6. **Swarga Brahma Temple at Alampur & Mahakuta Temple**: Show elements borrowed from **Odisha & Rajasthan temples**.
7. **Durga Temple at Aihole**: Unique **apsidal shrine**, reminiscent of **Buddhist chaitya halls**, with a **Nagara-style shikhara**.
8. **Lad Khan Temple at Aihole**: Resembles **wooden-roofed temples of the Himalayas**, but constructed in **stone**.

Temples of Rashtrakutas

1. The majority of their temples were built in the Chalukyan style.
2. **Kailasha temple at Ellora** (largest rock-cut monument in India) was constructed during the reign of **Krishna I (757-83 CE)**.
3. Other examples - Navalinga Temple, Kukkanur, Cave Temples, Jain temple in Pattadakkal.



PLAN OF KESHAVA TEMPLE, SOMNATHPUR.

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Temples of Hoysalas

1. **Star-Shaped Temples:** temples have **complex, multi-angled projections**, creating a **stellate-plan** resembling a star.
2. Usually, these temples stand in an enclosure with a usual garbha-griha fronted by an antrala and a pillared mandapa known as **navrang/gudha-mandapa.**
3. **Use of soft stone:** The use of soft soapstone enabled intricate carvings, especially in the detailed jewelry adorning temple walls.
4. **Eg.** The **Hoysaleshvara temple** at Halebid in Karnataka was built in dark schist stone. Kesava temple in Somanathpurais another example.

Buddhist and Jain Architectural Developments

- Buddhist and Jain architectural developments paralleled Hindu temple architecture between the 5th and 14th centuries. **Eg.** Sites like **Ellora** have Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain monuments, while **Badami, Khajuraho, and Kannauj** feature remains of at least two of these religious traditions side by side.

Buddhist Architecture

- **Mahabodhi Temple, Bodhgaya**
- The **Mahabodhi Temple**, though reconstructed in the colonial period, retains its **7th-century design**, influenced by earlier Mauryan and Pala styles.
- **Architectural uniqueness:** It combines features of both **Nagara** (tall, vertical structure) and **Dravida** (non-curving profile) styles.
- **Nalanda Mahavihara (5th-12th century CE)** was founded by Kumaragupta I.
- **Architectural features:**
  - Monastic cells and stupas.
  - Distinctive **Nalanda School of Sculpture** combining **Gupta, Bihar, and Central Indian influences**.
  - Nalanda bronzes from the 7th-12th centuries depict **Mahayana and Vajrayana deities**.
- **Odisha Buddhist Monasteries**
- Sites like **Lalitagiri, Ratnagiri, and Vajragiri** were **major Buddhist monasteries** with stupas, sculptures, and inscriptions. **Eg.** The stupa at **Ratnagiri** has exquisite carvings of Buddhist deities and influences from Pala art.
- **Buddhist Architecture in Tamil Nadu - Nagapattinam** was a prominent **Buddhist center during the Chola period**, with influences from Sri Lankan Buddhism.
- **Kailashnath Temple, Ellora (Rashtrakuta Period)** houses **Buddhist rock-cut caves** with detailed carvings. **Eg.** Cave 10, the **Vishvakarma Cave**, features a grand chaitya hall with a large Buddha image.

Jain Architecture

- **Early Jain Pilgrimage Sites in Bihar - Pawapuri and Rajgir** are sacred to Jainism for their association with Mahavira's life.
- **Jain Rock-Cut Temples in Deccan - Ellora and Aihole** have some of the best **Jain rock-cut temples**, reflecting **Western Chalukya and Rashtrakuta** influences. **Eg.** The **Indra Sabha Cave at Ellora (9th century CE)** features carvings of Tirthankaras and celestial beings.
- **Jain Temples of Central India - Deogarh, Khajuraho, Chanderi, and Gwalior** contain **Jain temples with intricate carvings**. **Eg.** The **Parshvanatha Temple at Khajuraho (10th century CE)**

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- **Karnataka - Sravanabelagola** is home to the world's **largest monolithic statue of Gomateshwara (Bahubali),** commissioned by the **Ganga dynasty's minister, Camundaraya (10th century CE). Other Sites like** Jain temples in **Mudabidri and Karkala** showcase Vijayanagara-style Jain architecture.
- **Jain Temples at Mount Abu** (built by **Vimal Shah**) have **simple exteriors** but **highly intricate marble interiors. Eg. Vimal Vasahi and Luna Vasahi Temples (11th-13th centuries CE).**
- **Shatrunjaya Temples, Palitana (Gujarat)** houses **over 800 Jain temples**, forming an extensive pilgrimage complex.

Rock Cut Architecture in India

Rock-cut architecture is a form of architecture that involves carving into natural rock formations to create structural elements, such as caves, temples, and monuments. The Barabar Caves in Bihar are the oldest surviving rock-cut temples in India, estimated to be as old as 300 BC. Before that, **the Harappans of Dholavira** built the first rock-cut architecture in India in the form of a rock-cut water reservoir.

Evolution of rock-cut architecture in ancient India

Rock-cut caves and temples in India **evolved from simple monasteries to grand temples**, showcasing architectural mastery.

Phase 1

Mauryan Period (3rd Century BCE)

1. The earliest rock-cut caves are attributed to **Ashoka (273-232 BCE)** and his grandson **Dasharath**.
2. Used mainly as **viharas (monasteries)** by **Jain and Buddhist monks**.
3. **The Ajivika sect** was among the first to use rock-cut caves (Lomas Rishi cave).
4. **Eg. Barabar Caves** (oldest surviving rock-cut caves) and **Nagarjuni Caves** in Bihar.

1. Post-Mauryan Period (2nd Century BCE - 3rd Century CE) - Continued the Mauryan tradition but introduced Chaitya halls (prayer halls) along with viharas. Initially made entirely of wood, later rock-cut adaptations.
   a. **Quadrangular chambers with flat roofs. Huge arched openings, stone screens, and human-animal sculptures.**
   b. **Eg. Karle Chaitya Hall** (Maharashtra), **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra) - 29 caves (25 viharas + 4 chaityas).

Phase 2 - Decline of wood usage in architecture. The Buddha image became the central focus.

1. Gupta Period (4th-6th Century CE) - "Golden Period of Indian Architecture." Use of mural paintings became prominent. Eg. Udayagiri Caves (Madhya Pradesh) - Contains the Varaha Cave (Cave 5) depicting Vishnu's boar incarnation rescuing the Earth. Ajanta Caves - fresco paintings.

Phase 3 - Dravidian Rock-Cut Style (6th Century CE Onwards). Characterized by Mandapa (pillared halls) and Rathas (monolithic shrines).

1. Rock-Cut Temple Architecture in India - Monolithic rock-cut temples are carved from a single rock, mimicking masonry or wooden structures with intricate sculptures.
   a. Pallava Rock-Cut Temple Architecture (7th-9th Century CE) - Initiated by Mahendravarman I, further developed by Narasimhavarman I (Mamalla). Eg. Pancha Rathas (Mahabalipuram)

Key Rock-Cut Temples

1. Kailash Temple (Ellora) - Built by Rashtrakuta King Krishna I (8th century CE). Noted for monolithic rock-cut design and carvings of Ramayana & Mahabharata.

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Mahabalipuram Monuments (Tamil Nadu) - UNESCO World Heritage Site

Pancha Rathas (7th century CE) - Largest is Dharmaraja Ratha.

Shore Temple - Predominantly Shaivite, with Anantashayana Vishnu sculpture.

Descent of the Ganges (Arjuna's Penance) - Carving narrates Ganga's descent.

Badami Cave Temples (Karnataka) - Four caves (3 Hindu + 1 Jain).

Cave 1: Shiva as Nataraja.

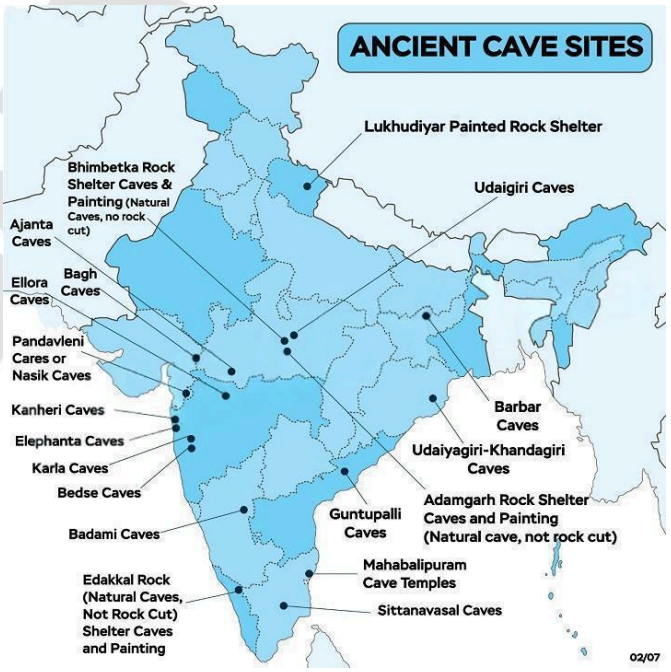
Cave 2: Vishnu Trivikrama & Vamana avatar.

Cave 3: Largest cave - Sculptures of Vishnu's various forms.

Cave 4: Jain Tirthankara sculptures.

Major Rock-Cut Cave Sites in India

1. Jogimara Cave (Chhattisgarh) - Features love inscriptions in Brahmi script, dating to 1000-300 BCE.
2. Nasik Caves (1st Century CE) - Also known as "Pandav Leni", comprising 24 Buddhist caves. Represents transition from Hinayana to Mahayana Buddhism.
3. Ajanta Caves (4th Century CE) - Located in Sahyadri ranges (Maharashtra) on the Waghora river. 29 caves in a horseshoe shape, used as viharas (monasteries) and chaityas (prayer halls). Noted for Gupta-era frescoes and paintings depicting Jataka tales.
4. Ellora Caves (5th-11th Century CE) - Located near Aurangabad, Maharashtra. 34 caves - 17 Brahmanical, 12 Buddhist, and 5 Jain.
5. Bagh Caves (6th Century CE) - Located on Bagh River, Madhya Pradesh. 9 Buddhist caves resembling Ajanta caves. Notable for rock-cut monasteries and fresco paintings.
6. Udayagiri & Khandagiri Caves (Odisha) - 18 caves at Udayagiri and 15 at Khandagiri made under Kalinga King Kharavela (1st-2nd century BCE). Hathigumpha Inscription in Brahmi script.
7. Sittanavasal Caves (Tamil Nadu) - Jain rock-cut temple, known for murals and paintings



Buddhist rock-cut architecture

Buddhist rock-cut architecture evolved from simple **earthen mounds (Stupas)** to **elaborate monastic complexes (Viharas & Chaityagrihas)**. Rock-cut architecture was **not exclusive to Buddhism**; many sites were shared by **Jain and Hindu traditions**. **Ellora & Badami Caves** exhibit mixed **Buddhist, Jain, and Hindu influences**.

Key Features

Types of Buddhist Structures

1. **Stupa** - Mound-like structure serving as a burial monument and a site for relics.
2. **Chaityagriha** - Rock-cut prayer halls containing stupas.
3. **Viharas** - Monasteries used as residences for monks.

1. **Rock-Cut Caves**

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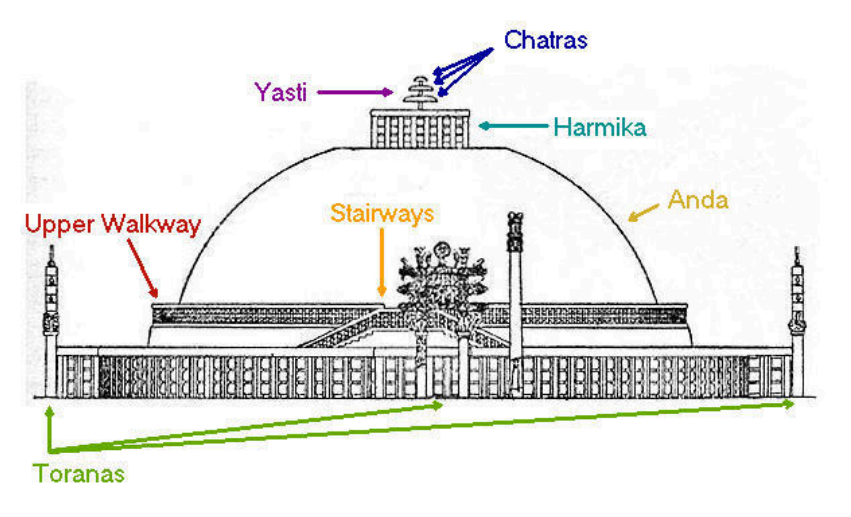
a. **Mauryan Period (3rd Century BCE)**
b. **Barabar & Nagarjuni Hills (Bihar)** - Dedicated to **Ajivika sect monks**.
c. **Swarna Bhandar Cave (Rajgir)** - Example of early rock-cut caves.
d. **Lomas Rishi & Sudama Caves** - Inspired by wooden architecture, featuring intricate **floral and geometric motifs**.
e. **Post-Mauryan Period**
f. **Bhaja Caves (Maharashtra)** - Retains evidence of wooden beams.
g. **Ajanta & Ellora Caves (Maharashtra)** - Depict Buddhist, Jain, and Hindu traditions.

2. **Elaborate Facades and Decorative Elements: Eg. The Karla Caves** are celebrated for their beautifully sculpted entrances and ornate carvings that exemplify early Buddhist art.
3. **Iconography and Narrative Art: Eg. Later sections of the Ajanta Caves** showcase vivid frescoes and sculptures depicting the life and teachings of the Buddha.
4. **Strategic Location and Natural Integration: Eg. The Bhaja Caves** in the Western Ghats are strategically positioned within rugged terrain, offering both natural protection and a serene setting.
5. **Proximity to Trade Routes**: Buddhist ideology encouraged engagement with commerce, leading to the establishment of monasteries near major trade routes, which also facilitated cultural exchange.

Stupa Architecture



- Derived from the Sanskrit word "Stupa" meaning **"pile-up"**, initially earthen mounds later built with stone and bricks.
- **Structure:**
  - **Anda** - Hemispherical dome.
  - **Harmika** - Railed platform atop the dome.
  - **Chatras** - Three-tiered umbrella structure symbolizing Buddhist ideals.
  - **Yasti** - Central supporting mast.
  - **Pradakshinapatha** - Circumambulatory path for devotees.
  - **Vedika** - Railing enclosing the stupa.
- **Regional Variations - Amaravati & Nagarjunakonda Stupas (Andhra Pradesh)**
  - **Ayaka platforms** - Box-like projections on four sides.
  - **Ayaka Stambhas** - Five tall pillars representing five Buddhist principles.

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- **Sculptural Vedika** - Decorated with figures of celestial beings and lotus motifs.

Chaitya-Grihas (Prayer Halls)

- Worship halls containing stupas, symbolizing **Buddha, Bodhi Tree, Dharma, and Sangha**.
- **Architectural Features:**
  - **Barrel-vaulted roof** with a semi-cylindrical appearance.
  - **Apsidal (elephant-back shaped) plan** with a circumambulatory path.
- **Transition from Hinayana to Mahayana (1st Century CE)**
  - **Hinayana Chaityas:** No human representation of Buddha, only symbolic depictions.
  - **Mahayana Chaityas:** Buddha depicted as **a divine figure (Avalokiteshvara, Maitreya)**, influenced by **Vaishnavism**.
- **Important Chaitya-Grihas**
  - **Bhaja, Karle, Pandulena (Nasik), Pitalkhora, Bedsa** - Early **Hinayana Chaityas** (2nd century BCE - 50 BCE).
  - **Ajanta (Caves 9, 10, 12)** - Depict Buddha using **symbolic representations (Stupa, Vajrasana, Bodhi Tree, Triratna)**.
  - **Ellora (Cave 10, Vishwakarma Cave)** - Example of later **Mahayana Chaitya-Grihas** with Buddha sculptures.
  - **Kanheri, Karle (1st Century CE)** - Reflect the **schism between Mahayana and Hinayana sects**.

Viharas (Monastic Complexes)

- Residential quarters for Buddhist monks.
- **Structure:**
  - **Central Hall (Worship Area).**
  - **Surrounding monk cells with stone-cut beds.**
  - **Pillared verandah and entrance doorway.**
- **Mahayana Influence**
- Some viharas evolved into **Chaitya-griha-cum-Viharas**, where the **central cell housed a Buddha image** instead of a stupa.
- **Façades were elaborately carved with lotus, wheel, swastika motifs**.

Key Examples

- **Ajanta (Caves 8, 12, 13), Ellora (Caves 6, 11, 12).**
- **Bedsa, Kondane, Pitalkhora, Nasik (Caves 3, 8, 15).**
- **Double-storeyed viharas (Ajanta Cave 6, Ellora Cave 11).**

Hindu rock-cut architecture

1. **Hindu rock-cut architecture** flourished from the **5th century CE onwards**, mainly in the **Deccan and South India**. These temples evolved under the **Chalukyas, Pallavas, Rashtrakutas, and Pandyas**.
2. **Major sites:** Badami, Ellora, Elephanta, Mamallapuram, Aurangabad, and Aihole.
3. These temples played a key role in the **transition from rock-cut shrines to structural temples**
4. **Chalukyan Rock-Cut Architecture @ Badami and Aihole** - Common features include **Front porch (mukha mandapa), central hall (mahamandapa), and square sanctum (garbhagriha).**
   a. **Badami Caves (Karnataka) - Four rock-cut caves**: Three **Brahmanical (Shaivite and Vaishnavite)**, one **Jain**.

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b. **Aihole Rock-Cut Temples - Ravana Phadi Cave (6th century CE)**: Dedicated to **Shiva**. Features **Shiva, Parvati, dancing Shiva with Ganesha, Ardhanarishvara, Saptamatrkas, Varaha, and Mahishasuramardini**

Rock-Cut Caves of Kalachuris & Rashtrakutas

1. **Ellora Caves (Maharashtra)**: A unique site showcasing **Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain monuments**.
2. **Kailasa Temple (Cave 16, Ellora)**
   a. Features:
   b. **West-facing** temple.
   c. **Four-story vimana** with **octagonal stupa**.
   d. **Massive Nandi pavilion**.
   e. **Intricately carved sculptures**.

1. **Pallava Rock-Cut Architecture**
   a. **First rock-cut cave: Mandagappattu (by Mahendravarman I, early 7th century CE).**
   b. **Mandapas (pillared halls) became a distinct feature**.
   c. **Mukha mandapa façade** with evenly spaced **pillars and pilasters**.
   d. **Pillars divided into three parts**:
   e. **Saduram (top & bottom square sections)**
   f. **Kattu (middle octagonal section)**
   g. **Motifs:** Lotus medallions, gaja (elephants), makara (crocodile), and kinnaras (celestial beings).
   h. **Post-Mahendra Style Rock-Cut Temples**
   i. **Somaskanda depictions (Shiva with Skanda) became common**.
   j. **Ornate relief sculptures** and **freestanding monolithic shrines (Rathas) introduced**.
   k. **Eg. Mamallapuram (7th century CE, under Narasimhavarman I Mamalla)**.
   l. **Three architectural components**:
   m. **Adhishthana (base)**
   n. **Kudya-stambha (pilasters)**
   o. **Prastara (parapet with decorative features)**
   p. **Pillars decorated with crouching vyalis (mythical lions).**
   q. Monolithic Rathas (Mamallapuram) - Pallava rathas (7th century CE) carved out of granite. Single-storeyed (Ektala) and multi-storeyed (Dvitala, Tritala, Chatushtala) vimanas. Kutina-shikhara (domical roof with stupis) and sala-shikhara (barrel-vaulted shikhara) used.

Rock-Cut Temples of the Pandyas

1. Inspired by **Pallava architecture, 7th century CE onwards**.
2. **Sri Karpaga Vinayakar Temple (Pillaiyarpatti, Tamil Nadu)** is **one of the earliest Pandya rock-cut shrines**.
3. **Vettuvankoil at Kalugumalai (8th century CE)** - Unfinished shrine illustrating **Pandya rock-cutting techniques**.
   a. Features:
   b. **Kutina-shikhara (dome with kudu arches).**
   c. **Carvings from top to bottom**.
   d. **Plain potikas (brackets) on pillars** (Unlike highly ornate Pallava ones).

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Jain rock-cut architecture

1. Khandagiri and Udayagiri, located in **Odisha**, are among the **earliest rock-cut shelters** associated with Jainism.
2. Developed around **2000 years ago** by **King Kharavela** of the **Chedi dynasty** for Jain monks' residence.
3. The twin hills contain **32 caves-18 in Udayagiri** and **14 in Khandagiri**.
4. Some caves are **double-storied**, but **most are single-storied**.
5. The caves contain **inscriptions, sculptures, and reliefs** depicting **Jain mythology and royal patronage**.
6. **Important Caves of Udayagiri**
   a. **Rani Gumpha (Cave No.1) - Double-storied monastery** with **seven entrances** and **nine upper columns**. **Sculptural depictions** include **royalty, elephants, monkeys**, and **Surya (Sun God) on a chariot**.
   b. **Manchapuri Gumpha (Cave No.9) - Double-storied cave** containing **inscriptions of Kudepasiri** (successor of Kharavela).
   c. **Ganesa Gumpha (Cave No.10)** - Houses **Jain Tirthankara images** and **inscriptions**. Contains **low-ceiling dwelling cells** with **verandah and stone bench**. **Later additions** include **large elephant sculptures** and **Ganesha figures**.
   d. **Hathi Gumpha (Cave No.14)** - detailing **King Kharavela's conquests and administration**. Features **symbols, footprints, and a hollowed boulder with doors and windows**.

Important Caves of Khandagiri

1. Tatowa Gumpha (Cave No.1) - Richly decorated cave with door attendants, bulls, and lions.
2. Ananta Gumpha - Features female figures, elephants, athletes, and geese carrying flowers.
3. Navamuni Gumpha (Cave No.7) - Houses carved by Jain Tirthankaras, Sasana Devis, and Ganesh. It contains Chandraprabha seated on a lotus and Naga sculpture.

Barabhuji Gumpha (Cave No.8) - Named after 12-armed Sasana Devis sculptures.

1. Trusula Gumpha (Cave No.9) - Contains three standing images of Rishabha Deva. Features 24 Tirthankaras in a rough, uneven finish.

Significance

1. **Religious Significance** - Served as **monastic retreats** for **Buddhists, Jains, and Hindus**. Depictions of **mythology, deities, and spiritual teachings** in sculptures and murals.
2. **Architectural Innovation** - Transition from **wood-based structures** to **stone-carved monolithic architecture**. Introduction of **intricate facades, sculptures, and relief carvings**.
3. **Engineering Marvel** - Monolithic structures like **Kailasa Temple (Ellora, Rashtrakuta period)** carved from a **single rock**, displaying **precision and craftsmanship**. Rock-cut temples like **Pancha Rathas (Mahabalipuram, Pallava period)** exhibit **experimental designs**.
4. **Cultural Synthesis** - Rock-cut sites depict **Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain influences**, showcasing **religious harmony**. Eg. **Ellora Caves house Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain shrines** in a single complex.
5. **Artistic and Sculptural Excellence** - Intricate **murals, frescoes, and relief sculptures** showcasing high artistic skill. Eg. **Ajanta paintings (Gupta period)** depict Buddhist **Jataka tales** and divine imagery.
6. **Political Patronage - Dynastic rulers** commissioned rock-cut caves to assert power and **patronize religion**. Eg. **Ashoka (Buddhist caves), Chalukyas (Badami caves), Pallavas (Mahabalipuram), Rashtrakutas (Ellora).**
7. **Tourism and Heritage Preservation** - Recognized as **UNESCO World Heritage Sites** (Ajanta, Ellora, Elephanta).

"Every great architecture is a testament to the civilization that built it." Rock-cut architecture in India stands as a **monument to human perseverance, devotion, and artistic excellence**.

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Indian Paintings

Indian paintings have a rich and diverse history, reflecting the country's cultural, religious, and social evolution over thousands of years. The tradition of painting in India can be classified into **prehistoric, classical, medieval, and modern periods**.

The evolution of painting in India can be traced through various stages

Prehistoric Paintings (Before 3rd Century BCE)

1. The pre-historic paintings were generally executed on rocks and these rock engravings were called Petroglyphs. The earliest evidence of painting in India is found in the rock shelters and caves of Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh), dating back to Mesolithic (9000-3000 BCE).
2. The paintings depict hunting scenes, dancing figures, animals, and daily life activities.

Ochre, white, red, and yellow colors were used, derived from minerals.

Murals and Classical Paintings (3rd Century BCE - 8th Century CE)

1. Murals flourished in Buddhist, Jain, and Hindu temples. Themes were religious, depicting Buddha's life, Jataka tales, and deities. Techniques used natural dyes and fresco styles, applied on dry plaster

Eg. Ajanta Caves: Bodhisattva Padmapani and Bodhisattva Vajrapani murals.

Medieval Period - Miniature Paintings

Schools of Miniature Paintings

1. Pala School (9th-12th Century, Bengal & Bihar) - Influenced by Buddhist traditions. Palm leaf manuscripts with delicate lines and bright colors.
2. Western Indian/Jain School (12th-16th Century, Gujarat & Rajasthan) - Illustrations in Jain manuscripts like Kalpasutra. Bold colors, red background, and angular faces.
3. Mughal School (16th-18th Century) - Introduced by Akbar, blending Persian and Indian elements. Naturalistic themes, court scenes, hunting, and portraits. Eg. Akbarnama, Padshahnama.
4. Rajput School (17th-19th Century, Rajasthan) - Themes: Ramayana, Mahabharata, Raga-Mala. Bright colors and intricate detailing.
5. Pahari School (17th-19th Century, Himachal & Jammu) - Kangra and Basohli styles: Soft colors, Krishna-Radha love themes.
6. Deccan School (16th-18th Century) - Influenced by Persian, Turkish, and Hindu styles. Bijapur, Golconda, and Hyderabad were centers.

Colonial & Modern Period (19th Century - Present)

The British colonial rule led to the decline of traditional art forms.

Company paintings (18th-19th Century) were made for British officials.

1. The Bengal School of Art emerged under Abanindranath Tagore to revive Indian traditional themes.

Raja Ravi Varma (19th Century) popularized mythological themes in oil paintings.

1. Modern Indian art evolved with artists like Amrita Sher-Gil, M.F. Husain, and S.H. Raza, blending traditional and Western styles.

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Principles of Painting

1. In the 3rd century AD, **Vatsyayana in his book Kamasutra mentioned six main principles/limbs or shadanga of paintings.**
   a. **Rupabheda** - Diversity in forms and appearances.
   b. **Sadrisyan** - Accurate depiction of the subject's likeness.
   c. **Bhava** - Creation of depth, expression, and radiance through colors.
   d. **Varnikabhanga** - Skillful blending of colors to achieve realistic effects.
   e. **Pramanam** - Proper proportion and symmetry in representation.
   f. **Lavanyayoganam** - Infusion of emotions and aesthetic grace.

Prehistoric Rock Paintings

1. The earliest known paintings in India were found on **rock shelters** and are called **Petroglyphs** (rock engravings).
2. The **Bhimbetka caves** in Madhya Pradesh hold the first discovered prehistoric paintings.
3. Paintings are categorized into **three major phases** based on historical periods.

Upper Paleolithic Period (40,000-10,000 BC)

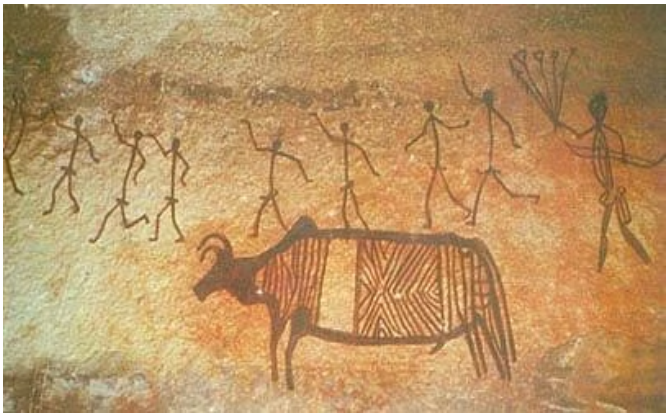
1. Quartzite rock shelters were used, and pigments were made from **minerals** like **ochre (geru) mixed with lime and water**.
2. A limited color palette included **red, white, yellow, and green**.
3. **Large animals** such as **bison, elephants, rhinos, and tigers** were depicted in **white, dark red, and green**.
4. **Human figures**: **Red was used for hunters, green for dancers**.

Mesolithic Period (10,000-4000 BC)

1. **Red was the dominant color** in this period.
2. **Paintings became smaller in size** than the previous period.
3. Common themes: **Group hunting scenes**, **Grazing activities**, **Riding scenes**.

Chalcolithic Period

1. Increased use of **green and yellow** in paintings.
2. Common depictions: **Battle scenes**, **Men riding horses and elephants**, **Armed figures with bows and arrows**, suggesting **war preparations**.



Bhimbetka Paintings

1. **Oldest paintings date back to ~30,000 years**.
2. Most paintings belong to the **Mesolithic period**, though traces of **Upper Paleolithic, Chalcolithic, Early Historic, and Medieval periods** are also found.
3. **Natural colors** used: **Red ochre, purple, brown, white, yellow, and green**. **Haematite ores** were used to produce red color.

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The Mural Paintings

1. The history of Indian murals starts in ancient and early medieval times, from the **2nd century BC** to the **8th - 10th century AD**.
2. 2 key characteristic of mural paintings -
   a. It is **organically connected with architecture**. It is the only form of painting that is truly three-dimensional, since it modifies and partakes of a given space.
   b. **Broad public significance** - A mural artist must visually interpret a **social, religious, or patriotic theme** on a **scale suited to both the wall's structure and the intended message**.

Features of Indian Mural Paintings

1. **Grand Scale & Visual Impact** - Murals **transform spaces**, turning plain walls into striking artworks. **Eg.** Shekhawati Murals (Rajasthan) cover entire havelis, depicting mythological and social themes.
2. **Narrative & Storytelling** - Murals **depict historical and cultural themes**, acting as visual records of India's past. **Eg.** Ajanta Caves Murals (Maharashtra) illustrate Jataka tales, showcasing Buddhist teachings.
3. **Community Engagement** - Many murals involve local participation, reflecting **regional identity and traditions**. **Eg.** Aravani Art Project (Bangalore) engages transgender artists to create murals expressing their stories.
4. **Emotional Resonance** - Murals **evoke strong emotions**, addressing **social issues, spirituality, or activism**. **Eg.** Kannagi Mural (Madurai) portrays the legendary Tamil heroine's tale of justice and devotion.
5. **Outdoor Public Art** - Murals in **public spaces make art accessible**, often carrying socio-political messages. **Eg.** Lodhi Art District (Delhi) features contemporary street art murals promoting cultural narratives.
6. **Vibrant Use of Color - Color choice enhances meaning**, setting the tone for the mural's message. **Eg.** Madhubani Murals (Bihar) use bold red, yellow, and black to depict Hindu epics and nature.
7. **Cultural Expression & Heritage** - Murals **preserve folklore, traditions, and religious beliefs**. **Eg.** Warli Paintings (Maharashtra) use simple geometric patterns to depict tribal life and rituals.
8. **Environmental Consciousness** - Modern murals often **promote ecological themes and sustainable practices**. **Eg.** Wall Art Project (Ladakh) features eco-conscious murals addressing climate change and water conservation.

Different types of Indian Mural Paintings

1. **Tempera Painting** - Uses **water-miscible pigments** mixed with a binding agent (typically egg yolk).
2. **Oil Painting** - Pigments are **suspended in drying oils** like linseed, allowing for rich texture and depth.
3. **Fresco Painting - Water-based pigments applied on fresh wet plaster**, making the colors bond with the surface. **Eg.** Ajanta Caves Murals (Maharashtra).

Other ancient Mural Paintings of India

1. **Ajanta Cave Paintings (2nd century BC - 5th-6th century AD)**
   a. Style: **Tempera technique** (pigments mixed with water-soluble binders)
   b. Themes: **Buddhism**, Jataka stories, Life of Buddha

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   c. **Key Features**:
      (a) Outlined in **red ochre**, unique hairstyles in female figures
      (b) Famous paintings: Padmapani (Avalokitesvara), Vajrapani, Manjusri, Dying Princess (Cave 16), Apsara

2. **Ellora Cave Paintings (Maharashtra)**
   a. Found in **5 caves**, mainly fragments on Kailashnath temple ceilings
   b. **Multi-religious themes**: Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism
   c. **Distinct Features**:
   d. **Angular bent limbs, sharp projected noses, long-drawn eyes**
   e. Murals created in **two phases** (during cave carving & later restoration)
3. **Bagh Cave Paintings (Madhya Pradesh)**
   a. **Extension of Ajanta school**, but with **stronger outlines** and tighter modeling
   b. **Cave No. 4 (Rang Mahal)** contains **more secular themes** compared to Ajanta
4. **Armamalai Cave Paintings (Tamil Nadu)**
   a. **8th-century Jain paintings.** Depicts **Astathik Palakas (deities protecting eight directions)**
   b. **Hybrid style**: Incorporates both **North and South Indian techniques**
5. **Ravan Chhaya Rock Shelter (Odisha)**
   a. Rock shelter resembling a **half-opened umbrella**
   b. **7th-century AD royal procession** depiction
   c. Also has **Chola-era paintings** (5th-9th century CE, **tempera technique**)
6. **Sittanavasal Cave Paintings (Tamil Nadu)**
   a. Dating: **1st century BC - 10th century CE**
   b. **Jain themes**, symbology, and **lotus pool scenes**
   c. **Stylistic resemblance** to Ajanta & Bagh murals
7. **Lepakshi Temple Paintings (Andhra Pradesh)**
   a. Period: **16th century (Vijayanagara period, King Achutaraya)**
   b. **Ramayana, Mahabharata, and Vishnu incarnations**
   c. **Decline in artistic quality** - black outlines, absence of primary colors
8. **Jogimara Cave Paintings (Chhattisgarh)**
   a. **Pre-Buddha era (1000-300 BC)**
   b. **Brahmi script inscriptions**
   c. **Themes**: Dancing couples, animals (elephants, fish)
   d. **Color Scheme**: White base plaster, **red outlines**, yellow & black accents
9. **Badami Cave Temple Paintings (Karnataka)**
   a. **Hindu themes**, **6th-7th century CE**
   b. Notable work: **Cave 3 mural of four-armed Brahma on a swan**
   c. **Recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site**
10. Nayaka Murals - an extension of the Vijayanagara style. Depict episodes from the Mahabharata and the Ramayana and also scenes from Krishna-Leela. Male figures are shown slim-waisted but with less heavy abdomen as compared to those in Vijayanagara. Eg. painting of Nataraja at Tiruvalanjuli

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Miniature Paintings

The term **"miniature"** is derived from Latin Minium (red lead paint), used in **illuminated manuscripts** during the **Renaissance**. **Flourished in India from the 6th-7th century** and developed distinct **regional schools** such as **Pala, Jain, Mughal, Rajasthani, and Pahari**.

1. The tradition of Indian miniature painting dates back to the **Buddhist Pala dynasty (8th-11th century)**.
2. It flourished under the **Mughal Empire (16th century)** but declined during **Aurangzeb's reign**.
3. The migration of artists led to the emergence of **regional schools** in **Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, and beyond**.

Techniques of miniature Paintings: Executed in the traditional tempera technique-

1. **Size Restriction**: Miniature paintings are typically **not larger than 25 square inches**.
2. **Scale of Subject**: The **main subject is painted at no more than 1/6th** of its actual size.
3. **Profile Representation**: **Few human figures** are depicted with a **visible front face**, while **most appear in side profile**.
4. **Color palette**: **Natural colors** (black, red, white, brown, blue, yellow) with **Krishna depicted in blue**.
5. **Traditional attire**: Men wear **turbans**, while women have **long hair** and wear **Indian clothing**.
6. Big eyes, pointed nose and slim waist, The skin colours of human beings are brown and fair.

Sub Schools of Miniature Paintings

Pala School of Art	• **It flourished in Bengal and Bihar under Buddhist patronage.** • **Palm leaf and paper manuscripts, featuring single figures, simple compositions, and soft, sinuous lines.** • **features fluid lines and muted tones, reflecting a naturalistic style akin to contemporary bronze and stone sculptures, with influences from Ajanta's classical art.** • **Eg. Illustrations of Vajrayana Buddhism, works by Dhimman and Vitapala.**

Apabhramsa School of Art (western school of art)	• This school traces its origin to Gujarat and Mewar region in Rajasthan. The dominant themes were **Jain**, later adopted by the **Vaishnava School**.
	• **This school is divided in two phases-**
	  ○ Illustrations made on palm leaf
	  ○ Illustrations made on paper
	• **Features**-fish shaped bulging eyes, a pointed nose and a double chin, angular faces in the third and fourth profile, stiff figures with ornamentation, animal and bird figurines in the paintings are represented as toys.
	• **Eg** -Kalpasutra and the Kalakacharya Katha from 15th century

Miniature Art during Delhi Sultanate	• Developed an Indo-Persian style of painting that drew heavily from schools in Iran and Jain paintings. • **Features- Groups of people standing in rows and identical poses**, narrow bands of decoration running across the width of the painting. • Manuscript called the **Nimat Nama** depicts scenes of food preparation. • Another style called **Lodi Khuladar** was also prevalent during this period.

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Mughal Era Miniature Painting	• The Mughal paintings are characterized by their subtleness and naturalism. • **Early Mughal painter- Bizhad** • Themes shifted from religious depictions to **court scenes, portraits, hunting expeditions, and historical events**. • Paintings showcased **brilliant colors, intricate detailing, and realism**, with a focus on **naturalism**. • Introduced the technique of **foreshortening**, making objects appear closer and smaller than they are. • **Famous painters of this period include**: Daswanth, Basawan and Kesu. • Prominent illustrated manuscripts during Akbar's reign are Tutinama, Hamzanama, Anvar-i-Suhaili and Gulistan of Sadi. **Humayun** • Humayun, during his exile in Persia, brought **Persian painters Abdus Samad & Mir Sayyid Ali** to India. • These artists laid the foundation for **Mughal miniature painting**, influencing later developments. **Akbar (1556-1605): Institutionalization of Mughal Painting** • Established a formal painting department, **Tasvir Khana**, where artists were **hired on salary**. • Focused on storytelling through **illustrated manuscripts** like: **Tutinama (Tales of a Parrot), Hamzanama (Adventures of Amir Hamza), Anwar-i-Suhaili, Gulistan of Sadi, Razmnama (Mahabharata translation)** • Introduced **3D figures and expressive faces**, blending Persian and Indian styles. • **Prominent artists**: Daswanth, Basawan, and Kesu. • **Persian masters: Mir Sayad Ali** and **Khwaja Abdus Samad** **Jahangir (1605-1627): The Golden Age of Mughal Paintings** • A **naturalist**, he encouraged realistic depictions of **flora, fauna, and human portraits**. • Shifted focus from illustrated manuscripts to **album paintings** with decorated margins. • **Famous artists**: Ustad Mansoor (expert in animal & bird studies). • **Notable paintings**: Realistic depictions of **Zebra, Turkey, Cock**, and an illustrated animal fable **Ayar-i-Danish**. **Shah Jahan (1628-1658): Shift Towards Opulence** • Moved away from naturalism, preferring **grandeur and decorative elements**. • Introduced **gold and silver detailing** and **brighter color palettes**. • Increased **European influence**, leading to **stiff postures and artificial compositions**. • Preferred **processions, festivals, court gatherings, and portraits** over dynamic storytelling. **Aurangzeb (1658-1707): Decline of Mughal Paintings**

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	• **Discouraged painting**, leading to the rise of **Provincial Mughal Schools**, especially in **Awadh**.
Deccani School of Miniature Painting	The **Deccani School of Miniature Painting** evolved as a **distinct offshoot of the Mughal tradition**, flourishing in the **Bahamani Sultanates-Bijapur, Ahmednagar, Golconda, Bidar, and Hyderabad**. Though politically opposed to the **Vijayanagar Empire**, the Deccan Sultanates drew **cultural influences** from Vijayanagar while also incorporating **Persian and Mughal elements**. • Early Deccani paintings show influences from **Ellora murals, Mewar and Malwa miniatures, and Persian traditions**. • Over time, **Mughal artists migrated** to the Deccan, blending **Persian, Mughal, and local Hindu styles** into a unique **Deccani Kalam**. • The **Deccani School** is recognized as one of the **four major miniature traditions** in India, alongside **Mughal, Rajasthani, and Pahari Schools**. Key Centers & Patronage: Bijapur (Ibrahim Adil Shah I & II), Ahmednagar, Golconda & Bidar Distinct Features: • Use of **rich colors**, **elongated figures**, and **ornate backgrounds**. • **Persian-style floral motifs** blended with **Indian themes**. • **Fantasy-like compositions** with an emphasis on elegance and sophistication. Later Developments & Decline: • As Mughal influence expanded, **Deccani artists adopted Mughal techniques**, leading to **hybrid styles**. • Despite this, the Deccani School **retained its distinct identity**, producing **exquisite court paintings**. Eg. Raga Vasanta, a Deccani miniature, exemplifies the fusion of Persian, Mughal, and local Deccan artistic traditions.
Rajput Paintings	• It thrived under the **Hindu Rajput rulers** of **Rajputana and Punjab Himalayas** from **1500 CE to the mid-19th century**. • Themes of Ramayana, the Mahabharata, Puranas, and Gita etc. were prominent. • Rajput paintings are classified into two major groups: • **Rajasthani School of Painting** • **Pahari School of Painting** (17th-19th century)
Pahari school of Painting	• These paintings were largely done in miniature painting forms throughout the era of the 17th to 19th centuries • Based on their regional diversity, Pahari paintings in India can be divided into two groups. Basohli and Kullu Style - Chaurapanchasika style Guler and Kangra Style - Calm colours and modification • **Nainsukh** was a famous master of the mid-18th century • **The central theme of Pahari painting is depiction of eternal love of Hindu deities Radha and Krishna**

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Rajasthani School of Painting	• Rajasthani paintings are those works that have been executed in Rajputana, from Bikaner to the border of Gujarat and from Jodhpur to Gwalior and Ujjain. • The **themes of the paintings were mostly religious and love subjects**, based on Lord Rama and Lord Krishna. Court scenes and royal portraits were also prominent themes. • **Characteristic**- Old outlines and brilliant colours. • Eg. themes from **Padmavati** by Malik Muhammad Jaisi, illustrations from the **Mahabharata, Bana Bhatta's Kadambari, and the Panchatantra**. • Rajput painting evolved into distinct regional styles in **Bundi, Kota, Jaipur, Mewar, and Kishangarh** **Mewar School** • Developed under **Rana Uday Singh and Rana Pratap**, fully evolving by **1571 CE** after artists migrated from **Mandu**. • **Sahibdin**, a 17th-century painter, played a key role in defining its style, focusing on **Ragamala, Ramayana, and Bhagavata Purana**. • **Ragamala paintings**, a hallmark of Rajput miniatures, depicted **raga (musical modes)** through vibrant colors and contemporary royal attire. • Later, court life became a dominant theme, particularly **tamasha paintings**, which captured **royal ceremonies and city views**. **Kishangarh School** • Developed under **Raja Savant Singh (1748-1757 CE)**. • **Famous Artist: Nihal Chand**, who modeled Krishna after **Sawant Singh** and Radha after **Bani Thani**. • **Style: Graceful female forms** with elongated **eyes, sharp noses, and arched lips** (Bani Thani style). **Bundi School** • Close to Mewar style; earliest painting **Chunar Ragamala (1561 CE)**. • Patronized by Krishna-worshipping kings, who ruled as **regents of Lord Krishna**. • **Themes**: Hunting, court life, festivals, processions, and Krishna's life. • Unique features: **Lush vegetation, dramatic night skies, swirling water patterns, and vibrant movement**. • **Human figures had round faces and pointed noses**, with skies often depicted in red and blue tones. • **Notable Work:** Ladies in the Garden-a **princess enjoying a pleasure scene**. **Amber-Jaipur School** • Originated in **Amber**, later flourished in Jaipur. • Strong **Mughal influence**, seen in detailed portraits and Krishna stories. • Used **large canvases, bright colors, and rich ornamentation**. • Popular themes: **Lord Krishna and Radha, Rajput princes, royal processions, festivals, and Mughal court life**. • Reached its peak under **Sawai Pratap Singh (18th century)**. **Marwar School**

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	• Encompassed **Jodhpur, Bikaner, and Jaisalmer**. • Early paintings (15th-16th century) had **Mughal influence**, later evolved into **bright, rhythmic compositions** with Rajput themes. • **Rulers like Man Singh (1803-1843)** commissioned extensive **Shiva Purana, Natya Charitra, Durgacharitra, Panchatantra** series. • Major centers included **Pali, Jodhpur, and Nagaur**, producing portraits, court scenes, and **Ragamala paintings**. **Kotah Kalam** • Matured under **Raja Umed Singh**, incorporating **Mughal naturalism**. • **Themes: Hunting scenes** with lifelike tigers and thick vegetation. • **Notable Works:** Portraits of **princesses and forest landscapes**. **Bikaner Kalam** • Strong **Mughal influence** due to Bikaner's close ties with **Mughal emperors**. • **Themes:** Court life, portraits, and social events. • **Famous Painter: Rukn-ud-Din**-known for his refined color sense and sophisticated details.
Miniature Paintings in South India	The tradition of **miniature painting** in **South India** developed independently, distinct from the **North Indian** styles, due to the **heavy use of gold, divine themes, and temple influences**. Unlike the **Rajput and Mughal** schools, these paintings focused more on **depicting gods and religious themes** rather than royal life. Tanjore Paintings (Tamil Nadu) • Originated in the **late 18th-19th century**, flourishing under **Maharaja Serfoji II of the Maratha dynasty**. • **Notable for: Gold leaf coating**, semi-precious stones, pearls, and **bold colors**. • **Themes:** Mostly **Hindu gods and goddesses**, with Krishna in various poses being a prominent subject. • Figures are **large, round-faced, and divine**, often with a **halo effect**. • Still practiced today, incorporating new subjects like **birds, animals, and architecture**. Mysore Paintings (Karnataka) • Evolved from the **Vijayanagar School** (1336-1565 CE). • **Features: Delicate lines, muted colors, intricate brushwork**, and **fine gold detailing**. • **Themes:** Hindu mythology, with **one figure predominating in size and color** over others. • **Distinctive Element: Gesso work** - an embossing technique using **white lead powder, gamboge, and glue**, later covered with **gold foil** to create intricate **clothing, jewelry, and temple designs**.
Modern Paintings	**Company Paintings (Colonial Period)** • A hybrid style that blended **Rajput, Mughal, and Indian techniques** with **European realism**.

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- Developed when **British officers** hired Indian artists trained in **traditional styles** but influenced by **Western perspective and shading**.
- **Themes:** Exotic **flora, fauna, landscapes, architecture**, and **Indian life**.
- **Notable Patrons:** Mary Impey, Marquess Wellesley.
- **Famous Artists: Mazhar Ali Khan, Ghulam Ali Khan**.

Bazaar Paintings

- Influenced by European art, but unlike **Company paintings**, they lacked Indian elements.
- **Key feature: Greco-Roman influence**-painters were asked to replicate **Greek and Roman statues**.
- Flourished in **Bengal and Bihar**.
- **Themes:**
  - **Everyday Indian bazaar scenes** with a **European backdrop**.
  - **Courtesans dancing for British officers**.
  - **Religious themes**, but **modified to suit European aesthetics** (Eg. Hindu gods depicted with natural human anatomy rather than multiple arms).

Bengal School of Art (Early 20th Century)

- **Founded by Abanindranath Tagore** as a reaction against **Western materialism** in Indian art.
- **Key Features:**
  - Soft, **simple colors** and **fluid brushwork**.
  - Inspired by **Swadeshi values** and **traditional Indian themes**.
  - Influence of **Japanese and Mughal styles**.
- **Notable Painters:**
  - **Abanindranath Tagore** - **"Bharat Mata"**, Mughal-themed paintings, Arabian Nights series.
  - **Nandalal Bose** - Known for **Dandi March sketch**, illuminated the **original Constitution of India**.
  - **Rabindranath Tagore** - Used **dominant black lines**, often linked to his literary works.
  - **Others:** Asit Kumar Haldar, Manishi Dey, Mukul Dey, Sunayani Devi.

Cubist Style of Painting

- Inspired by the **European Cubist movement** (Pablo Picasso, Georges Braques).
- **Concept: Objects are broken, analyzed, and reassembled** into abstract forms, balancing **lines and color**.
- **Key Indian Artist:**
  - **M.F. Husain - Frequent use of horses** as a **symbol of fluid motion**.
  - Used **bold strokes and fragmented figures** to depict **Indian mythology, history, and society**.

Indian folk paintings

Indian folk paintings are a **vibrant reflection of India's diverse cultural traditions**, deeply rooted in **regional customs, myths, and daily life**.

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Features of Indian Folk Paintings

1. Use of Natural Colors - Traditional folk paintings use natural dyes and pigments extracted from vegetables, minerals, flowers, and soil. Eg. Madhubani paintings use indigo, turmeric, rice powder, and red ochre.
2. Bold and Bright Colors - Characterized by vivid hues like red, yellow, blue, green, and black. Eg. Pattachitra paintings.
3. Simple and Stylized Figures - Human and animal figures are often two-dimensional, flat, and highly stylized. Eg. Warli paintings use stick figures to depict daily tribal life.
4. Religious and Mythological Theme - Many paintings depict Hindu gods, goddesses, and epics like Ramayana and Mahabharata. Eg. Thangka paintings portray Buddha, mandalas, and Tibetan deities.
5. Nature-Centric Themes - Inspired by flora, fauna, seasons, and village life. Eg. Gond paintings depict tigers, trees, and birds using intricate patterns.
6. Intricate Borders and Patterns - Paintings feature detailed geometric, floral, and ornamental borders. Eg. Phad paintings have elaborate narrative panels with decorative frames.
7. Narrative Storytelling - Many folk paintings depict continuous storylines through sequential panels. Eg. Cheriyal scroll paintings narrate stories from Ramayana and Mahabharata.
8. Absence of Perspective and Depth - Figures are arranged in hierarchical order rather than following natural perspective. Eg. Madhubani art places larger figures as more important.
9. Symbolic Representation - Use of symbols to convey deeper meanings. Eg. Kalamkari art represents lotus as purity, peacock as prosperity.
10. Handmade and Traditional Techniques - Painted on walls, cloth, palm leaves, scrolls, or paper using handmade brushes and organic materials. Eg. Saura paintings are drawn on mud walls using rice paste

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Chapter 6

Performing Arts & Material Culture

Dances of India

Dance is a rhythmic, ordered bodily movement, often set to music, expressing sentiments, illustrating events, or daily activities like hunting, warfare, or religious rituals. The dances performed in India are believed to trace their origins to the ritualistic dances mentioned in the Vedas, dating back to around 5000 BCE.

Some of the ancient treatise on dance and drama is the Nāṭyaśāstra, Abhinaya Darpana, Nartana Sarvaswam, Rāmāyaṇa, Mahābhārata and Harivaṁśa.

1. These dance forms are commonly performed during **festivals, cultural gatherings, college events, and other platforms**, reflecting **India's rich artistic heritage**.
2. India officially recognizes **eight classical dance forms**, as listed by the **Sangeet Natak Akademi**, the principal institution for preserving Indian performing arts.
3. The recognized classical dance styles include **Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kuchipudi, Odissi, Kathakali, Sattriya, Manipuri, and Mohiniyattam**. Additionally, the **Ministry of Culture** acknowledges **Chhau**, expanding the total to **nine** classical dance forms.
4. The key elements of Indian dance include:
    a. A movement technique encompassing facial expressions, head gestures, and body postures.
    b. Integration of vocal music, musical instruments, and literary themes drawn from Hindu mythology and ancient texts.
    c. Distinctive costumes, makeup, and stage settings. Eg. In Bihu dance, performers wear traditional Assamese attire like mekhola chaddar and dhoti, while in Rajasthan, dancers don lehenga and chunri.
    d. Indian classical dance consists of **three main components**:
    e. **Natya** - The dramatic aspect, involving character portrayal.
    f. **Nritta** - The rhythmic and technical movements.
    g. **Nritya** - The expressive element, incorporating gestures (**mudras**) to convey emotions.
    h. As communicative art forms, **Abhinaya** plays a key role in conveying ideas to the audience. It is classified into four types:
    i. **Āṅgikābhinaya**: Body movements (aṅga).
    j. **Vāchikābhinaya**: Use of words, songs, speeches, and narration.
    k. **Āhāryābhinaya**: Costumes, jewellery, make-up, props, and stage settings.
    l. **Sāttvikābhinaya**: Expression of inner emotions, feelings, and mental states outwardly.

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Overall features of Classical Dances

1. Classical dances are deeply rooted in ancient traditions, with their origins tracing back to the **Natya Shastra**, a treatise on performing arts written by the sage **Bharata Muni**. Eg. Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Odissi have roots in the Natya Shastra.
2. Classical dances are performed in synchronization with **Raga** (melody) and **Tala** (rhythm), which are key elements of Indian music. The dancer's movements reflect the mood and the rhythm of the music. Eg. In Kathak, dancers follow intricate rhythms and melodies set in different ragas and talas.
3. **Abhinaya** (expressions) and **Mudras** (hand gestures) are integral to conveying emotions and stories in classical dance. These help communicate the narrative to the audience. Eg. In Bharatanatyam, the dancer uses **Asamyukta and Samyukta Mudras** to express various characters and emotions.
4. Most classical dance forms present a story, often derived from **mythology**, **epic literature**, or **religious themes**, through **gestures**, **facial expressions**, and **movement**. Eg. In Kathakali, dancers perform elaborate stories from Hindu mythology, like the **Ramayana** and **Mahabharata**.
5. Dancers wear traditional costumes and use elaborate makeup, which helps in enhancing their facial expressions and overall visual presentation. Costumes vary according to the specific dance form but are generally ornate and symbolic. Eg. In Kathakali, dancers wear elaborate costumes and face paint representing different characters from mythology.
6. The dances also include elements of **ritualistic** offerings, especially in temple settings. Eg. Odissi is often performed in temples as an offering to the deities, with the dancer portraying divine figures.
7. Classical dance is traditionally learned through the **Guru-Shishya Parampara**, where the disciple learns under the direct guidance of a guru (teacher), maintaining the purity of the tradition.
8. Classical dances are highly narrative, often conveying stories through symbolic gestures and facial expressions. Eg. In Kathak, the dancer narrates stories through spinning and expressive hand gestures, often telling tales from the **Ramayana** or **Mahabharata**.

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Significance of Indian Classical and Folk Dances

1. Preservation of Cultural Heritage - Eg. Bharatanatyam, Kuchipudi, and Kathak reflect ancient temple traditions, while folk dances like Bihu and Garba represent local customs.
2. Medium of Storytelling - Indian dances serve as a powerful narrative medium, conveying stories from epics like Ramayana, Mahabharata, Puranas, and regional folklore.
3. Spiritual and Devotional Expression - Classical dances evolved in temples as offerings to deities, making them an intrinsic part of spiritual life. Eg. Bharatanatyam and Odissi are often performed as a form of Bhakti (devotion) to Lord Shiva or Krishna
4. Social Cohesion and Community Identity - Folk dances foster unity and a sense of belonging within communities, especially during festivals, harvests, weddings, and social gatherings. Eg. Bhangra in Punjab and Ghoomar in Rajasthan.
5. Symbol of Regional Diversity - Each classical and folk dance form reflects the unique cultural identity, language, attire, and traditions of its region. Eg. Manipuri dance highlights the culture of Manipur, while Lavani is specific to Maharashtra.

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6. Artistic Synthesis of Music, Drama, and Visual Art - Indian dances blend music, facial expressions, hand gestures (mudras), costumes, and stagecraft, offering a complete artistic experience.
7. Vehicle for Social and Political Messages - Many folk and classical performances have been used historically to spread social awareness, moral values, and resistance against oppression.
8. Economic and Tourism Significance - Dance festivals like Konark Dance Festival, Khajuraho Festival, and Surajkund Mela attract tourists, supporting artisans, performers, and local economies
9. Global Cultural Recognition - Eg. UNESCO has recognized dance forms like Koodiyattam and Chhau dance as Intangible Cultural Heritage.

Indian Music

1. Music is central to Indian culture, with deep historical roots. Mythology credits Narada Muni with introducing music, while a seven-holed flute from the Indus Valley Civilization reflects its ancient origin.
2. The **Sama Veda** and its Upaveda, the **Gandharva Veda**, highlight the spiritual and scientific importance of music.
3. Indian music is melodic in nature, as opposed to Western music which is harmonic.

Historical Background

The history of Indian music can be categorized into three major periods: Ancient, Medieval, and Modern. Below is a structured summary of the three major periods in Indian music:

1. Ancient Period (Vedic to 10th Century)

Time Frame: Vedic age to 10th century

Key Concepts

1. Early Indian music was tied to the Vedas, with Sama Veda being the foundation of music.
2. Vedic recitations began with one note, then gradually expanded to multiple notes and eventually stabilized with 7 basic notes (Saptaswaras).

Narada Parivrajakopanishad mentions the saptaswaras for the first time.

1. Ancient music was linked to rituals, yagas, and yagnas, where hymns were recited with instrumental accompaniment.

Kutapa: Early form of orchestral music.

1. Instruments: String and percussion instruments were used in group performances, but the concept of Raga had not yet emerged.
2. Musical Terms: Seven swaras, three gramas, twenty-one murchanas, and three layas (speeds).

Treatises

1. Bharata's Natya Shastra (2nd century): First detailed treatise on music, classified musical instruments and introduced the 22 microtones (Srutis).

Matanga's Brihaddharma Purana: Further developed theories of Ragas and Srutis.

Vedic texts: Mentioned seven solfa notes (sa, ri, ga, ma, pa, dha, ni).

1. Tamil Contributions: Ilango Adigal and Mahendra Verma contributed to the development of basic musical concepts in Tamil Nadu.

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2. Medieval Period (13th Century to 17th Century)

Time Frame: 13th century to 17th century

Key Developments

1. Hindustani and Carnatic Music: The bifurcation into two systems-Hindustani (North Indian) and Carnatic (South Indian) music.
2. Cultural Exchange: With the advent of Muslim rule in North India, there was significant interaction with Arabian and Persian music systems, enriching Indian classical music.
3. Bhakti Movement (7th century onwards): Led to the creation of devotional songs by saints such as Purandara Dasa, Annamacharya, Mira Bai, Surdas, Kabir, and others, utilizing regional languages to reach the masses.

Key Composers and Influencers

1. Purandara Dasa (15th century): Known as the 'Karnataka Sangita Pitamaha', simplified Talas and developed Sarali Varisa, Sapta Tala Alankaras, and Kirtanas.
2. Bhakti Saints: Composed devotional songs with simple rhythms and melodies, forming the basis for the later Carnatic music compositions.

Vidyaranya (14th century): Classified Ragas into 15 Melas.

1. Ramamatya (16th century): Mentioned 20 Melas in his treatise Swara Mela Kalanidhi.

Key Changes

1. Introduction of Raga Classifications: Raga system became more defined, with clear divisions between Melas and their Janya Ragas.
2. Chaturdandi Prakasika (17th century): Venkatamakhi's treatise, which detailed the 72 Melas and Raga Lakshanas.
3. Devotional Composers: The period saw prolific compositions in regional languages, with many new forms of music (Eg. Kritis, Swarajatis, and Varnas) emerging.

3. Modern Period (18th Century to Present)

Time Frame: 18th century to present

Key Developments

1. Golden Age of Carnatic Music: The late 18th century saw the rise of the Trinity of Carnatic music-Sri Shyama Shastri, Sri Tyagaraja, and Sri Muthuswami Dikshitar-who revolutionized the music scene with their compositions in complex Ragas and Talas.
2. Expansion of Musical Forms: The 18th century saw the composition of numerous Kritis, Swarajatis, Varnas, and Ragamalikas.
3. Instruments: Violin became an integral part of South Indian classical music. New techniques of fingering and tuning were developed to improve tonal quality and gamaka embellishments.
4. Western Influence: Western instruments like the Mandolin and Saxophone were incorporated into Carnatic music, and the concept of concert singing was formalized.
5. Music Notation: Preservation of music through notation systems began in the 19th century, making compositions more accessible to future generations.

Key Composers

1. Sri Shyama Shastri (1763-1827): Known for his scholarly compositions, mainly in praise of Goddess Kamakshi, and use of rare Ragas.

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2. Sri Tyagaraja (1767-1847): Composed over 1000 Kritis, many of which became the cornerstone of Carnatic music. His contributions to the development of Raga systems and Talas are immense.
3. Muthuswami Dikshitar (1775-1835): Composed scholarly Kritis on various deities, combining deep knowledge of Indian philosophy with music.
4. Swati Tirunal Maharaja (1813-1847): A prolific composer, his works contributed to both Carnatic and Hindustani traditions.

20th Century

1. Music Conferences and Seminars: Music sabhas, institutions, and associations became platforms for exchanging ideas and preserving musical traditions.
2. Technological Advancements: The advent of audio and video recordings helped in preserving the musical compositions for posterity.

Classical Music - The evolution of Indian music led to the emergence of Hindustani and Carnatic music as distinct subsystems. The terms were first used in Haripala's "Sangeeta Sudhakara" (14th century A.D.). The divergence between the two styles occurred after the Muslim influence, especially during the Mughal Empire.

Hindustani Music - Key elements

1. **Origins**: Hindustani and Carnatic music both originate from Bharata's Natyasastra, but diverged in the 14th century.
2. **Focus**: Hindustani music emphasizes musical structure and improvisation.
3. **Scale**: It adopts the **Shudha Swara Saptaka** (Octave of Natural Notes).
4. **Cultural Influences**: Combines elements from ancient Hindu tradition, Vedic philosophy, and Persian influences, enriched by Arab, Persian, and Afghan styles.
5. **Vocal Forms**: Major vocal forms include **Khayal**, **Ghazal**, **Dhrupad**, **Dhammar**, **Tarana**, and **Thumri**.
6. **Swara (Notes)**: In Hindustani music, swaras are the foundation of melody, akin to colors on an artist's palette. The seven primary notes - Sa, Re, Ga, Ma, Pa, Dha, and Ni - each have distinct characteristics, allowing for a wide range of expressive melodies. For Eg.
   a. **Sa**: Stabilizing tonic
   b. **Re**: Energetic and exciting
   c. **Ga**: Serene and beautiful
   d. **Ma**: Sweet and tender
   e. **Pa**: Solid and strong
   f. **Dha**: Melancholic and introspective
   g. **Ni**: Mysterious and intriguing
7. **Raga (Melodic Theme)**: melodic structures that define specific notes and phrases, each evoking distinct emotions and moods. Eg. **Rageshri** conveys love, **Yaman Kalyan** evokes majesty, and **Malkauns** expresses melancholy.
8. **Taal (Rhythm)**: It is the rhythmic framework of Hindustani music, with various complex cycles like **Teentaal** (16 beats), **Ektaal** (12 beats), **Jhoomra** (14 beats), **Dadra** (6 beats), and **Rupak** (7 beats). These patterns create texture and excitement in performances.
9. **Alankaar (Ornamentation)**: refers to musical embellishments such as **Meend** (glides), **Murki** (trills), **Gamak** (tremolos), **Khinch** (note bending), and **Sthai** (held notes). These ornaments add emotional depth and expressiveness to the music.
10. **Improvisation**: It allows musicians to spontaneously create melodies and rhythms within the framework of a raga and taal, reflecting their personal artistry and fostering creative exploration.

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11. **Transmission**: Historically passed down through the **Guru-Shishya Parampara**.
12. **Instruments**: Key instruments include **Tabla**, **Sarangi**, **Sitar**, **Santoor**, **Flute**, and **Violin**.

1. Dhrupad

1. One of the oldest and grandest forms of Hindustani classical music, mentioned in the **Natyashastra** (200 BC-200 AD).
2. It reached its peak during the reign of **Emperor Akbar**, with patronage from musical masters like **Baba Gopal Das, Swami Haridas, and Tansen** (one of Akbar's Navaratna).
3. A poetic form marked by precise, orderly raga elaboration. The performance typically begins with **Alap**, the longest portion of the presentation.

Dhrupad Gharanas:

a. **Dagari Gharana**: Emphasizes **Alap**, sung by the Dagar family.
b. **Darbhanga Gharana**: Combines **Alap** and composed songs.
c. **Bettiah Gharana**: Unique techniques, known only within the family.
d. **Talwandi Gharana**: Based in Pakistan, its practices have become challenging to maintain in Indian music.

2. Khayal

1. Derived from the Persian word for "idea" or "imagination."
2. Originated by **Amir Khusrau**, and offers greater improvisational scope.
3. Repertoire of short songs (2-8 lines), called **Bandish**, composed in a specific raga and tala.
4. Themes include **praise of kings, seasons, Lord Krishna's pranks, divine love, and sorrow of separation**.
5. Major **Khayal Gharanas**: **Gwalior**, **Kirana**, **Patiala**, **Agra**, and **Bhendibazaar**

3. Tarana

1. Focuses heavily on rhythmic patterns, with melody forming the structural base.
2. Requires expertise in rhythmic variations and fast-paced singing.
3. Developed by Amir Khusrau (13th-14th century) and later incorporated into compositions by Guru Gobind Singh (10th Sikh Guru).
4. **Pandit Rattan Mohan Sharma** of the **Mewati Gharana** is known as the world's fastest **Tarana** singer.

Sub-Classical Styles of Classical Music

1. Thumri

1. Known as "the lyric of Indian classical music," this style is expressive and often romantic.
2. Themes center around love, longing, and devotion, particularly stories from the life of Radha and Krishna.
3. Compositions are in **Brij Bhasha** and typically romantic or religious. Performed as the last item in a **Khayal concert**.
4. Major **Thumri Gharanas**: **Benaras**, **Lucknow**, and **Patiala**. **Begum Akhtar** is a prominent Thumri singer.

2. Thappa

1. Originally derived from folk songs sung by North-West Indian camel riders.
2. Gained recognition when introduced to the Mughal court of Emperor Muhammad Shah.
3. Notable performers include **Mian Sodi**, **Pandit Laxman Rao of Gwalior**, and **Shanno Khurana**.

3. Ghazal

1. A poetic and musical form used to convey love, loss, and separation, blending deep emotions with lyrical beauty.

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2. Originated in Iran (10th century) and flourished in India, particularly due to **Sufi mystics** and **Islamic Sultanate courts**. It reached its zenith during the **Mughal period**.
3. Notable poets include Rumi and Amir Khusrau (13th century), followed by Muhammad Iqbal and Mirza Ghalib in later periods.

Carnatic Music

1. The term Carnatic music originates from the Sanskrit phrase "Karnâtaka Sangîtam", meaning "traditional" or "codified music." It is based on a well-defined system of Ragam (melodic framework) and Thalam (rhythmic cycles).
2. Predominantly practiced in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka, representing the Dravidian cultural heritage.
3. Carnatic music uses a **seven-note system**, known as the **Sapta Swaras**
   a. **Sa** (Shadjam)
   b. **Ri** (Rishabham)
   c. **Ga** (Gandharam)
   d. **Ma** (Madhyamam)
   e. **Pa** (Panchamam)
   f. **Dha** (Dhaivatam)
   g. **Ni** (Nishadam)
4. **Vocal Range of Carnatic Music** - Carnatic music allows for an **extensive vocal range**, spanning from **deep lower octaves** to **melodious upper octaves**. Singers are expected to navigate through these ranges with **precision** and **emotional expression**, showcasing their vocal abilities.
5. **Melodic Nature** - Carnatic music is primarily **melodic**, focusing on the development of melodies through **sequential single notes**.
6. **Sruti Concept**: Sruti, the smallest detectable pitch interval, is fundamental in Carnatic music. It is often described as the frequency on an instrument (Ahata) or sung syllables (Swara). There are **22 srutis** in total.
7. **Importance of Gamaka**: **Gamaka** refers to the oscillations or embellishments of a swara, enhancing the raga's melody. It creates a soothing effect. Carnatic music generally follows **10 types of gamakas** today, though earlier texts mentioned 13-17.
8. **Improvisational Capacity** - Known for its **improvisational nature**, Carnatic music allows extensive creativity within the structured framework of ragas.
9. **Musical Forms of Carnatic Music:**
   a. **Gitam**: Simple and melodious raga composition.
   b. **Suladi**: A **talamalika** with different talas in sections.
   c. **Svarajati**: Composed of **Pallavi**, **Anupallavi**, and **Charanam**, often with devotional, heroic, or amorous themes.
   d. **Jatisavaram**: Known for rhythmical excellence and Jati patterns.
   e. **Varnam**: Unique to Carnatic music, interweaving **Svara group patterns** (Varnas).
   f. **Kirtanam**: Focuses on **devotional** content (**Bhakti Bhava**).
   g. **Kriti**: An evolved form of **Kirtanam**, highly sophisticated.
   h. **Pallavi**: A creative form allowing **improvisation**.

- **Purandardas** (1484-1564), a mystic and composer from Vijayanagar, is regarded as the father of **Carnatic music**.

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- **Venkatamakhi**, a prominent theorist of the 17th century, developed the **Melakarta system** to classify South Indian ragas, currently consisting of 72 Melakartas.
- The **Trinity of Carnatic Music** includes **Tyagaraja**, **Syama Sastri**, and **Muttusvami Dikshitar**.

Significance

1. Social and Cultural Insights

1. **Depiction of Society:** Music reflects the daily life, traditions, and social norms of different historical periods. Eg. Bhakti and Sufi music emphasized social harmony and devotion, transcending caste and religious barriers.
2. **Role in Social Gatherings**: Folk music portrays community bonding, festivals, and agricultural celebrations. Eg. Bihu songs (Assam) narrate agrarian life and harvest festivities.
3. **Gender Roles and Status:** Lyrics and themes in music highlight women's roles, love, and emotions in society. Eg. Thumri and Dadra (Hindustani music) depict the emotions of women, love, and separation.

2. Religious and Mythological Documentation

1. **Sacred Texts and Hymns**: Vedic chants and devotional compositions preserve religious teachings. Eg. Sama Veda (one of the four Vedas) forms the foundation of Indian classical music.
2. **Temple Traditions:** Eg. Carnatic music compositions by saints like Tyagaraja and Muthuswami Dikshitar were dedicated to Hindu gods.
3. **Mythological Narratives:** Music helps preserve and propagate epic stories from Ramayana and Mahabharata. Eg. Kirtans and Bhajans narrate tales from Hindu epics.

3. Political and Dynastic Influences

1. **Royal Patronage:** Many rulers supported and shaped musical traditions, reflecting political power and artistic preferences.
   a. Eg. Mughal Emperor Akbar patronized Tansen, leading to the growth of Dhrupad and Khayal styles.
   b. Eg. Chola and Vijayanagara kings encouraged Carnatic music development.
2. **Fusion of Cultural Elements:** Foreign influences integrated into Indian music through Persian, Islamic, and Western interactions.
   a. Eg. Amir Khusrau combined Persian and Indian elements, contributing to the development of Qawwali and Khayal.
   b. Eg. Western instruments like the violin were adapted into Carnatic music during the colonial period.

Folk Music

It refers to the music of ordinary people, as opposed to the formalized classical music tradition. Its name is derived from the German word volk, meaning 'people'. Originating as a traditional genre, it is closely linked with the folklore of specific regions.

General Characteristics of Folk Music

1. **Cultural Diversity**: Each region has its own unique style, instruments, and themes, representing the local traditions, customs, and beliefs. Eg. **Bhangra** from Punjab, **Garba** from Gujarat, **Lavani** from Maharashtra, **Kaili** from Uttarakhand

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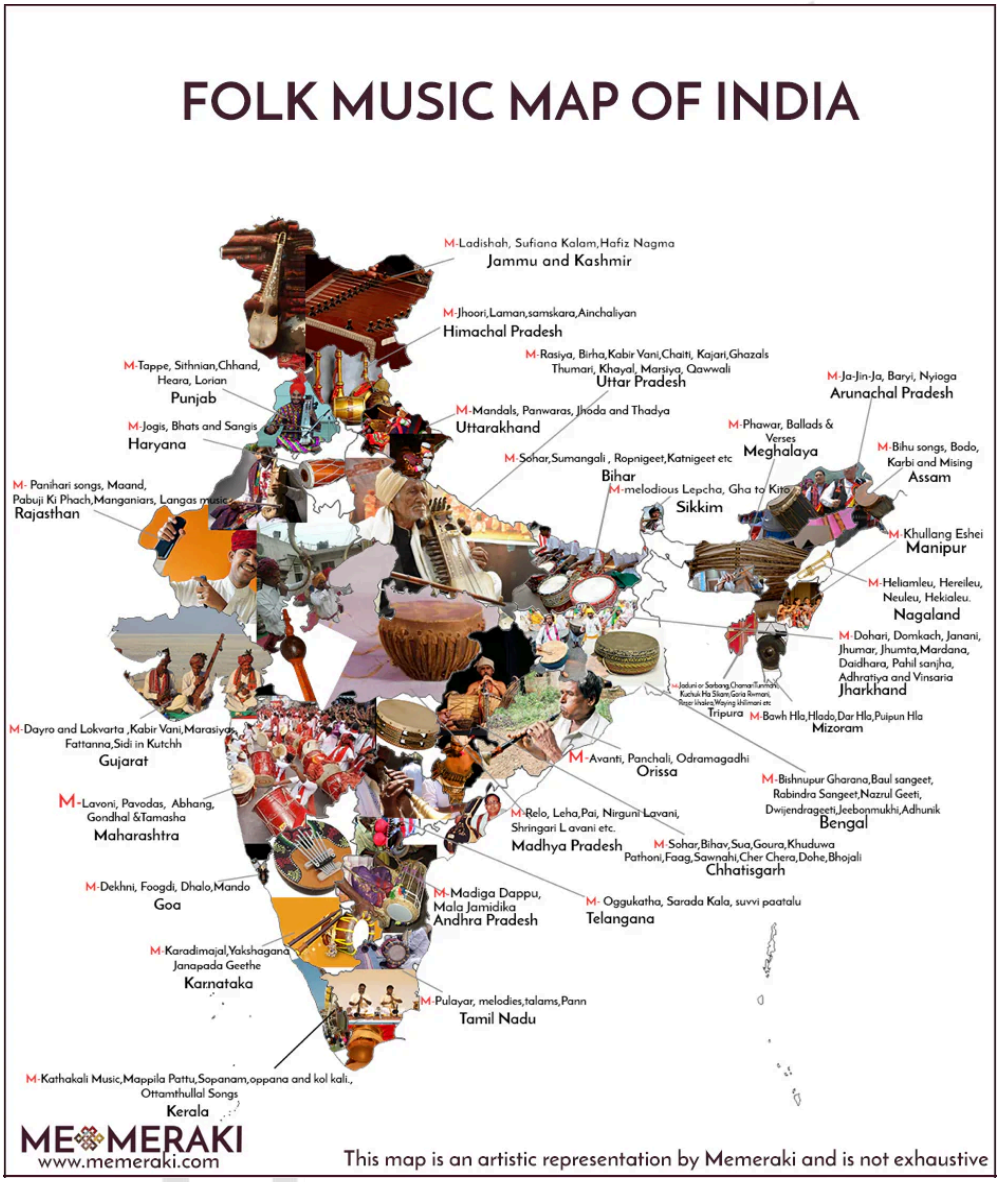
2. **Simple and Direct**: Folk music is typically simple, with easy-to-understand melodies and rhythms. The lyrics often deal with everyday life, emotions, nature, and community activities, making it accessible to all people.



3. **Community-Oriented**: Folk music is often performed as a communal activity. It brings together people from different walks of life, fostering a sense of unity. The songs are performed at local gatherings, festivals, and ceremonies.
4. **Oral Tradition**: Most folk music is passed down orally, with no formal notation. The songs and stories are shared through generations, with each performer adding their own interpretation or variation. Eg. **Baul** music of Bengal
5. **Rhythmic Simplicity**: Eg. **Dhol** beats in **Bhangra** music or the rhythmic pattern in **Koli** songs from Maharashtra are repetitive, simple, and easy to follow in group performances.
6. **Instruments**: Eg. Folk music makes use of local instruments like the **dholak** (in Punjab), **sarangi** (in Rajasthan), **ektara** (in Bengal), and **bansuri** (in Uttar Pradesh), which are integral to regional performances.

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7. **Theme and Lyrics**: The themes of folk music often revolve around love, social issues, religious stories, historical events, folk legends, and nature. The lyrics are often simple, poetic, and reflective of the life and struggles of the people.
8. **Improvisation**: Folk music allows a degree of improvisation, particularly in melodies and rhythms. The performers often add their own creative touch, making each performance unique.
9. **Role in Rituals and Festivals**: Folk music plays an important role in religious ceremonies, harvest festivals, weddings, and other traditional rituals. It is used to celebrate community life. Eg. **Baisakhi** in Punjab
10. **Emotional Expression**: Folk music is deeply connected with emotional expression, often conveying joy, sorrow, hope, or despair. TEg- **Lavani** (MH) - expressing intense emotions like love, longing, and passion through both music and dance.
11. **Folk Dance Integration**: Folk music is often closely linked with folk dance. The rhythms and melodies inspire local dances, which are performed in synchrony with the music during community events.
12. **Role of Storytelling**: Eg. Folk songs like the Rajasthani **"Pabuji ki Phach"** or **"Pandavani"** from Chhattisgarh tell stories of historical heroes and gods, passing cultural heritage through song and narration.

Indian Theatre

Evolution

1. The Indian theatre has a tradition going back to at least 5000 years.
2. The earliest book on dramaturgy anywhere in the world was written in India. It was called Natya Shastra, i.e., the grammar or the holy book of theatre by Bharat Muni. Its time has been placed between 2000 BCE to 4th Century CE.
3. Theatre in India started as a narrative form, i.e., reciting, singing and dancing becoming integral elements of the theatre. This emphasis on narrative elements made our theatre essentially theatrical right from the beginning.
4. That is why the theatre in India has encompassed all the other forms of literature and fine arts into its physical presentation: Literature, Mime, Music, Dance, Movement, Painting, Sculpture and Architecture - all mixed into one and being called 'Natya' or Theatre in English.

1. Sanskrit Theatre (Ancient India)

Sanskrit theatre developed between 200 BCE - 1000 CE, reaching its peak during the Gupta period (4th-6th century CE).

It consists of two major styles:

1. **Lokadharmi**: Realistic depictions of daily life and human behavior.

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2. **Natyadharmi**: Stylized gestures and symbolism, more artistic than realistic.

Types of Sanskrit Theatre

1. Nāṭaka - Large-scale plays with heroic themes, often based on epics (Eg. Shakuntala by Kalidasa).
2. Prakaraṇa - Social plays based on fictional stories (Eg. Mṛcchakaṭika by Shudraka).
3. Bhāṇa - A single-actor performance with satirical elements.
4. Vīthī - A short play with music and dance, often humorous.
5. Prahasana - Comedy plays mocking society.

Features of Sanskrit Theatre

1. Natya Shastra (by Bharata Muni) - The foundational text defining acting, gestures (mudras), emotions (bhavas), and sentiments (rasas).
2. Use of Rasas - Aimed at evoking emotions such as shringara (romance) and hasya (humor).
3. Integration of Dance and Music - Instruments like veena, flute, mridangam were used.
4. Elaborate Stagecraft - Open-air theatres with three sections (Rangashirsha, Nepathya, Ranga).
5. No Tragedy - Unlike Greek drama, Sanskrit plays always ended on a positive note.

Famous Sanskrit Playwrights

1. **Asvaghosa**: Known for "**Sariputraprakarana**," a humorous work promoting Buddhist teachings.
2. **Bhasa**: Authored "**Swapanavasavadatta**," with themes from **Ramayana** and **Mahabharata**.
3. **Sudraka**: Famous for "**Mricchakatika**," introducing conflict between hero, heroine, and villain.
4. **Kalidasa**: Renowned playwright with classics like "**Malavikagnimitra**," "**Vikramorvashi**," and "**Shakuntalam**."
5. **Bhavabhuti**: Known for "**Uttaramcharitra**," hailed as the best of its time.

Elements of Sanskrit Plays

Sanskrit plays followed a **ritualistic structure**:

1. **Pre-Play Rituals**: Music and dance performed behind the curtain.
2. **Puja**: Worship of the presiding deity for success.
3. **Prologue**: The leading actress introduced the play's time, place, and playwright.

Decline of Sanskrit Theatre

1. **Shift to Poetry**: Playwrights turned to poetry, reducing the popularity of drama.
2. **Rigid Orthodoxy**: Creative restrictions limited new playwrights.
3. **Religious Confines**: Sanskrit theatre became confined to religious themes.
4. **Muslim Invasions**: The invasions marginalized Sanskrit theatre, leading to its eventual decline.

2. Regional Folk Theatre (Ancient & Medieval India)

Folk theatre emerged as an oral and performance tradition, distinct from the classical Sanskrit plays.

Features of Folk Theatre

1. Indian folk theatre is classified into two categories: **Ritual Theatre** (religious) and **Theatre of Entertainment** (secular).
2. **Regional Language & Dialects** - Unlike Sanskrit drama, folk theatre used local languages.
3. **Improvisation & Spontaneity** - No fixed scripts, performers adapted to audience responses.
4. **Social & Religious Themes** - Often conveyed moral lessons or celebrated religious events.
5. **Use of Masks & Costumes** - Bright costumes and masks to represent characters like demons and gods.

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6. **Minimal Stage Setup** - Performed in open spaces, village squares, or temple courtyards.

Theatre as source of Information

1. **Social Commentary**:
   a. **Sanskrit theatre (Eg. plays by Kalidasa, Bhasa, and Shudraka)** adhered to the caste system, where Brahmins and Kshatriyas were depicted as noble characters, while lower castes had minor or comedic roles.
   b. **Folk theatre (Eg. Bhavai, Nautanki)** challenged these norms by giving voice to lower-caste communities and satirizing social inequalities. **Eg.** Mṛcchakaṭika (The Little Clay Cart) by Shudraka portrays a Brahmin courtesan falling in love with a noble but poor merchant, questioning rigid caste norms.
2. Bhakti Movement Influence: Raslila and Ramlila emerged to spread Vaishnavism and devotion to Krishna and Rama.
3. Sufi and Islamic Influence: Qisse and Dastangoi (storytelling traditions) reflected Persian and Mughal cultural integration in medieval India.
4. Politics and Kingship - Theatre often glorified rulers and their patronage, reinforcing the idea of dharma (duty) and righteous kingship. Eg. Sanskrit plays depicted ideal kings (Eg. Rama, Vikramaditya) as just, benevolent, and dharmic.
5. Economic Life - Eg. Mṛcchakaṭika (Shudraka) showcases a merchant class, economic disparity, and the influence of money in relationships and power dynamics.
6. Use of Humor & Satire to mock social norms, hypocrisy, and governance failures, engaging audiences while subtly questioning authority. Eg. Prahasana (comic plays) used humor to critique greedy priests and corrupt officials.
7. Cultural Preservation - Indian theatre preserves cultural, religious, and social traditions, showcasing myths, rituals, and values.
8. Education: It imparts moral lessons and historical knowledge, with performances often based on epics like the Ramayana and Mahabharata.
9. Artistic Fusion: Indian theatre combines music, dance, and drama, enhancing storytelling and emotional expression, as seen in Koodiyattam.
10. Regional Identity: Various regional forms like Bhavai and Yakshagana help nurture local cultural identities.

Indian theatre provides a window into the evolution of Indian society, from ancient caste structures and religious beliefs to medieval political dynamics and folk traditions. It highlights the struggles, aspirations, and moral dilemmas of different communities while preserving India's cultural heritage and storytelling traditions.

Coinage in India

The earliest reference to coins in India is found in the Vedas, where the term **'Nishka'** is used to describe coins made of metals. Panini's **Asthadhyayi** (c. 6th-5th BCE) refers to minted coins called **Karshapana** and **Sana** that were stamped (**ahata**) with symbols (**rupa**)

Classification of Coins

1. During the **Mahajanapadas period** (500 BC), the first Indian punch-marked coins called Puranas, Karshapanas or Pana were minted.
   a. These coins had irregular shapes, and a standard weight, and were made of silver and occasionally copper with different markings.

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   b. They lacked inscriptions of dates or kings' names. Common motifs included religious, mythological, and astronomical symbols, like sun, tree, dharmachakra, and animals like the elephant, bull, horse, tiger, and cow.
   c. Saurashtra coins featured a humped bull, Dakshin Panchala had a Swastika, and Magadha had five symbols.
   d. These are mentioned in the Manusmriti and Buddhist Jataka stories.
2. During the **Mauryan Period** (322-185 BC), these coins were referred to as Karshapanas
   a. Chanakya mentioned the minting of punch marked coins such as rupyarupa (silver), suvarnarupa (gold), tamrarupa (copper), and sisarupa (lead) in his Arthashastra treatise.
   b. Symbols of sun and six-armed wheel were the most consistent.
3. The **Indo-Greek** (189 BCE to 30 BCE)
   a. **Busts and Ruler Depictions**: The ruler's head or bust became a prominent feature on their coins. Eg. **Demetrius I** of the Indo-Greek Kingdom (circa 200-180 BCE) is depicted with his bust on coins.
   b. **Bilingual Legends**: Coins featured inscriptions in **Greek** on one side and **Kharosthi** script on the other. Eg. Coins of **King Menander I (Milinda)**
   c. **Hellenistic Symbols**: Common representations included Greek gods such as **Zeus**, **Heracles**, **Apollo**, and **Pallas Athene**. Eg. Coins of **King Apollodotus** feature **Greek gods** like **Zeus** and **Athena**.
   d. **Greek Artistic Influence**: Coins showed Greek artistic style, including fine details and realistic portraits of rulers.
   e. **Cultural Fusion**: Indo-Greek coins often blended Greek iconography with Indian symbols, showcasing the synthesis of Greek and Indian cultures during the period.
   f. **Use of Precious Metals**: Coins were primarily made of **gold** and **silver**, highlighting the economic prosperity during the Indo-Greek rule.
   g. **Commemorative Coins**: Eg. **Menander I** issued coins to commemorate his **military conquests**, with inscriptions referring to his **victories** and **expansion** of his kingdom in **North-Western India**.

Saka Coinage- Saka coinage was minted by the Western Kshatrapas from the 1st century CE

1. Saka Era Dating: Coins are dated using the Saka calendar, starting from 78 CE, Eg. coins of Rudrasimha II.
2. Ruler Depictions: Coins featured portraits of kings, such as Rudrasimha II, reflecting royal authority.
3. Bilingual Legends: Coins had inscriptions in Greek and Brahmi or Kharosthi, Eg. Chastana's coins.
4. Cultural Symbols: Common motifs included elephants, bulls, and fire altars, symbolizing royal and religious power.

Material: Coins were primarily made of silver, with some copper coins.

1. Distinctive Designs: Designs included fire altars and bulls, seen on coins of rulers like Nahapana.

Kushan Coins- Kushan coinage was issued by the Kushan Empire (1st to 3rd century CE), founded by the Yueh-chi tribe. The coins reflect a blend of Hellenistic, Iranian, and Indian influences.

1. **Gradual Indianization**: Initially influenced by **Greek** and **Persian** designs, Kushan coins later incorporated **Indian religious motifs** like **Shiva**, **Buddha**, and **cross-legged rulers**.
2. **Bilingual Inscriptions**: Coins featured inscriptions in **Greek** on one side and **Brahmi** or **Kharosthi** on the other, Eg. coins of **Kujula Kadphises** and **Kanishka**.
3. **Portraits of Rulers**: Coins prominently displayed the **portraits of rulers** in Greek style, Eg. **Kanishka's** bust on coins.
4. **Iconography**: Coins depict **Greek gods** (Zeus, Heracles) and **Indian deities** like **Shiva** and **Buddha**, signifying cultural fusion.
5. **Material Composition**: The Kushans issued coins in **gold**, **silver**, and **copper**, with **gold coins** being especially significant.

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Coins by Satavahanas

1. Satavahana kings (232 BC-227 AD) primarily used lead and an alloy of silver and copper known as "potin" as materials.
2. Iconography: Figures like elephants, horses, lions, or Chaitya on one side, and the Ujjain symbol - a cross with four circles at the end of the two crossing lines on the other.
3. Cowrie Shells served as another major medium of exchange by the common people for small-scale economic transactions

Coins Issued in Gupta Age (319-550 AD)

1. Gupta coins were primarily made of gold, although silver and copper coins were also issued.
2. Depictions on Coins: On one side, Gupta coins depicted the king engaged in various activities like playing the veena (Samudragupta), performing rituals, hunting animals etc.
    a. The other side often featured the goddess Lakshmi seated on a throne or a lotus seal, or the queen herself. Other deities featured included Durga, Ganga, Garuda, and Kartikeya.
3. For the first time, coins were inscribed in Sanskrit (Brahmi script)

Transition After Gupta Rule

1. Post-Gupta period coins were characterized by low metallic content and less artistic design.
2. A mix of designs borrowed from the Kushana-Gupta pattern as well as foreign designs, were employed by successor dynasties
3. South India's Gold Standard: In South India, a different coin paradigm emerged, moving toward a gold standard influenced by Roman gold coins.

Coins of Chalukya Kings (6th-7th century AD)

1. The Western Chalukyas had a temple or a lion on one side with the other side being blank.
2. The Eastern Chalukyas had a boar at the center, with each letter of the king's name in a separate punch. The other side was blank.

Coins of the Vardhanas (7th Century AD)

1. Vardhana silver coins featured the king's portrait on one side and a peacock on the other.
2. Harshavardhana's coins used a new era dating system, beginning most likely in 606 AD.

Coins of the Rajput Dynasties (11th-12th Century)

1. Coins were primarily made of gold, copper, or billion (a silver copper alloy), with silver being rarely used.
2. There were two types of Rajput Coinage:
    a. Displaying the king's name in Sanskrit on one side and a goddess on the other side.
    b. Silver coins with a seated bull on one side and a horseman on the other.

Coins of the Pandyan, Chola and Pallava Dynasty

1. Pandyan Dynasty: Early Pandyan coins were square-shaped with an image of an elephant. Later, fish became a significant symbol.
    a. Gold and silver coins had Sanskrit inscriptions, while copper coins had inscriptions in Tamil.
2. Chola Dynasty: Raja Raja-I's coins featured the standing king on one side and a seated goddess on the other, typically with inscriptions in Sanskrit.
    a. Rajendra-I's coins carried legends like 'Sri Rajendra' or 'Gangaikonda Chola' along with emblems of a tiger and fish.

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b. Pallava dynasty: Coins showcased the figure of a lion.

Delhi Sultanate Coins (1206-1526)

1. Sultans of Delhi issued gold, silver, copper, and billon coins featuring inscriptions with the king's name, title, mint's name and Hijri calendar date.
2. No images of issuing monarchs due to Islamic prohibition of idolatry.
3. Iltutmish introduced Silver Tanka and Copper Jital.
4. Alauddin Khilji replaced the Khalifa's name with self-praising titles.
5. Muhammad bin Tughlaq introduced bronze, copper coins, and token paper currency.
6. Sher Shah Suri established weight standards, rupee (silver), and dam (copper) and introduced the Rupee.

Vijayanagara Empire Coins(14th-17th century)

1. Gold, pure silver, and copper coins were issued by the Vijayanagara Empire.
2. Different coins for various purposes: Pagodas (higher denomination), Gold fanams (fractional units) [UPSC 2022], Silver taras (fractional units), and Copper coins (daily transactions).
3. Coins had inscriptions in Kannada or Sanskrit.
4. The coins were minted in places called Barkur Gadyanas and Bhatkal Gadyanas.
5. Images on coins included a double-headed eagle, a bull, an elephant, and Hindu deities.
6. Gold Vardhan coin by Krishna Deva Raya featured a seated Vishnu and a three-line legend Shri Pratap Krishna Raya in Sanskrit on the other side.

Mughal Coinage (1526-1707)

1. The Mughal standard gold coin was called Mohur (170-175 grains). Abul Fazl in 'Ain-i-Akbari' indicated that a Mohur was equivalent to nine rupees.
2. Mughal copper coin was derived from Sher Shah's dam, while Silver Rupee was adopted from Sher Shah's currency.
3. Akbar issued round and square coins. His "Ilahi coins" promoted his religious creed.
   a. Sahansah was the largest gold coin and featured the names of the Persian solar months.
4. Jahangir's coins included couplets, his wife Noorjahan's name, and Zodiac signs.
5. Other Coins
   a. Chhatrapati Shivaji issued gold huns and copper Shivarais with titles in Nagari script.
   b. Wodeyar dynasty (Mysore) coins featured the Narasimha avatar of Vishnu.
   c. Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan continued coinage with figures of Shiva, Parvati.

Numismatics as Source of Informations

Economic history

1. The use of metal and craftsmanship in the coin indicate the relative prosperity of the country. Eg. The gold coins of the Kushana and Gupta dynasty indicate general prosperity.
2. The high volume of foreign coins in a region indicates the prevalence of robust trade and commerce. Eg. Roman and Byzantine coins found in. South India, during the Sangam era, indicates deep trade ties between Rome and India.
3. Coins of Satavahana King Sri Yajana Satkanisha bear the image of two-masted shipl with a fish, highlighting an increase in maritime/trade activities

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Political history

1. The coins provide a reliable source of information about the political leadership of the time. Eg. coins bearing the face of King Meander, coins bearing the name of Prithviraj-Chauhan.
2. The existence of several dynasties is known solely because of the coins, as no other substantial evidence is to be found. Eg. Nagas of Mathura region, Malavas, Yaudheyas and Mitra rulers of Panchala.
3. Coins aid us in assessing the chronology of political leadership. Eg. dates on coins are an indication of coronation of kings.
4. The place of discovery of the coins give an indication about territorial extents of a kingdom

Cultural practices

1. Coins give a general indication about the cultural practices followed during the time. Eg. Gupta coins show the king playing veena, depicting the cultural importance of music
2. Coins also give an indication of the prevalent languages during different periods of history in different kingdoms. Eg. Chalukyan king Pulakesin I issued coins with Nagari and Kannada languages; Sanskrit language and Brahmi script used by Gupta kings.

Religious practices

1. Coins depict the popular religions, religious deities etc., during different phases of history. Eg. Kushana coins have the picture of God Shiva, Goddess Parvati, and Shaiva symbols like Nandi (bull) and trident.
2. Coins also depict the prevalence of secular and cosmopolitan culture. Eg. Images of the deities from countries like Iran, Bactria were depicted on Kushana coins; coins of Akbar depicting images of Goddess Sita and God Ram.
3. Kanishka issued coins bearing the images of Buddha, highlighting the prevalence of Buddhism during his reign.
4. Images of goddess Kali/Lakshmi were found in the coins of Chauhana rulers. The same coins were re-struck by Muhammad Ghori, with original images left untouched.

Coins are **valuable historical sources** that provide a deep understanding of **societal structures, cultural evolution, religious transitions, and linguistic diversity** in ancient and medieval India. Numismatics offers a **tangible record of India's rich and complex past**, shaping our understanding of its diverse traditions and transformations.

Martial Arts

Martial arts mean "arts concerned with the waging of war". Various Indian Martial arts have originated from various ancient war skills.

Origin of Martial arts in India

1. An Indus valley civilization seal shows two men spearing one another in a duel which seems to be centred on a woman. A statue of a spear thrower was also excavated from an Indus Valley site.
2. Dhanurveda, a section found in the Vedas (1700 BCE - 1100 BCE) contains references to martial arts
3. The Mahabharata tells of fighters armed only with daggers besting lions and describes a prolonged battle between Arjuna and Karna using bows, swords, trees, rocks and fists.
4. The oldest recorded organized unarmed fighting art in the Indian subcontinent is Malla-yuddha or combat-wrestling, codified into four forms in the Vedic Period.

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5. The Charanavyuhaauthored by Shaunaka mentions four upaveda (applied Vedas). Included among them are archery (Dhanurveda) and military sciences (shastrashastra)
6. A number of Indian fighting styles remain closely connected to yoga, dance and performing arts
7. Written evidence of martial arts in Southern India dates back to the Sangam literature of about the 2nd century BC to the 2nd century AD. The Akananuru and Purananuru describe the use of spears, swords, shields, bows and Silambam in the Sangam era.

Martial Arts as a Source of Information About Indian Society

1. **Social Hierarchy and Class System**
   a. Martial arts were often associated with **specific communities or warrior classes**, highlighting **caste-based military roles**.
   b. **Examples:**
   c. **Paika Akhada** was practiced by **peasant warriors** in Odisha, showing the participation of non-Kshatriya communities in defense.
   d. **Gatka** was developed by Sikh warriors, reflecting their **martial tradition** against Mughal oppression.
2. **Women and Martial Arts**
   a. Some Indian martial arts recognize **women warriors and their role in combat and self-defense**.
   b. **Examples:**
   c. **Velu Nachiyar**, a queen of Tamil Nadu, mastered **Silambam**, showing women's participation in war.
3. **Religious and Spiritual Influence**
   a. Many martial arts have **deep connections with religious beliefs, rituals, and spiritual practices**.
   b. **Examples:**
   c. **Thang Ta** of Manipur integrates **sword fighting with Tantric practices** and rituals.
   d. **Vajra Mushti** has connections to **Hindu mythology**, where the vajra (thunderbolt) symbolizes Indra's divine weapon.
4. **Military and Warfare Traditions**
   a. Indian martial arts were deeply integrated into **historical military strategies** and **guerrilla warfare tactics**.
   b. **Examples:**
   c. **Mardani Khel** was used by the Marathas in guerrilla warfare against the Mughals.
   d. **Paika Akhada** fighters played a key role in the **Paika Rebellion of 1817** against the British.

Martial arts in India are more than just combat techniques; they reflect **social structures, religious beliefs, regional identities, and military history**. They help us understand the **dynamism of Indian society**, showcasing how different communities adapted and preserved their traditions through physical combat, discipline, and cultural expressions.

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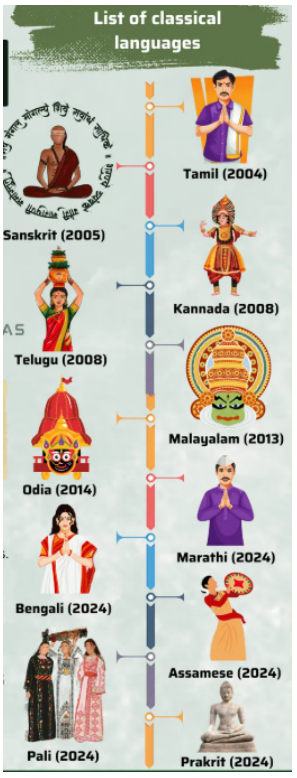
Chapter 7

Language, Literature & Cultural Legacy

Classical Language

Recently, Union Cabinet has approved Classical Language status to Marathi (Maharashtra), Pali and Prakrit (Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh), Assamese (Assam) and Bengali (West Bengal) languages.

About Classical Language



1. Classical Languages serve as a custodian of India's profound and ancient cultural heritage, embodying the essence of each community's historical and cultural milestone.
2. In 2004, the Government of India, for the first time, created a new category of languages known as Classical Languages.
   a. The Linguistic Experts Committee (LEC) was constituted by the Ministry of Culture under Sahitya Akademi in 2004 to examine the proposed languages for the status of Classical Language.
3. **Criteria were revised in 2005 as following**
   a. High antiquity of its early texts/recorded history over a period of 1500-2000 years.
   b. A body of ancient literature/texts, which is considered a valuable heritage by generations of speakers.
   c. The literary tradition is original and not borrowed from another speech community.
   d. The classical language and literature being distinct from modern, there may also be a discontinuity between the classical language and its later forms or its offshoots.

1. Criteria for declaring a language as classical was again revised by LEC in 2024. 'Original literary tradition' norm was dropped from revised 2005 criteria as LEC observed that it was 'very difficult to prove or disprove original literary tradition as all ancient languages borrowed from each other'.
2. Earlier, six Indian languages namely **Tamil (2004), Sanskrit (2005), Telugu & Kannada (2008), Malayalam (2013) and Odia (2014)** were accorded the status of Classical Language.
3. All these Classical Languages are listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.

Benefits of Conferring Classical Language Status

1. **Financial Support**: Classical status ensures increased funding for research, academic exploration, and the preservation of the language.
2. **Documentation and Conservation**: It promotes efforts to document, conserve, and digitize ancient texts, ensuring their accessibility for future generations.
3. **Cultural Identity**: Enhances awareness and strengthens the linguistic identity of speakers, fostering pride in the language's cultural contributions.

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4. **Employment Opportunities**: Jobs in archiving, translation, publishing, and digital media are created through the preservation and digitization efforts.
5. **Study Centres**: Dedicated centres for studying these languages are established in universities, enhancing scholarship and visibility (Eg. **Central Institute of Classical Tamil**).

Steps taken to promote classical languages

1. **Dedicated Institutions:**
   a. **For Sanskrit:** Rashtriya Sanskrit Sansthan, New Delhi; Maharishi Sandipani Rashtriya Ved Vidya Pratishthan, Ujjain; Rashtriya Sanskrit Vidyapeetha, Tirupati; etc.
   b. **For Telugu and Kannada**: Centres of Excellence for Studies in respective languages at Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL) established in 2011.
2. **National Education Policy, 2020:** Focuses on promotion of all Indian Languages including classical languages.
3. **University Grants Commission** supports the creation of Professional Chairs in central universities and research institutions, focusing on the classical languages of India.
4. **National Mission for Manuscripts:** Its key objectives are documentation, conservation, digitization and online dissemination of manuscript heritage of India.
5. Most of the Indian scripts have been used for writing; 70% of manuscripts are in the Sanskrit language. The other 30% of manuscripts are in languages like Assamese, Bengali, Malayalam, Marathi, Odia, Tamil etc.
6. **National and international awards:** Several national and international awards have been introduced to recognize and encourage achievements in the field of Classical Languages

What are the Challenges Associated

1. **Diminished Native Speakers**: Many classical languages, such as Pali and Prakrit, no longer have active native speakers, which makes preservation efforts difficult. Languages like Pali have been out of everyday use for centuries.
2. **Lack of Digital Resources**: The process of digitizing ancient manuscripts and making them accessible is slow and costly. There is a significant gap in bringing classical language texts into the digital era.
3. **Limited Educational Integration**: Despite being classical, these languages are often not integrated into mainstream education systems. Many of these languages are not taught in schools, leading to a loss of knowledge among younger generations

Way Forward

1. **Expand Educational Outreach**: Classical languages should be integrated into school curricula, particularly in regions where these languages were historically spoken. Eg. integrating Prakrit and Pali into university studies.
2. **Digital Preservation**: Governments should prioritize digitizing ancient texts to make them widely available. Tamil, which has benefitted from extensive digitization efforts, serves as a good example of how this can be done
3. **Promote Public Awareness**: Cultural events, academic conferences, and community outreach programs should be organized to raise awareness about the importance of preserving classical languages. Collaboration with international universities can further expand research efforts

By conferring this status, the government seeks to protect the linguistic milestones of India's diverse cultural landscape, ensuring that future generations can access and appreciate the deep historical roots of classical languages.

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Literature

Indian literature is a complex mixture of religious, cultural, and spiritual beliefs that reflect the country's multidimensional social fabric. It spans over 3,000 years encompassing a vast variety of thoughts, philosophies, emotions, and aspirations of the Indians.

Literature in Ancient India

1. **Vedic Literature** - The Vedic literature is the oldest layer of Indian literature, primarily written in **Vedic Sanskrit**. Vedic literature forms the foundation of **Hindu philosophy** and **rituals** and provides insight into early **Indian society** and **religion**.

Key Texts

1. Rigveda: The oldest and most important Veda, consisting of hymns dedicated to gods and nature.

Yajurveda: Contains rituals and sacrificial formulas.

Samaveda: Composed of melodies and chants for rituals.

Atharvaveda: Contains hymns, spells, and incantations.

1. **Epic Literature** - The epics of ancient India, written in **Sanskrit**, are two of the most significant and influential works in world literature. These epics reflect the ideals of **dharma** (duty) and the complexities of human nature, influencing art, culture, and philosophy.

Key Texts

1. Mahabharata: An epic that tells the story of the Kurukshetra war and the fate of the Kauravas and Pandavas. It includes philosophical teachings, especially in the Bhagavad Gita.
2. Ramayana: The tale of Rama, his exile, and his battle to rescue Sita from the demon Ravana, embodying ideals of dharma and virtue.

1. **Classical Sanskrit Literature** - Classical Sanskrit literature developed after the Vedic period and is rich in drama, poetry, and philosophy. Sanskrit literature represents the height of intellectual and artistic achievement in **classical India**, with its profound influence on culture, drama, and philosophy.

Key Texts

1. Kalidasa's Plays: Works like Shakuntala and Meghaduta are among the finest examples of classical Sanskrit drama and poetry.
2. Bhagavata Purana: A key text of Hindu mythology, focusing on the life and deeds of Lord Krishna.
3. Mahakavyas: Epic poems like Raghuvamsa by Kalidasa, focusing on royal lineages and valor.

1. **Buddhist and Jain Literature-** Literature from **Buddhism** and **Jainism** was mostly written in **Pali**, **Prakrit**, and **Sanskrit**. Buddhist and Jain literature promotes **ethical teachings**, **philosophical reflection**, and **spiritual knowledge**.

Key Texts

1. Pali Canon (Tipitaka): The central scriptures of Theravada Buddhism, consisting of Vinaya (rules), Sutta (sermons), and Abhidhamma (philosophy).

Jataka Tales: Stories about the previous lives of Buddha in various forms.

1. Jain Agamas: Scriptures of Jainism, which include teachings of Mahavira and the practice of ahimsa (non-violence).

1. **Prakrit Literature** - Prakrit was the vernacular language of ancient India, used in both religious and secular literature. Prakrit literature reflects the cultural and social lives of common people and offers a contrast to the elite Sanskrit literature.

Key Texts

1. Gatha Saptashati: A collection of Prakrit poetry by King Hala, famous for its simple and emotional verses.

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2. Jain and Buddhist texts: Many important religious texts were also written in Prakrit.

1. **Philosophical and Scientific Literature** - Ancient Indian philosophical literature, written in **Sanskrit** and **Prakrit**, forms a significant part of the intellectual heritage. These works laid the foundation for **Indian philosophy**, **statecraft**, and **spirituality**, influencing global thought.

Key Texts

1. Upanishads: Philosophical texts exploring metaphysics, Brahman (universal soul), and Atman (individual soul).
2. Arthashastra: A treatise on political science and economics by Kautilya (Chanakya).
3. Yoga Sutras: Written by Patanjali, the text outlines the philosophy and practice of yoga.

1. **Secular Literature** - Ancient secular literature in **Sanskrit** and **Prakrit** includes poetry, plays, and historical texts. Secular literature highlights **art**, **entertainment**, and **human emotions**, contributing to Indian cultural life.

Key Texts

1. Kalidasa's Plays: Known for their beauty and depth, such as Abhijnanasakuntalam and Vikramorvashiyam.
2. Bhasa's Dramas: The earliest known plays in Sanskrit, focusing on mythological and historical themes.

Features of Sanskrit Literature

1. **Oral Tradition and Early Codification**: Sanskrit literature was initially transmitted orally through **Vedic hymns** and later codified into **written texts**. It evolved into **two main categories**:
   a. **Vedic Sanskrit**: Includes the **four Vedas (Rigveda, Yajurveda, Samaveda, Atharvaveda)**, along with **Brahmanas, Aranyakas, and Upanishads**.
   b. **Classical Sanskrit**: Encompasses **epics, poetry (Kavya), dramas (Nataka), scientific texts, and philosophical treatises**. Eg. **Panini's Ashtadhyayi** (4th century BCE) laid the foundation for Sanskrit grammar.
2. **Language and Grammar:** unlike spoken dialects which constantly change, the **literary form of Sanskrit became stationary** around the 4th century B.C. This stabilization was largely due to **Panini** whose grammar was so thorough that no change was permitted thereafter
3. **Diverse Literary Forms and Genres**: Sanskrit literature includes **religious scriptures, philosophical discourses, epics, plays, fables, scientific writings, and historical chronicles**. Eg. **Panchatantra (by Vishnu Sharma)**-a collection of fables teaching moral lessons.
4. **Sacred and Secular Balance**: While early Sanskrit texts were **spiritual and ritualistic**, later literature covered **secular themes**, including governance, ethics, astronomy, and medicine. Eg. **Charaka Samhita** and **Sushruta Samhita** are foundational texts in **Ayurveda**.
5. **Influence on Language and Linguistics**: Sanskrit played a **pivotal role in shaping Indian linguistic traditions**, contributing to **Prakrit, Pali, and vernacular languages**.

Sanskrit Literature Examples

1. **Kalidasa's Meghaduta (lyrical poem) and Abhijnanasakuntalam (play)** represent the peak of Sanskrit literary elegance.
2. **Arthashastra (by Kautilya)**: Discusses **statecraft, economics, taxation, and trade regulations**, offering insights into governance and wealth management.
3. **Manusmriti**: Defines **occupations and duties of different varnas**, outlining social and economic structures.
4. **Yajurveda**: Mentions **agriculture, animal husbandry, and metallurgy**, highlighting early economic activities.

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5. **Sanskrit Drama and Natya Shastra**: Bharata's **Natya Shastra** (dramaturgy text) influenced **Indian classical dance, theater, and music**. Eg. **Sanskrit plays like Mricchakatika (by Shudraka)** depict social realism.
6. **Bhagavad Gita and Ramayana**: Themes of **dharma, righteousness, and devotion** are depicted in **paintings and sculptures**. **Harshavardhana's court patronized Banabhatta**, who wrote **Harshacharita (biography of Harsha)**.
7. **Sanskrit Buddhist and Jain texts** influenced religious discourses beyond India, spreading to **China, Tibet, and Southeast Asia.** Eg. **Buddhist Sanskrit texts like Lalitavistara Sutra** were translated into Chinese and Tibetan.
8. Sanskrit Literature's Influence on Vernacular Languages
9. **Panchatantra stories influenced Persian, Arabic (Kalila wa Dimna), and European literat**
10. **Hemachandra's grammar influenced Prakrit and Apabhramsha development**
11. **Aryabhata's Aryabhatiya** and **Bhaskara's Siddhanta Shiromani** contributed to **astronomy and mathematics**.

Pali and Prakrit Literature

Both languages were widely spoken in India after the Vedic period. Prakrit, in its broadest sense, referred to any language that deviated from Sanskrit, the standard language. Pali is an archaic form of Prakrit and was adopted by Buddhist and Jain traditions as their sacred language. Lord Buddha delivered his sermons in Pali.

Buddhist Literature

Features of Buddhist Literature

1. **Oral Tradition and Codification**: Initially passed down orally, Buddhist teachings were codified around the **4th-3rd century BCE** in **Pali and Sanskrit**, forming the basis of Buddhist scriptures.
2. **Diverse Literary Forms and Languages**: Buddhist texts cover **scriptures (Nikayas and Agamas), chronicles (Mahavamsa, Dipavamsa), Jataka tales, commentaries (Atthakatha), and Mahayana sutras**. These were written in **Pali, Sanskrit, Chinese, Tibetan, and regional Indian languages**. Eg. **Lalitavistara Sutra**, a **Sanskrit Mahayana text**, details Buddha's life story.
3. **Emphasis on Dhamma (Righteousness) and Nirvana**: Buddhist literature revolves around **ethical living, mindfulness, and the path to enlightenment**. Eg. **Dhammapada**, a collection of **Buddha's verses**, teaches moral discipline and wisdom.
4. **Language**: **Pali** and **Sanskrit** are the primary languages of Buddhist literature. **Eg.** The **Pali Canon** (Tipitaka) in **Pali**, while **Mahayana** texts like the **Lotus Sutra** and **Heart Sutra** are primarily in **Sanskrit**.
5. **Canonical Texts**: **Tipitaka (Pali Canon)**: Divided into three sections:
   a. **Vinaya Pitaka**: Rules for monastic discipline.
   b. **Sutta Pitaka**: Discourses of the Buddha.
   c. **Abhidhamma Pitaka**: Philosophical analysis of mental and physical phenomena.
   d. **Eg.** The **Dhammapada**, a part of the **Sutta Pitaka**, is one of the most widely read and translated Buddhist texts.
6. **Jataka Tales**: Stories of the **Buddha's previous lives**, focusing on moral teachings and virtues. **Eg.** The **Jataka Tales** contain stories like **The Monkey King** and **The Golden Goose**, each imparting moral lessons and wisdom.

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7. **Philosophical Teachings**: Focus on core concepts such as **Four Noble Truths**, **Eightfold Path**, **impermanence**, and **Anatta (no-self)**. **Eg.** The **Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta** (The Turning of the Wheel of Dharma) is one of the Buddha's first sermons, introducing the **Four Noble Truths**.
8. **Dialogues and Discourses**: Buddhist texts often present teachings in the form of dialogues between the **Buddha** and his disciples or others. **Eg.** The **Samyutta Nikaya** is a collection of **discourses** that include dialogues between the **Buddha** and various seekers, exploring topics like suffering, mindfulness, and liberation.
9. **Moral and Ethical Focus**: Emphasis on **non-violence (Ahimsa)**, **compassion (Karuna)**, and the practice of **right conduct**.
10. **Poetry and Metaphor**: Buddhist literature often uses **poetry**, **metaphors**, and **parables** to express deep philosophical ideas. **Eg.** The **Dhammapada** is composed in verse and uses poetic language to convey moral teachings, such as "We are what we think. All that we are arises with our thoughts."
11. **Inclusion of Both Prose and Verse** to aid in memorization and oral transmission. **Eg.** The **Jataka Tales** are written in both prose and verse, with some parts in narrative prose and others in verse form.
12. **Religious and Devotional Themes**: includes **prayers**, **hymns**, and **chants** dedicated to the **Buddha** and **Bodhisattvas**. **Eg.** The **Namo Amituofo** chant is a central devotional prayer in **Pure Land Buddhism**, praising **Amitabha Buddha**.

Features of Jain Literature

1. **Codification:** Around the 4th century BCE, Jain disciples compiled Agamas in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit, forming the core Jain scriptures. Eg. The 12 Angas, considered Mahavira's direct teachings, reflect early codification.
2. **Diverse Genres and Languages:** Jain texts include Agamas (canonical texts), Puranas (mythological stories), Champus (romantic epics), and Kathas (narrative poems), written in Prakrit, Sanskrit, Tamil, Kannada, and Hindi. Eg. Naladiyar, a Tamil Jain text, conveys ethical teachings.
3. **Language**: **Prakrit** was the primary language used for Jain scriptures, though **Sanskrit** was also used for later texts. **Eg.** The **Agamas**, the core texts of **Jainism**, were composed in **Ardha-Magadhi Prakrit**.
4. **Religious Texts**: Jain literature is centered around religious texts that define Jain philosophy, ethics, and rituals. **Eg.** The **Tattvartha Sutra** by **Umaswati** is a key philosophical text, providing a comprehensive summary of Jain doctrine, including concepts like **karma**, **ahimsa (non-violence)**, and **moksha (liberation)**.
5. **Philosophical Teachings**: Jain literature focuses on the concepts of **ahimsa** (non-violence), **anekantavada** (the doctrine of non-absolutism), and **samyak darshana** (right perception). **Eg.** The **Samaysar** by **Acharya Kundkund** is a philosophical text that discusses the nature of the soul and how one can attain spiritual liberation through right conduct.
6. **Ethics and Morality**: Jain texts emphasize the ethical practices of non-violence, truth, non-stealing, celibacy, and non-possession. **Eg.** The **Sutrakritanga** is a Jain scripture that outlines the code of ethics for ascetics and laypeople, with a focus on purity and non-violence.
7. **Historical and Biographical Accounts**: Jain literature contains biographical works on the lives of the **Tirthankaras** and other prominent figures in Jainism. **Eg.** The **Kalpasutra** is a key text that provides biographical details of the **Tirthankaras**, especially **Lord Mahavira**.
8. **Didactic and Instructional Nature**: Jain literature is often instructional, offering guidelines for personal development and spiritual advancement. **Eg. Acharya Bhadrabahu's** teachings in the **Mahavir Charita** are dedicated to explaining the path of asceticism and spiritual discipline.

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Tamil (Sangam) Literature

The earliest Tamil literature is called Sangam Literature, referring to an association of Tamil poets in ancient South India. Tamil legends mention three Sangams: Madurai, Kapadapuram, and Thenmadurai. Sangam literature is classified into:

1. Aham: Subjective love poetry
2. Puram: Objective public and heroic poetry

Sangam literature comprises 18 works-8 anthologies and 10 long poems, known for their direct expression. Composed by 473 poets, including 30 women, Avvaiyar being the most famous.

Notable Sangam Texts

1. Tolkappiyam: Tamil grammar text.
2. Thirukkural (by Thiruvalluvar): A moral and practical guide to noble living with secular themes.
3. Silappadikaram (by Ilango Adigal) and Manimekalai (by Chattanar): Twin Tamil epics, providing detailed accounts of Tamil society.

Persian Literature in India

Features of Persian Literature

1. Introduction to India and Patronage: Persian literature entered India with the Ghaznavids and Ghurids (10th-12th centuries CE) and flourished under the Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Empire. It became the official language of administration, court poetry, and historical chronicles. Eg. Amir Khusrau, a court poet of Alauddin Khalji, wrote extensively in Persian, blending Indian and Persian themes.
2. Diverse Literary Forms: Persian literature in India includes historical chronicles, poetry, Sufi mysticism, philosophical writings, and translations of Sanskrit texts. Eg. Babur's Tuzuk-i-Baburi is a Turkish memoir later translated into Persian.
3. Influence of Sufi Thought and Mysticism: Persian literature deeply influenced Indian Sufi traditions, emphasizing love, devotion, and unity with the divine. Eg. Masnavi of Rumi and Diwan of Hafiz became popular in Indian Sufi circles.
4. Blend of Indo-Persian Culture: Indian themes, idioms, and folklore blended into Persian writings, enriching both language and literary style. Eg. Amir Khusrau's poetry includes Hindavi influences, creating an early form of Urdu literature.
5. Persian as the Language of Administration: Persian was the court language of the Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Empire, shaping legal, diplomatic, and bureaucratic documents. Eg. Ain-i-Akbari (by Abul Fazl) records Akbar's administration, policies, and social conditions.

Examples

1. Ziauddin Barani's Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi describes economic policies, taxation systems, and trade regulations under the Delhi Sultanate. Eg. Fatawa-i-Jahandari discusses market control and price regulation under Alauddin Khalji.
2. Persian literature reflects the hierarchical Mughal and Sultanate courts, emphasizing etiquette and administrative ranks. Eg. Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri records courtly traditions and interactions between the emperor and nobles.
3. Eg. Ain-i-Akbari provides details on land measurement, taxation, and agrarian economy.Baburnama and Humayun Nama mention women's roles in administration, diplomacy, and cultural patronage.

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4. Persian Sufi texts influenced Indian Bhakti and Sufi movements, promoting spiritual inclusivity and religious harmony. Eg. Fawaid-ul-Fu'ad by Amir Hasan Sijzi records Nizamuddin Auliya's teachings on divine love.
5. Eg. Amir Khusrau's Persian-Hindavi compositions led to the emergence of early Urdu poetry.
6. Eg. Dara Shikoh's Persian translation of Upanishads (Sirr-i-Akbar, 1657) facilitated Hindu-Muslim philosophical dialogue.

Philosophical Impact of Persian Literature

1. Ethics and Moral Philosophy Eg. Saadi's Gulistan and Bostan, widely read in India, imparted moral wisdom and ethical governance.
2. Sufism and Mysticism Eg. Rumi's Masnavi and Hafiz's Ghazals inspired Sufi thought and Bhakti traditions in India.
3. Persian Historiography and Political Philosophy Eg. Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi by Ziauddin Barani explores political theory, justice, and governance.
4. Interfaith Dialogue and Syncretism Eg. Dara Shikoh's Persian works emphasized harmony between Hindu and Islamic philosophies.
5. Influence on Islamic Jurisprudence and Governance Eg. Fatawa-i-Alamgiri (compiled under Aurangzeb) codified Islamic law in Persian.

Bhakti Literature

Characteristics of Bhakti literature include the following

1. **Religious Focus**: Bhakti literature is centered around practices such as chanting the divine names, self-surrender, and deep devotion to personal gods as a path to salvation. Examples include Mirabai's Raag Govinda and Meera ki Malhar (praise for Krishna), as well as Thirumurai, a collection of hymns dedicated to Shiva.
2. **Non-Orthodox Nature**: Nirguna saints, like Kabir, rejected idol worship. Kabir, in particular, was critical of both the Vedas of Hinduism and the Quran of Islam.
3. **Non-Sectarian Approach**: Bhakti literature stresses that all gods are the same, albeit known by different names, promoting an inclusive, non-sectarian outlook. Passages from Kabir's Bijak and the poetry of Sufi poet Baba Farid were included in the Guru Granth Sahib, a reflection of this inclusivity.
4. **Regional Influence**:
   a. **Use of Vernacular Languages**: Bhakti saints wrote in local languages, enabling wider participation from various societal groups. For example, Mirabai's songs were in Rajasthani, Basavanna's Vachana Sahitya in Kannada, Tulsidas in Sanskrit and Awadhi.
   b. **Geographic Spread**: The Bhakti movement began in South India in the 7th to 8th centuries CE and gradually spread northwards, reaching regions like Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Assam, Bengal, and northern India by the 15th century.

Contributions of Bhakti Literature to Indian Culture

1. **Vernacular Language Development**: Bhakti literature contributed to the promotion of regional languages, such as Sankardeva's Brajavali and the Nayannars' influence on Tamil.
2. **Literary Contributions**: Bhakti saints enriched regional literatures, including Narshinh Mehta in Gujarati, Jnanadev in Marathi, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu in Bengali, and Vallabhacharya's impact on Telugu literature.
3. **Musical Influence**: Bhakti poets like Purandara Dasa (Carnatic music) and Sankardeva (Borgeet) introduced new forms of music. The Abhangas, devotional poems of Maharashtra's Varkari saints, are another notable contribution.

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4. **Dance Contributions**: Bhakti culture led to the creation of traditional dances such as Sattriya in Assam, Jhatra in Bengal, and ecstatic dance forms associated with Chaitanya Mahaprabhu.
5. **Theatrical Contributions**: Bhakti literature also influenced dramatic arts, with forms like Ankia Naat and Bhaona gaining prominence in regional performances.
6. **Philosophical Growth**: Bhakti thought contributed to philosophical developments, such as Sankaracharya's Advaita (non-dualism) and Ramanujacharya's Vishistadvaita (qualified non-dualism).
7. **Promotion of Secular Values**: Bhakti literature often promoted secular ideals. Dadu Dayal, for example, rejected formalism and priestcraft, advocating Hindu-Muslim unity through his poetry.
8. **Roots of Feminism**: Bhakti literature challenged patriarchal norms. Female saints like Mirabai, who rejected her marriage to Raja Bhojraj, and Akka Mahadevi, who walked away from her marriage, were trailblazers. The rise of female saints, including Lal Dev of Kashmir, also contributed to this movement.
9. **Social Reforms**: Bhakti literature emphasized equality before God, bringing spirituality to marginalized communities. Saints like Basavanna and Ravi Das opposed caste and social hierarchies, while Guru Nanak critiqued unnecessary rituals and pilgrimages.

Examples of Bhakti literature

Book	Author	Significance
Raag Govinda	Mirabai	A devotional hymn in praise of Krishna, reflecting Mirabai's deep love and devotion. It emphasizes the personal relationship with the divine.
Meera Ki Malhar	Mirabai	A collection of songs praising Krishna, symbolizing devotion and surrender to God, and is part of the Bhakti movement's emphasis on emotional devotion.
Thirumurai	Various Saints	A compendium of hymns in praise of Lord Shiva, particularly by the Nayanmar saints of Tamil Nadu, contributing to Tamil devotional literature.
Bijak	Kabir	A collection of Kabir's verses, critiquing religious orthodoxy and promoting a non-sectarian, personal devotion to the divine, blending Hindu and Muslim traditions.
Borgeet	Sankardeva	A form of devotional song composed by Sankardeva in Assam, contributing to the Bhakti movement's musical and theatrical expressions.
Vachana Sahitya	Basavanna	A collection of poetic verses in Kannada, emphasizing devotion to Lord Shiva and advocating for social equality and spiritual liberation.
Bhagavad Gita	Vyasa (relevant to Bhakti tradition)	Though primarily a philosophical text, the Bhagavad Gita emphasizes devotion to Krishna (Bhakti) as a means to liberation, integral to the Bhakti movement.
Abhangas	Sant Tukaram	Devotional poetry dedicated to Vithoba (a form of Lord Krishna) and emphasizing the importance of surrendering to God, deeply influencing Marathi devotional practices.

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Book	Author	Significance
Ankia Naat	Sankardeva	A form of Assamese theatre linked to the Bhakti movement, combining dance, music, and devotional themes to spread the message of devotion.
Guru Granth Sahib	Compiled by Guru Arjan and others	A sacred scripture combining writings from Sikh Gurus and other saints, including Sufi poets and Bhakti saints like Kabir and Baba Farid, promoting unity and devotion.

Scientists of Ancient India

Mathematics and Astronomy

Baudhayan

1. Baudhayana was an Indian Mathematician who was born in 800 BC(Later vedic time) and dies in 740 BC. He was a Vedic brahmin priest.
2. He was the first-ever Indian Mathematician who came up with several concepts in Mathematics.
3. The value of pi was first calculated by him.
4. He is said to be the original founder of Pythagoras's Theorem
5. What is known as Pythagoras theorem today is already found in Baudhayan's
6. Śulbasûtra is one of the oldest books on advanced Mathematics. Sulbasutras is all about rules for religious rites.
    a. This book contains several important mathematical results. This book contains 3 chapters.
    b. In all these 3 chapters, he has written how he has calculated the value of pi, calculated the square root of 2, and circled the area of the square and worked on Pythagoras theorem.
7. This book has geometric solutions of a linear equation in a single unknown

Aryabhatta

1. Aryabhatta was a fifth century mathematician, astronomer, astrologer and physicist. He was a pioneer in the field of mathematics
2. Aryabhatta was a contemporary of Gupta ruler Chandragupta II, who was also known as Chandragupta Vikramaditya.
3. **He wrote Aryabhattiya**
    a. In the first section he describes the method of denoting big decimal numbers by alphabets.
    b. In the second section, we find difficult questions from topics of modern day Mathematics such as number theory, geometry, trigonometry and Beejganita (algebra).
    c. The remaining two sections are on astronomy.
    d. Aryabhatta showed that zero was not a numeral only but also a symbol and a concept.
    e. Discovery of zero enabled Aryabhatta to find out the exact distance between the earth and the moon.
    f. The discovery of zero also opened up a new dimension of negative numerals.
    g. He also gave a scientific explanation for solar and lunar eclipse clarifying that the eclipse were not because of Rahu and/or Ketu or some other rakshasa (demon,).

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Brahmgupta

1. In 7th century, Brahmgupta took mathematics to heights far beyond others
2. In his methods of multiplication, he used place value in almost the same way as it is used today.
3. He introduced negative numbers and operations on zero into mathematics.
4. He wrote Brahm Sputa Siddantika through which the Arabs came to know our mathematical system
5. Brahmagupta moved to Ujjain, Avanti, a major centre for astronomy in central India. At the age of 67, he composed his next well-known work Khanda-khādyaka, a practical manual of Indian astronomy in the karana category meant to be used by students

Bhaskaracharya

1. Bhaskaracharya was the leading mathematician and Astronomer of the 12th century
2. He became head of the astronomical observatory at Ujjain, the leading mathematical centre in India at that time. Outstanding mathematicians such as Varahamihira and Brahmagupta had worked there and built up a strong school of mathematical astronomy.
3. Bhaskara wrote to Siddhanta Shiromani at the age of 36 in 1150 AD. In his book he wrote on his astronomical observations of planetary positions, conjunctions, eclipses, cosmography, geography, the mathematical techniques and given the references of many of the instruments used by the astronomers before him.
4. It is divided into four sections: Lilavati (Arithmetic), Beejaganit
5. (Algebra), Goladhyaya (Sphere) and Grahaganit (mathematics of planets).
6. Bhaskara introduced Chakrawat Method or the Cyclic Method to solve algebraic equations. This method was rediscove**red six centuries later by European mathematicians, who called it inverse cycle**

Mahaviracharya

1. Mahaviracharya was a 9th-century Jain mathematician born near Mysore, in southern India. He was born in the year 815 AD.
2. He used to work with Rashtrakuta king Amoghavarsha and applied his mathematical skills to do something good for society.
3. There is an elaborate description of mathematics in Jain literature (500 B.C
4. -100 B.C).
5. Jain gurus knew how to solve quadratic equations. They have also described fractions, algebraic equations, series, set theory, logarithms and exponents in a very interesting manner.
6. Jain Guru Mahaviracharya wrote Ganit Sara Sangraha in 850A.D., which is the first textbook on arithmetic in present day form.
7. The current method of solving Least common Multiple (LCM) of given numbers was also described by him

Science

Kanad

1. Kanad was a sixth century scientist of Vaisheshika School, one of the six systems of Indian philosophy.
2. His original name was Aulukya.
3. He got the name Kanad, because even as a child, he was interested in very minute particles called “kana”.
4. His atomic theory can be a match to any modern atomic theory.
5. According to Kanad, the material universe is made up of kanas, (anu/atom) which cannot be seen through any human organ. These cannot be further subdivided. Thus, they are indivisible and indestructible.

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6. **In this book, Kanad Rishi has shown the characteristics of religion in this way.** Yatobhyudayanihshreyasiddhih sa dharmah. That is, the religion in which both Abhyudaya (happiness and prosperity of this world) and Nishreyas (transcendental salvation) can be achieved.

Varahamihira

1. Varahamihira, also known as Varaha or Mihira, (born 505, Ujjain, India-died 587, Ujjain) was an Indian philosopher, astronomer, and mathematician who wrote the Pancha-siddhantika ("Five Treatises"), a collection of Greek, Egyptian, Roman, and Indian astronomy.
2. His astrological abilities finally caught the attention of Vikramaditya Chandragupta II, who made him one of his court's Nine Gems.
3. He was one of the first scientists to claim that termites and plants could be the indicators of the presence of underground water.
4. He gave a list of six animals and thirty plants, which could indicate the presence of water.
5. He gave very important information regarding termites (Deemak or insects that destroy wood), that they go very deep to the surface of water level to bring water to keep their houses (bambis) wet.
6. Another theory, which has attracted the world of science is the earthquake cloud theory given by Varahmihira in his Brhat Samhita. The thirty second chapter of this samhita is devoted to signs of earthquakes. He has tried to relate earthquakes to the influence of planets, undersea activities, underground water, unusual cloud formation and abnormal behaviour of animals.
7. Another field where Varahamihira's contribution is worth mentioning is Jyotish or Astrology

Nagarjuna

1. Nagarjuna was a tenth century scientist(metallurgist).
2. The main aim of his experiments was to transform base elements into gold, like the alchemists in the western world.
3. Even though he was not successful in his goal, he succeeded in making an element with gold-like shine. Till date, this technology is used in making imitation jewellery.
4. In his treatise, Rasaratnakara, he has discussed methods for the extraction of metals like gold, silver, tin and copper.

Medical Science In Ancient India (Ayurveda & Yoga)

Susruta

1. Sushruta lived 2000 years ago in the ancient city of Kashi, now known as Varanasi or Banaras in the northern part of India
2. Sushruta is the father of surgery.
3. His works are compiled as Sushrutaa Samhita. He describes 60 types of upkarma for treatment of wounds, 120 surgical instruments and 300 surgical procedures, and classification of human surgeries in eight categories.
4. Susruta's greatest contribution was in the fields of Rhinoplasty (plastic surgery) and Ophthalmic surgery (removal of cataracts). In those days, cutting of nose and/or ears was a common punishment

Charak

1. Charak is considered the father of ancient Indian science of medicine.
2. He was the Raj Vaidya (royal doctor) in the court of Kanishka.
3. His Charak Samhita is a remarkable book on medicine. It has the description of a large number of diseases and gives methods of identifying their causes as well as the method of their treatment.

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4. In Charak Samhita, more stress has been laid on removing the cause of disease rather than simply treating the illness. Charak also knew the fundamentals of genetics.

Yoga & Patanjali

1. The science of Yoga was developed in ancient India as an allied science of Ayurveda for healing without medicine at the physical and mental level.
2. The term Yoga has been derived from the Sanskrit work Yoktra. Its literal meaning is "yoking the mind to the inner self after detaching it from the outer subjects of senses"
3. The credit of systematically presenting this great science goes to Patanjali.
4. In the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali, Aum is spoken of as the symbol of God. He refers to Aum as a cosmic sound, continuously flowing through the ether, fully known only to the illuminated.
5. Besides Yoga Sutras, Patanjali also wrote a work on medicine and worked on Panini's grammar known as Mahabhasaya.

Application of Ancient Science and Technology in the Modern World

1. Mathematics and Astronomy

1. The Pythagorean theorem, originally documented in Baudhayan's Sulva Sutras, is fundamental in modern architecture, engineering, and physics.
2. It is extensively used in GPS technology, satellite positioning, and geospatial mapping.
3. Aryabhatta and the Concept of Zero
   a. The introduction of zero as a numeral and a concept revolutionized mathematics.
   b. It forms the basis of computer programming, binary coding, and AI algorithms.
   c. Aryabhatta's trigonometric contributions aid modern astronomy in calculating planetary orbits.
4. Brahmagupta and Algebraic Advancements
   a. The use of negative numbers and zero in arithmetic operations is crucial in financial modeling, economics, and data science as shown in Brahm Sputa Siddhantika
   b. The Chakrawat method, rediscovered in Europe as the inverse cycle, is used in modern cryptography and advanced numerical computations.
   c. His calculations of planetary movements aid in modern astrophysics and space research.
5. Mahaviracharya's Work on LCM and Algebraic Equations
   a. His early work on the Least Common Multiple (LCM) is applied in computing, time synchronization, and electronic circuits.

2. Science and Metallurgy

1. Kanad's Atomic Theory
   a. His concept of indivisible particles (anu and paramanu) laid the foundation for modern atomic theory and quantum physics. Today, particle physics and nanotechnology apply similar principles in material sciences.
2. Varahamihira's Earthquake and Water Detection Theories
   a. His observations on underground water detection using plants and termites are applied in hydrology and groundwater surveys.
   b. The earthquake cloud theory, linking atmospheric changes to seismic activities, aligns with modern disaster prediction techniques.
3. Nagarjuna's Metallurgical Contributions
   a. His work on metal extraction techniques influenced modern metallurgy and material science.
   b. The imitation gold technology is still used in the jewelry industry.

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3. Medicine and Surgery (Ayurveda & Yoga)

1. Sushruta's Contributions to Surgery
   a. His advancements in plastic surgery (rhinoplasty) are widely used in reconstructive and cosmetic surgery today.
   b. The use of specialized surgical instruments inspired modern surgical tools.
2. Charak's Medical Science and Genetics
   a. The principles in Charak Samhita, emphasizing disease prevention and holistic health, align with modern preventive healthcare.
   b. His insights into genetics relate to hereditary diseases and modern genetic research.
3. Patanjali's Yoga and Mental Health
   a. Yoga's benefits in stress management, cardiovascular health, and neurotherapy have been validated by modern science.
   b. It is widely used in psychotherapy, physical rehabilitation, and wellness programs worldwide.

Ancient Indian science and technology provided fundamental principles that are still relevant today. Their concepts and discoveries have evolved into sophisticated modern applications in fields like mathematics, medicine, metallurgy, and engineering. By integrating ancient knowledge with modern advancements, we continue to innovate and solve contemporary challenges.

Foreign Travellers in India

Reasons for Foreign Visitors

1. **Religious Exploration:** Buddhist scholars like Hiuen Tsang visited India to study the origins and practices of Buddhism.
2. **Trade and Commerce:** Merchants were drawn to India's flourishing trade networks and vibrant markets, seeking economic opportunities.
3. **Cultural Exchange:** India's rich traditions in arts, philosophy, and literature intrigued foreign scholars eager for intellectual engagement.
4. **Diplomatic Missions:** Emissaries like Megasthenes were sent to establish political and economic ties with Indian rulers.
5. **Scientific Inquiry:** India's advancements in astronomy, mathematics, and medicine attracted scholars eager to learn from its intellectual heritage.
6. **Historical Documentation:** Travellers like Ptolemy aimed to record India's geography, society, and historical developments.

Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
Megasthenes	Greece	Mauryan Empire, Pataliputra, India	3rd Century BCE	Chandragupta Maurya	• Described India as a quadrilateral-shaped country. • Noted India's great prosperity, abundant metals, crops, and water resources.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
					• Mentioned the absence of famines and the practice of two annual crops. • Described Indian society as diverse, with no slavery and with women in roles such as palace guards. • Criticized fantastical stories such as tribes with eight toes or snake-like legs.
Fa-Hien	China	Lumbini, Pataliputra, Tamralipti, Sri Lanka	399-412 CE	Chandragupta II (Gupta Empire)	• Highlighted India's well-ordered society and liberal administration under Gupta rule. • Observed that the majority of Indians followed a vegetarian diet, with Chandalas (untouchables) engaging in hunting and fishing. • Praised Ashoka's palace and the emperor's religious tolerance. • Described trade networks, mentioning ports like Cambay, Sopara, and Tamralipti.
Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)	China	Nalanda, Pataliputra, various Buddhist sites	629-645 CE	Harsha (Gupta Empire)	• Described India as a land of education, fine arts, and literature, with a thriving intellectual life.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
					• Noted the rigid caste system, but also the provision of education to women. • Mentioned the practice of Sati and highway robberies. • Detailed India's exports (cloth, sandalwood, spices) and imports (gold, silver, horses).
Al-Biruni	Uzbekistan	Punjab, Northern India	11th Century	Mahmud of Ghazni	• Conducted a comparative study of Indian society through extensive use of Sanskrit texts. • Criticized ritual pollution but acknowledged the intellectual and mathematical prowess of Hindus. • Observed that social divisions, including caste, were not unique to India. • Described Indian society as self-absorbed and isolated from other cultures. • Highlighted scientific advancements in mathematics, astronomy, and medicine.
Ibn Battuta	Morocco	Delhi, Malabar Coast, Bengal, Assam, Sumatra, Maldives	14th Century	Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Delhi Sultanate)	• Praised the agricultural prosperity of India, noting two crop cycles per year.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
					• Detailed India's well-organized postal system and efficient trade routes. • Observed the prosperous and densely populated cities, although disrupted by occasional wars. • Noted the threat of highway robbers and praised the role of women in commerce.
François Bernier	France	Mughal Empire, Delhi	17th Century	Aurangzeb (Mughal Empire)	• Criticized the absence of private land ownership and lack of long-term investment in agriculture. • Described India as a society with a small wealthy ruling class and a large impoverished population. • Observed that cities relied heavily on the imperial court, without much independent economic development. • Detailed the role of women, especially in agriculture and commerce, and described the practice of Sati.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
Athanasius Nikitin	Russia	Bahmani Sultanate, Bidar, Perwattum	1469-1472 CE	Mahmud Gawan (Bahmani Sultanate)	• Described the Bahmani Sultanate and its markets, where horses, brocade silk, and enslaved people were traded. • Witnessed war games involving elephants and observed the ongoing wars between the Bahmani Sultanate and Vijayanagara. • Referred to Perwattum as "the Jerusalem of the Hindus," acknowledging its religious significance.
Domingo Paes	Portugal	Vijayanagara (Krishnadevaraya 's reign)	1520 CE	Krishnadevaraya (Vijayanagara Empire)	• Praised the size and prosperity of Vijayanagara, comparing it to Rome. • Detailed the city's grand temples, markets, and royal complexes. • Described the military organization, with a focus on the feudal Nayankara system. • Noted the annual royal Durga festival and the grandeur of Vijayanagara's urban landscape.
Fernão Nuniz	Portugal	Vijayanagara	1532 CE	Krishnadevaraya (Vijayanagara Empire)	• Highlighted the prosperity and grand architecture of Vijayanagara, noting the king's palace and the fortified city.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
					• Described the involvement of women in the administration, including managing financial records and palace accounts. • Documented the extensive trade in diamonds and other precious goods.
Marco Polo	Italy	Malabar, Kerala	Late 13th Century	-	• Described the cultural practices of the Malabar region, including minimal clothing, hygiene norms, and the constant chewing of paan (betel leaf). • Noted that people bathed twice a day and used personal drinking vessels. • Observed unique practices among Jain monks, including extreme non-violence and living naked.
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	Vijayanagara	1500-1516/17 CE	Krishnadevaraya (Vijayanagara Empire)	• Praised Vijayanagara's fortified city, its grand gardens, and well-built streets. • Observed that the city was bustling with a diverse community of Hindus, Muslims, Christians, and Jews. • Described the importance of diamond mining in the region and the trade of spices and metals.

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Traveler	Country	Places Visited in India	Time Period	King/Empire	Remarks Made About India
Niccolò de' Conti	Italy	Vijayanagara, Cambay, Barkur	1420 CE	Devaraya I (Vijayanagara Empire)	• First to mention the fortifications of Vijayanagara and the military presence. • Described social customs such as polygamy, Sati, and extreme religious devotion, including human sacrifices. • Documented grand festivals like Deepavali, Navaratri, and weddings with traditional customs and rituals.
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	France	Mughal Empire, Agra, Golconda	17th Century	Shah Jahan (Mughal Empire)	• Detailed India's diamond trade and explored diamond mines under Mughal patronage. • His writings provide insights into the Mughal economy and trade, especially the Indian gem industry. • Famous for discovering the Blue Diamond, which he later sold to Louis XIV of France.

Foreign travellers provided **valuable historical documentation** but often had **biased perceptions** influenced by their own backgrounds. Their accounts remain significant historical sources, but they must be **analyzed critically**, considering their limitations and cultural perspectives.

Spread of Indian Culture

Indian traders ventured to **distant lands** in search of economic opportunities, traveling westward to **Rome** and eastward to **China**. By the **1st century BCE**, they reached regions like **Indonesia and Cambodia** in search of gold. The islands of **Java, Sumatra, and Malaya** were known as **Suvarnadvipa** (Golden Islands) due to their rich resources.

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These traders originated from major Indian cities such as **Kashi, Mathura, Ujjain, Prayag, and Pataliputra**, as well as coastal ports like **Mamallapuram, Tamralipti, Puri, and Kaveripattanam**. **Kalinga** had established trade ties with **Sri Lanka** during Emperor **Ashoka's reign**.

Wherever Indian traders traveled, they **established cultural connections**, functioning as **cultural ambassadors** and strengthening ties with foreign lands.

Buddhist Influence and Cultural Centers

Many **Buddhist monastic centers** were located along the west coast of India, including **Karle, Bhaja, Kanheri, Ajanta, and Ellora**. These institutions played a crucial role in cultural interactions.

Universities as Centers of Cultural Exchange

Indian universities attracted **students and scholars** from across Asia. **Nalanda University**, known for its **seven-story library**, was a hub for learning. Scholars from foreign lands, including China, frequently visited these centers.

Chinese traveler **Hiuen Tsang** documented his experiences at **Nalanda (in the east) and Valabhi (in the west)**. **Vikramashila University**, situated on the **right bank of the Ganges**, was another renowned institution. The Tibetan king once sent a delegation to invite its head to **promote common cultural and intellectual traditions**.

1. **Odantapuri University** in Bihar flourished under the **Pala rulers** and influenced **Tibetan scholars**, many of whom migrated and settled in Tibet.

Indian Scholars and Teachers Abroad

1. In **67 CE**, Indian scholars **Kashyapa Martanga** and **Dharmarakshita** traveled to China upon the Chinese emperor's invitation. They were followed by **scholars from Nalanda, Takshila, Vikramashila, and Odantapuri**.
2. **Acharya Kumarajiva** was invited by the **Chinese king** to **translate Sanskrit texts into Chinese**.
3. **Bodhidharma**, a specialist in **Yoga philosophy**, remains revered in **China and Japan**.
4. **Acharya Kamalasheel** of **Nalanda University** was invited to **Tibet**, where his embalmed body was later preserved in **Lhasa**.
5. **Jnanabhadra** and his two sons traveled to **Tibet to spread Buddhism**, leading to the establishment of a **monastery modeled on Odantapuri University**.
6. **Acharya Ateesha (Dipankara Shreejnana)** of **Vikramashila University** played a pivotal role in **strengthening Buddhism in Tibet** in the **11th century**.
7. **Thonmi Sambhota**, a Tibetan minister and a student of **Nalanda**, helped spread **Buddhism in Tibet**, leading to mass conversions, including the **Tibetan king's adoption of Buddhism as the state religion**.
8. **Kumarajiva**, an influential teacher, was active in **the 5th century**, contributing to **the transmission of Buddhist teachings**.

Spread of Indian Culture Through Other Modes

Some **Indian groups migrated as wanderers**, identifying themselves as **Romas** and speaking **Romani**. In Europe, they came to be known as **Gypsies**.

1. Their journey took them **westward through Pakistan and Afghanistan**, passing through **Iran, Iraq, Turkey, Persia, the Taurus Mountains, and Constantinople**.
2. Over a span of **four centuries**, they spread across **Greece, Bulgaria, the former Yugoslavia, Romania, Hungary, the Czech Republic, Slovakia, Russia, Poland, Switzerland, France, Sweden, Denmark, and England**.

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3. While they eventually lost **direct ties** to their homeland, they **preserved their language, customs, and traditional way of life**.

Spread of Indian Culture in Central Asia

From the **2nd century BCE**, India maintained extensive **trade and cultural connections** with **China, Central Asia, West Asia, and the Roman Empire**. Central Asia, bordered by **China, Russia, Tibet, India, and Afghanistan**, played a key role in cross-cultural exchanges.

Silk Route: A Conduit for Indian Culture

1. The **Silk Route**, initially used by traders, later became a pathway for **scholars, monks, and missionaries**.
2. The route facilitated **the exchange of goods, ideas, and religious philosophies**.
3. Indian cultural influence was deeply felt, especially in **Kuchi**, a thriving center along the Silk Route where the path **bifurcated** before converging at the **Dunhuang caves in China**.

Silk Route Divisions

1. **Northern Route**: Passed through **Samarkand, Kashgarh, Tumshuk, Aksu, Karashahr, Turfan, and Hami**.
2. **Southern Route**: Traversed **Yarkand, Khotan, Keriya, Cherchen, and Miran**.

Numerous **Chinese and Indian scholars** traveled along these routes, seeking wisdom and propagating **Buddhism**.

Influence of Indian Culture in Japan and Tibet

Japan

1. Indian Buddhist scriptures were introduced to Japan through **China** during the reign of **Prince Shotoku Taishi (7th century CE)**.
2. **Sanskrit syllables and mantras** were adopted, written in the script **'Shittan'**, which is believed to be derived from **Siddham**, the script associated with spiritual accomplishment (Siddhi).
3. Even today, **Japanese scholars study Sanskrit**, as it remains a key link between **India and Japan's Buddhist traditions**.

Tibet

1. The people of **Tibet** embraced **Buddhism**, influenced by Indian scholars and teachers.
2. Tibetan King **Naradeva** sent **Thonmi Sambhota and sixteen scholars** to study in **Magadha**. Later, **Thonmi Sambhota** traveled to **Kashmir** and developed the **Tibetan script**, modeled on the **Brahmi script**.
3. This script influenced the **writing systems of Mongolia and Manchuria**.
4. Tibetan scholars translated approximately **96,000 Sanskrit texts** into **Tibetan** between the **7th and 17th centuries**.

Indian Cultural Influence in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia

Sri Lanka

1. According to the **Ramayana**, Sri Lanka was historically linked to India.
2. **Emperor Ashoka** played a vital role in spreading **Buddhism**, sending his **son Mahendra** and **daughter Sanghamitra** to **Sri Lanka**, where they planted a **cutting of the Bodhi tree from Bodhgaya**.
3. King **Devanampiya Tissa** embraced Buddhism, leading to the **oral transmission of Buddhist scriptures** in Sri Lanka.
4. **Monasteries like Mahavihara and Abhayagiri** became centers of learning.

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5. **Pali became the literary language**, influencing Sri Lankan culture.
6. Indian **art, architecture, and literature** significantly shaped **Sri Lankan traditions**.
7. **Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa**, Sri Lanka's key Buddhist texts, document this period.
8. **Sigiriya Cave Paintings**, influenced by Indian styles, were created during **King Kashyap's reign (5th century CE)**.

Indian Cultural Influence in Southeast Asia

Myanmar (Burma)

1. Indian traders, **Brahmins, and artisans** began migrating to **Myanmar** in the **early centuries CE**.
2. **Pagan (Bagan)** became a major **Buddhist center (11th-13th century CE)**.
3. **King Aniruddha** built **Shwezegon Pagoda** and several other temples.
4. **Burmese Pali language developed**, incorporating **Buddhist and Hindu texts**.
5. **Brahmin astrologers, called Ponnas**, held prominent positions at the royal court, preserving Indian traditions.

Thailand

1. Indian cultural influence in Thailand dates back to the **1st century CE** through **traders, teachers, and missionaries**.
2. **Sanskrit names** were widely used for **Thai kingdoms and cities**, including:
   a. **Dwaravati, Shrivijaya, Sukhodaya, Ayutthiya (Ayodhya)**.
   b. Cities like **Kanchanaburi (Kanchanapuri), Rajburi (Rajpuri), and Lobpuri (Lavapuri)** retain their Sanskrit origins.
3. **Brahminical and Buddhist temples** were built from the **3rd-4th century CE** onwards.
4. **Ayutthiya (Ayodhya)**, a historical city, still houses **400 temples**, though many are now in ruins.

Cambodia

1. The **Champa (Annam) and Kambuja (Cambodia) kingdoms** were ruled by **Indian-origin kings** from the **1st-2nd century CE**.
2. **Kaundinya dynasty** ruled **Kambuja**, adopting Indian governance systems, law codes, and Brahminical traditions.
3. Sanskrit remained the **administrative language** until the **14th century**.
4. **Angkor Wat**, one of the greatest Hindu temples, was dedicated to **Vishnu** and modeled on **Mount Meru**.
5. **King Suryavarman** is depicted as an **incarnation of Vishnu**.
6. **Scenes from the Ramayana and Mahabharata**, including **Samudra Manthan (Churning of the Ocean)**, are carved on Angkor Wat's walls.
7. The **Baphuon temple (11th century CE)** features depictions of **Rama vs. Ravana, Shiva with Parvati, and Kamadeva's destruction**.

Vietnam (Champa Kingdom)

1. Indian traders and rulers played a key role in shaping **Vietnamese culture**.
2. Cities were named **Indrapura, Amaravati, Vijaya, Kauthara, and Panduranga**.
3. **Hindu and Buddhist temples** were constructed, housing images of **Shiva, Ganesha, Saraswati, Lakshmi, Buddha, and Avalokitesvara (Lokeswara)**.
4. Many temples still exist, though some are in ruins.

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Malaysia

1. **References to Malaysia** appear in ancient Indian texts like the **Ramayana, Jataka tales, Malindapanha, and Raghuvamsha**.
2. **Shaivism** was widely practiced, as evidenced by discoveries of **Shivalingas, Durga reliefs, and Nandi statues (7th-8th century CE)**.
3. **Brahmi script** was adapted for Malaysian inscriptions.
4. **Buddhist texts in ancient Tamil script** have been found at Kedah.
5. **Sanskrit remained an administrative language in Cambodia** until the **14th century CE**.

Indian Cultural Influence in Indonesia

Religious Architecture

1. The **largest Shiva temple in Indonesia, Prambanan**, is located on **Java Island**.
2. Built in the **9th century**, it consists of a **Shiva temple**, flanked by **Vishnu and Brahma temples**.
3. Opposite these temples are shrines for their **vahanas**:
   a. **Nandi (Bull) for Shiva**,
   b. **Garuda for Vishnu**,
   c. **Goose for Brahma**.
4. The complex includes **eight additional temples dedicated to Durga and Ganesha** and is surrounded by **240 smaller temples**.
5. **Ramayana and Krishna legends** are carved on its walls, making them the **oldest depictions of these stories in the world**.

Hindu Traditions in Bali

1. **Sanskrit hymns** are still recited during **pujas**.
2. Over **500 hymns and stotras** dedicated to **Shiva, Brahma, Durga, Ganesha, and Buddha** have been discovered in **Bali**.
3. **Bali remains the only region where Hinduism has flourished**, while the rest of Indonesia has adopted Islam.

Indian Literary Influence

1. Many ancient **palm-leaf manuscripts** have been found in **Java**, written in the **Kawi script**, which is derived from **Brahmi**.
2. Some texts contain **Sanskrit verses** followed by **Kawi translations**.
3. The **Bhuvanakosha**, a **Shaiva text with 525 Sanskrit shlokas**, is the **earliest and longest** religious text discovered.

Impact of Indian Culture

1. **Sanskrit inscriptions** found throughout **Southeast Asia** reveal strong Indian influences in **language, literature, religion, politics, and social structures**.
2. The **Varna system** existed in Bali but was **not as rigid as in India**, resembling the **Rig Vedic era**, where social divisions were **based on profession rather than birth**.
3. **Wayang (shadow puppetry)**, inspired by **Indian epics**, remains a popular art form in **Southeast Asia**.

Contacts Between India and the Arab Civilization

Trade and Cultural Exchange

1. India had strong **economic and cultural ties** with **West Asia** through **land and sea routes**.

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2. **Islamic civilization**, after its rise, deepened these connections.
3. Arab travelers such as **Sulaiman the Merchant, Al-Masudi, Ibn Hauqal, and Al-Idrisi** recorded India's flourishing trade and cultural influence.

Indian Contributions to Arab Civilization

Astronomy

1. Indian astronomical texts like:
   a. **Brahma-sphuta-siddhanta** (known in the Arab world as **Sindhin**),
   b. **Khandakhadyaka** (known as **Arkand**),
   c. Works of **Aryabhatta and Varahamihira** were translated into **Arabic** in **Baghdad** by scholars like **Alfazari** and **Yaqub ibn Tariq**.

Mathematics

1. The **Arabs referred to mathematics as 'Hindisa' (pertaining to India)**, recognizing India's contributions.
2. Indian numerals and the **decimal system, including zero**, revolutionized **Arab and later European mathematics**.
3. **Al-Kindi**, a renowned Arab scholar, spread **Indian mathematical concepts**.

Medicine

1. Indian medical texts, such as the **Sushruta Samhita**, were translated into Arabic under **Caliph Harun al-Rashid (786-809 CE)**.
2. **Mankh, an Indian scholar**, played a key role in these translations.

Other Fields

1. Indian knowledge in **astrology, logic, ethics, politics, veterinary science, and warfare** was incorporated into Arab scholarship.
2. Many **shipping terms in Arabic** have **Indian origins**, such as:
   a. **Hoori** (small boat) from **Hori**,
   b. **Banavi** from **Baniya (merchant)**,
   c. **Donij** from **Dongi (canoe)**.

India's Contact with Rome

Trade with the Roman Empire

1. **South India** had a **monopoly** over products **highly demanded in Rome**, such as:
   a. **Pepper, betel, spices, scents, pearls, diamonds, silk, muslin, and ivory**.
2. Trade was particularly active during the first **three centuries CE**.
3. **Roman coins** have been found in **Coimbatore and Madurai**, confirming trade relations.

Economic Impact

1. India enjoyed a **trade surplus**, bringing **gold inflows**, which **strengthened the Kushana Empire's economy**.
2. Tamil kings employed **Yavana (Western/Greek and Roman) guards** for their **battlefield tents and city gates**.

Major Trade Centers

1. **Kaveripattinam** became a **major foreign trade hub**, with:
   a. **Warehouses, customs offices, and merchant settlements**.
   b. **Markets selling textiles, spices, coral, sandalwood, pearls, and gold**.
   c. **Foreign traders from different backgrounds speaking multiple languages**.

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2. **Sopara and Broach (Barygaza)** were key **west coast ports**, while the **Coromandel Coast** facilitated trade with **Southeast Asia**.

Roman Demand for Indian Goods

1. **Pliny** recorded that **Indian pepper and ginger** were **sold at 100 times their original price** in Rome.
2. **Indian incense, spices, and aromatics** were in high demand.

Diplomatic Relations

1. A **Pandya king sent an ambassador** to **Roman Emperor Augustus (1st century BCE)**.
2. Roman envoys visited **Troy, Claudius, Trajan, and Antoninus Pius**.

Archaeological Evidence

1. At **Arikamedu (near Pondicherry)**, archaeologists have found:
    a. **Roman pottery (Arretine ware)** stamped with Italian inscriptions.
    b. **Fragments of Roman lamps**, confirming Roman settlements in India.

Andhra's Role in Trade

1. The **Andhra region** was actively involved in foreign trade.
2. **Paithan (Pratishthana)** exported:
    a. **Cotton, muslin, precious stones, and perfumes**.
3. The **Andhra king Yajnasri** issued **coins with ships engraved**, symbolizing maritime trade.

Ships and Foreign Trade

1. Trade played a **vital role in spreading Indian culture abroad**.
2. Ancient Indian ships were **capable of long voyages**, sailing across vast open seas.
3. Indian merchants, traders, and scholars established **permanent settlements in foreign lands**, leading to the **integration of Indian customs, traditions, and religious beliefs** into various civilizations.

India's **cultural and economic influence** extended across **Central Asia, the Arab world, Rome, and Southeast Asia**. **Trade, diplomacy, religious exchanges, and scholarly contributions** helped shape **astronomy, mathematics, medicine, philosophy, and literature** in these regions. Even today, remnants of **Indian language, traditions, and art forms** can be found across **Southeast Asia and beyond**.

Preservation and Protection of Indian Culture

1. Constitutional Provisions for Cultural Protection

Article 29: Protection of Interests of Minorities

1. Ensures that **minority communities** have the right to **preserve their distinct language, script, and culture**.
2. Eg. **Tribal communities in Chhattisgarh, Odisha, and the Northeast** receive **state assistance** to conserve their traditions.
3. No citizen shall be **denied assistance** from government institutions based on **religion, caste, language, or race**.

Article 49: Protection of National Heritage

1. The **State is responsible** for protecting **monuments, places, and objects of historical and artistic value**.
2. Eg. **Taj Mahal, Ajanta & Ellora Caves, Sanchi Stupa**, and **Konark Sun Temple** are under state protection to prevent **disfigurement, destruction, or illegal export**.

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Article 51A(f): Fundamental Duty of Citizens

1. Every **Indian citizen** must **value and preserve** India's **rich cultural heritage**.
2. Eg. **Public participation in heritage conservation efforts**, such as **cleaning drives at historical sites and promoting indigenous art forms**.

2. Key Acts for the Protection of Cultural Heritage

Indian Treasure Trove Act, 1878

1. Ensures that **archaeological and historical treasures found accidentally** are **declared and preserved**.
2. Eg. If **ancient gold coins or sculptures** are found in **Ujjain or Varanasi**, they must be reported to the **District Collector** to prevent smuggling.

Ancient Monuments Preservation Act, 1904 (Amended in 1932, 1958 & 2010)

1. Allows the **government to take control of historical monuments** to ensure their protection.
2. Eg. **Qutub Minar and Fatehpur Sikri** were brought under **state protection** to prevent illegal construction or damage.

The Antiquities (Export Control) Act, 1947

1. Prohibits the **export of valuable Indian artifacts and antiquities** without permission.
2. Eg. The **stolen idols from Tamil Nadu temples** were recovered under this law and brought back to India.

The Ancient and Historical Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1951

1. Declared **450+ monuments and archaeological sites** as **nationally important**.
2. Eg. **Harappan sites like Lothal and Dholavira** were added to protected lists.

Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972

1. Defines **antiquities** as objects that are at least **100 years old** and requires **registration and licensing** for selling or exporting them.
2. Eg. **Chola bronze statues and ancient manuscripts** cannot be exported without government approval.

Public Records Act, 1993

1. Ensures the **preservation of official documents, manuscripts, and records**.
2. Eg. **National Archives of India maintains Mughal-era farmans and colonial-era records** for historical research.

What are official languages under the Indian Constitution

1. Under **Article 343(1)**, the official language of the Union shall be Hindi in Devanagari script, while **Section 3 of the Official Language Act, 1963** talks about the continuance of the English language for official purposes of the Union and for use in Parliament.
2. However, The **Eighth Schedule of the** enumerates the official languages of the Republic of India.

What are the constitutional provisions pertaining to the official languages in India

Part XVII of the Constitution deals with the official language in **Articles 343 to 351**.

Articles	Provisions
1. Language of the Union	**1. Language of the Union**
Article 343(1)	The official language of the Union shall be Hindi in Devanagari script, with international form of Indian numerals.

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Articles	Provisions
Article 343(2)	For a period of fifteen years from the commencement of the Constitution, the English language shall continue to be used for all the official purposes of the Union for which it was being used immediately before the commencement of the constitution. However, they may authorize the use of the Hindi language in addition to the English language for any of the official purposes of the Union.
Article 344	**Official language commission** to be constituted by the President.
2. Regional Languages	**2. Regional Languages**
Article 345	The Legislature of a State can adopt any one or more of the languages in use in the State or Hindi as the language to be used for any of the official purposes of the State.
Article 346	Official language for communication between one State and another or between a State and the Union.
Article 347	The President can direct any language that shall also be officially recognized throughout that State or any part of the state.

Article 350	Language to be used in representations for redress of grievances.
Article 350A	Facilities for instruction in mother-tongue at primary stage
Article 350B(1)	Special Officer for linguistic minorities.
Article 351	Directive for development of the Hindi language

Implementation and Real-world Impact

Restoration and Protection Efforts

1. **ASI (Archaeological Survey of India)** plays a crucial role in **restoring and conserving monuments**.
2. Eg. The **renovation of the Kedarnath Temple complex** after the 2013 floods was undertaken under cultural preservation laws.

Crackdown on Smuggling and Illegal Export

1. The **Idol Wing of Tamil Nadu Police** has successfully **retrieved stolen temple idols from foreign museums**.
2. Eg. The **Nataraja idol from Chola Dynasty** was brought back from **Australia** under these laws.

Encouraging Cultural Conservation Initiatives

1. **Government-sponsored schemes** like the **HRIDAY (Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana)** and **PRASAD (Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Augmentation Drive)** aim to **revive and maintain heritage sites**.
2. Eg. The **revival of Kashi Vishwanath Corridor** to enhance the **spiritual and historical significance of Varanasi**.

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